

Advanced English (C1 Advanced)

The full teaching manual for a 13-week adult-education C1 class (26 classes × 90 minutes): lesson stages and timing, board plans, drilling and concept-check questions, pair-work, error correction, differentiation, and L1 watch-outs.

8 modules • 24 lessons

26 classes • 90 min • 13 weeks

Teacher copy • not for students

CONTENTS

MOD 1 Precision in Time & Modality

- 1.1 Advanced Aspect — The Future in Detail
- 1.2 Advanced Modality — Speculation & Nuance
- 1.3 The Subjunctive & Unreal Uses

MOD 2 Conditionals, Inversion & Emphasis

- 2.1 Advanced & Mixed Conditionals + Alternatives to "if"
- 2.2 Inversion for Emphasis & Style
- 2.3 Cleft Sentences & Fronting for Cohesion

MOD 3 Cohesion, Register & Style

- 3.1 Nominalization & Academic Style
- 3.2 Cohesion — Reference, Substitution & Ellipsis
- 3.3 Hedging, Vague Language & Diplomatic English

MOD 4 Lexical Range & Fluency

- 4.1 Phrasal Verbs & Multi-word Verbs
- 4.2 Collocation, Idiom & Connotation
- 4.3 Review Project — The Advanced Communicator

MOD 5 Structure & Advanced Vocabulary

- 5.1 Participle & Absolute Clauses
- 5.2 Advanced Prepositions & Prepositional Phrases
- 5.3 Academic & Formal Vocabulary

MOD 6 Reading & Writing at C1

- 6.1 Critical Reading — Evaluating Arguments & Bias
- 6.2 Academic & Argument Writing — Structuring an Essay
- 6.3 Professional & Formal Writing — Reports, Emails & Applications

MOD 7 Listening, Speaking & Delivery

- 7.1 Understanding Lectures & Talks — Following & Note-taking
- 7.2 Pronunciation & Intonation for Fluency
- 7.3 Seminar & Discussion Skills

MOD 8 Fluency, Craft & the Final Project

- 8.1 Fluency & Spontaneity — Speaking Strategies
- 8.2 Precision & Concision — Editing Your English
- 8.3 Review Project — A Position Paper & Its Defense

Module 1 — Precision in Time & Modality

Three classes that open the C1 level. Learners already control the future perfect and future continuous (B2 5.1), past deduction with *must / can't / might have* (B2 2.2), *wish, would rather, it's time* (B2 1.3) and *suggest that + base verb* (B2 3.3). The C1 work is **precision and register**: placing an event exactly on a timeline (*will have been running · was to have launched · is on the verge of*), setting certainty on a dial rather than a switch (*may well · could conceivably · is bound to · can't possibly have*), and using the subjunctive and other unreal forms to shape formal recommendations (*It is essential that he be present · Were we to delay...*). Class 1 also welcomes a new group and gives you a B2 diagnostic with a short speaking and writing sample.

3 lessons

Lessons 1.1–1.3

Classes C1–C3

Weeks 1–2

90 min per class

CEFR C1

HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

- One lesson block = one 90-minute class. Every class follows the same shape: **warmer** → **lead-in** → **Meaning / Form / Pronunciation** with concept-checking questions (CCQs) → **drill** (choral, then individual) → **controlled practice** (workbook) → **freer practice** (a demanding communicative or writing task) → **feedback** with delayed error correction → **homework**.
- The **stage plan** is your clock. Each one adds up to 90 minutes. The numbers in the Time column are minutes.
- Present from [slides/module-1-time-modality.html](#). Print [materials/module-1/classroom-materials.html](#) before C1. It holds the grammar flashcards, the welcome question cards, the **B2 diagnostic grid** and writing-sample rubric, the new identity cards, the **Project Briefing** cards and stakeholder question cards, the **Evidence Ladder** case files, clue cards and ladder sheet, the **Policy Memo** issue briefs, memo frame and peer-review checklist, the **Precision Board** game and all the listening scripts.
- The online lessons are the learners' **homework and review**. Each one has  Listen buttons, so learners can hear the model sentences again at home.
- Refinement, not a first meeting.** Nothing in this module is completely new to a learner who finished B2. Don't re-teach the future perfect or *must have*. Check them fast in each lead-in and spend the time on what is new at C1: the **future perfect continuous** used precisely, the **future in the past** and "on the brink" forms (*was to have, is to, is about to, is on the verge of*), the **fine grain of certainty** and the hidden jobs of *will* and *would*, and the **mandative subjunctive** as a register tool.

- ◆ **Feedback in three columns.** In every freer task, take notes in three columns: **range** (ambitious, precise language to praise and spread), **accuracy** (errors to fix) and **appropriacy** (right form, wrong register or tone: a future perfect in casual chat, "It is imperative that you pass the salt," *may as well* where *may well* was meant). At C1, appropriacy is often the most useful column. In the feedback stage, board 2 errors, 1 appropriacy point and 1–2 range examples, without names.
- ◆ **Dominant speakers.** C1 groups often contain one or two confident, fast speakers (frequently professionals used to leading meetings). All three freer tasks have built-in roles. Give the strongest speaker the job that needs listening: the **timeline keeper** in the briefing, the **ladder keeper** in the case files, the **second reader** in the peer review. Use a talking-turn token in group discussion. Say it kindly: "That's a sharp point, Daniel. Let's hear how the others read the evidence before we decide."
- ◆ **Stretching strong learners toward C2.** Each lesson has a stretch box. The C2 direction in this module is **economy and stance**: one exact form instead of a paraphrase (*was to prove decisive*), modal and adverb collocations that signal a precise stance (*may yet, could conceivably, in all likelihood*), and conscious register choices (why the subjunctive here and *should* there). Ask strong learners to *justify* each choice, not only produce the form.
- ◆ **American English is the classroom standard.** The online lessons use British spellings and words (*realised, enquiries, behaviour, analyse, apologise, organisation, neighbouring, centrepiece, postman, parcel*). Teach *realized, inquiries, behavior, analyze, apologize, organization, neighboring, centerpiece, mail carrier, package*. For the subjunctive this matters: the base form (*that he **be***) is the normal American choice; *that he **should** be* is the typical British one. Accept British forms when learners use them.
- ◆ Dashed boxes = lines to say out loud, CCQs and ICQs (instruction-checking questions). Green boxes = scripts you read aloud. **Amber** = watch-outs.

THE THROUGH-LINE

Place it → weigh it → shape it. In C1 learners **place** events precisely in time, delivering a project briefing that says what will be in progress, what will have been completed and what nearly happened (*By the launch we'll have been testing for six months · We were to have gone live in March · The supplier is on the verge of signing*). In C2 they **weigh** evidence, moving hypotheses up and down an evidence ladder as clues arrive (*It can't possibly have been the cleaners · The update may well be clashing with the backup · It's bound to happen again on Thursday*). In C3 they **shape** an outcome, writing and peer-reviewing a formal recommendation (*It is essential that every new hire be assigned a mentor · Were we to delay, ...*). Every class ends with a real product that the group hears or reads: a briefing, a verdict, a memo.

TRAUMA-INFORMED: PROJECTS, PUZZLES AND POLICIES, NOT PERSONAL FUTURES

The online lessons invite very personal content: "where you will be in five years," "a plan you once had that didn't unfold," "a decision facing you." For some adults (newcomers with uncertain status, refugees, people who have lost jobs or family), questions about the future and about plans that fell through can be painful. **In class, anchor every task in a project, an organization or an invented persona.** The Project Briefing uses invented projects; the Evidence Ladder uses invented workplace and community puzzles, **never crimes, accidents, illness or real people**; the Policy Memo uses invented workplaces. For every personal task, offer three choices out loud: **your real life, a new identity card, or something invented.** Positions in the memo task are **assigned**: learners argue the brief, not themselves. The online lesson 1.3 lists "God save the King / Queen" among the fixed subjunctive phrases: it is fine to recognize, but don't build tasks around it; use *be that as it may, suffice it to say, if need be, come what may* instead.

BEFORE THE MODULE

- ◆ **Placement.** Ideally, learners took the toolkit placement test ([../../instructor-toolkit/placement-test.html](#)) before C1. If not, the C1 welcome mingle and the 8-minute writing sample double as a **B2 diagnostic** (see Lesson 1.1). They won't replace a placement test, but they will show you who needs support and who is already pushing toward C2.
- ◆ Print the **welcome question cards** (Set B, one set per 16 learners), **one copy of the B2 diagnostic grid** for you on a clipboard, and one **writing-sample sheet** per learner (it is also in the workbook, Lesson 1.1). Print name tents (folded paper is fine).
- ◆ Print the **flashcards** (Set A, one set for the board): the future-form cards and the picture cards (C1), the certainty-dial cards (C2) and the subjunctive trigger cards, color-coded by verb / adjective / noun (C3).
- ◆ For C1: the **Project Briefing** cards (Set D, 6 projects) and one set of **stakeholder question cards** per group. For C2: the **Evidence Ladder** case files (Set E, 4 cases; each has a case summary, 6 clue cards in three rounds and a ladder sheet). Cut the clue cards and clip each round together. For C3: the **Policy Memo** issue briefs (Set F, 5 briefs), one memo frame per group and one **peer-review checklist** per learner.
- ◆ Print the **new identity cards** (Set C) and keep them on a side table where anyone can take one without asking.
- ◆ The **Precision Board** game (Set G, 1 board per group of 3–4, a die, counters) is for early finishers in C3 and for the C4 warmer.

MODULE AT A GLANCE

LESSON	CLASS	FOCUS	LEARNERS CAN...
1.1	C1 • wk 1	Welcome + B2 diagnostic (speaking mingle + 8-minute writing sample: range, accuracy, appropriacy); future continuous for in-progress	deliver a two-minute project briefing to "stakeholders" that places every milestone precisely in

LESSON	CLASS	FOCUS	LEARNERS CAN...
		and tactful inquiries; future perfect vs future perfect continuous ; the future in the past (<i>was going to, would, was about to, was to have</i>); formal and imminent futures: <i>be to, be about to, be on the verge of, be due to, be set to</i>	time, and answer tactful questions about it
1.2	C2 · wk 1	Certainty as a dial: <i>can't possibly have · can't · could conceivably · might just · might / could · may / might / could well · should · is bound to · must</i> ; may well vs may as well ; the hidden jobs of will / won't (character, refusal, present deduction) and would (habit, refusal, criticism, politeness); continuous and perfect modals for present and past speculation	analyze an invented case file as clues arrive, move hypotheses up and down an evidence ladder, and deliver a calibrated verdict with a softened recommendation
1.3	C3 · wk 2	The mandative subjunctive after verbs, adjectives and nouns (negative <i>that he not...</i> , passive <i>that it be done</i>); subjunctive vs <i>should</i> vs indicative as register choices; the unreal were (<i>If I were · Were we to · I wish it were</i>); suppose / supposing, it's high time, would rather; as if / as though ; fixed subjunctive phrases	write a formal policy memo or meeting recommendation on a workplace issue with at least three mandative triggers and two unreal forms, then peer-review a partner's memo for accuracy, range and appropriacy

1.1 · C1

Welcome to C1 · Advanced Aspect — The Future in Detail

90 min

◆ OBJECTIVES — LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ get to know the group and show the teacher their B2 range, accuracy and sense of register in a friendly mingle and a short piece of writing
- ◆ place an event exactly relative to a future point: **in progress** (*will be doing*), **completed by** (*will have done*), **ongoing up to** (*will have been doing*), anchored with *by, by then, by the time*
- ◆ use the future continuous as a **tactful inquiry** (*Will you be needing the room?*) and as a neutral "in the course of things" future (*I'll be seeing her anyway*)
- ◆ describe a future seen from the past with **was going to, would, was about to, was to / was to have + pp**
- ◆ choose the precise formal or imminent future: **be to** (official arrangement, instruction, "if we are to..."), **be about to, be on the verge / point of, be due to, be set to**

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 1.1 (Welcome box, writing sample, New words, Grammar box, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, Project Briefing planner)
- ◆ Slides 1–8 · name tents · **Welcome question cards** (Set B) · **B2 diagnostic grid** + writing-sample rubric (your copies) · future-form flashcards and picture cards (Set A) · **Project Briefing** cards + stakeholder question cards (Set D) · New identity cards (Set C)
- ◆ Listening scripts 1.1-A (Harbor Point stand-up) and 1.1-B (dictation)

BOARD PLAN

Left: a timeline. NOW ——— ★ **FIXED POINT** (*by the launch / by June / this time next week*) ———. At ★: **will be doing** (in progress). Before ★ with an arrow ending at it: **will have done** (completed) · **will have been doing** (duration up to ★). Rule under it: *By the time we launch (present!), we'll have...*

Center: the past looking forward. A second timeline, THEN ——— NOW. From THEN, an arrow forward: **was going to** (plan) · **would** (narrative) · **was about to** (imminent) · **was to have + pp** (planned, didn't happen). Model: "We **were to have gone** live in March, but the supplier **was about to** go out of business."

Right: formal and imminent. *The mayor **is to** open the site on May 12.* (official) · *You **are to** report to reception.* (instruction) · *If we **are to** meet the deadline, ...* (condition) · *We're **about to** sign.* (any minute; no time phrase) · *on the **verge** of signing · **due to** arrive at 3* (timetable) · ***set to** expand* (news). Tact: *Will you **be using** the car?*

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Welcome & name tents	6	T-S	Greet each person at the door. Learners write the name they want to be called on a name tent (a new-identity name is fine). Learn to say every name correctly , and ask once how the person prefers it said. Introduce yourself in a way that previews the lesson: "I'm _____. By the end of this term, I'll have been teaching adults for _____ years, and I was going to become an engineer, until I taught my first class."
Welcome mingle = B2 diagnostic (speaking)	15	S-S (mingle)	Slide 3. Each learner takes four welcome question cards , one of each color (LOOK BACK · WHAT IF · TAKE A POSITION · SAY IT TWO WAYS). They find a partner, ask one question and one follow-up , answer in a long turn (about a minute), then swap one card and find a new partner (4 rounds, about 3 min each). You walk with the diagnostic grid (see "Running the diagnostic" below). Last 2 minutes: 2-3 learners report something interesting a partner said. ICQs first.
Writing sample	8	S	Workbook 1.1, "First-day writing sample." Learners choose prompt A (a short update email to a manager) or B (a short paragraph: "a change that would improve a workplace or school I know"), 80-120 words, no phones or dictionaries . Say: "This isn't a test. It helps me plan your course." Collect the pages at the end of class (tear-out) or photograph them.
About this course	3	T-S	Slide 2. 26 classes, 2 a week, 13 weeks; the workbook; the online course is homework (show it and tap a 📶 button). C1 = precision, nuance and register : saying familiar things more exactly, and choosing how formal to be. Module 1 = place it, weigh it, shape it.
Lead-in: three futures	4	T-S	Board three sentences: "This time next week, I'll be lying on a beach." · "By this time next week, I'll have finished my exams." · "By June, I'll have been working here for a decade." Ask: "Same topic, the future. What's different?" (in progress / completed /

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			how long). Elicit the three names; learners met them at B2.
Grammar: placing the future	13	T-S → S-S	Slides 4–7. (1) The timeline (board, left): the three futures, the <i>by the time</i> + present rule, stative verbs. (2) The future continuous as tact (slide 5): contrast "Will you use the car tonight?" with "Will you be using...?" (3) The past looking forward (board, center; slide 7). (4) Formal and imminent futures (board, right): <i>be to</i> , <i>about to</i> , <i>on the verge of</i> , <i>due to</i> , <i>set to</i> . CCQs throughout (below). Pairs then label the 5 sentences on slide 7 with the flashcards (1 min).
Drill	5	T-S → S	See Drill script: the "fixed point" chain, the tact transformation and the "nearly happened" drill. Choral, then individuals, then open pairs.
Listening: the Monday stand-up	5	T-S → S	Workbook Ex 1. Read Script 1.1-A once for gist ("Is the project on time? What's the big news?"), then again: learners write the seven future forms. Pairs compare. Ask: "Why <i>will have been running</i> and not <i>will have run</i> ?"
Controlled practice	6	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 2–4 alone, then check in pairs. Board-check only the items pairs disagree on (usually Ex 4, the choice of form). Ex 5 goes to homework.
Freer: Project Briefing	16	S-S (groups) → T-S	Slide 8. Groups of 3 get a Project Briefing card (an invented project, a timeline and a fixed "steering meeting" date). (1) Plan (5 min) on the workbook planner: one sentence per row. (2) Brief (8 min) : each group briefs another group (the "stakeholders") in 2 minutes, then takes 2 minutes of questions; stakeholders ask from their stakeholder question cards , which force the tactful future continuous (<i>Will you be needing...?</i>). Swap. (3) Class (3 min) : one group briefs the whole class. ICQs first.
Feedback	4	T-S	Three columns on the board (no names). Accuracy: "By the time we will open, we'll finish." · "We'll have been knowing the client for years." Appropriacy: "Will you use the lab tomorrow?" to a senior

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			colleague (fine, but blunt: upgrade it). Range: one briefing sentence to praise (" <i>We were to have gone live in March</i> ").
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Show online lesson 1.1 on screen; point at a  button. Set the homework (below). Learners tick the "I can..." box. Collect the writing samples.
Total	90		6 + 15 + 8 + 3 + 4 + 13 + 5 + 5 + 6 + 16 + 4 + 5

IF YOU RUN LONG

The welcome mingle is the most important part of C1: the group needs it, and you need the diagnostic. Don't cut it. If time is short, the writing sample becomes homework (same prompt, same 120-word limit, "no dictionary, 10 minutes, please"), Ex 4 moves to the C2 warmer, and the class-wide briefing in the freer task is dropped. Keep at least 12 minutes for the Project Briefing.

◆ RUNNING THE DIAGNOSTIC – WHAT TO LISTEN FOR

The mingle is a friendly first conversation, not an exam. Learners must never feel watched. Hold the grid on a clipboard, stand near a pair for 30–60 seconds, and join in sometimes ("And what would you have done if...?"). Mark each learner ✓ (confident and accurate) · ~ (communicates well, some errors or gaps) · ✗ (avoids or can't produce it yet) in four columns:

- ◆ **RANGE:** Does the learner reach beyond safe B1 language? Listen for the narrative tenses including *had been* + *-ing* (LOOK BACK cards), third and mixed conditionals (WHAT IF), passives and reporting verbs, linkers such as *whereas*, *despite*, *as a result*, and precise vocabulary and collocation.
- ◆ **ACCURACY:** Are errors systematic or slips the learner self-corrects? Typical B2 fossils: "If I would have known," "I am agree," "suggested me to," "When I arrived, the meeting already started," missing articles, "people is."
- ◆ **APPROPRIACY** (the SAY IT TWO WAYS cards): Does the learner *shift register* between a friend and a manager? Softening (*I was wondering if...*, *Would it be possible...*), hedging, indirect questions, tone. Many strong B2 speakers are accurate but register-flat: that is exactly what C1 teaches.
- ◆ **FLUENCY & INTERACTION:** long turns (a minute or more), follow-up questions, turn-taking, paraphrasing around a missing word, recovering from a false start.

The writing sample. Score it with the four-row rubric in the materials (Set B): **task & register**, **range**, **accuracy**, **organization & cohesion**, 0–3 each. As a rough guide: 9–12 = comfortable at C1 (give Stretch tasks); 6–8 = right level, typical C1 entry profile; 5 or less **and** mostly ✗ in the speaking grid = check the placement privately (the toolkit's oral interview takes 5 minutes); the learner may do better in the B2 course or with extra support from Day 1. A learner with strong speaking and a weak sample (or the reverse) is common; note it and target the weaker skill in feedback.

What to do with the results. Write one short, private, encouraging note to each learner by C3: one strength and one focus ("You shift register naturally. Focus: articles with abstract nouns."). **Never share the grid with learners.** Keep it; compare it with Progress Test 1 in C13.

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE WELCOME MINGLE

SAY: *How many cards do you take? (Four, one of each color.) · How long is your answer: one sentence? (No, about a minute.) · What do you ask after the answer? (A follow-up question.) · After each conversation, what do you do? (Swap one card, find a new partner.) · Do you have to answer about your real life? (No. A new identity card, something invented, or "Pass.") · On the TAKE A POSITION card, must you give your real opinion? (No, you can argue the side printed on the card.)*

◆ MEANING · FORM · PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: three vantage points. Stand at a future moment and look: what is *happening* then (future continuous), what is *finished* by then (future perfect), how *long* something has been going on by then (future perfect continuous).

SAY: *"This time tomorrow, I'll be flying over the Atlantic." At that moment, is the flight finished? (No, in progress.) · "By the end of the year, we'll have completed the merger." Is the merger finished at the end of the year? (Yes.) Exactly when did it finish? (We don't know: some time before.) · "In August, they'll have been running the business for twenty years." Will they stop in August? (No, probably not.) What does the sentence measure? (The duration up to August.)*

Meaning: the future continuous as tact.

SAY: *"Will you use the car tonight?" / "Will you be using the car tonight?" Which one could sound like a request or a challenge? (The first.) Which just asks about the plan? (The second.) Why is it more polite? (No pressure to decide now: it treats the plan as already there.) · "I'll be seeing Tom tomorrow anyway." Did I plan the meeting to tell Tom something? (No, it's happening anyway.)*

Meaning: the future in the past.

SAY: *"We were going to fly, but the strike changed everything." Did we fly? (No.) Was it a plan? (Yes, an earlier plan.) · "She left in 2001; she would never return." Is this conditional? (No.) Is it a prediction or a fact, from today's point of view? (A fact: we know now.) · "The launch was to have taken place in March." Did it take place in March? (No: was to have + pp = planned, didn't happen.)*

Meaning: formal and imminent futures.

SAY: *"The mayor is to open the new library on May 12." Who arranged it? (Officials: it's a formal arrangement.) Where would you read this? (A press release, the news.) · "You are to report to reception at nine." Is this a suggestion? (No, an instruction.) · "If we are to meet the deadline, we need two more testers." Is the deadline certain? (No: if we want to / if we're going to meet it.) · "We're about to sign."*

Tomorrow? (No, very soon: minutes, hours.) Can I say "We're about to sign next week"? (No: no future time phrase with about to.) · "They're on the verge of signing." Close to it? (Yes, very close.) · "The train is due to arrive at 3:15." Whose plan? (The timetable's.)

Form.

Future continuous	will be + -ing	This time tomorrow I'll be flying . · Will you be joining us?
Future perfect	will have + past participle	By 2030 we'll have opened ten offices.
Future perfect continuous	will have been + -ing	By June I'll have been working here for a decade.
Time clause	by the time / before / when + present	By the time you arrive , we'll have finished.
Future in the past	was going to · would · was about to · was to (have + pp)	The decision was to have far-reaching consequences. · The launch was to have taken place in March.
Formal / imminent	be to · be about to · be on the verge of + -ing · be due to · be set to	The CEO is to visit on Friday. · The firm is set to expand.

Pronunciation. In fast speech the auxiliaries shrink and the main verb carries the stress: "I'll be **flying**" /aɪl bi 'flaɪɪŋ/ · "we'll have **finished**" /wi:l əv 'fɪnɪʃt/ (*have* is /əv/: never write "will of") · "I'll've been **working**" /aɪləv bɪn 'wɜːrkɪŋ/, with *been* weak /bɪn/. In a briefing, don't over-reduce: keep a steady pace and stress the time anchor and the result: "By the **launch** | we'll have **tested** every **screen**." Tactful questions have a gentle rise: "Will you be **needing** the room ↗?"

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- The fixed-point chain** (point at ★ on the board): T: "The launch is June 1. The testing: in progress then?" → S: "On June 1 we'll be testing." T: "The design: finished before?" → S: "By June 1 we'll have finished the design." T: "The team started in January. How long?" → S: "By June 1 the team will have been working on it for five months." Choral, then individuals.
- Make it tactful:** T: "Will you use the projector?" → S: "Will you be using the projector?" T: "Will you need a parking space?" → S: "Will you be needing a parking space?" T: "Will you stay for lunch?" → S: "Will you be staying for lunch?"
- Nearly happened:** T: "Plan: fly. Result: the strike." → S: "We were going to fly, but the strike changed everything." T: "Official plan: launch in March. Didn't happen." → S: "The launch was to have taken place in March." T: "Sign the contract. Seconds away. Then the phone rang." → S: "I was about to sign the contract when the phone rang."

- 4 **Headline to briefing:** T reads a headline, S expands it: T: "MAYOR TO OPEN LIBRARY MAY 12" → S: "The mayor is to open the library on May 12." T: "TECH FIRM SET TO DOUBLE STAFF" → S: "The firm is set to double its staff." T: "TALKS ON VERGE OF DEAL" → S: "The two sides are on the verge of reaching a deal."
- 5 **Open pairs → closed pairs:** S1 names a fixed point and a project (real or invented): "The end of this course." S2 gives three sentences: in progress, completed, duration. Then all pairs, 1 minute.

◆ PROJECT BRIEFING – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ Groups of 3. Each group gets one **Project Briefing** card: an invented project (a library app, a clinic move, a warehouse sorting system, a community solar garden, a college enrollment system, a bakery's second location), today's date, a fixed "steering meeting" date, and a timeline with finished, ongoing, delayed and imminent items.
- ◆ **Plan (5 min):** on the workbook planner, the group writes one sentence per row: **in progress** at the meeting (*will be doing*), **completed** by then (*will have done*), **duration** (*will have been doing ... for*), **a plan that changed** (*was going to / was to have*), **imminent** (*about to / on the verge of / due to*), **a formal arrangement** (*is to*) and **a condition** (*If we are to..., we need...*).
- ◆ **Brief (8 min):** pair two groups. Group 1 briefs Group 2 in **2 minutes** (everyone speaks); Group 2 are the stakeholders and ask 2–3 questions from their **stakeholder question cards** (each card forces a tactful future continuous: "Will you be needing extra staff in June?"). Swap roles.
- ◆ **Roles:** the **project lead** opens and closes ("Thanks for your time. To sum up..."); the **timeline keeper** holds the card and checks every time phrase (*by the time* + present!) but speaks only for the one condition sentence; the **risks officer** covers delays and "on the brink" items. Give the timeline keeper job to a dominant speaker.
- ◆ **Class (3 min):** one group briefs the whole class. The class listens for the most precise sentence and the most tactful question.
- ◆ Everything is invented. If a learner wants to brief a real project from their job, that's fine, but nobody has to.

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE PROJECT BRIEFING

SAY: *Is this project real? (No, invented.) · How long is the briefing? (Two minutes.) · Who speaks? (Everyone in the group.) · The stakeholders' questions: "Will you use..." or "Will you be using..."? (Will you be using.) · After "by the time," present or future? (Present.) · Does the timeline keeper talk a lot? (No, checks the times and says one sentence.)*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

At C1, "literacy support" usually means a learner whose speaking is strong but whose reading and writing are slower (often a learner who learned English at work, or whose first script is not Latin). Give the planner with sentence starters already written ("At the steering meeting we'll be..." · "By then we'll have..." · "We were going to..., but..."). Let the learner **say** each sentence to a partner before writing it. In the writing sample, accept a shorter text (50–70 words) and score it on what is there. Target: three precise future forms, spoken clearly in the briefing.

STRETCH (TOWARD C2)

Add passive and modal futures: *By then the site **will have been handed over** · The report **should have been completed** by Friday · The work **is to be carried out** overnight.* Use narrative *would* and *was to* for a biographical sweep: "The prototype **was to prove** decisive." In the briefing, ask the learner to cut one sentence by replacing a paraphrase with a single precise form ("It is very likely that they will soon sign" → "They're on the verge of signing"). Ask: "Where is a future perfect over-precise? Change one back to *will* and justify it."

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **Future in the time clause:** "By the time I will finish..." · "When the client will arrive...". French (*quand je finirai*), Italian, Portuguese (future subjunctive *quando eu terminar*), Russian and Polish all mark the future in the time clause. Point at the *by the time* clause on the board: "present here, future there."
- ◆ **Present for the future:** German, Dutch and the Scandinavian languages use the present with a time phrase ("By June I work here ten years"), and so avoid the future perfect continuous. Many learners also use **since** for a duration ("for ten years" → "since ten years": French *depuis*, Spanish *desde hace*, German *seit*).
- ◆ **Dropping the auxiliaries:** "By June I will been working..." · "we will finished." Chinese, Vietnamese, Thai and Indonesian speakers mark time with adverbs, not verb forms, and may drop *have* or *been*. Color *will* · *have* · *been* differently on the board.
- ◆ **be to ≠ have to:** learners read "You are to report at nine" as possibility or confuse it with "You have to." Arabic, Turkish and Hindi/Urdu speakers sometimes translate a native "should / must" structure here. CCQ: "Is it an instruction?" (Yes: formal, from someone in charge.)
- ◆ **about to + a time phrase:** "We're about to sign next month." Common for everyone, especially where the L1 equivalent (Spanish *estar a punto de*, French *être sur le point de*) is more flexible. Keep *about to* for "any moment now."
- ◆ **Stative verbs in the continuous:** "will have been knowing / owning / believing." Common with Hindi/Urdu, Arabic and some African-language speakers, whose continuous forms work with more verbs.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 1.1: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-c1/lesson_01.html. Listen to the five model sentences with 🎧 and say them back; do Exercises 1–2, the Quick Quiz and the "Projection" project (for a project, a team or an invented persona rather than your personal future, if you prefer; record it on a phone if possible). Workbook 1.1: Ex 5 (a future-point paragraph), "My new words" and the journal (three sentences about one fixed future point in the three aspects, each with a one-line note on *why* that aspect).

◆ CHECK – SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **C** will have been waiting · Q2 **B** were going to · Q3 (new) **A** The director is to visit the site on Friday. Stand-up (Ex 1): 1 were going to reopen · 2 will be working · 3 will have finished · 4 will have been running · 5 are about to sign · 6 is to visit · 7 will ... be needing.

◆ OBJECTIVES — LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ set certainty on a dial: **can't possibly have** · **can't** · **could conceivably** · **might just** · **might / may / could** · **may / might / could well** · **should** (expectation) · **is bound to** · **must**
- ◆ tell **may well** (it's quite likely) from **may / might as well** (there's no better option)
- ◆ recognize and use the hidden jobs of **will / won't** (typical behavior, refusal, present deduction: *That'll be the courier*) and **would** (past habit, past refusal, criticism, politeness)
- ◆ speculate about **now** with *modal + be + -ing* and about **the past** with *modal + have + pp* and *modal + have been + -ing*
- ◆ analyze a case as evidence arrives and give a calibrated verdict with a softened recommendation

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 1.2 (New words, Grammar box, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, Evidence Ladder sheet and verdict frame)
- ◆ Slides 9–13 · Certainty-dial flashcards (Set A) · **Evidence Ladder** case files (Set E: 4 cases × summary + 6 clue cards in 3 rounds + ladder sheet) · New identity cards
- ◆ Listening scripts 1.2-A (The Tuesday slump) and 1.2-B (dictation)

BOARD PLAN

Left: the dial (a vertical ladder, top = certain). **must** · **is bound to** · **should** (expected) · **may / might / could well** · **might / may / could** · **might just** · **could conceivably** · **can't** · **can't possibly**. Next to it: **now** → **must be** joking / **must be** waiting · **past** → **must have** left · **must have been** waiting.

Center: false twins. *The train **may well** be late.* = probably → probability · *The train's late, so we **may as well** get a coffee.* = no reason not to → decision. Test: "it's probably going to..." or "we might as well just..."?

Right: will & would at work. *That'll be the courier.* (deduction, now) · *He **won't** listen.* (refusal) · *She'll sit there for hours.* (typical) · *We'd drive to the coast every summer.* (past habit, actions only) · *The lock **wouldn't** turn.* (past refusal) · *You **would** say that!* (criticism) · *I'd suggest...* (politeness)

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: stakeholder questions	8	S-S	Review C1 (1.1). Pairs: A names a fixed point in an invented project ("the grand opening, Sept 1"); B asks two tactful future-continuous questions; A

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			answers with a future perfect and a future perfect continuous. Swap. Then 3 learners share their most precise sentence. Return the writing samples if you've marked them (a short private note only, no scores).
Lead-in: the dark office	5	T-S	Board: "The office is dark. Priya's coat is gone. Her laptop is still on her desk." Ask: "Where's Priya?" Collect answers and write each one exactly as said. Then: "Who's sure? Who's guessing? How do we <i>show</i> how sure we are?" Circle the modals learners used; most will be <i>must</i> , <i>maybe</i> , <i>might</i> . "Today: twelve shades between <i>must</i> and <i>maybe</i> ."
Grammar: the dial	13	T-S → S-S	Slides 9–10. Build the ladder on the board (left) with the dial flashcards: learners place each card, you adjust. Focus on the C1 additions: <i>may / could well</i> , <i>could conceivably</i> , <i>might just</i> , <i>is bound to</i> , <i>can't possibly</i> , and <i>should</i> for expectation. Then the false twins (center). Then now vs past (<i>must be waiting / must have been waiting</i>). CCQs (below). Pairs rank the four sentences in workbook Ex 2a (1 min).
Will & would at work	10	T-S → S-S	Slide 11. Board (right). Say each example with its natural intonation: flat and confident for "That'll be the courier," exasperated with stress on will / would for "She will keep interrupting! · You would say that." Learners guess the job from the tone before you name it. Habitual <i>would</i> vs <i>used to</i> (actions only). Then slide 12, the Priya dialogue, read in pairs: learners underline each modal and name its job.
Drill	6	T-S → S	See Drill script: dial up / dial down, now or past, and "that'll be...".
Listening: the Tuesday slump	6	T-S → S	Workbook Ex 1. Read Script 1.2-A (two voices) once for gist ("What do they think the reason is? What will they do?"), then again: learners write the eight modal expressions and mark each one on the dial. Pairs compare.

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Controlled practice	9	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 2-5 alone (rank, choose the nuance, name the job, now or past), then pairs. Board-check only disagreements (usually Ex 4: politeness vs conditional <i>would</i> , accept both with a reason).
Freer: The Evidence Ladder	22	S-S (groups) → T-S	Slide 13. Groups of 4 get a case file (an invented workplace or community puzzle) and a ladder sheet . Round 1 (5 min) : read the case summary and clues 1-2; list at least four explanations and place each on the ladder, saying it with the matching expression ("The courier could conceivably be..."). Round 2 (4 min) : the evidence reader reveals clues 3-4; the group moves hypotheses up or down, saying why. Round 3 (4 min) : clues 5-6 (one is a twist). Verdict (5 min) : each group gives a 90-second verdict to the class: what must / can't possibly have happened, what may well be true, what is bound to happen next, and a softened recommendation (<i>I'd suggest...</i> · <i>We might as well...</i>). Reveal (4 min) : you read the "most likely explanation" from the answer key; groups say how close they were. ICQs first.
Feedback	6	T-S	Three columns (no names). Accuracy: "He must have forget the password." · "They can't be sent it yesterday." · "It may as well be the backup" (meaning likely). Appropriacy: "It is definitely the IT guy" (over-certain, and a person's reputation: hedge it). Range: praise one precise stance ("The update could conceivably be the cause, but the backup may well be...").
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Show online lesson 1.2 and a  button. Set the homework (below). Learners tick "I can...".
Total	90		8 + 5 + 13 + 10 + 6 + 6 + 9 + 22 + 6 + 5

◆ MEANING · FORM · PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: certainty as a dial. Each position is a statement about how likely the speaker thinks something is, and how much credibility they are staking on it. *Well* after *may* / *might* / *could* pushes a bare possibility toward probability. *Conceivably* pushes it down: "it's possible, but only just, and I'm being fair to the idea." *Bound to* is a confident prediction from what we know, almost *must* for the future.

SAY: "She might be exhausted." / "She may well be exhausted." Which speaker leans more toward "yes"? (The second.) Is either speaker certain? (No.) · "It could conceivably be the backup." Does the speaker think it's likely? (No, just not impossible.) Why say it? (To be fair; to keep the idea on the table.) · "Prices are bound to rise." Past or future? (Future.) How sure? (Very: a confident prediction.) · "They can't possibly have known." How sure is the speaker that they didn't know? (Completely: it's ruled out.)

Meaning: may well vs may as well.

SAY: "The train may well be late." Is this about probability or a decision? (Probability: it's quite likely.) · "The train's late, so we may as well get a coffee." Is the coffee likely? (Not the point: it's a decision.) Why get a coffee? (There's no better option; no reason not to.) Is there a feeling in may as well? (Yes, a little shrug, resignation.)

Meaning: should for expectation.

SAY: "They left at noon, so they should be home by now." Is this advice? (No, an expectation.) Is the speaker sure? (Fairly, "if all goes normally.") Compare "They must be home by now." Which one is stronger? (must: the evidence forces it.)

Meaning: will and would at work.

SAY: "There's the doorbell. That'll be the courier." Is this about the future? (No, now: a confident guess.) · "The car won't start." Does the car refuse? (It persistently fails: we talk about it as if it refuses.) · "Every summer we'd drive to the coast." Once or many times? (Many: a past habit.) Can I say "When I was young, I'd have a bike"? (No: have a bike is a state: I used to have.) · "You would say that!" Is it a compliment? (No: typical of you, a light criticism.) · "I'd suggest a short break." Is there a condition? (Not really: it's softening, politeness.)

Meaning: now or past.

SAY: "He must be joking." When? (Now.) · "He must have been joking." When? (Earlier.) · "She must have been waiting for hours." Is she still waiting? (Probably not: past, and long.) · "They can't have left already." Are we sure they're still here? (Yes, we think so: it's ruled out.)

Form.

Present speculation	modal + be / modal + be + -ing	She may well be tired. · He must be joking.
Past speculation	modal + have + pp	They can't possibly have known.

Past, in progress	modal + have been + -ing	She could have been planning this all week.
Adverb boosters	may / might / could + well · could + conceivably · might + just · can't + possibly	This might just work.
bound to	be bound to + base verb	It's bound to happen again.
may / might as well	+ base verb (a decision)	We might as well walk.

Pronunciation. Stress carries the meaning. In *may well* the stress falls on **well**; in *may as well* it falls on the main verb that follows ("we may as well **walk**"), and *as* is a weak /əz/. Perfect modals reduce heavily: "must have been" /'mʌstəv bi:n/, "can't have" /'kænt əv/ (never "must of"). Characteristic *will / would* is **stressed** and not contracted when it's critical: "She **will** keep interrupting!" · "You **would** say that." Deduction *'ll* is contracted and light: "That'll be the courier" /'ðætəl bi/.

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 Dial up, dial down** (point at a rung): T: "She's exhausted. Might." → S: "She might be exhausted." T: "Lower: only just possible." → S: "She could conceivably be exhausted." T: "Higher: quite likely." → S: "She may well be exhausted." T: "Top." → S: "She must be exhausted." T: "Bottom, past, 'she slept twelve hours!'" → S: "She can't possibly be exhausted: she slept twelve hours."
- 2 Now or past?** T: "He's joking. Sure. Now." → S: "He must be joking." T: "He was joking. Sure. Earlier." → S: "He must have been joking." T: "She waited for hours. Sure." → S: "She must have been waiting for hours." T: "They knew. Impossible." → S: "They can't have known."
- 3 That'll be...** T rings a bell / knocks on the table. → S: "That'll be the courier." T: (a phone buzzes) → S: "That'll be my manager." T: "She's just flown in from Tokyo." → S: "She'll be tired."
- 4 Twins:** T: "It's likely to rain." → S: "It may well rain." T: "The bus has gone. No better option: walk." → S: "We may as well walk."
- 5 Open pairs → closed pairs:** S1 describes a small invented mystery ("The meeting room is booked every Friday, but nobody's ever in it."). S2 gives three explanations at three points on the dial. Then all pairs, 1 minute.

◆ THE EVIDENCE LADDER – HOW TO RUN IT

- Groups of 4. Each group gets **one case file**: a case summary card, 6 clue cards clipped in three rounds (1–2, 3–4, 5–6), and a **ladder sheet** (rungs from *can't possibly* at the bottom to *must / is bound to* at the top). Cases: **1** The Vanishing Deliveries (an office building) · **2** The 3 a.m. Alert (a server) · **3** The Empty Training Room (a community center) · **4** The Missing Saturday Volunteers (a community garden). Two groups can have the same case.

- ◆ **Roles:** the **case lead** keeps the discussion moving and gives the verdict; the **evidence reader** holds the clue cards and reveals them only when the round starts; the **ladder keeper** writes each hypothesis on the sheet and moves it (arrows) as the evidence changes; the **skeptic** must challenge at least one claim per round with "But couldn't it be that...?" or "That can't be the whole story, because...". Give the ladder keeper job to a dominant speaker; give the skeptic job to a quieter learner who likes to think before speaking.
- ◆ **The rule of the ladder:** every hypothesis is *said* with the expression of its rung. Not "Maybe it's the courier," but "The courier **could conceivably** be leaving them downstairs." When a hypothesis moves, the group says why: "Clue 4 makes this **far more likely**: it **may well** be the name change."
- ◆ **No blame on people.** The cases have no villains. If a group jumps to "the new temp must be lazy," the skeptic's job is to ask for evidence, and your job is to steer: "What else could explain it?" Reputation is a real appropriacy issue at work: hedging protects colleagues.
- ◆ **Verdict (90 seconds per group):** use the frame in the workbook: what *can't possibly have* happened; what *must have / is bound to*; what *may well* be true; one characteristic *will / would* sentence; a softened recommendation.
- ◆ If time is short, run only Rounds 1 and 2 and skip the reveal; hand out the solutions at the start of C3 as a warmer.

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE EVIDENCE LADDER

SAY: *Can the evidence reader show all six clues at once? (No, two per round.) · Can you say "maybe"? (No: say the rung: "could conceivably," "may well"...)* · *What does the skeptic say? ("But couldn't it be that...?")* · *Can you blame a person without evidence? (No.)* · *How long is the verdict? (Ninety seconds.)* · *How does it end? (With a softened recommendation: "I'd suggest...")*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

The case files are reading-heavy. Give the learner the evidence-reader role (they read two short clues at a time, aloud, after a minute's preparation) or pre-teach the key words of one case the day before. Reduce the dial to **five rungs**: *can't · might · may well · should · must*. Give the verdict frame with the starters already written. Target: three hypotheses said on three different rungs, and one "must have" about the past.

STRETCH (TOWARD C2)

Add stance collocations: *in all likelihood, there's every chance that, I'd be surprised if, it's by no means certain that, may yet* ("The deal may yet go through"). Use perfect passive modals: "The label **can't have been updated**." Ask the learner to write the verdict as a two-sentence email to a manager, then as a one-line message to a colleague, and compare the modals chosen. Challenge: "Remove every *maybe* and *definitely* from your verdict."

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **may well / may as well:** the false twins confuse everyone, and a few languages have a similar-looking "also" structure (Spanish *bien podría* = may well; French *autant* + infinitive = may as well). Drill the test question.
- ◆ **One verb for must and should:** French *devoir*, Spanish *deber (de)*, Portuguese *dever*, Italian *dovere* and Chinese 应该 *yīnggāi* cover obligation, expectation and deduction. Learners say "He should be at home, the lights are on" when they mean *must*, or "must" when they mean mild expectation.
- ◆ **mustn't have for impossibility:** "He mustn't have known." Spanish (*no debe de haber sabido*) and French (*il n'a pas dû savoir*) push learners toward *mustn't*. The logical negative of deduction is **can't have**.
- ◆ **will = want:** German (*ich will*) and Dutch (*ik wil*) speakers may read "He won't listen" as "He doesn't want to listen." Close, but point out the stronger idea of refusal.
- ◆ **Perfect modal forms:** "must have went," "should have came," "can't have be," "must of." Common for all L1s. Hold up the "have + past participle" card every time.
- ◆ **Hedging by particle or adverb:** Japanese and Korean (sentence-final particles) and many other languages hedge with adverbs, so learners overuse "maybe" and "I think" and underuse modals. Praise every modal hedge.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 1.2: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-c1/lesson_02.html. Listen to the five model sentences with 🗣️ and say them back; do Exercises 1–3, the Quick Quiz and the "Informed Speculation" project (choose a trend, a technology or a workplace decision, not a person). Workbook 1.2: write your group's verdict as a 120-word email to a (fictional) manager, "My new words" and the journal (one situation you're unsure about, written four ways: *must* / *can't*, *may well*, bare *might*, *should*, with a note on how much certainty each signals).

◆ CHECK – SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 A may as well · Q2 B habitual past · Q3 (new) A can't possibly have. The Tuesday slump (Ex 1): 1 can't be · 2 might be · 3 can't possibly have started · 4 may well have switched · 5 would always order · 6 must be · 7 are bound to be · 8 might as well try.

◆ OBJECTIVES – LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ use the **mandative subjunctive** (base form, every person) after verbs (*recommend, insist, propose, request, require*), adjectives (*It is essential / vital / imperative that...*) and nouns (*our recommendation that...*), including the negative (*that he **not** attend*) and the passive (*that it **be** reviewed*)
- ◆ choose between the subjunctive, *should* + base and the indicative as **register** choices, and tell a demand (*insisted that he **leave***) from a statement of fact (*insisted that he **was** innocent*)
- ◆ use the unreal **were** in hypotheses and wishes (*If I were..., Were we to..., I wish it were...*), and unreal forms after **suppose / supposing, it's high time** and **would rather**
- ◆ use **as if / as though** with a present tense (possibly true) or a past tense (contrary to fact)
- ◆ write and peer-review a short formal policy memo or meeting recommendation on a workplace issue

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 1.3 (New words, Grammar box, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, memo frame and peer-review checklist)
- ◆ Slides 14–18 · Subjunctive trigger flashcards (Set A, colored: verb / adjective / noun) · **Policy Memo** issue briefs (Set F, 5 briefs with assigned positions) · peer-review checklists · the **Precision Board** game (Set G) for early finishers · New identity cards
- ◆ Listening scripts 1.3-A (The volunteer program recommendations) and 1.3-B (dictation)

BOARD PLAN

Left: the mandative subjunctive. TRIGGER + **that** + subject + **BASE FORM**. Verbs: *recommend, insist, propose, request, require, demand, urge, suggest* · Adjectives: *It is essential / vital / imperative / crucial / advisable that...* · Nouns: *our recommendation / proposal / requirement that...* Under it: *that he ~~goes~~ go* · *that she ~~doesn't~~ not attend* · *that it **be** reviewed* · *that I **be** informed*.

Center: three registers. *I suggest that she **be** promoted.* (most formal; standard American) · *...that she **should be** promoted.* (British, softer) · *...that she **is** promoted.* (informal). And the lookalike: *The data **suggests** that he **is** right.* (= shows: a fact, not a demand).

Right: unreal forms. *If I **were** you...* · ***Were** we to delay...* · *I wish it **were** simpler.* · **Suppose / Supposing** the budget **were** cut... · *It's (high) time we **reviewed** this.* · *I'd rather you **didn't** mention it.* Then: *He talks as if he **knows*** (maybe he does) vs *as if he **knew*** (he doesn't).

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: case closed	7	S-S	Review C2 (1.2). If you didn't reveal the case solutions in C2, read one aloud now. Otherwise: pairs get a new mini-mystery from the board ("The team's shared calendar has been empty since Monday.") and give three explanations on three rungs of the dial plus one <i>may as well</i> decision. Two pairs share. Note one <i>may well</i> / <i>may as well</i> slip for the feedback stage.
Lead-in: which one came from HR?	5	T-S	Board two lines: "I think Tom should really come to the meeting." · "It is essential that Tom be present at the meeting." Ask: "Who wrote each one? Where would you see the second?" (HR, minutes, a policy.) "Anything strange about the grammar?" Let learners find <i>be</i> (not <i>is</i>). "This is the subjunctive. You've used it for years in <i>If I were you</i>."
Mandative subjunctive	12	T-S → S-S	Slide 14. Board (left). Sort the trigger flashcards into verbs / adjectives / nouns with the class. Build the form: base verb for every person; negative <i>not</i> + base; passive <i>be</i> + pp. CCQs (below). Then Listening Script 1.3-A: learners complete Ex 1 (the committee's recommendations), and pairs check.
Three registers +	3	T-S	Slide 15. Board (center). The three options are all

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
the lookalike			grammatical; the choice is register (and dialect). The lookalike: <i>suggest</i> = "show" and <i>insist</i> = "assert" take ordinary verbs.
Drill	5	T-S → S	See Drill script: casual request → memo line, then the negative and passive transformations.
Unreal were, suppose, high time, as if	11	T-S → S-S	Slide 16. Board (right). Unreal <i>were</i> in all persons; inversion <i>Were we to...</i> (only <i>were</i> , never <i>was</i>); <i>suppose / supposing</i> + past or <i>were to</i> for a tentative hypothesis; <i>it's (high) time</i> + past simple (something is overdue); <i>would rather</i> + past for another person. Then <i>as if / as though</i> : the truth-value test (slide 16 CCQs). Pairs do workbook Ex 4 items 1–4 aloud (2 min).
Listening: dictation	5	T-S → S	Read Script 1.3-B (4 sentences, 3 times each). Learners write, then compare in pairs. Check the forms that disappear in speech: "that every application be submitted," "that he not be told."
Controlled practice	9	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 2, 3, 4 (items 5–8) and 5 alone, then pairs. Board-check disagreements (usually Ex 3b, the lookalikes, and Ex 4, <i>as if</i> tenses).
Freer: Policy	23	S-S (groups) → S-S (review) → T-S	Slide 17. Groups of 3 get an issue brief (meeting overload, onboarding new staff, the

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Memo + peer review			shared kitchen, hybrid desk booking, the volunteer rota) with an assigned recommendation. Write (12 min) : a 120–160-word memo on the frame: background (1–2 sentences, one <i>as if / as though</i> allowed), three or more recommendations (three different trigger types, one negative, one passive), a rationale with an unreal form (<i>Were we to...</i> , <i>Supposing...</i> , <i>If the budget were...</i>), a closing line (<i>It is high time we...</i>). Peer review (8 min) : groups swap memos and use the three-pass checklist (below). Read-out (3 min) : two groups read their memo as if to a committee; the committee (the class) responds with one formal line (<i>Be that as it may...</i> , <i>If need be...</i>). ICQs first.
Feedback	5	T–S	Three columns (no names). Accuracy: "We recommend that each manager sends..." · "It is vital that the kitchen is not be..." · "Was I in charge...". Appropriacy: "It is imperative that you bring cookies to the party" (a sledgehammer for a nut: a subjunctive in a friendly note). Range: one elegant line from a memo (<i>Were we to postpone the change, ...</i>).
Homework & module wrap-up	5	T–S	Slide 18, recap. Show online lesson 1.3 and a 🗣️ button. Set the homework (below).

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			Learners tick the three "I can..." lists. Early finishers and the C4 warmer: the Precision Board game.
Total	90		7 + 5 + 12 + 3 + 5 + 11 + 5 + 9 + 23 + 5 + 5

◆ MEANING • FORM • PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: the mandative subjunctive. The that-clause describes something that is *required, recommended or willed*, not something that is true. The base form marks it as "not yet real." It sounds impersonal and authoritative, which is why it dominates policies, minutes and reports.

SAY: "The board insists that he resign." Has he resigned? (No, not yet.) Is it a fact or a demand? (A demand.) Why not "resigns"? (It isn't a statement of fact: it's what the board wants.) • "It is essential that everyone be present." Is everyone present now? (We don't know: it's a requirement.) • "We ask that he not resign before the vote." Is this "don't resign"? (Yes, a request.) Where's do? (No do: not + base.)

Meaning: the lookalike.

SAY: "The evidence suggests that he is guilty." / "I suggest that he be released." Which suggest means "shows"? (The first.) Which means "propose"? (The second.) Which needs the subjunctive? (The second: it's a recommendation.) • "She insisted that she was innocent." / "She insisted that he leave." Which is a demand? (The second.)

Meaning: unreal were and friends.

SAY: "Were we to delay the launch, we'd lose the client." Are we delaying? (No, it's a hypothesis.) Same as? (If we delayed / If we were to delay.) More or less formal? (More.) • "Supposing the budget were cut by half, what would we drop first?" Has it been cut? (No: imagine it.) • "It's high time we reviewed this policy." Past or present? (Present: it's overdue now.) Have we reviewed it? (No, and we should have already.) • "I'd rather you didn't mention it." Whose action? (Yours.) Past? (No: the past form is unreal, polite.)

Meaning: as if / as though.

SAY: "He talks as if he owned the company." Does he own it? (No: past = contrary to fact.) When is he talking? (Now: the past form doesn't mean past time.) • "It looks as if it's going to snow." Might it snow? (Yes: present = possibly true.) • "She looked as though she had seen a ghost." Had she seen one? (No: past perfect, unreal, earlier.)

Form.

Mandative	trigger + (that) + subject + base form	We recommend that she chair the meeting.
Negative	not + base form	...that staff not share passwords.
Passive	be + past participle	...that the policy be reviewed annually.
Unreal were	were for all persons · inversion Were + subject (+ to)	If it were possible... · Were she to refuse...
Suppose / high time / rather	suppose(-ing) + past / were to · it's (high) time + past simple · would rather + past	It's high time we left . · I'd rather you didn't .
As if / as though	+ present (possibly true) · + past / were (unreal) · + past perfect (unreal, earlier)	as if he knows · as if he knew · as if he had seen

Pronunciation. The subjunctive is easy to miss in speech because *be* and the bare verb are unstressed. In formal reading, give the verb its full value and a small pause before *that*: "It is **essential** | that every member **be** present." In the negative, stress **not**: "that he **not** be told." *Were* is /wɜr/ when stressed at the start of an inverted clause ("**Were** we to delay..."), weak /wər/ elsewhere. *As though* is /əz 'ðʊʊ/: the *th* is voiced.

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 Casual → memo:** T: "Tom really needs to come to the meeting. (essential)" → S: "It is essential that Tom be present at the meeting." T: "She should chair it. (recommend)" → S: "We recommend that she chair the meeting." T: "Everyone has to sign in. (require)" → S: "We require that everyone sign in."
- 2 Negative and passive:** T: "Staff shouldn't share passwords. (request)" → S: "We request that staff not share passwords." T: "Someone must review the policy every year. (vital)" → S: "It is vital that the policy be reviewed every year."
- 3 If → Were:** T: "If I were in charge, I'd cancel it." → S: "Were I in charge, I'd cancel it." T: "If we delayed the launch, we'd lose the client." → S: "Were we to delay the launch, we'd lose the client."
- 4 Overdue:** T: "We should have updated the handbook already." → S: "It's high time we updated the handbook." T: "Someone should have fixed the printer weeks ago." → S: "It's high time someone fixed the printer."
- 5 Real or unreal?:** T: "He talks like an expert. He isn't one." → S: "He talks as if he were an expert." T: "He talks like an expert. Maybe he is." → S: "He talks as if he knows what he's doing."

◆ POLICY MEMO + PEER REVIEW – HOW TO RUN IT

- Groups of 3. Each group gets **one issue brief** (Set F): the situation, three facts with numbers, a constraint (budget, time, staffing) and an **assigned recommendation**. Brief 1: meeting overload (Lakeside

Logistics) · Brief 2: new staff leaving within three months (Northgate Clinic) · Brief 3: the shared kitchen (Oakridge Tower) · Brief 4: hybrid desk booking (Crestview College admin office) · Brief 5: no-shows on the volunteer rota (Riverside Community Center). Two groups may share a brief; give them opposite assigned positions (each brief has an A and a B position) and let them compare at the end.

- ◆ **Write (12 min)** on the memo frame: **To / From / Date / Re · Background** (1–2 sentences) · **Recommendations** (three or more, numbered: three different trigger types, one negative, one passive) · **Rationale** (one unreal form: *Were we to...*, *Supposing...*, *If X were...*) · **Next steps** (*It is high time...* · *If need be, ...*). 120–160 words. Roles: a **writer**, a **drafter** (says each sentence aloud before it's written) and a **register checker** (reads for tone: memo, not chat; not over-dramatic).
- ◆ **Peer review (8 min): the three-pass protocol.** Groups swap memos. Each reviewer takes one pass with the checklist: **Pass 1 Accuracy** (base form after every trigger, no -s, *not* + base, *be* + pp, *were* after inversion) · **Pass 2 Range** (three trigger types? an unreal form? an *as if* or *it's high time*?) · **Pass 3 Appropriacy** (consistent formal tone, clear actions, fossil phrases used sparingly). Reviewers write in pencil in the margin and finish with **one strength (quoted)**, **one question**, **one suggested change**. The authors decide what to accept: "It's your memo."
- ◆ **Read-out (3 min):** two groups read their memo "to the committee." The class responds with one formal line: "Be that as it may, the cost..." · "If need be, we could..."
- ◆ **Handling dominant speakers:** the drafter role keeps a fast speaker useful (they say sentences aloud) without taking the pen. In peer review, the strongest learner is the **third** reviewer (appropriacy), which means they speak last. Positions are assigned, so nobody argues their personal view; no one has to say what their real workplace is like.

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE POLICY MEMO

SAY: *Do you choose your recommendation? (No, it's assigned on the brief.) · How many words? (120 to 160.) · How many trigger types? (Three: a verb, an adjective, a noun.) · After "It is essential that he..." do we add -s? (No, base form.) · The negative: "that staff don't share" or "that staff not share"? (Not share.) · In peer review, do you rewrite the memo? (No, pencil comments: a strength, a question, a change.) · Who decides what to change? (The authors.)*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Give the memo frame with the trigger phrases pre-printed at the start of each recommendation line ("It is essential that ____ · We recommend that ____ · Our proposal is that ____"). The learner completes each with a base-form verb. Focus on **three structures**: *It is essential that + base*, *We recommend that + base*, *If I were...* In peer review, give them Pass 1 only (a single, concrete check: "Is there an -s after the trigger?"). Target: three correct mandative sentences and one *If I were* sentence.

STRETCH (TOWARD C2)

Use *Should*-inversion and *Were it not for* in the rationale ("**Should** the budget allow, ... · **Were it not for** the new rota, ..."): a preview of Lesson 2.2. Recognize *lest* ("lest the problem recur") as formal and rare: meet it, don't force it. Ask the learner to write the same recommendation for three audiences (the board, the team, a friend over coffee) and justify each verb form. Early finishers edit their memo down by 20% without losing a recommendation (a preview of 8.2).

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **"I want that you come"**: Spanish (*quiero que vengas*), Portuguese, Italian, French (*je veux que tu viennes*), Russian (*хочу, чтобы*) and Polish put a that-clause after *want*. In English *want* is not a mandative trigger: "I want you to come." Learners with a strong L1 subjunctive often overextend it.
- ◆ **Subjunctive after doubt or emotion**: Romance-language speakers may try "It's possible that he be late" or "I'm glad that she be here." English uses the subjunctive only after demand, recommendation and importance.
- ◆ **Infinitive after the trigger**: "They demanded that he to leave," "It is important that he to be informed." Common with Chinese, Arabic and Turkish speakers. Cross out *to*; point at the subject.
- ◆ **do-support in the negative**: "We ask that she doesn't attend." Common for all L1s. Teach "that she **not** attend" as a chunk.
- ◆ **"It's time that we go"**: Spanish *ya es hora de que nos vayamos* and French *il est temps que nous partions* use a present subjunctive. English uses the past: "It's time we **went**."
- ◆ **as if + present for unreal**: German, Dutch and the Scandinavian languages use a subjunctive or conditional here (*als ob er ... wäre*), which may help. Chinese, Japanese and Korean speakers often keep the present ("as if he owns it") because the L1 doesn't mark it. Ask the truth-value question.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 1.3: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-c1/lesson_03.html. Listen to the five model sentences with 🎧 and say them back; do Exercises 1–3, the Quick Quiz and the "Proposal & Reflection" project (a workplace or community change; real or invented). Workbook 1.3: a clean final copy of your group's memo that includes the reviewers' changes you accepted (write one line explaining a suggestion

you *rejected*, and why), "My new words" and the journal (one recommendation written three ways: subjunctive, *should*, indicative, with a note on which register each suits).

◆ CHECK — SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 A be · Q2 C didn't know · Q3 (new) A We ask that staff not share their passwords. Committee recommendations (Ex 1): 1 be updated · 2 attend · 3 not be asked · 4 have · 5 were · 6 were · 7 took.

CLOSING THE MODULE

END OF C3: MODULE 1 WRAP-UP

Recap on slide 18, "place it, weigh it, shape it": **By the launch we'll have been testing for six months. The launch was to have taken place in March.** (place it) → **It can't possibly have been the cleaners; the update may well be clashing with the backup.** (weigh it) → **It is essential that every new hire be assigned a mentor. Were we to delay, we would lose good people.** (shape it). Learners tick the three "I can..." lists in the workbook. Anything still unticked goes on a sticky note for you. Review it in the C4 warmer (the **Precision Board** game is ready for that) and again in the C13 progress-test catch-up.

Watch for in Module 2: the unreal *were* from 1.3 is the engine of the mixed conditionals in 2.1 (*If I were more organized, I would have finished*) and of the inverted conditionals in 2.2 (*Were we to...*, *Had I known...*, *Should you need...*): make the connection out loud. The evidence-ladder language from 1.2 comes back in 3.3 (hedging and diplomatic English), and the tactful future continuous from 1.1 is part of the same diplomatic toolkit.

Progress Test 1 (C13) covers Modules 1–4. From this module it tests: choosing among the future continuous, future perfect and future perfect continuous (with *by the time* + present), the future in the past (*was going to*, *was about to*, *was to have*), *be to* / *be about to* / *be on the verge of*, the certainty dial (*may well*, *could conceivably*, *is bound to*, *can't possibly have*), *may well* vs *may as well*, the jobs of *will* and *would*, present and past speculation with continuous and perfect modals, the mandative subjunctive (including negative and passive), unreal *were* and inversion, *it's high time* + past, and *as if* tense choice.

Module 2 — Conditionals, Inversion & Emphasis

Three classes about where the weight of a sentence falls. Learners already know the four conditionals, a few negative inversions and the basic cleft from B2; here those become deliberate choices. First, **mixed conditionals** and the precise alternatives to *if* (*provided that, as long as, unless, in case, even if, but for, if it hadn't been for, should, were to*) through a business case-study panel. Then **inversion** for emphasis and formality (*Never before have we... · Had we known... · So great was...*) through a speechwriting task, with as much attention to **when not to invert** as to the form. Last, **cleft sentences, fronting and end-weight** for cohesion, through an editing desk and a spoken "setting the record straight" activity.

3 lessons

Lessons 2.1–2.3

Classes C4–C6

Weeks 2–3

90 min per class

CEFR C1

HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

- One lesson block = one 90-minute class. Every class follows the same shape: **warmer** → **lead-in** → **Meaning / Form / Pronunciation** with concept-checking questions (CCQs) → **drill** (choral, then individual) → **controlled practice** (workbook) → **freer practice** (a demanding communicative task) → **feedback** with delayed error correction → **homework**.
- The **stage plan** is your clock. Each one adds up to 90 minutes. The numbers in the Time column are minutes.
- Present from [slides/module-2-conditionals-emphasis.html](#). Print [materials/module-2/classroom-materials.html](#) before C4. It holds the flashcards (alternatives to *if*, precaution pictures, inversion triggers, cleft frames), the new identity cards, the **Case Study Panel** files and board-question cards, the **Speechwriter** briefs and WEIGHT / POMP cards, the **Editing Desk** articles and **Record Straight A/B** cards, **The Emphasis Track** board game and the listening scripts.
- The online lessons are the learners' **homework and review**. Each one has  Listen buttons, so learners can hear the model sentences again at home and shadow the stress and pausing.
- Refinement, not first meetings.** At B2 learners met all four conditionals, *unless / in case / provided that, Never have I... / Not only...* and basic clefts (B2 Module 4.2). Check those in two minutes in each lead-in and spend the class on what is new at C1: **time-crossing conditionals, the nuance of each alternative** (*in case* ≠ *if*, *unless* ≠ *if not* in every case), **the full inversion system and its register**, and **information structure** (given → new, end-weight, extraposition).

- ◆ **Feedback on range, accuracy and appropriacy.** In every freer task, take notes in three columns: **accuracy** (errors to fix), **range** (ambitious language to praise and spread) and **appropriacy** (correct but wrong for the occasion: an inversion in a chatty line, three clefts in a row, *but for* in small talk). In the feedback stage, board 2–3 items from each column without names. At C1, appropriacy feedback is often the most valuable: "That sentence is perfect grammar. Would you say it at the dinner table?"
- ◆ **Peer review: Praise • Probe • Polish.** Use one protocol all module. After a presentation, speech or edited text, each reviewer gives **one praise** (a line that worked and why), **one probe** (a genuine question: "Why *in case* there and not *if*?") and **one polish** (a single concrete improvement). No more than one of each, so feedback stays focused and nobody is flattened.
- ◆ **Dominant speakers.** Every task has built-in roles. Give strong, talkative learners the jobs that require listening: the **language monitor** on the panel (ticks the checklist, speaks only at the end), the **editor** in the speechwriting pair (must cut, not add), the **fact-checker** at the editing desk. In board questioning, use a **two-question cap** per person. Say it warmly: "Great question, Omar. Let's hear from someone on the board who hasn't asked yet."
- ◆ **Stretching strong learners toward C2.** Each lesson has a stretch box. The C2 direction for this module is **economy and idiom**: fixed conditionals (*if need be, failing that, barring delays, come what may*), rarer inversions (*Not once did... So quickly did it spread that..., as did his father*), and text-level information structure (thematic progression across a paragraph). Ask strong learners to justify choices, and to find the line where a plainer structure would be better.
- ◆ **American English is the classroom standard.** The online lessons use British spellings and forms (*analyse, organised, apologise, realise, practising, theatre, flavour, judgement, memorise, topicalisation, travelled, got for gotten*). Teach *analyze, organized, apologize, realize, practicing, theater, flavor, judgment, memorize, topicalization, traveled, gotten*. Accept British forms when learners use them.
- ◆ Dashed boxes = lines to say out loud, CCQs and ICQs (instruction-checking questions). Green boxes = scripts you read aloud. **Amber** = watch-outs.

THE THROUGH-LINE

Weigh the options → add the weight → place the weight. In C4 learners weigh what was, what is and what might have been, and they set terms with exactly the right conjunction: *If they had accepted, they'd be twice the size now • provided that the date holds • but for one loyal customer base*. In C5 they add weight to single sentences for a formal occasion, and learn to stop before it becomes pomp: *Never have I worked with anyone quite like Grace*. In C6 they place weight across a paragraph, so that each sentence starts from what the listener knows and ends on what is new: *It wasn't the shorter week that caused the rise; it was better scheduling*. Every class ends with a real product that other learners hear and respond to: a panel analysis, a delivered speech, an edited article and a spoken correction.

TRAUMA-INFORMED: INVENTED CASES, CHOSEN DISTANCE

This module invites learners to talk about **regret, turning points and "what might have been."** For many adult learners, the biggest what-ifs in their lives involve leaving a country, a lost career, illness or family separation. **Never ask learners to analyze why they left their home country, or what their life would be like if they hadn't.** All class analysis uses the **invented companies** on the case cards (Harbor Fresh, Kestrel Software, Maple & Stone, Northgate Textiles) or the **new identity cards**. In the journal and the drill, offer three choices out loud every time: **your real life, a new identity card, or a company or something invented.** The online lesson's project mentions "a historical event (a treaty...)": in class, steer this toward discoveries and inventions (penicillin, the sticky note, the bicycle), never wars, political treaties or disasters. The speeches in C5 are tributes, awards, a science fair and a safety briefing; no political or religious speeches. The misconceptions in C6 concern invented libraries, cafés, bus routes and pools; learners correct a **card**, never a claim about a real person or group. Opinions in the board questioning are **assigned** by card.

BEFORE THE MODULE

- Print the **flashcards** (one set for the board): the alternatives-to-*if* cards, the six precaution picture cards and the *but for* cards (C4); the inversion-trigger cards and the *Had / Were / Should* cards (C5); the cleft-frame and fronting cards (C6). Card stock helps. Cut them before C4.
- For C4: the **Case Study Panel** files (4 cases × A "The story" + B "The numbers & hinge factors") and the **board-question cards**. One case per group of 3–4. With more than four groups, two groups can take the same case and present to each other.
- For C5: the four **Speechwriter briefs** (one per pair; duplicates are fine) and one **WEIGHT / POMP** card per learner. A lectern, a music stand or even a chair turned around makes "the podium" feel real.
- For C6: the **Editing Desk** articles B and C (article A is in the workbook) and the **Record Straight A/B** cards (6 pairs). The **Emphasis Track** board game (1 board per group, a die, counters) is for early finishers in C6 and the C7 warmer.
- Print the **new identity cards** and leave them on a side table where anyone can take one without asking or explaining.
- Optional: bring one real printed example of each structure from light, non-political sources: a customer-service letter ("Should you require..."), a product review with an inverted opening, a company newsletter with a cleft ("What makes this year different is..."). Learners enjoy finding them in the wild.

MODULE AT A GLANCE

LESSON	CLASS	FOCUS	LEARNERS CAN...
2.1	C4 • wk 2	Mixed conditionals in both directions (past → present, present → past); modal and tense	analyze an invented business decision in a three-minute panel presentation

LESSON	CLASS	FOCUS	LEARNERS CAN...
		variation (<i>might have, if + should, if + were to, continuous</i>); alternatives to <i>if</i> (<i>provided that, as long as, on condition that, unless, supposing, in case, otherwise, even if</i>); but for / if it weren't for / if it hadn't been for	with at least one mixed conditional in each direction, a <i>but for</i> construction and three precise alternatives to <i>if</i> , then field "Supposing..." questions from a board
2.2	C5 • wk 3	Inversion after fronted negative and restrictive adverbials (with <i>do</i> -support); conditional inversion (<i>Had / Were / Should, uncontracted negatives</i>); <i>So... / Such...</i> inversion; place inversion; register and density	rewrite a plain draft for a formal occasion (tribute, statement, opening address, safety briefing) with three to five well-judged inversions, and deliver a paragraph of it with appropriate pacing
2.3	C6 • wk 3	It-clefts (spotlight, correction, <i>It wasn't until...</i>); what-clefts and other frames (<i>All / The thing / The reason / The way...</i>); fronting for cohesion; given → new, end-weight , extraposition with <i>it</i>	edit a choppy article so that it flows (keeping every fact, using clefts with restraint), and correct a misconception politely in speech with a corrective it-cleft and a what-cleft

2.1 · C4

Mixed Conditionals & Alternatives to "if"

90 min

◆ OBJECTIVES – LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ build a **mixed conditional** in either direction by diagnosing the time of each clause separately: *If we had accepted, we'd be bigger now* (past → present) · *If she weren't so cautious, she would have invested* (present → past)
- ◆ vary the modal and the if-clause for nuance: *might / could have* in the result, tentative *if + should*, formal *if + were to*, continuous forms (*If you'd been listening...*)
- ◆ choose the precise **alternative to if**, and keep **in case** for precautions taken in advance
- ◆ isolate a decisive factor with **but for / if it weren't for / if it hadn't been for** + a noun, matching the time frame
- ◆ present a short, structured analysis of a business decision and respond to hypothetical questions from a panel

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 2.1 (New words, Grammar box, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, Case Study Panel frame)
- ◆ Slides 3–8 · Alternatives-to-if flashcards · Precaution picture cards · *But for* cards · **Case Study Panel** files (4 cases, A + B) · Board-question cards · New identity cards
- ◆ Listening scripts 2.1-A ("The Hinge" podcast: Brightwell Bikes) and 2.1-B (dictation)

BOARD PLAN

Left: two time logics. 🔄 condition → 🟢 now: If we **had accepted** the offer, we'd be twice the size now. · 🟢 always → 🔄 then: If she **weren't** so cautious, she **would have invested** years ago. · Ask: **When** is the condition? **When** is the result?

Center: shades. If it fails... (real) · If it **should** fail... (unlikely) · If it **were to** fail... (formal hypothesis). **Alternatives:** provided that · as long as · on condition that · unless · supposing · **in case** (precaution!) · otherwise · even if.

Right: the decisive factor (+ NOUN). **But for** your help, I'd have failed. · **If it weren't for** the traffic (now), ... · **If it hadn't been for** one witness (then), ... · ❌ ~~But for you helped~~. Phrase bank: *In hindsight...* · *the turning point was...* · *the hinge factor was...*

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: it's essential that...	7	S-S	Review C3 (1.3, the subjunctive and unreal forms). Board three frames: "It's essential that the new manager ____ · I'd rather you ____ · It's high time we ____ ...". Pairs write one sentence for each about an invented workplace (or a new identity card), then read their best one aloud. Listen for <i>be / didn't / started</i> . Note one error and one good example for the feedback stage.
Lead-in: one decision	5	T-S	Board an invented headline: "BRIGHTWELL BIKES SAID NO TO A BIG CONTRACT IN 2022. TODAY IT'S HALF THE SIZE OF ITS RIVAL." Ask: "What if it had said yes? What would be different now ?" Elicit a few attempts without correcting. "Today you'll analyze decisions like this one as consultants."
Mixed conditionals	12	T-S	Slide 3. Quick check of the four basics (one example each, from learners). Then build the two time logics with the timeline arrows on the board. Use learners' lead-in attempts as raw material: "If Brightwell had accepted, it would have been bigger now?" Diagnose: when is the condition? When is the result? Fix it together. Meaning, form, pronunciation, CCQs (below).
Drill	6	T-S → S	Diagnose-and-say drill (see Drill script). Choral, then individuals, then open pairs.
Nuance & alternatives to <i>if</i>	11	T-S → S-S	Slides 4–6. The three shades (<i>fails / should fail / were to fail</i>): learners rank them by probability and formality. Then the alternatives: stick the flashcards on the board and elicit a sentence for each. Hold up the precaution picture cards for in case vs if (umbrella, charger, passport copy, spare key): "Do I take the umbrella before or when it rains?" Finish with the <i>unless</i> test: can you say "except if"?
<i>But for</i> & the decisive factor	5	T-S	Slide 7. Unpack "But for your help, I would have failed" into "If you hadn't helped me...". Show <i>if it weren't for</i> (now) vs <i>if it hadn't been for</i> (then). Register: <i>but for</i> is formal, tributes and writing. One CCQ on the noun rule.
Listening: "The Hinge"	6	T-S → S-S	Workbook Ex 1. Read Script 2.1-A twice in a relaxed podcast voice. First listening: "What was the hinge factor?" Second: learners complete the seven gaps. Pairs compare. Ask: "Which sentence explains a present situation with a past decision?"

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Controlled practice	10	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 2-5 alone (diagnose the time, the exact alternative, isolate the factor, right or wrong), then check in pairs. Board-check only disputed items, especially Ex 5 items 2 and 6 (<i>unless</i> and <i>in case</i>). Early finishers annotate the dialogue.
Freer: The Case Study Panel	18	S-S → T-S	Slide 8. Groups of 3-4 get a case: A holds "The story," B holds "The numbers & hinge factors." Share (3 min, cards hidden), prepare on the workbook frame (6 min), present (3 min per group) to another group acting as the board, who ask two "Supposing... / What if..." questions from the board-question cards. With time, run two rounds so each group presents and questions once. ICQs first.
Feedback	5	T-S	Delayed correction in three columns. Accuracy: "If they had built the warehouse, they would have been the leader now." · "But for they found a co-op...". Range: praise <i>were to</i> , <i>on condition that</i> , <i>if it hadn't been for</i> . Appropriacy: "We'll keep a wholesaler on standby <i>if</i> the harvest fails": precaution or condition? One Praise · Probe · Polish round for one volunteer group.
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Show online lesson 2.1 on screen; play one 🗣️ model sentence and have the class shadow it. Set the homework (below). Learners tick the "I can..." box in the workbook.
Total	90		7 + 5 + 12 + 6 + 11 + 5 + 6 + 10 + 18 + 5 + 5

◆ MEANING · FORM · PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: mixed conditionals. The condition and the result sit in different times because they genuinely do. Past → present: a decision not taken then explains a situation now. Present → past: a permanent trait or general situation explains a one-off past event.

SAY: "If we had accepted the offer, we'd be twice the size now." Did we accept? (No.) When was the decision? (In the past.) Are we twice the size? (No.) When is "twice the size"? (Now.) · "If she weren't so cautious, she would have invested years ago." Is she cautious? (Yes, she is; it's her character.) Did she invest? (No.) Is "cautious" about one moment or always? (Always.) So why weren't and not hadn't been? (Because she is still cautious now.)

Meaning: the three shades.

SAY: "If the merger fails, we'll cut costs." Is this a real possibility? (Yes, we're planning for it.) · "If the merger should fail..." More likely or less likely? (Less: unlikely, but we're considering it.) · "If the merger

were to fail..." Where would you hear this? (A boardroom, a formal report: it's a hypothesis.) Does the event change? (No, only the probability and the formality.)

Meaning: the alternatives.

SAY: "I'll take an umbrella in case it rains." When do I take it? (Now, before.) Is it raining? (No, it might rain later.) · "I'll take an umbrella if it rains." When do I take it? (Only when it rains.) · "We'll leave at six unless you object." If you don't object? (We leave at six.) Can I say "except if"? (Yes: so unless is safe.) · "I'd be amazed unless she won"? Can I say "except if she won"? (No, so it's wrong: "if she didn't win.") · "You can borrow it provided that you return it by Monday." Is this a free choice or a condition? (A condition, and a strict one.) · "Even if it rains, we'll go." Does the rain change anything? (No.)

Meaning: but for.

SAY: "But for your help, I would have failed." Did you help? (Yes.) Did I fail? (No.) What made the difference? (Your help: one factor.) · "If it weren't for the traffic, the commute would be pleasant." Is there traffic now? (Yes.) Is the commute pleasant? (No.) · What comes after but for: a noun or a clause? (A noun: "your help," not "you helped.")

Form.

Past → present	if + past perfect , would / could / might + base	If I had taken that job, I'd be living in Berlin now.
Present → past	if + past simple / were , would / could / might + have + pp	If I spoke Japanese, that meeting would have gone differently.
Tentative	if + should + base (→ <i>Should you...</i>)	If you should see him, pass on my thanks.
Formal hypothesis	if + were to + base (→ <i>Were...to</i>)	If the deal were to collapse, jobs would be lost.
Alternatives	provided / providing (that) · as / so long as · on condition that · unless · supposing · in case · otherwise · even if	+ present tense for real future conditions (no <i>will</i>)
Decisive factor	but for / if it weren't for / if it hadn't been for + noun	If it hadn't been for the grant, we would have closed.

Pronunciation. Contractions carry the naturalness: *If I'd known* /aɪd 'nəʊn/, *I'd be...*, *would have* → /wʊdəv/ ("would've," never written "would of"), *wouldn't have* → /'wʊdntəv/. In mixed conditionals, stress the **time words** that justify the tense: "I'd be a doctor **now**" · "she would have invested **years ago**." *Provided* is /prə

'vaɪdɪd/ (three syllables; learners often drop the /ɪd/). In negotiation, *provided that* and *on condition that* take a small pause after them, which signals "here comes the term."

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 **Diagnose and say** (point at the arrows): T: "I didn't study medicine. I'm not a doctor now." → S: "If I had studied medicine, I'd be a doctor now." T: "He's afraid of flying. He didn't come to the wedding." → S: "If he weren't afraid of flying, he would have come to the wedding." Choral, then fast individuals.
- 2 **Now or then?** T gives only the half and a time word: T: "If we hadn't missed that flight... now." → S: "... we'd be in Lisbon now." T: "If she were more organized... last week." → S: "...she wouldn't have missed the deadline last week."
- 3 **Swap the *if*** (hold up an alternative card): T: "We'll sign if the date stays in March. Strict condition." → S: "We'll sign provided that the date stays in March." T: "Take a charger. The battery might die." → S: "Take a charger in case the battery dies." T: "We'll go. It doesn't matter if it rains." → S: "Even if it rains, we'll go."
- 4 **One factor:** T: "You helped. I didn't fail." → S: "But for your help, I would have failed." T: "The traffic is terrible. The commute isn't pleasant." → S: "If it weren't for the traffic, the commute would be pleasant."
- 5 **Open pairs → closed pairs:** S1 states a fact about an invented company ("Cobalt Cycles took the Swift contract."); S2 turns it into a mixed conditional; S3 adds *but for* or an alternative. Then all pairs, 1 minute, using the case headlines on slide 8.

◆ THE CASE STUDY PANEL – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ **Groups of 3–4 are consultants.** Each group gets one invented case: **Harbor Fresh** (grocery delivery), **Kestrel Software** (clinic scheduling app), **Maple & Stone** (family furniture maker) or **Northgate Textiles** (recycled fabrics). Learner A holds "**The story**" (what happened, in order); learner B holds "**The numbers & hinge factors**" (costs, character traits, the lucky break, the offer now on the table). No showing cards.
- ◆ **Share (3 min):** A and B tell the group their halves in ordinary spoken English. Others take notes on the workbook frame.
- ◆ **Prepare (6 min):** the group plans a **three-minute analysis** for the board: what happened, the hinge factor, a past → present conditional, a present → past conditional (from a character trait), *but for / if it hadn't been for*, a recommendation with terms (*provided that, as long as, unless, in case*) and a projection with *were to* or *should*. Everybody speaks at least once.
- ◆ **Present and question (4 + 4 min per round):** the group presents to another group (the board). The board draws two **board-question cards** ("Supposing the co-op raised its prices?") or asks its own, beginning *Supposing...* or *What if...* The consultants answer on the spot. Then the groups swap roles.
- ◆ **Roles:** **lead analyst** (opens and closes) · **numbers expert** (holds card B; handles fact questions) · **strategist** (the recommendation and terms) · **language monitor** (ticks the checklist during the

presentation and gives one Praise · Probe · Polish at the end). Give the monitor role to a dominant speaker.

- ◆ **Say before you start:** "These companies are invented. You're analyzing them, not judging anyone's real life."

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE CASE STUDY PANEL

SAY: *Can you show your card to the group? (No, tell them.) · How long is the presentation? (Three minutes.) · How many mixed conditionals? (At least two, one in each direction.) · What comes after but for? (A noun.) · Who ticks the checklist? (The language monitor.) · What do the board's questions start with? ("Supposing..." or "What if...") · Are these real companies? (No, invented.)*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Some C1 learners speak far more fluently than they write, or read slowly in the Latin script. Give a **two-arrow sentence strip** ("If ___ had ___, ___ would ___ now. · If ___ weren't ___, ___ would have ___.") and let them build their two mixed conditionals from it. Read Card A aloud to them before the share stage, or pair them as the **numbers expert** with a partner who reads the story. Workbook: Ex 2 items 1–4, Ex 3 items 1–6, Ex 4 items 1–3. Target: two correct mixed conditionals and one correct *in case*, said aloud in the panel.

STRETCH (TOWARD C2)

Add fixed conditionals: *if need be · if so / if not · failing that · barring (further) delays · come what may · assuming (that)*. Ask for a continuous mixed conditional ("If they'd been listening to their customers, they'd be selling online by now"). In the panel, the stretch learner must use *Were it not for* or *Had it not been for* once (previewing 2.2) and answer one board question with a counter-hypothesis: "Even if that were the case, ...". Early finishers rewrite the dialogue as formal written minutes and compare the registers.

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **in case as a false friend:** Spanish *en caso de que*, Italian *nel caso in cui*, Portuguese *caso*, German *im Fall*, *dass / falls* and French *au cas où* all work as plain conditions ("if"), so learners say "Call me in case you need help" meaning "if." Use the umbrella test every time: **before** or **when**?
- ◆ **would in the if-clause:** "If I would have known..." is common from German and Dutch speakers (*wenn ich ... hätte / würde*) and appears in informal American speech too. Say: "It's heard, but it isn't written. Keep *would* for the result."
- ◆ **One conditional form for all times:** Russian, Polish and Ukrainian use one particle (*by*) for present and past unreal, and Chinese, Vietnamese, Thai and Indonesian mark time with adverbs, not tense. Mixed conditionals can feel arbitrary. Always anchor with a time word (*now, years ago, last week*) and draw the arrows.

- ◆ **unless overuse:** learners who learned "unless = if not" produce "I'd be surprised unless...". Spanish *a menos que* and French *à moins que* have the same limit, so point out the parallel: "except if" must fit.
- ◆ **Arabic speakers** often have a helpful distinction already (*'idhā* for real conditions, *law* for unreal ones): use it. "*Law* = the unreal ones today."
- ◆ **But for + clause:** "But for you helped me" is common for everyone; Spanish/Portuguese *si no fuera por* + noun is a good bridge: "It's the same: *por* + noun."

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 2.1: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-c1/lesson_04.html. Listen to the five model sentences with 🗣️ and shadow them (same stress, same speed); do Exercises 1–3, the Quick Quiz and the "What-If Analysis" project, choosing an invented company, a new identity card's decision, or an invention or discovery (record two minutes on a phone if possible). Workbook 2.1: write up your panel analysis in 120–150 words, "My new words" and the journal (one mixed conditional, rewritten with *but for* or *if it weren't for*).

◆ CHECK – SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 C hadn't sent · Q2 B in case · Q3 (new) A provided that. "The Hinge" (Ex 1): 1 had accepted · would be · 2 weren't · would have taken · 3 But for · 4 provided that · 5 in case · 6 were to · 7 Unless.

◆ OBJECTIVES – LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ invert auxiliary and subject after a fronted **negative or restrictive adverbial** (*Never, Rarely, Little, Not only, Not until, No sooner, Hardly, Only then / by / when, Under no circumstances, At no time, Nor*), adding **do / does / did** and a bare verb when there is no auxiliary
- ◆ use **conditional inversion** with *Had, Were, Should*, keeping negatives uncontracted (*Had it not been for...*)
- ◆ use **So + adjective + be + subject** and **Such + be + subject** with a *that*-clause of result, and recognize place inversion (*In the doorway stood...*)
- ◆ avoid false inversion: a mid-position negative, *Only* + subject, a fronted ordinary topic, a pronoun after *Here / There*
- ◆ judge **register and density**: where inversion adds weight, where it sounds pompous, and how many a paragraph can carry

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 2.2 (New words, Grammar box, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, Speechwriter frame)
- ◆ Slides 9–12 · Inversion-trigger flashcards · *Had / Were / Should* cards · **Speechwriter** briefs (4) · **WEIGHT / POMP** cards (1 per learner) · New identity cards
- ◆ Listening scripts 2.2-A (Volunteer of the Year acceptance speech) and 2.2-B (dictation)

BOARD PLAN

Left: the mechanism. I had never seen... → **Never had I seen...** · I never imagined... → **Never did I imagine...** (imagined) · 1 front the trigger → 2 auxiliary + subject → 3 no auxiliary? **do / does / did** + bare verb.

Center: the triggers. Never (before) · Rarely · Seldom · Little · Not only... but also · Not until... · No sooner... than · Hardly... when · Only then / by / when · Under no circumstances · At no time · Nor. **If → inversion:** **Had** I known · **Were** she to accept · **Should** you require · Had it **not** been for (~~Hadn't it~~). **So** great **was** the demand that... · **Such was** his anger that...

Right: weight or pomp? ✓ speeches · tributes · reviews · warnings · formal letters. ✗ texts · small talk · quick emails. **Density rule:** one well-placed inversion beats three. No inversion: I have never... · **Only Sarah** knew · Here **it** comes · That book, I've never read.

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: terms & conditions	7	S-S	Review C4. Pairs negotiate a quick, light deal from a slip (borrowing a neighbor's car for a weekend, sharing an office fridge, lending a friend a camera). Each must use <i>provided that</i> , <i>unless</i> , <i>in case</i> and one mixed conditional ("If you'd returned the ladder, I'd be happier to lend the car"). Two pairs perform their best exchange. Note errors for feedback.
Lead-in: which opening?	5	T-S	Board two openings: "I've never seen so many people here." / "Never have I seen so many people here." Ask: "Same meaning? Which one for a text to a friend? Which one for a keynote?" Elicit: same content, different weight and formality. "Today you're speechwriters."
Negative & restrictive inversion	12	T-S	Slide 9. Build the mechanism on the board in three steps, first with an auxiliary (<i>had never seen</i>), then without (<i>never imagined</i> → <i>Never did I imagine</i>). Stick the trigger cards up and elicit one sentence per card. Spend time on the two traps: <i>Only when X happened did we...</i> (the main clause inverts) and <i>Not only did she..., but she also...</i> (only the first clause inverts). Meaning, form, pronunciation, CCQs.
Drill	6	T-S → S	Front-and-flip drill (see Drill script). Choral, then individuals.
Conditional, so /such & place inversion	10	T-S → S-S	Slide 10. Link back to C4: "Should you see him..." and "Were the deal to collapse..." were already there. Build <i>Had / Were / Should</i> , then the negative (<i>Had it not been for</i> , never <i>Hadn't it</i> : "That's a question!"). Then <i>So great was...</i> and <i>Such was...</i> , and a one-minute look at place inversion (<i>In the doorway stood a stranger</i> · <i>Here comes the bus</i> / <i>Here it comes</i>).
Listening: the acceptance speech	6	T-S → S-S	Workbook Ex 1. Read Script 2.2-A twice, with a little ceremony (stand, pause before each inverted line). First listening: "What is the speaker thanking people for?" Second: learners complete the six inversions. Pairs compare and name each trigger. Ask: "Six inversions in one short speech: too many? Which would you cut?"
Register: weight or pomp?	4	T-S	Slide 11. Read the model dialogue with a strong learner. Then read three quick lines and learners hold up WEIGHT or POMP cards: a toast ("Rarely does a team..."), a text ("Never have I been so hungry") and a four-inversion paragraph. Establish the density rule.

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Controlled practice	10	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 2–5 alone (front and invert, drop <i>if</i> , faulty or fine, weight or pomp), then compare. Board-check Ex 2 item 3 and Ex 4 items 3–4, which cause the most debate. Ex 5 has room for disagreement: accept any reasoned answer.
Freer: The Speechwriter	20	S-S → T-S	Slide 12. Pairs (or threes) get a brief: a tribute to a retiring custodian, a statement after an IT outage, an opening address for a science fair, or a safety briefing. Rewrite (10 min) on the workbook frame: 3–5 inversions, three different triggers, one conditional, one <i>so / such</i> . The editor must then cut one inversion that isn't earning its place. Podium (10 min) : one learner per pair delivers the strongest paragraph (60–90 seconds); the audience holds up WEIGHT / POMP after each and one reviewer gives Praise · Probe · Polish. ICQs first.
Feedback	5	T-S	Accuracy: "Never I have seen..." · "Rarely does he admits..." · "Hadn't it been for...". Range: praise <i>So modest was he..., At no time was....</i> Appropriacy: read one over-inverted line back and ask the room: "Weight or pomp?" Then show how one plain sentence between two inversions makes both land.
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Show online lesson 2.2 and a 🗣️ button; shadow "Rarely does an opportunity like this come along." Set the homework (below). Learners tick "I can...".
Total	90		7 + 5 + 12 + 6 + 10 + 6 + 4 + 10 + 20 + 5 + 5

◆ MEANING · FORM · PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: inversion adds weight, not content. Fronting a negative or restrictive adverbial puts the emphasis first and signals a heightened, formal register. The propositional meaning does not change. The choice is whether to front at all; once fronted, inversion is obligatory.

SAY: "Never have I seen such a turnout." Does this mean something different from "I have never seen such a turnout"? (No, the same fact.) What's different? (It's more emphatic, more formal.) Where would you hear it? (A speech, a toast, a review.) · "Never I have seen..." Is this possible? (No: once you front Never, you must invert.) · "I have never seen it." Is there inversion here? (No: never isn't at the front.)

SAY: "Only when the water went down did we realize how much she had saved." Which clause inverts: "when the water went down" or "we realize"? (The main clause: did we realize.) · "Only Sarah knew the password." Inversion? (No: Only Sarah is the subject, not an adverbial.) · "Not only did she resign, but she also exposed the fraud." How many clauses invert? (Only the first.)

Meaning: conditional inversion.

SAY: "Had I known, I would have called." Did I know? (No.) Is this past or present? (Past.) Formal or neutral? (More formal than "If I'd known.") · "Should you require assistance, please ask." Do they expect you to need help? (Not really: it's polite and tentative.) Where do you see this? (Hotels, formal letters, customer service.) · "Hadn't I known..." Is this a condition? (No, it's a question! Say "Had I not known.")

Meaning: register and density.

SAY: "Never have I been so bored!" to a friend over coffee: natural or theatrical? (Theatrical: fine only as a joke.) · A paragraph with four inversions: more emphatic or less? (Less: they cancel each other out and sound pompous.) · How many in a one-minute speech? (Two or three, well placed.)

Form.

With an auxiliary	trigger + auxiliary + subject + rest	Rarely have we faced such a choice.
Without an auxiliary	trigger + do / does / did + subject + bare verb	Little did he know. (knew)
Only / Not until + clause	the main clause inverts	Not until the review ended did the truth emerge.
Conditional	Had / Were / Should + subject (no <i>if</i>) · negative: + subject + not	Had it not been for the fog, we'd have arrived on time.
So / Such	So + adj + be + subject + that · Such + be + subject + that	So convincing were the results that critics fell silent.
Place	adverbial of place + verb + noun subject (not a pronoun)	Down the road came the parade. · Here it comes.

Pronunciation. An inverted sentence is delivered, not rushed. Stress the **trigger** and pause lightly after the fronted phrase when it is long: "**Only** when the water went **down** | did we realize...". Keep the auxiliary weak (/dɪd wi/, /həv aɪ/) and let the stress fall on the main verb and the key noun: "**Never** have I seen such a **turnout**." In *Had it not been for*, **not** is stressed and never contracted. For the podium: slower than conversation, a falling tone at the end of each inverted sentence, and a real pause before the next one so it lands.

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 **Front and flip** (hold up a trigger card): T: "I have never seen such generosity. Never." → S: "Never have I seen such generosity." T: "She rarely admits a mistake. Rarely." → S: "Rarely does she admit a mistake." T: "He little suspected the truth. Little." → S: "Little did he suspect the truth." Choral, then fast individuals.

- 2 **Which clause?** T: "We realized the cost only then." → S: "Only then did we realize the cost." T: "The truth emerged only after the audit." → S: "Only after the audit did the truth emerge."
- 3 **Drop the *if*** (hold up Had / Were / Should): T: "If I had known..." → S: "Had I known..." T: "If you should need help..." → S: "Should you need help..." T: "If it hadn't been for the guide..." → S: "Had it not been for the guide..." (insist on *not* after the subject).
- 4 **Turn up the volume:** T: "The demand was very great. The servers crashed." → S: "So great was the demand that the servers crashed." T: "His anger was enormous. Nobody spoke." → S: "Such was his anger that nobody spoke."
- 5 **Open pairs → closed pairs:** S1 gives a plain sentence about an invented event ("We had never had so many volunteers."); S2 delivers it "from the podium" with an inversion; S3 says **WEIGHT** or **POMP** and why. Then all pairs, 1 minute.

◆ THE SPEECHWRITER – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ **Pairs (or threes) are a speechwriting team.** Each gets a **brief**: the occasion, the speaker, the audience, and a plain, flat draft of about 120 words. Brief 1: a tribute to Walter Chen, retiring after 28 years as head custodian of Riverside High. Brief 2: the CEO of Kestrel Software apologizing to customers after a six-hour outage. Brief 3: the opening address at the tenth Riverside Community Science Fair. Brief 4: a safety briefing for new volunteers at the Harborview food pantry warehouse.
- ◆ **Rewrite (10 min):** the team rewrites the draft for the occasion on the workbook frame. Requirements: **3–5 inversions in total**, at least **three different triggers**, one **conditional inversion**, one **so / such**. The underlined lines on the brief are good candidates, but teams choose.
- ◆ **The editor's cut:** before the podium, the **editor** must cut (or un-invert) one inversion that is doing no work and explain why to the partner. This is the heart of the lesson: judgment, not decoration.
- ◆ **Podium (10 min):** one learner per team delivers the strongest paragraph (60–90 seconds) standing, from a lectern or a turned chair. After each, the audience holds up **WEIGHT** or **POMP**, and one named reviewer gives **Praise • Probe • Polish**. Keep a brisk pace: the whole round should take about 90 seconds per team.
- ◆ **Roles:** **writer** (drafts), **editor** (checks the auxiliary and the bare verb, makes the cut), **speaker** (delivers). In a pair, the writer speaks and the editor edits. A dominant speaker is the editor.
- ◆ **Anxiety:** nobody has to speak from the podium alone if it causes real distress. A pair may deliver alternately, one sentence each, or the learner may read seated. Offer this privately.

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE SPEECHWRITER

SAY: *How many inversions: as many as possible? (No, three to five.) • How many different triggers? (At least three.) • Must you have a Had / Were / Should sentence? (Yes, one.) • What does the editor do before the podium? (Cuts one inversion.) • How long is the paragraph you deliver? (60–90 seconds.) • What does the audience hold up? (WEIGHT or POMP.)*

LITERACY SUPPORT

Focus on **four triggers** only: *Never have I...*, *Not only did...*, *Under no circumstances should...*, *Had I known....* Give a sentence strip with the auxiliary slot highlighted ("Never ____ I ____ ..."). In the speechwriter task, the learner rewrites **three** underlined lines with the partner's help and delivers those three sentences, practiced once with you. Workbook: Ex 2 items 1, 2, 4, 6; Ex 3 items 1, 2, 4; Ex 4 items 1, 2, 6. Target: three correct inversions, delivered aloud with the stress on the trigger.

STRETCH (TOWARD C2)

Add rarer patterns: *Not once did...*, *So quickly did the news spread that...* (so + adverb), *Nowhere is this more evident than...*, *Only later was it discovered that...* (passive), comparative inversion (*She worked hard, **as did** her colleagues · more than **did** any other team*) and fixed forms (*Suffice it to say... · Be that as it may...*). In the speech, the stretch learner must achieve the effect with **two** inversions only and explain the placement. Early finishers write the same message twice, once as a formal statement and once as a friendly text, and annotate every difference.

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **Verb-second transfer:** German, Dutch, Swedish, Norwegian and Danish invert the **main verb** after *any* fronted element (*Nie habe ich... / Gestern ging ich...*). Expect "Never saw I such a thing" (no *do*) and over-inversion after ordinary adverbials: "Yesterday went I...", "That book have I never read." Contrast: English inverts only after negative / restrictive triggers, and only the auxiliary moves.
- ◆ **Free subject position:** Spanish, Portuguese and Italian allow the subject after the verb (*Nunca he visto yo...*), so learners produce "Never have seen I..." or forget the subject. French often keeps normal order after *jamais*. Drill the auxiliary + subject pair as one chunk: *have I · did we · was the*.
- ◆ **No *do*-support in L1:** Chinese, Japanese, Korean, Vietnamese, Thai and Indonesian speakers often skip *do / does / did* ("Rarely she admits") or double-mark tense ("Little did I knew"). Treat it as a question: "How do you ask? *Did you know?* Same shape."
- ◆ **Contracted negative conditionals** ("Hadn't I known...") are universal. Write the question mark on the board: "Hadn't I known?"
- ◆ **Register transfer:** learners from languages or schools where formal style is highly valued (for example, Arabic, Persian, Russian or French academic traditions) may enjoy inversion so much that they overuse it. Praise the ambition, then apply the density rule.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 2.2: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-c1/lesson_05.html. Listen to the five model sentences with 🗣️ and shadow them, pausing where the speaker pauses; do Exercises 1–3, the Quick Quiz and the "Emphatic Transformation & Set Piece" project (a 150–200-word toast, review or safety warning with three to five inversions; record it if possible). Workbook 2.2: write a clean final version of your speech (or the

other brief), "My new words" and the journal (one inverted sentence and an honest verdict: stronger, or just louder?). Bring one inverted line to the next class for the warmer.

◆ CHECK — SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **A** Rarely does she admit a mistake. · Q2 **A** Had I known, I would have called. · Q3 (new) **B** Not only did she apologize, but she also offered a refund. Acceptance speech (Ex 1): 1 have I been · 2 did I imagine · 3 did you keep · 4 was the response · 5 Had it not been · 6 will we be.

◆ OBJECTIVES – LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ use an **it-cleft** to spotlight one element, to contrast, and to **correct politely** (*It was the timing, not the price, that worried us* · *It wasn't until Monday that...*)
- ◆ use a **what-cleft** and related frames (*All / The thing / The reason / The way / The one who... + be*) to save the focus for the end, with correct agreement and tense of *be*
- ◆ front a **given** element to link a sentence back to the previous one, without inverting
- ◆ apply **given before new** and **end-weight**, including extraposition with anticipatory *it* (*It's a pity that...*)
- ◆ edit a choppy text into a cohesive one, and use clefts with restraint

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 2.3 (New words, Grammar box, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, Editing Desk with Article A, Record Straight checklist)
- ◆ Slides 13–18 · Cleft-frame and fronting flashcards · **Editing Desk** articles B and C · **Record Straight** A/B cards (6) · **The Emphasis Track** board game (early finishers) · New identity cards
- ◆ Listening scripts 2.3-A (radio interview: The Copper Kettle) and 2.3-B ("Which question does it answer?")

BOARD PLAN

Left: one fact, three shapes. Her attitude impressed me. → **It was** her attitude **that** impressed me. (spotlight / "not her CV") → **What** impressed me **was** her attitude. (focus at the end) → Her attitude, I could not fault. (fronted topic)

Center: frames. It wasn't until... that... · It was X, not Y, that... · What happened was (that)... · All I want is... · The reason... is **that...** (~~because~~) · The thing that worries me is... · *be* agrees: What I need is a break / **are** answers · What surprised us **was...**

Right: the flow. GIVEN → NEW · light → HEAVY. We tried three strategies. **The first** we dismissed at once. · ~~That you missed it is a pity.~~ → **It's** a pity (that) you missed it. · Fronting ≠ inversion: ~~That book have I never read.~~ · Restraint: max 3 clefts per paragraph.

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: one-line toasts	7	S → T-S	Review C5. Each learner stands and delivers the inverted line they brought from homework (or one from their speech). The class holds up WEIGHT / POMP; you board two good ones and

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			one error without names. Keep it quick and warm: 20 seconds each, applause after every line.
Lead-in: which question?	5	T-S	Board: "Her attitude impressed me." Then the three reshaped versions (Board plan, left). Ask: "Which one answers: <i>Was it her CV that impressed you?</i> Which one answers: <i>What impressed you?</i> Which one continues a conversation about her attitude?" Elicit: word order carries information. "Today: moving the weight across a whole paragraph."
It-clefts & what-clefts	12	T-S	Slides 13–14. It-cleft: spotlight, contrast, the corrective frame, <i>It wasn't until...</i> What-cleft: the curtain drawn back, focus at the end. Then the other frames (hold up the cards: <i>All / The thing / The reason / The way</i>). Agreement and tense of <i>be</i> ; <i>The reason is that</i> . Meaning, form, pronunciation, CCQs.
Drill	6	T-S → S	Spotlight drill and "correct me" drill (see Drill script). Choral, then individuals, with the stress on the focus.
Fronting, given → new, end-weight	10	T-S → S-S	Slide 15. Read the flat "missed deadline" paragraph from the online lesson, then the cohesive version. Pairs underline what changed. Name the two principles. Show fronting ("The first we dismissed at once") and extraposition ("It's a pity that..."). Warn: fronting doesn't invert unless there is a negative trigger (link to C5).
Listening: The Copper Kettle	6	T-S → S-S	Workbook Ex 1. Read Script 2.3-A twice, with two voices or with a confident learner as Nadia. First listening: "What's the misconception?" Second: the six gaps. Then Script 2.3-B (quick, oral): learners call out which question each cleft answers.
Controlled practice	10	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 2–5 alone (rewrite for focus, front the link, move the weight, which flows better), then compare. Board-check Ex 5 with reasons, not just letters.
Freer 1: The Editing Desk	15	S-S → T-S	Slide 17. Groups of 3 edit a choppy article (A in the workbook; B and C on cards) so that it flows: every fact kept, at least one it-cleft, one what-cleft (or other frame), two frontings or extrapositions, and no more than three clefts . 10 minutes editing, 5 minutes for two groups to read aloud and one Praise · Probe · Polish each. ICQs first.

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Freer 2: Setting the Record Straight	9	S-S	Slides 16–17. Pairs get Record Straight cards: A reads "What people think," B (the spokesperson) corrects it politely from "What actually happened" with a corrective it-cleft and a what-cleft, then adds one fact. Swap cards and roles every 90 seconds; three rounds. Stress the focus word.
Feedback	5	T-S	Accuracy: "What surprised us is the silence." · "The reason is because..." · "That book, I have read it." Range: praise corrective clefts and fronted comparatives (<i>Even more surprising is...</i>). Appropriacy: read an over-clefted paragraph back ("It was... What... The reason..."): "How does it sound?" Restraint is the C1 skill.
Homework & module wrap- up	5	T-S	Slide 18 (recap). Show online lesson 2.3 and shadow one  sentence. Set the homework (below). Learners tick the three "I can..." lists. Unticked items go on a sticky note for you.
Total	90		7 + 5 + 12 + 6 + 10 + 6 + 10 + 15 + 9 + 5 + 5

◆ MEANING · FORM · PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: it-clefts. The it-cleft lifts one element into the spotlight and backgrounds the rest. It often carries "...and not something else," which makes it the natural frame for polite correction.

SAY: "It was her attitude that impressed me." What impressed me? (Her attitude.) Is there a hint of contrast? (Yes: not her CV, not her experience.) · "Actually, it was the timing that worried us, not the price." What did the other person think? (That the price worried us.) Is the speaker rude? (No, it's a calm correction.) · "It wasn't until Monday that we noticed." Did we notice on Friday? (No.) When? (On Monday, later than expected.)

Meaning: what-clefts and frames. The what-cleft holds back the focus and delivers it at the end, which builds a little anticipation. Frames name the aspect: the reason, the thing, the way, the person.

SAY: "What we need right now is a clear explanation." Where is the important part: the start or the end? (The end.) Why use this and not "We need a clear explanation"? (It prepares the listener: something important is coming.) · "All I want is a quiet evening." A lot or a little? (A little: all minimizes.) · "The reason I called is because..." Is this OK in a report? (Not in formal writing: "The reason... is **that**...")

Meaning: fronting and end-weight.

SAY: "We tried three strategies. The first we dismissed at once." Is "the first" new or already known? (Known: we just heard "three strategies.") Why put it first? (It links back.) What's the new part? (Dismissed at once.) · "That you missed it is a pity." Natural? (Top-heavy.) Better? ("It's a pity (that) you

missed it.") Where does the heavy clause go? (To the end.) · "That book have I never read." Correct? (No: fronting a topic doesn't invert. "That book, I have never read.")

Form.

It-cleft	It + be + focus + that / who + rest (<i>who</i> for people)	It was my sister who suggested it.
Negative time	It wasn't until + time / clause + that...	It wasn't until later that I realized.
What-cleft	What + clause + be + focus (<i>be</i> agrees with the focus and matches the time)	What surprised us was the silence.
Frames	All / The thing / The reason / The way / The place / The one who + clause + be	The way she handled it was masterful.
Fronting	given element first, then normal order (no inversion without a negative trigger)	Of the three options, the first seems best.
Extraposition	It + be / verb + ... + heavy clause at the end	It's unclear whether they'll agree.

Pronunciation. The grammar and the voice must agree: the **focus** carries the main stress. It-cleft: "It was her attitude that impressed me" (the rest is low and quick). Corrective: contrastive stress on both items: "It was the **timing**, not the **price**." What-cleft: a slight rise and a small pause after *was / is*, then a strong fall on the focus: "What we need ↗ | is **time** ↘." Fronted topics get their own tone unit: "The **first** ↗ | we dismissed at once ↘."

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- Spotlight it:** T: "Maria fixed the printer. Spotlight Maria." → S: "It was Maria who fixed the printer." T: "Spotlight the printer." → S: "It was the printer that Maria fixed." T: "We met in Lisbon. Spotlight the place." → S: "It was in Lisbon that we met."
- Save it for the end:** T: "I need a break." → S: "What I need is a break." T: "The engine overheated." → S: "What happened was (that) the engine overheated." T: "I want a quiet evening, nothing more." → S: "All I want is a quiet evening."
- Correct me** (T states a wrong assumption; S corrects with contrastive stress): T: "So the price put customers off?" → S: "No, it was the **parking** that put them off, not the **price**." T: "You found the error on Friday?" → S: "No, it wasn't until **Monday** that we found it."
- Lighten the front:** T: "That she said nothing surprised me." → S: "It surprised me that she said nothing." T: "To argue with him is pointless." → S: "It's pointless to argue with him."

- 5 **Open pairs → closed pairs:** S1 says a plain fact about an invented workplace; S2 asks a wrong-assumption question about it; S1 corrects it with a cleft. Then all pairs, 1 minute.

◆ THE EDITING DESK & SETTING THE RECORD STRAIGHT – HOW TO RUN THEM

- ◆ **Editing Desk (groups of 3, 10 min):** each group gets one choppy article of 11–14 short sentences: **A** Tallis Print Works' four-day week (in the workbook), **B** nap pods at Eastgate Distribution Center, **C** the Greenway Middle School garden. The brief: **every fact stays**; use at least **one it-cleft**, **one what-cleft** (or another frame) and **two** instances of fronting or extraposition; **no more than three clefts** in total; check each change against given → new. Roles: **writer**, **fact-checker** (ticks each fact as it survives), **reader** (reads each new sentence aloud; if it sounds staged, the group reconsiders).
- ◆ **Read-out (5 min):** two groups read their edited articles aloud. The class listens for flow and names one sentence that "clicked." One Praise · Probe · Polish each. Model versions are in the answer key.
- ◆ **Setting the Record Straight (pairs, 9 min):** A reads the misconception from a "**What people think**" card as a journalist or a neighbor would say it ("So the pool is closing because it's unsafe?"). B, the **spokesperson**, holds the matching "**What actually happened**" card and corrects it politely: a corrective it-cleft, a what-cleft, one extra fact. Swap after 90 seconds and take a new card pair.
- ◆ **Tone matters:** the goal is calm, courteous correction, not "winning." Model it: "I can see why people think that. Actually, it wasn't... What really happened was...". Every card is about an invented organization; no learner corrects a claim about a real person.
- ◆ Early finishers play **The Emphasis Track** board game, which recycles the whole module.

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE TASKS

SAY: *Editing Desk: can you delete a fact? (No, every fact stays.) · How many clefts: as many as possible? (No, three at most.) · Who ticks the facts? (The fact-checker.) · What goes first in a sentence, the given or the new? (The given.) · Record Straight: are you arguing with the journalist? (No, correcting politely.) · Which structures? (An it-cleft and a what-cleft.) · Which word do you stress? (The focus, the correct information.)*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Focus on **two frames**: *It was ___ that...* and *What ___ was....* In the Editing Desk, give the learner Article A with the sentences already cut into strips so they can physically move them, and make them the **fact-checker**. In Record Straight, provide the frame on a card ("Actually, it wasn't ___ that ___. It was ___.") and let them read the correction from it the first time, then try without. Workbook: Ex 2 items 1–5, Ex 3 items 1–2, Ex 5. Target: two correct corrective clefts said aloud with the stress on the focus.

STRETCH (TOWARD C2)

Add reversed pseudo-clefts (*That's what I mean* · *This is where it gets interesting*), *It's not that...*, *it's that...*, *What... did was to...*, and fronted participles and comparatives (*Equally important is...* · *Gone are the days when...*). At text level, ask the stretch group to map the **thematic progression** of their edited article: does each sentence start from something in the one before? In Record Straight, the stretch learner must also concede one point gracefully ("The one thing we did get wrong was...").

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **Missing dummy *it***: Spanish, Portuguese and Italian (*Es importante que...* · *É uma pena que...*) and Arabic often produce "Is a pity that you missed it" / "Is unclear whether...". Point at the empty subject slot: "English needs **it**."
- ◆ **Topic-comment transfer**: Chinese, Japanese and Korean put the topic first very naturally, which helps with fronting, but learners often add a resumptive pronoun ("This problem, we must solve it"). Cross out the *it*.
- ◆ **Cleft overuse**: French uses *c'est... qui / que* far more than English does, and learners may cleft every other sentence. Praise accuracy, then apply the restraint rule.
- ◆ **Frozen *is* and agreement**: "What surprised us is the silence" (for a past event) and "What we need is answers" occur for all L1s. Accept plural focus with *is* in speech; ask for agreement in writing.
- ◆ **"The reason is because"** is universal (and common in native speech). Correct it in writing only.
- ◆ **Free word order languages** (Russian, Polish, Ukrainian, Czech) put new information last simply by moving words, so learners may produce "The engineering nobody mentioned" without a comma or pause, which can sound abrupt. Teach the pause and the fronted topic's own intonation.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 2.3: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-c1/lesson_06.html. Listen to the five model sentences with 🎧 and shadow them, stressing the focus; do Exercises 1–3, the Quick Quiz and the "From Flat to Cohesive" project (use a paragraph you wrote about work or study, or one of the other Editing Desk articles). Workbook 2.3: a clean final copy of your edited article, "My new words" and the journal (two sentences from a message this week, rewritten with a cleft or a fronted element, with a one-line explanation).

◆ CHECK – SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **B** What I admire most of all is her honesty. · Q2 **C** The last, we rejected outright. · Q3 (new) **B** The reason sales fell is that the store moved. Radio interview (Ex 1): 1 wasn't · that · 2 What we noticed · 3 wasn't until · 4 All we · 5 was that · 6 we didn't lose.

CLOSING THE MODULE

END OF C6: MODULE 2 WRAP-UP

Recap on slide 18, "weigh, add, place": **If they had accepted, they'd be bigger now · provided that the date holds · but for one loyal customer base** (weigh the options) → **Never have I... · Had it not been for... · So modest was he that...** (add the weight, sparingly) → **It wasn't the price that...; it was the parking · What happened was... · The first we dismissed at once** (place the weight). Learners tick the three "I can..." lists; anything unticked goes on a sticky note for you. Review it in the C7 warmer (**The Emphasis Track** is ready for that) and in the C13 progress-test catch-up.

Watch for in Module 3: 3.1 nominalization (*the decline of the economy*) works hand in hand with end-weight and extraposition: "What caused **the decline...**" Make the link out loud. 3.2 (reference, substitution and ellipsis) continues the cohesion work of C6: "*if so / if not*" from C4 are substitution in action. 3.3 (hedging and diplomatic English) builds directly on the tentative *should* (*Should you require...*) and the corrective it-cleft: both are diplomatic tools.

Progress Test 1 (C13) covers Modules 1–4. From this module it tests: mixed conditionals in both directions, the meaning of *in case / unless / provided that / even if, but for* + noun and *if it weren't / hadn't been for* with the right time frame, inversion after negative and restrictive adverbials (including *do*-support and *Only when... did...*), conditional inversion with an uncontracted negative, *So / Such* inversion, it-clefts and what-clefts (agreement of *be*, *The reason is that*), and choosing the continuation that respects given → new and end-weight. The writing and speaking tasks reward **appropriate** use: one well-placed inversion or cleft scores higher than four.

Module 3 — Cohesion, Register & Style

Three classes about the packaging of meaning rather than the meaning itself. First, **nominalization**: turning actions into nouns (*they decided to expand* → *the decision to expand*) to write in a compact, impersonal academic register, and, just as important, turning them back into verbs when a plain-English reader needs clarity. Then **cohesion**: reference, substitution and ellipsis (*this trend* · *the latter* · *do so* · *I hope not* · *I'd love to*), the quiet devices that stop a text repeating itself. Last, **softening**: academic hedging (*the data suggest... to some extent*), diplomatic English for bad news, disagreement, refusals and feedback (*I was wondering if...* · *I'm afraid...* · *the thing is...*), and casual vague language (*eightish, or so*).

3 lessons

Lessons 3.1–3.3

Classes C7–C9

Weeks 4–5

90 min per class

CEFR C1

HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

- One lesson block = one 90-minute class. Every class follows the same shape: **warmer** → **lead-in** → **Meaning / Form / Pronunciation** with concept-checking questions (CCQs) → **drill** → **controlled practice** (workbook) → a demanding **freer task** (a workshop, not a quick chat) → **feedback** with delayed error correction → **homework**.
- The **stage plan** is your clock. Each one adds up to 90 minutes. The numbers in the Time column are minutes.
- Present from `slides/module-3-cohesion-register.html`. Print `materials/module-3/classroom-materials.html` before C7. It holds the flashcards, the new identity cards, the **Register Workshop** source texts (verbal → academic) and **Plain English** notices (academic → plain), the **Repair the Report** drafts and talk-topic cards, the **Diplomatic Role-Play Series A/B** cards with observer sheets, the **Soften It!** board game and the listening scripts.
- The online lessons are the learners' **homework and review**. Each one has  Listen buttons, so learners can hear the model sentences again at home.
- These are skills classes, so run them as workshops.** Every class spends roughly a quarter of its time on one extended product: a rewritten text in two registers (C7), a repaired report plus a two-minute talk (C8), a series of four difficult workplace conversations (C9). Protect that time. If you're running late, shorten the controlled practice (set the rest for homework), never the workshop.
- Refinement, not a first meeting.** At B2 learners met the passive and impersonal reporting (B2 3.1), reduced clauses (B2 3.2), linking and formal/informal style (B2 Module 4) and polite requests. Don't re-teach any of it.

The C1 step is **control of register**: choosing, sentence by sentence, the packaging that fits *this* reader, and being able to justify the choice.

- ◆ **Feedback on three things.** In every freer task, take notes in three columns: **accuracy** (errors to fix: *the arrivement, an increase of prices, I don't hope so*), **range** (ambitious, well-chosen language to praise and spread: *pose a threat to, such a move, the latter, I'd have thought...*) and **appropriacy** (grammatical but wrong for the room: a nominalized friendly email, *the former / the latter* in a chat, *sort of* in a report, a "diplomatic" refusal so soft nobody noticed it was a refusal). At C1 the appropriacy column is often the most useful. In the feedback stage, board 2–3 items from each column, without names.
- ◆ **Peer review, every class.** Each workshop ends with a structured peer-review step, and each has its own test: the **"Who does what?" test** (C7: can a reader say who did what in each sentence?), the **"Point at it" test** (C8: draw an arrow from every *it / this / one* to what it refers to) and the **"What must change?" test** (C9: the listener says back what they understood they must do or accept). Reviewers always give **one strength** and **one suggestion**, in that order, and quote the text instead of summarizing it ("In line 3, *this* could point at two things").
- ◆ **Dominant speakers.** C1 classes often include confident professionals who are used to running meetings. Use the built-in roles: give them the jobs that need listening, not talking. In C7 they are the **plain-English reader** (who must honestly say where they get lost); in C8 the **tally-keeper** in the two-minute talk; in C9 the **observer** with the checklist. Say it kindly: "Your ear is excellent. I want you on the checklist this round." In whole-class feedback, use "a new voice first" before opening the floor.
- ◆ **Stretching strong learners toward C2.** Each lesson has a stretch box. The C2 direction for this module is **deliberate effect**: nominalizing to *hide* an agent on purpose and noticing when a text does it to you (C7), cohesion across paragraphs with summary nouns and cataphoric reference (*The problem is this: ...*) (C8), and calibrated understatement that a listener has to read between the lines (C9). Ask strong learners to explain the effect of a choice, not just make it.
- ◆ **American English is the classroom standard.** The online lessons use British spellings and words (*nominalisation, utilisation, analyse, behaviour, favour, criticise, colour, flat, quid, film*). Teach *nominalization, utilization, analyze, behavior, favor, criticize, color, apartment, dollars / bucks, movie*. Accept British forms whenever a learner uses them. Note that British English uses more understatement than American English; point that out in C9 rather than asking learners to copy it.
- ◆ Dashed boxes = lines to say out loud, CCQs and ICQs (instruction-checking questions). Green boxes = scripts you read aloud. **Amber** = watch-outs.

THE THROUGH-LINE

Package it → connect it → soften it. In C7 learners choose how to package an idea: as a verb (*we cut the budget, so staff were unhappy*) or as a noun (*budget cuts led to a decline in morale*), and learn that the best writers move in both directions. In C8 they connect ideas across sentences without repeating them (*this decline · such a move · the latter · I hope so · I'd love to*). In C9 they control force: hedging a claim so it is defensible and softening a message so the relationship survives it, without losing the message. Every class produces something another learner reads or hears: a two-register rewrite, a repaired report, a set of difficult conversations.

TRAUMA-INFORMED: REALISTIC WORKPLACES, LOW PERSONAL STAKES

Diplomatic English lives next to difficult moments: criticism, refusals, conflict with a boss, bad news. Keep every scenario **workplace-realistic but low-stakes and invented**: a delayed project, a rejected budget request, a vacation that can't be approved this month, a report that needs another draft, a colleague asking for too much help. **Never** role-play a firing or layoff, a disciplinary hearing, a medical diagnosis, a landlord eviction, a police or immigration interview, or a family conflict. The online lesson's journal asks learners to recall a real difficult conversation: always offer "a real one, an invented one, or one from a new identity card." Every role-play position is **assigned** on the card; learners play the role, not themselves, and anyone can say "Pass." Some learners come from workplaces where disagreeing with a manager was genuinely unsafe. Make it explicit that the C9 scenarios practice **language options**, not a rule that they must disagree with anyone in real life.

BEFORE THE MODULE

- ◆ Print the **flashcards** (one set for the board): verb → noun and light-verb collocation cards (C7); cohesion device cards (C8); softening cards color-coded by toolkit, H / D / V (C9). Four picture "register rooms" cards (book, email, coffee, notebook) are used in all three classes. Cut them before C7.
- ◆ For C7: one set of **Register Workshop** source cards (6 chatty texts, one per group of 3) and **Plain English** notices (4 over-nominalized texts, one per pair), plus one **two-register worksheet** per group.
- ◆ For C8: one **Repair the Report** draft per group of 3 (3 different reports), a **device checklist** per group, a set of **two-minute talk** topic cards and a phone timer.
- ◆ For C9: the **Diplomatic Role-Play Series** (4 scenarios × 2 versions, each an A/B pair) and one **observer checklist** per group of 3. The **Soften It!** board game (1 board per group, 1 die, counters) is for early finishers in C9 and the C10 warmer.
- ◆ Print the **new identity cards** (workplace profiles) and keep them on a side table where anyone can take one without asking.
- ◆ Optional but powerful: bring two real texts on the same light topic in two registers, for example a city's recycling page written for residents and the council report behind it, or a clinic's patient leaflet and the study it cites. Learners love finding the same fact packaged twice.

MODULE AT A GLANCE

LESSON	CLASS	FOCUS	LEARNERS CAN...
3.1	C7 • wk 4	Nominalization: noun-forming suffixes (<i>-tion, -ment, -ance, -ity, -ness, -al, -ure, -th</i>) and zero-derivation (<i>an increase</i>); process vs person/result nouns; light verbs (<i>carry out an investigation into, pose a threat to, reach a conclusion</i>); noun + preposition (<i>a rise in, the impact on</i>); why nominal style is concise, impersonal and abstract; over-nominalization and plain English	rewrite a chatty spoken update as a formal academic summary using nominalization, the passive and light verbs, then rewrite a bureaucratic notice in plain English for its real reader, and justify both choices
3.2	C8 • wk 4	Cohesion: reference (pronouns, <i>this / that</i> + summary noun, <i>such, the former / the latter, the above / as follows</i>); substitution (<i>one / ones, do / do so / do it, so / not</i>); ellipsis (after <i>and / but</i>, auxiliaries, <i>to</i>, comparatives) and the anchor word; ambiguity; register of each device	repair a repetitive report so it is at least a third shorter and completely unambiguous, and speak for two minutes on a familiar topic without repeating a noun or verb phrase they could point to, replace or omit
3.3	C9 • wk 5	Two reasons to soften; academic hedging (modals, <i>suggest / appear / tend to, arguably, to some extent, It would appear that...</i>); diplomatic softening (distancing with past / continuous / <i>would</i>, minimizers, litotes, negative questions, <i>with respect</i>); preface → soften → reason for bad news and refusals; vague language (<i>-ish, or so, sort of</i>); matching the register	handle four workplace-realistic difficult conversations (giving bad news, disagreeing with a manager, declining a request, softening criticism in feedback) so that the relationship is protected and the message still lands, and hedge an academic claim to the strength of its evidence

◆ OBJECTIVES – LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ form the noun from a verb or adjective with the right suffix, including irregulars (*believe* → *belief*, *choose* → *choice*, *grow* → *growth*) and zero-derivation (*increase* → *an increase*), and choose the process noun over the person noun (*the analysis*, not *the analyst*, of the data)
- ◆ rewrite a verb-heavy, agent-visible sentence in a compact, impersonal, noun-based style, using a **light verb** (*carry out*, *make*, *reach*, *pose*, *provide*, *bring about*) and the right **preposition** after the noun (*a reduction in*, *the impact on*, *an investigation into*)
- ◆ explain the three effects of nominal style (concise, impersonal, abstract) and recognize its partners: the passive, *there is / there are*, long noun phrases
- ◆ diagnose **over-nominalization** with the "Who does what?" test and rebalance the sentence with working verbs, producing plain English that is still serious
- ◆ choose the packaging for a given reader and genre, and justify the choice

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 3.1 (New words, Grammar box, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, Register Workshop frame, self-check)
- ◆ Slides 3–7 · Verb → noun and light-verb flashcards · "Register rooms" picture cards · **Register Workshop** source cards (6) · **Plain English** notices (4) · two-register worksheets · New identity cards
- ◆ Listening scripts 3.1-A (the team update and the written summary) and 3.1-B (dictation)

BOARD PLAN

Left: same fact, two packages. They decided to expand, which reduced their costs. (verbal · spoken · agent visible) → The decision to expand led to a reduction in costs. (nominal · written · agent hidden). Suffixes: -tion/-sion · -ment · -ance/-ence · -ity · -ness · -al · -ure · -th · zero (an increase). Irregulars: belief · choice · growth · analysis.

Center: the machinery. noun + light verb: *carry out an investigation into* · *make an assessment of* · *pose a threat to* · *reach a conclusion* · *bring about a change in* · *have an impact on*. Partners: passive · *there is* · long noun phrases. Effects: concise · impersonal · abstract.

Right: the other direction. *The implementation of the utilization of renewable resources is a requirement for the achievement of a reduction in emissions.* ✗ → *To reduce emissions, we must use renewable resources.* ✓ Test: Who does what? Can I tell in 3 seconds? If not → turn a noun back into a verb.

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: fronted and clefted	7	S-S	Review C6 (2.3, clefts and fronting). Board two flat sentences: "The schedule change annoyed people most." · "We need clearer instructions." Pairs rewrite each as a cleft and a fronted version (<i>What annoyed people most was...</i> · <i>Clearer instructions are what we need.</i> · <i>Most annoying of all was...</i>), then write one true or invented sentence about their week starting "What I..." (new identity cards available). Two pairs read theirs. Note one error and one range example.
Lead-in: two writers	5	T-S	Slide 3 (the four "register rooms": book, email, coffee, notebook). Board: "They decided to expand, which reduced their costs." and "The decision to expand led to a reduction in costs." Ask: "Same facts? (Yes.) Which one is from a coffee chat, which from a report? How do you know? Where did <i>they</i> go?" Elicit: the actions have become things. "Today: how to package an idea as a noun, and when not to."
Form: building the nouns	10	T-S → S-S	Slide 4. Don't lecture the suffix table: give pairs 90 seconds to sort ten verb and adjective flashcards by suffix, then check on the slide. Highlight irregulars (<i>belief, choice, growth, analysis, failure</i>), zero-derivation (<i>an increase, a rise, a change, a use</i>) and process vs person nouns (<i>analysis / analyst, production / product</i>). CCQs (below).
Meaning: why and how	10	T-S	Slide 5. The three effects (concise, impersonal, abstract) with one example each; the partners (passive, <i>there is</i> , long noun phrases). Then light verbs: a noun still needs a verb, but an empty one. Build <i>We investigated the cause</i> → <i>We carried out an investigation into the cause</i> and show why it's useful: the noun can take adjectives (<i>a thorough / preliminary / independent investigation</i>). Noun + preposition on the board: <i>a rise in, the impact on, a threat to, the cause of</i> .
Drill	6	T-S → S	Three rounds (see Drill script): verb → noun ping-pong, light-verb completion, whole-sentence transformation. Choral for the ping-pong, then individual.
Listening: the update and the summary	7	T-S → S-S	Workbook Ex 1. Read Script 3.1-A : first the spoken team update (chatty, verbal), then the written summary of the same meeting. First listening: "What happened to the delivery van project?" Second listening (summary only): learners complete seven

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			nominalizations. Pairs compare and match each noun to the verb in the spoken version.
Controlled practice	10	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 2–4 alone (nouns, light verbs + prepositions, verbal → nominal), then check in pairs. Board-check only the disagreements. Ex 5 (over-nominalization) is the bridge into the workshop: do item 1 together, leave the rest for homework.
Freer: Register Workshop	25	S-S → T-S	Slides 6–7. Round 1, Verbal → Academic (10 min): groups of 3 get a source card , a chatty spoken update (a team meeting, a clinic's healthy-habits pilot, a library's opening-hours trial...). They write a 4–5 sentence formal summary for a report on the two-register worksheet: at least 4 nominalizations, 2 light-verb collocations, 1 passive, no <i>we / they / I</i> . Round 2, Academic → Plain (8 min): each group gets a Plain English notice , an over-nominalized letter written for residents, patients or parents, and rewrites it so the real reader understands it in one read, keeping it polite and serious. Round 3, Peer review (7 min): groups swap both texts with the next group and run the " Who does what? " test (see below), then give one strength and one suggestion. Two groups read their pair of texts aloud; the class says which reader each version is for. ICQs first.
Feedback	5	T-S	Delayed correction in three columns. Accuracy, for example: "the arrivement of the order" · "an increase of prices" · "made an investigation about". Range: "posed a serious threat to", "brought about a change in". Appropriacy: a plain-English notice that still says "prior to the commencement of". Learners fix and discuss.
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Show online lesson 3.1 on screen; point at a  button. Set the homework (below). Learners tick the "I can..." box in the workbook.
Total	90		7 + 5 + 10 + 10 + 6 + 7 + 10 + 25 + 5 + 5

◆ MEANING • FORM • PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: nominalization. The information stays the same; the grammatical packaging changes. An action or quality becomes a noun, so it can be a subject or object, take adjectives, be counted and be linked to other nouns. The doer usually disappears.

SAY: "The decision to expand led to a reduction in costs." Who decided? (We don't know: the company, probably.) Did anyone reduce anything? (Yes, costs went down.) Is it a story about people or about

processes? (Processes.) Where would you read it? (A report, an article, a company update.)

SAY: "The analysis of the data" vs "the analyst of the data." Which is a process? (Analysis.) Which is a person? (Analyst.) Which one do we want in a report about results? (Usually the process: the analysis.)

Meaning: light verbs. In *carry out an investigation*, the meaning is in the noun. The verb just makes the grammar work.

SAY: "We carried out an investigation into the cause." Did anybody carry anything? (No.) Where is the real meaning? (In investigation.) Why not just "We investigated"? (Both are fine; the noun lets us add a thorough / an independent investigation.) · "Poor lighting poses a threat to cyclists." Is lighting a person? (No: an abstract noun can be the subject now.)

Meaning: over-nominalization. Too many abstract nouns and the reader can't find who did what. Dense is not the same as intelligent.

SAY: "The facilitation of the improvement of communication is an objective of the reorganization." Who is doing something? (Hard to say!) What is the real message? (The reorganization aims to improve communication.) Is the short version less serious? (No, just clearer.) · Would you send the long version to a friend? (No.) To tenants of a building? (Also no: they need to understand it quickly.)

Form.

Verb → noun	-tion / -sion · -ment · -ance / -ence · -al · -ure · zero	decide → decision · assess → assessment · perform → performance · arrive → arrival · fail → failure · increase → an increase
Adjective → noun	-ity · -ness · -th · -ance / -ence	stable → stability · aware → awareness · strong → strength · important → importance
Light verb + noun	make · carry out · conduct · reach · draw · provide · pose · bring about · have · place	reach a conclusion · pose a threat to · place emphasis on
Noun + preposition	the preposition often differs from the verb	increase → an increase in · impact → an impact on · investigate → an investigation into · respond → a response to
Agent after the noun	's or of / by	the company's rapid expansion · the approval of the proposal by the committee
Partners	passive · <i>there is / are</i> · long noun phrase	No explanation was provided. · There is growing recognition that... · a significant reduction in urban air pollution levels

Pronunciation. Suffixes move the stress, and learners who know the verb often stress the noun wrongly. -tion / -sion / -ity put the stress on the syllable just before them: *deCIDE* → *deCision*, *eDUcate* → *eduCAtion*, *STable* → *staBility*, *COMplex* → *comPLEXity*. -ment, -ness, -al, -ure don't move it: *deVElop* → *deVElopment*, *aWARE* → *aWAREness*. Zero-derivation often shifts stress to the first syllable for the noun: *to inCREASE* → *an INcrease*, *to reCORD* → *a REcord*. For formal read-aloud, long noun phrases need chunking: "The committee's approval of the proposal | ensured its swift implementation."

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 **Ping-pong** (fast, choral then individual): T: "decide" → S: "decision." T: "aware" → "awareness." T: "fail" → "failure." T: "grow" → "growth." T: "believe" → "belief." T: "increase" → "an INcrease" (exaggerate the stress). T: "analyze" → "analysis." T: "complex" → "complexity."
- 2 **Light verb, please:** T: "an investigation" → S: "carry out / conduct an investigation into." T: "a conclusion" → "reach / draw a conclusion." T: "a threat" → "pose a threat to." T: "emphasis" → "place emphasis on." T: "a contribution" → "make a contribution to."
- 3 **Package it:** T: "They decided to close the branch." → S: "The decision was made to close the branch. / The decision to close the branch..." T: "Prices went up because more people were buying." → S: "Rising demand led to a price increase." T: "The new law really helped small businesses grow." → S: "The legislation contributed significantly to the growth of small businesses."
- 4 **Unpack it** (the reverse): T: "The utilization of the software resulted in an enhancement of accuracy." → S: "Using the software made the measurements more accurate." T: "There was a consideration of the postponement of the vote." → S: "They considered postponing the vote."

◆ REGISTER WORKSHOP – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ **Groups of 3** with three roles: **writer** (holds the pen), **editor** (checks the checklist) and **plain-English reader** (in Round 2, reads the rewrite as if they were the tenant, patient or parent, and must honestly say where they got lost). Rotate the pen between rounds. Give the plain-English reader job to a dominant speaker.
- ◆ **Round 1 (10 min):** each group gets one source card, a chatty spoken update (topics: a team trial of a four-day work pattern, a clinic's walking-group pilot, a library's longer opening hours, a bike-lane trial, an office move to shared desks, a school's phone-free lunch trial). They write a 4–5 sentence formal summary for a report. Checklist on the worksheet: ☐ 4+ nominalizations ☐ 2 light-verb collocations ☐ 1 passive ☐ 1 *there is / are* ☐ no *I / we / they* ☐ facts unchanged.
- ◆ **Round 2 (8 min):** each group gets one Plain English notice (a building-management letter about elevator repairs, a clinic letter about appointment changes, a school letter about pickup times, an office memo about a new expense form). They rewrite it for its real reader: short sentences, active verbs, *you / we*, and no loss of politeness or facts. They may keep a nominalization when it names a real thing the reader knows (*the repairs, your appointment*).

- ◆ **Round 3, peer review (7 min):** swap with the next group. Run the **"Who does what?" test** on both texts: for every sentence, can you say in three seconds who does what? In the academic text, the answer may properly be "it's hidden," but the *relationship* must be clear (X led to Y). In the plain text, the answer must be obvious. Reviewers write one strength and one suggestion on a sticky note, quoting the text.
- ◆ **Share:** two groups read both versions aloud. Ask the class: "Which reader is each version for? Would either one work in the other room?"
- ◆ Keep it honest: there is no single right answer. Praise any version that fits its reader and keeps the facts.

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE REGISTER WORKSHOP

SAY: *In Round 1, who's the reader? (A manager reading a report.) Can you use "we"? (No.) How many nominalizations at least? (Four.) Can you change the facts? (No.) · In Round 2, who's the reader? (The tenant / patient / parent.) More nouns or more verbs? (More verbs.) Can it be rude or chatty? (No: polite and clear.) · In the peer review, what's the question for every sentence? (Who does what?)*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Some C1 speakers are much stronger orally than in writing (often learners with interrupted schooling who have lived in English for years). Give them the **suffix table on a strip** and a set of four noun + light-verb "chunks" to copy into Round 1 (*led to a reduction in · carried out an assessment of · there was an increase in · had a positive impact on*). In Round 2 they're the ideal plain-English reader: their honest "I got lost here" is exactly what the group needs. Fewer items: Ex 2 items 1–8, Ex 4 items 1–3. Target: one clean nominal sentence and one clean plain-English sentence, read aloud.

STRETCH (TOWARD C2)

Nominalization as **strategy**. Give a sentence like *Mistakes were made in the processing of your application*: who is being protected by the grammar? Ask strong learners to write two versions of one bad-news sentence: one that hides responsibility and one that takes it (*We made a mistake when we processed your application*), and to say which a customer would trust. Then ask them to build one long, well-controlled noun phrase (*a gradual but measurable improvement in patient satisfaction scores*) and a sentence where a nominalization refers back to a whole earlier paragraph (*This reorganization...*), which leads straight into C8.

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **Over-nominalizing by default:** academic writing in Spanish, Portuguese, French, Italian, Arabic, Russian and German (*Nominalstil*) often prizes long noun chains, so these learners may produce "the realization of the implementation of..." with pride. Frame it as a **genre difference**, not an error: English academic style is noun-based too, but it expects a working verb in every sentence.

- ◆ **False-friend nouns:** Spanish *realización* and French *réalisation* → "the realization of a meeting" (= holding); *actualización* → "actualization" (= update); *formación* → "formation" (= training). Portuguese *efetivação*, Italian *attuazione* produce similar coinages. Ask "Is that a real English noun?" and check a learner's dictionary together.
- ◆ **Invented suffixes:** "the arrivement," "the deciding," "the failment," "ableness." Everyone does this; treat each noun as vocabulary to learn, not assemble.
- ◆ **Articles with abstract nouns:** Russian, Polish, Chinese, Japanese, Korean and Vietnamese speakers may drop them ("Decision to expand led to reduction in costs"); Spanish, French, Portuguese and Arabic speakers may add them to general statements ("The education is important"). Rule of thumb: general and uncountable → no article (*Education matters*); specific, with an *of*-phrase → *the* (*the education of refugees' children*), and a count noun with an adjective → *a* (*a sharp increase*).
- ◆ **Wrong preposition after the noun:** "an increase of prices" (Spanish *un aumento de*, French *une augmentation des*), "an impact in," "an investigation about," "a solution of." Teach noun + preposition as one chunk.
- ◆ **Stress on derived nouns:** learners who read far more English than they hear often say *de-CI-sion* correctly but *STA-bi-li-ty*, *e-CO-no-my* / *e-co-NO-mic*, *PHO-to-graph* / *pho-TO-gra-phy* wrongly. Use the Pronunciation note above.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 3.1: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-c1/lesson_07.html. Listen to the five model sentences with 🗣️ and say them back with the right stress on each noun; do Exercises 1–3, the Quick Quiz and the "From Spoken to Scholarly" project (record the 90-second briefing on a phone if possible). Workbook 3.1: finish Exercise 5, "My new words" and the journal (one sentence about your week in three versions: plain verbal, nominal academic, and deliberately over-nominalized, then one line on why the middle version is best for a report).

◆ CHECK – SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **A** ability · Q2 **B** It's over-nominalized: rebalance with plain verbs · Q3 (new) **C** The survey showed a sharp increase in demand for evening classes. Listening (Ex 1): 1 introduction · 2 assessment · 3 increase · 4 failure · 5 reduction · 6 approval · 7 implementation.

◆ OBJECTIVES — LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ refer back cleanly with pronouns, **this / that + a summary noun** (*this decline, these findings, such a move*), *the former / the latter* and formal *the above / as follows*, and repair an ambiguous *it* or *this*
- ◆ substitute with **one / ones** (countable nouns only), **do / do so / do it** (verb phrases) and **so / not** (clauses after *think, hope, be afraid*, etc.), including *I don't think so* vs *I hope not*
- ◆ leave out recoverable words (**ellipsis**) after *and / but*, after auxiliaries, after *to* and in comparatives, keeping the **anchor word** (*I'd love to. · but Sara has.*)
- ◆ choose devices that fit the register: *do so, such, the latter, the above* in writing; *one, do it, I think so* and ellipsis in speech
- ◆ repair a repetitive text so it is much shorter and still completely clear, and sustain cohesion in two minutes of unscripted speech

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 3.2 (New words, Grammar box, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, Repair the Report frame, self-check)
- ◆ Slides 8–12 · Cohesion device flashcards · **Repair the Report** drafts (3) + device checklists · **Two-minute talk** topic cards · phone timer · New identity cards
- ◆ Listening scripts 3.2-A (the handover call) and 3.2-B (dictation)

BOARD PLAN

Left: point back (reference). it · they · **this / that + noun** (*this trend, such a move, these findings*) · the former / the latter · the above / as follows (formal). ✗ *Sales fell and the CEO resigned. It was unexpected.* → ✓ *The resignation was unexpected.*

Center: swap it (substitution). the red **one** / the old **ones** (count only! coffee → **some**) · She works harder than I **do**. · If you fail to **do so...** (formal) · I **did it** the next day (concrete) · I think **so** / I don't think so · I hope **not** / I'm afraid **not** (✗ I don't hope so).

Right: drop it (ellipsis). He was poor but ~~he was~~ honest. · I haven't finished, but Sam **has finished**. · I'd love **to come**. · more than I expected ~~it to cost~~. Keep the anchor: **to** / the auxiliary. Three questions: point to it? swap it? drop it?

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer:	8	S–S	Review C7. Board four sentences, two verbal and two over-nominalized ("We looked into why the printer keeps jamming." ·

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
unpack			"The introduction of the new rota brought about an improvement in the satisfaction of staff."). Pairs convert each in the other direction, then decide which reader each version suits. Quick check of the nouns' stress (<i>an INcrease, staBility</i>). Collect homework journals, or glance at them.
Lead-in: the robot committee	5	T-S	Read the repetitive "committee" text from slide 8 in a flat robot voice ("The committee rejected the proposal. The committee felt the proposal was too expensive..."). Learners count the repetitions of <i>committee</i> and <i>proposal</i> . Then read the cohesive version with natural rhythm. "Same information. What did the second speaker do?" Elicit: point back, swap, leave out.
Reference	12	T-S → S-S	Slide 9. Pronouns quickly; spend the time on this / that pointing at a whole idea and the fix for ambiguity: this + summary noun . Pairs get 3 minutes to write a summary noun for four board sentences ("Rents have doubled in five years. This ___ has..." → <i>this increase / rise / trend</i>). Then <i>such, the former / the latter</i> and their register (writing, not a chat). CCQs.
Substitution & ellipsis	12	T-S	Slide 10. <i>one / ones</i> (and not for uncountables), <i>do / do so / do it</i> with register, <i>so / not</i> after thinking verbs with the <i>think vs hope</i> negative split. Then ellipsis: strike out the echoed words on the board with learners calling "drop it!" and ring the anchor that must stay. CCQs.
Drill	6	T-S → S	Quick-fire questions for <i>so / not</i> and ellipsis responses (see Drill script). Choral, then individuals, then open pairs.
Listening: the handover call	6	T-S → S-S	Workbook Ex 1. Read Script 3.2-A twice (two voices, or with a confident learner). First: "What does Priya still have to do?" Second: learners write what each underlined device refers to. Pairs compare. Slide 11 shows the model exchange from the online lesson for comparison.
Controlled practice	10	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 2-4 alone (replace the repetition, ellipsis, fix the faulty reference), then check in pairs. Board-check disagreements only. Ex 5 (the short repair) is homework unless a pair finishes early.
Freer: Repair the Report +	21	S-S → T-S	Slide 12. Repair (10 min) : groups of 3 get one clunky report (about 140 words: a facilities report on the office kitchen, a pilot report on a tenants' composting scheme, a customer survey

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
the two-minute talk			summary for a bike-repair shop). Target: 90 words or fewer , every fact kept, at least 2 reference, 2 substitution and 2 ellipsis devices, register consistent (it's a written report). Peer review (5 min) : swap reports and run the " Point at it " test: draw an arrow from every <i>it / they / this / that / one / the latter / do so</i> to what it refers to. Any arrow with two possible targets = a flag. Two-minute talk (6 min) : in the same groups, one speaker talks for two minutes from a topic card; the tally-keeper counts full repetitions and devices; the third listener gives one strength and one suggestion. Swap roles as time allows (at least one speaker per group). ICQs first.
Feedback	5	T-S	Three columns on the board. Accuracy: "if you want a milk one" · "I don't hope so" · "I'd love." Range: "such a move," "the latter," "Those who fail to do so." Appropriacy: "the former... the latter" in a casual chat, or an ellipsis so heavy the listener was lost. Learners fix and say which test caught it.
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Show online lesson 3.2 and a 📶 button. Set the homework (below). Learners tick "I can...".
Total	90		8 + 5 + 12 + 12 + 6 + 6 + 10 + 21 + 5 + 5

◆ MEANING • FORM • PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: reference. A reference word sends the reader to find something elsewhere in the text, usually earlier. It must be impossible to point at the wrong thing.

SAY: "House prices rose sharply. This surprised economists." What does this point at? (The whole idea: the sharp rise.) A single noun or a whole sentence? (A whole sentence.) How can we make it even clearer? (This **rise** / this **increase** surprised...) · "We can fly or take the train; the latter is cheaper." Which is cheaper? (The train, the second one.) Would you say "the latter" to a friend over coffee? (Probably not: "the train's cheaper.")

Meaning: substitution. A short stand-in replaces a repeated word of the same kind: *one* for a count noun, *do* (so) for a verb phrase, *so* / *not* for a whole clause.

SAY: "I'll take the red one." One what? (The red jacket: something countable we already mentioned.) Can I say "Is there coffee? — Yes, there's a hot one"? (No, coffee is uncountable here: "Yes, there's some.") · "Applicants must register by Friday; those who fail to do so will lose their place." Do so = ? (Register by Friday.) Formal or chatty? (Formal: a notice.) · "Will he pass?" — "I hope not." Do I want him to pass?

(No!) Can I say "I don't hope so"? (No: hope and be afraid take not.) · "I don't think so" vs "I think not": which is normal in conversation? (I don't think so. "I think not" sounds formal or old-fashioned.)

Meaning: ellipsis. We leave out words the listener can recover. It's the natural rhythm of English, not laziness; repeating everything sounds robotic or even aggressive.

SAY: "I haven't read the memo, but Sara has." Has Sara read what? (The memo.) Which word must stay? (has: it holds the meaning.) · "Are you coming?" — "I'd love to." Can I say "I'd love"? (No: keep to.) · "The results were significant; the controls were not." Is ellipsis OK in a formal report? (Yes: ordinary ellipsis works in every register.) · "Seen it?" "Told you." Formal or informal? (Very informal: speech only.)

Form.

Reference	it · they · this / that / these / those (+ noun) · such (a) + noun · the former / the latter · the above · as follows	These findings... · Such a move... · For the above reasons...
one / ones	replaces a count noun (keep the adjective or <i>this / which</i>)	the small one · the new ones · Which one?
do / do so / do it	auxiliary <i>do</i> in comparisons and tags · <i>do so</i> (formal, general action) · <i>do it / that</i> (concrete, spoken)	She works harder than I do. · if you fail to do so · I did it the next morning
so / not	after think, believe, expect, suppose, imagine, guess, hope, be afraid	I think so / I don't think so · I hope so / I hope not · I'm afraid so / I'm afraid not
Ellipsis	after and / but / or · after an auxiliary · after <i>to</i> · in comparatives	poor but honest · but Sam has · I'd love to · more than we expected

Pronunciation. Ellipsis moves the stress onto the **anchor**, which becomes strong: "I haven't finished, but **Sam has**" /bæt 'sæm 'hæz/, not a weak /əz/. The same with *to*: "I'd love **to**" /aɪd 'lʌv tu:/, with a full vowel, never /tə/ at the end. In *I think so / I hope not*, the stress normally falls on the verb or *not*: "I **think** so," "I hope **not**." Contrastive *one*: stress the adjective, not *one*: "not the **big** one, the **small** one."

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 So or not?** T asks, S answers with the cue: T: "Is it going to rain? (think, yes)" → S: "I think so." T: " (think, no)" → "I don't think so." T: "Will the train be late? (hope, no)" → "I hope not." T: "Is the meeting canceled? (afraid, yes)" → "I'm afraid so." T: "(afraid, no)" → "I'm afraid not."
- 2 Keep the anchor:** T: "Have you sent the report?" (no / Kim yes) → S: "No, but Kim has." T: "Can you come on Friday?" (want, but can't) → "I'd like to, but I can't." T: "Did you finish on time?" (should have, didn't) → "I should have, but I didn't." Stress the anchor.

- 3 **One or some?** T: "Do you need a pen?" → S: "No thanks, I've got one." T: "Do you need some paper?" → "No thanks, I've got some." T: "Which chairs do you want?" → "The black ones."
- 4 **Summary noun:** T reads a sentence, S starts the next with *This + noun*: T: "Sales doubled in March." → S: "This increase..." T: "The manager canceled the trip." → "This decision..." T: "Three staff members left in one month." → "These departures..."

◆ REPAIR THE REPORT + THE TWO-MINUTE TALK – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ **Groups of 3.** Each gets one Repair the Report draft and a device checklist. The drafts are deliberately terrible: every noun repeated, every verb phrase in full. Tell learners that's the joke; they may laugh.
- ◆ **Repair (10 min):** rewrite in 90 words or fewer (the original is about 140). Every fact must survive. Tick the checklist as they go: ☐ 2+ reference (at least one *this / these* + summary noun) ☐ 2+ substitution ☐ 2+ ellipsis ☐ no ambiguous *it / this* ☐ written-report register (*so do so, such, the latter* are welcome; *and stuff* is not). The word-counter counts.
- ◆ **Peer review (5 min):** swap with another group and run the "**Point at it**" test: the reviewers draw an arrow in pencil from every reference and substitution word to its target. An arrow that could land in two places gets a "?" flag. Then one strength and one suggestion, quoting the text. Return the drafts; groups fix any flags.
- ◆ **Two-minute talk (6 min):** the speaker picks a topic card (a place they know well, how their workplace or school has changed, a skill they learned, a tool or app they rely on; a new identity card or an invented answer is always fine). The **tally-keeper** makes two columns: **repeats** (a full noun or verb phrase repeated when it could have been replaced) and **devices** (*it, this, one, so, I did, the latter...*). The third learner gives the strength-and-suggestion feedback. Give the tally-keeper job to your most dominant speaker first.
- ◆ **Share:** one group reads its repaired report; the class checks it with the "Point at it" test live on the board.

◆ ICQS BEFORE REPAIR THE REPORT

SAY: *How many words at the end? (90 or fewer.) Can you delete a fact? (No.) Is this a chat or a written report? (A written report.) So the latter and do so are...? (Fine, good.) What do reviewers draw? (Arrows from each it / this / one to what it means.) What does a "?" mean? (It could point at two things: fix it.) · In the talk, what does the tally-keeper count? (Repeats and devices.)*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Give the report on a sheet with the repeated nouns already **highlighted**, and a strip of six ready-made devices to try (*it · they · this problem · the latter · one · did*). The learner's job is to cross out and replace, not to rewrite from scratch. Speaking is often the stronger skill: in the two-minute talk they can go first, with a 30-second planning time and the phrase strip on the table. Fewer items: Ex 2 items 1–5, Ex 3 items 1–4. Target: five repetitions replaced, one "I hope not / I'm afraid so" used in speech.

STRETCH (TOWARD C2)

Cohesion **across paragraphs**. Ask strong learners to add a two-sentence closing paragraph to their repaired report that opens with a summary noun referring to the whole report (*These problems...*, *Such an arrangement...*). Introduce **cataphoric** reference (pointing forward): *The problem is this: nobody owns the kitchen.* · *Here's what I'd suggest: ...* and **lexical cohesion** (synonyms and general nouns instead of pronouns: *the scheme... the initiative... the pilot*). In the talk, the target is zero repeats and at least one forward reference.

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ "I think yes" / "I think that yes" / "I hope no": Spanish *creo que sí / espero que no*, Portuguese *acho que sim*, French *je pense que oui*, Italian *credo di sì*. Very common even at C1 in speech. Drill *so / not* until it's automatic; keep "I think yes ✗" on the board.
- ◆ **Dropped subjects and objects**: pro-drop languages (Spanish, Italian, Portuguese, Arabic) drop the subject ("Is very expensive"); Chinese, Japanese and Korean often drop the object as well ("I bought the report and read"). These learners may *over-elide* in English. Remind them: English ellipsis needs an anchor.
- ◆ **Gendered it**: French, Spanish, Portuguese, German, Arabic and Russian speakers may refer to a thing as *he / she* ("The proposal... she is too expensive"). Recast gently to *it*.
- ◆ **Repetition as good style**: in some languages and school traditions (for example, Chinese, Korean, Japanese and some formal Arabic writing), repeating the full noun is clearer and more respectful than a pronoun. Learners don't hear it as clumsy. Explain that English readers do.
- ◆ **"one" for everything**: "a coffee one," "an information one," "the advices ones." Tie it to the countable / uncountable distinction learners already know.
- ◆ **Formal devices in speech**: learners from exam-focused systems use *the former / the latter* and *aforementioned* in conversation. Praise the range, then point out the register: "Perfect in your report. At the coffee machine: *the first one / the second one*."

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 3.2: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-c1/lesson_08.html. Listen to the five model sentences with 🎧 and say them back (stress the anchor word); do Exercises 1–3, the Quick Quiz and the

"Repetitive → Cohesive" project. Workbook 3.2: Exercise 5 (the short repair), "My new words" and the journal (find a paragraph you wrote recently, or use the one on your new identity card, and note two repetitions you didn't hear at the time and how you fixed them).

◆ CHECK – SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **C** do so · Q2 **A** "I haven't read the memo, but Sara has." · Q3 (new) **B** I hope not. Handover call (Ex 1): 1 the supplier's invoice · 2 check the invoice · 3 chairs (the new chairs) · 4 (have) sent the figures to finance · 5 (that) the budget will be approved on Monday · 6 (that) the delivery date will move again · 7 the meeting-room order · 8 the training-room order. Priya still has to check the invoice tomorrow and place the meeting-room order (urgent); the training-room order can wait.

◆ OBJECTIVES – LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ tell the **two reasons to soften** apart: protecting a claim (academic caution) and protecting a person (diplomacy), plus a third, casual kind: vague language for rapport
- ◆ hedge a claim to the strength of the evidence with modals (*may, might, could, tend to*), lexical verbs (*suggest, appear, indicate*), adverbials (*arguably, largely, to some extent*) and impersonal frames (*It would appear that..., There is some evidence that...*), without hedging it into nothing
- ◆ soften requests and opinions with **distancing** (*I was wondering if..., Would it be possible...*), **minimizers** (*a slight problem, not exactly ideal*), **litotes** (*not the cheapest*), **negative questions** (*Wouldn't it be safer...?*) and **deference markers** (*With respect...*)
- ◆ deliver bad news and refusals with **preface → soften → reason** (+ an alternative), and give critical feedback that the listener can act on
- ◆ handle four workplace-realistic difficult conversations so that the relationship survives and the message still lands

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 3.3 (New words, Grammar box, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, role-play planning grid, self-check)
- ◆ Slides 13–17 · Softening flashcards (H / D / V colors) · **Diplomatic Role-Play Series** cards (4 scenarios × 2 versions, A/B) · observer checklists · **Soften It!** board game (early finishers, C10 warmer) · New identity cards
- ◆ Listening scripts 3.3-A (the feedback conversation) and 3.3-B ("What do they really mean?")

BOARD PLAN

Left: why soften? Three rooms. H protect the claim (academic): *The data suggest... may... to some extent · It would appear that...* · D protect the person (diplomatic): *I was wondering if... · I'm not entirely convinced · a slight problem · With respect...* · V sound relaxed (casual): *eightish · twenty or so · sort of · and stuff. ✕ The results were sort of significant.*

Center: the distance ladder. Can you send it today? → Could you...? → Would it be possible to...? → I was wondering if you could... (past + continuous = more distance = more polite). Negative question: *Wouldn't it be safer to wait?* Litotes: *not the cheapest* = expensive · *not bad at all* = good.

Right: bad news frame. Preface (I'm afraid... / Unfortunately... / The thing is...) → **Soften** (it's not going to be possible to... / we won't quite be able to...) → **Reason** (...because the budget's already committed) → **Alternative** (Could we perhaps look at... instead?). Test: gentle and clear: can the listener say what must change?

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: so, not and the anchor	7	S-S	Review C8. Pairs ask each other quick yes/no questions about light topics (the weather this weekend, the next class, a sports result, a work deadline); partners must answer with <i>I think so / I hope not / I'm afraid so / I'd love to / I should have, but...</i> , never with the full clause. Then each pair repairs a three-sentence repetitive text on the board ("I bought a new phone. The new phone is faster than my old phone. I like the new phone.").
Lead-in: the blunt manager	5	T-S	Slide 13. Say, deadpan: "Your report is full of mistakes." Pause. "How do you feel? What will you do next?" Then: "This study proves that coffee improves memory." "Would a scientist write that? Why not?" Elicit the two reasons: protecting the person and protecting the claim . Add the third room with "See you around eightish!"
Academic hedging	10	T-S → S-S	Slide 14. The four families (modals, lexical verbs, adverbials, impersonal frames). Build a claim up the "caution scale" on the board: <i>proves</i> → <i>shows</i> → <i>suggests</i> → <i>may suggest</i> → <i>There is some evidence that... may...</i> Then the danger of over-hedging: stack six hedges until the claim says nothing, and let learners laugh. Pairs hedge one over-strong claim (Ex 3 item 1). CCQs.
Diplomatic softening & bad news	12	T-S	Slides 15–16. The distance ladder; minimizers; litotes (with a quick "What does it really mean?" guessing round using Script 3.3-B); negative questions and tags; <i>With respect / If you don't mind me saying</i> . Then the preface → soften → reason → alternative frame on slide 16, modeled with one refusal. Stress that the message must still land: "gentle <u>and</u> clear."
Vague language & matching the register	5	T-S	Back to slide 13 (the H / D / V table). Hold up softening flashcards one at a time; learners call out H , D or V and name the room (a report, a meeting, a chat with a friend). Note: over-precision in casual talk ("I'll arrive at 7:43") sounds odd too.
Drill	6	T-S → S	Distance ladder, soften-the-blunt and intonation (see Drill script). Choral, then individuals.
Listening: the feedback conversation	6	T-S → S-S	Workbook Ex 1. Read Script 3.3-A twice (a team lead giving feedback on a newsletter draft). First: "What exactly does Dev have to change?" (If learners can't say, the softening failed; they can.) Second: complete the seven softeners. Pairs compare.

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Controlled practice	8	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 2-4 (soften the blunt, hedge the claim, label H / V / D). Pairs check. Ex 5 (litotes) is homework or for early finishers.
Freer: Diplomatic Role-Play Series	21	S-S → T-S	Slide 17. Groups of 3: A (has to deliver the difficult message), B (receives it; the card says how B feels and what B wants), Observer (checklist). Four rounds, one per scenario, roles rotate each round: ① giving bad news · ② disagreeing with a manager · ③ declining a request · ④ softening criticism in feedback . Each round: 1 min to read and plan (the workbook grid), 2½ min conversation, 1½ min observer feedback including the "What must change?" test (B says, in one sentence, what they now understand). ICQs first. Early finishers play Soften It!
Feedback	5	T-S	Three columns. Accuracy: "I want that you send it" · "Can you to check" · "You're coming, isn't it?" Range: "I'd have thought...", "not exactly ideal", "Would it be at all possible...". Appropriacy: the refusal that never said no; the blunt "You must change this" to a manager; "sort of" in the hedged claim. Learners fix and say how B might have felt.
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Show online lesson 3.3 and a 🗣️ button. Set the homework (below). Learners tick the "I can..." lists for all of Module 3.
Total	90		7 + 5 + 10 + 12 + 5 + 6 + 6 + 8 + 21 + 5 + 5

◆ MEANING · FORM · PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: academic hedging. You calibrate the claim to the evidence. A hedged claim is *stronger* in academic terms, because it is harder to attack.

SAY: "These results suggest that caffeine may improve memory in some conditions." Did the study prove it? (No.) Is the writer weak or careful? (Careful.) Which is easier for a critic to attack: this or "proves"? ("Proves.") · "It would seem, arguably, that it may possibly tend to help to some extent in some cases." What is the claim? (We can't tell: too many hedges.)

Meaning: distancing. Past tense, continuous and *would* move a request "further away," so it sounds less demanding. The time is still now.

SAY: "I was wondering if you could do me a favor." Past or present request? (Present: I'm asking now.) Why the past tense, then? (It's softer, less direct.) · "Wouldn't it be safer to wait?" Is the speaker asking for information? (No: suggesting we wait.) Is the speaker giving an order? (No: inviting agreement.)

Meaning: minimizers and litotes.

SAY: "There's a slight problem with the figures." Could it be a big problem? (Yes! Listen to the tone and the context.) · "It's not the cheapest option." Cheap or expensive? (Expensive.) · "I'm not entirely convinced this will work." Does the speaker agree? (No, they think it won't work.)

Meaning: preface → soften → reason.

SAY: "I'm afraid that's not going to be possible this time. The thing is, the budget's already committed. Could we perhaps revisit it in the spring?" Is it a yes or a no? (A no.) Is it clear? (Yes.) Is there a reason? (The budget.) What does the listener get instead? (A possible alternative: spring.) · If I only say "Hmm, that might be a bit tricky..." and stop, what's the risk? (The listener might think it's a yes.)

Form.

H · modals	may · might · could · would tend to · can	Rising temperatures may accelerate the decline.
H · lexical verbs	seem · appear · suggest · indicate · tend to · point to	The data suggest a link rather than prove one.
H · adverbials	arguably · apparently · relatively · largely · generally · to some extent · in some respects	The policy was largely successful.
H · frames	It would appear / seem that... · There is some evidence that... · It could be argued that...	It would appear that the effect is smaller than expected.
D · distancing	past · continuous · would	I was hoping you could help. · Would it be possible to...?
D · minimizers, litotes	a slight / a bit of a · just · not exactly · not entirely · not the (best)	It's not exactly ideal. · I'm not entirely convinced.
D · questions, markers	negative question · tag · With respect, ... · If you don't mind me saying, ...	Wouldn't it be better to wait? · That's a bit risky, isn't it?
Bad news	preface → soften → reason (→ alternative)	Unfortunately, we won't be able to... as... Perhaps we could... instead.
V · vague	-ish · or so · sort of / kind of · and that sort of thing · a couple of · roughly	Come round eightish. · There were twenty or so people.

Pronunciation. Softening is half intonation. A **fall-rise** on the key word signals "there's a *but* coming" or "I'm not saying everything": "The opening's ~strong..." (...but the rest isn't). A flat, falling tone on a softened sentence can undo all the words ("I was wondering if you could send it" said flatly sounds like an order).

Requests with *Would it be possible...?* rise gently at the end. Keep *just, a bit, slightly* unstressed; stressing them sounds sarcastic ("It's a **BIT** late"). Tag questions that seek agreement fall: "It's a bit risky, *isn't it?*"

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 **The distance ladder** (choral, then individual): T: "Send me the file." → S: "Can you send me the file?" → "Could you send me the file?" → "Would it be possible to send me the file?" → "I was wondering if you could send me the file." Then with a new request: "Move the meeting."
- 2 **Soften the blunt**: T: "That's wrong." → S: "I'm not sure that's quite right." T: "That's a bad idea." → "I'm not entirely convinced that's the best idea." T: "It's expensive." → "It's not the cheapest option." T: "It's late." → "It's a little behind schedule."
- 3 **Hedge the claim**: T: "Exercise improves mood." → S: "Regular exercise appears to improve mood in many people." T: "Remote work increases productivity." → "There is some evidence that remote work may increase productivity, at least in some roles."
- 4 **Preface, please**: T gives the bad news bluntly, S adds the preface and reason: T: "No vacation in August." → S: "I'm afraid we can't approve August this year. The thing is, half the team is already away. Would September work instead?"
- 5 **Intonation**: say "The opening's strong..." with a fall-rise and a pause; learners finish the "but." Then say "I was wondering if you could help" flat, then warm; learners judge which one they'd say yes to.

◆ DIPLOMATIC ROLE-PLAY SERIES – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ **Groups of 3**. Four scenarios, each with two versions (1 and 2) so neighboring groups aren't identical. Every card gives the setting, the relationship (peer, manager, client, team member), the message A *must* deliver, and how B feels and what B wants. Positions are assigned: nobody is expressing their own view of their own boss.
- ◆ ① **Giving bad news**: a project lead tells a client the delivery will be two weeks late (v1); an office manager tells a team their requested standing desks aren't in this year's budget (v2).
- ◆ ② **Disagreeing with a manager**: a manager wants to launch a new booking app to customers next week without testing (v1); a manager proposes moving the team's weekly meeting to 7:30 a.m. (v2). A disagrees respectfully and proposes an alternative; B (the manager) is attached to the idea but open to a good argument.
- ◆ ③ **Declining a request**: a colleague asks A to cover their Saturday shift, but A has a family commitment (v1); a manager asks A to take on a third project while A is already overloaded (v2). A must say no (or "not now") and protect the relationship.
- ◆ ④ **Softening criticism in feedback**: A gives feedback on a colleague's presentation slides that are too crowded (v1), or on a new team member's customer emails that are too informal (v2). A must start with a real strength and name one specific change; B is proud of the work.

- ◆ **Each round (5 min):** 1 min plan with the workbook grid (preface, softeners, reason, alternative) · 2½ min conversation · 1½ min observer feedback. The observer ticks: ☐ preface ☐ 3+ different softeners ☐ reason ☐ alternative or next step ☐ message clear. Then the **"What must change?" test:** B says in one sentence what they now understand ("So the delivery will be on the 18th, not the 4th"). If B can't, the message was over-softened.
- ◆ **Rotate roles** after every round so each learner plays A, B and Observer at least once. With pairs only, drop the observer and B fills in the checklist after the conversation.
- ◆ **Whole-class share (last minute):** ask one group to replay their best 30 seconds of scenario ②, the hardest one.

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE ROLE-PLAY SERIES

SAY: *Are you playing yourself? (No, the card.) How many scenarios? (Four.) Do roles change? (Yes, every round.) What does the observer count? (The preface, softeners, the reason, the alternative.) After the conversation, what does B say? (What they understood: what must change.) If B can't say it? (It was too soft.) Can you say "Pass"? (Yes.)*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Give a **four-line frame card** for A: "I'm afraid... / The thing is... / I know that... / Could we perhaps...?" and let the learner say it from the card. In feedback scenarios, give two ready-made openers ("I really liked... One thing I'd suggest is..."). Let this learner play B first (listening role) to hear the language before producing it. Fewer items: Ex 2 items 1–4, Ex 4 items 1–5. Target: one complete preface → soften → reason turn, said aloud with a warm tone.

STRETCH (TOWARD C2)

Calibrated understatement. Ask strong learners to play scenario ② three times at three strengths (mild concern, clear disagreement, firm opposition) using only understatement: "I might have a slight concern..." · "I'm not entirely comfortable with..." · "I'd have real reservations about...". The group guesses which level was intended. Discuss cross-cultural misreading: the same "slight concern" might be read as nothing by one listener and as a strong objection by another. On the academic side: write a hedged abstract sentence with exactly two hedges and justify each one against the evidence.

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **Directness norms:** learners from cultures where directness is honest and efficient (for example, German, Dutch, Hebrew, Russian, Polish, and many Eastern European workplaces) may sound blunt or even rude

in English with perfect grammar ("You must change this," "This is wrong"). Present softening as **a tool for being heard**, not as dishonesty.

- ◆ **Over-softening:** learners from high-context communication cultures (for example, Japanese, Korean, Thai, Indonesian, Filipino and Vietnamese workplaces) may soften so much that the message disappears. The "What must change?" test is designed for them: gentle and clear.
- ◆ **"I want..." and "Please + imperative":** Spanish *quiero*, Portuguese *quero*, Russian *я хочу*, Arabic *ureed* make "I want that you send the file" feel neutral. And *please* doesn't soften an imperative much in English ("Please send it today" is still an order). Teach the distance ladder.
- ◆ **Modal strength:** German *müssen*, Russian *нужно / надо* and French *il faut* often come out as "must" or "have to," which sound far stronger in English. Offer *it might be worth...*, *we'd probably need to...*
- ◆ **One-size tag "isn't it?":** speakers of Chinese, Malay, Hindi-Urdu, Tagalog and others (and of some world Englishes) use "isn't it?" everywhere ("You're coming, isn't it?"). At C1, match the auxiliary: *aren't you?* · *won't it?* · *didn't we?*
- ◆ **"Maybe" as the only hedge:** Chinese 可能 *kěnéng*, Spanish *quizás*, Arabic *rubbamā*. Push for range: *may*, *tends to*, *appears to*, *to some extent*.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 3.3: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-c1/lesson_09.html. Listen to the five model sentences with 🎧 and copy the intonation, not just the words; do Exercises 1–3, the Quick Quiz and the "Piece of Sensitive Communication" project (choose any scenario; an invented one is fine). Workbook 3.3: Exercise 5 (litotes), "My new words" and the journal (a difficult moment, real, invented or from a new identity card: what was said, a softened version, and the one change that would make the biggest difference).

◆ CHECK – SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 C "I wonder if it might be a bit risky — it might be worth thinking through the downside first?" · Q2 B "The data suggest that the intervention may improve outcomes to some extent." · Q3 (new) B "I'd really like to help, but I'm afraid I can't take on another project right now. The thing is, the Harris report is due on Friday. Could we look at it again next month?" Feedback conversation (Ex 1): 1 a couple of thoughts · 2 really solid · 3 maybe a bit long · 4 I wonder if · 5 not entirely convinced · 6 might be worth · 7 Would it be possible.

END OF C9: MODULE 3 WRAP-UP

Recap on slide 18, "package, connect, soften": **The decision to expand led to a reduction in costs**, and knowing when to say **we cut costs** instead (package) → **this trend** · **the latter** · **I hope not** · **I'd love to** (connect) → **The data suggest...** · **I was wondering if...** · **I'm afraid...** **the thing is...** (soften). Learners tick the three "I can..." lists in the workbook. Anything still unticked goes on a sticky note for you. Review it in the C10 warmer (the **Soften It!** board game is ready for that) and again in the C13 progress-test catch-up.

Watch for in Module 4: phrasal verbs in 4.1 are the **verbal, spoken** side of the register dial learners met in C7 (*look into* vs *investigate* vs *carry out an investigation into*): make that three-way link out loud. Collocation and connotation in 4.2 build directly on light verbs (*pose a threat, reach a conclusion*) and on the "hidden meaning" of litotes. The 4.3 review project is the natural place to demand all three skills in one performance: a nominal, hedged written summary and a diplomatic spoken exchange.

Progress Test 1 (C13) covers Modules 1–4. From this module it tests: forming nouns (including irregulars and zero-derivation), light-verb collocations and noun + preposition, rewriting in both directions (verbal → nominal, over-nominalized → plain), reference with a summary noun, *one / ones, do so, so / not* (especially *I hope not*), ellipsis with the anchor word, hedging a claim, softening a blunt request or refusal, and labeling H / D / V register.

Module 4 — Lexical Range & Fluency

Three classes that move the spotlight from grammar to word choice, and then bring the whole first half of C1 together. First, **phrasal and multi-word verbs**: the four types, the pronoun rule, polysemy, and the C1 skill of the **register swap** (*look into* ↔ *investigate*, *put off* ↔ *postpone*) and knowing when each one fits. Then **collocation, idiom and connotation**: strong vs weak collocations, collocation grids, connotation clines (*slim* · *thin* · *skinny* · *scrawny*) and the appropriacy of idioms. Last, the halfway review, **The Advanced Communicator**: a short persuasive presentation, a Q&A and a written summary that draw on Modules 1–4, scored with a speaking and writing checklist that feeds Progress Test 1 in C13.

3 lessons

Lessons 4.1–4.3

Classes C10–C12

Weeks 5–6

90 min per class

CEFR C1

HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

- One lesson block = one 90-minute class. Every class follows the same shape: **warmer** → **lead-in** → **Meaning / Form / Pronunciation** with concept-checking questions (CCQs) → **drill** (choral, then individual) → **controlled practice** (workbook) → **freer practice** (a demanding communicative task) → **feedback** with delayed error correction → **homework**. C12 is a task-based review: the language work comes *from* the tasks.
- The **stage plan** is your clock. Each one adds up to 90 minutes. The numbers in the Time column are minutes.
- Present from [slides/module-4-lexical-range.html](#). Print [materials/module-4/classroom-materials.html](#) before C10. It holds the flashcards, the new identity cards, the **Register Swap** A/B cards and "Which fits?" context cards, the **connotation cline** cards, the idiom and "Use it or lose it" cards, the chunk-bingo listener cards, the **Advanced Communicator** topic, persona and challenge cards, the **C12 speaking & writing checklist**, the **Register Ladder** review game and the listening scripts.
- The online lessons are the learners' **homework and review**. Each one has  Listen buttons, so learners can hear the model sentences again at home.
- This module is lexical, not grammatical**. C1 learners already understand hundreds of phrasal verbs and collocations; what they lack is **controlled production and judgment**. Don't teach long lists. Teach the *system* (the four types, the pronoun rule, the collocation types, the cline) and then spend the time on **choice**: which verb, which partner, which shade, which register, and why. The question you'll ask most in this module is "Would you say that *here*, to *these* people?"

- ◆ **Fluency before accuracy, then range and appropriacy.** In every freer task, take notes in three columns: **accuracy** (errors to fix: *turn off it, make a photo*), **range** (ambitious language to praise and spread: *it paid off handsomely, a pressing concern*) and **appropriacy** (register slips: *commence* over coffee, *sort out* in a formal report, an idiom in a written summary). At C1 the third column matters most. In feedback, board 2–3 items from each column without names.
- ◆ **Dominant speakers.** Every task has a listening role. Give it to the learner who talks most: the **register judge** in the Register Swap (decides, doesn't narrate), the **chunk counter** in the Precise Talk (ticks the bingo card), the **timekeeper** and **last questioner** in the C12 circles. Use talking tokens in C12. Say it kindly: "Great point, Viktor. Let's hear from someone who hasn't spoken yet."
- ◆ **Peer review, every class.** C1 learners can and should give each other precise feedback. Use one protocol all module so it becomes routine: **Praise – Question – Polish**. Praise one exact word choice ("*tolerate* was perfect there"); ask one question ("Why did you keep *carry out*?"); polish one item ("*very worried* could be *deeply concerned*"). Model it once with your own text before learners try it. Feedback is on the language, never the person.
- ◆ **Stretching strong learners toward C2.** Each lesson has a stretch box. The C2 direction for this module is **finer lexical judgment**: the particle's own meaning (*up* = completion: *use up, eat up*), phrasal verbs that are fully at home in formal prose (*carry out, point out, bring about*), **semantic prosody** (*cause* and *rife with* attract negative partners), playful variation of an idiom in a talk (*the tip of a very large iceberg*), and holding one register while shifting another feature. Don't add new lists; ask strong learners to *justify* choices aloud.
- ◆ **American English is the classroom standard.** The online lessons use British spellings and a few British informal words (*nominalisation, practise, recognise, colour, favour, programme, grey, travelling, centres, apologise; reckon, well dodgy, Shall we...?*). Teach *nominalization, practice* (verb), *recognize, color, favor, program, gray, traveling, centers, apologize*; for the informal register, *I think / I figure* (for *reckon*), *pretty sketchy* (for *well dodgy*), *Should we...? / Want to...?*. *Get away* means a short vacation, not "holiday." Accept British forms when learners use them.
- ◆ Dashed boxes = lines to say out loud, CCQs and ICQs (instruction-checking questions). Green boxes = scripts you read aloud. **Amber** = watch-outs.

THE THROUGH-LINE

Choose the verb → choose the partner → choose the voice. In C10 learners choose between a phrasal verb and its single-word synonym, and learn that neither is "better": *We'll look into it* belongs in the team meeting, *We will investigate the matter* in the formal reply. In C11 they choose the word's partner (*heavy rain, meet a deadline, deeply concerned*) and its shade (*slender, thin, skinny, scrawny*), and they learn when an idiom sparkles and when it clangs. In C12 they orchestrate all of it: one argument, delivered aloud to a small audience, defended in Q&A, and then written up as a formal summary. The same message, in the voice the moment calls for, is the whole module in miniature.

TRAUMA-INFORMED: STORIES, BODIES AND OPINIONS

Three places in this module need care. **(1) Stories in C10.** The online project suggests "a trip" or "a career move": for some learners, the biggest trip of their life was forced migration, and a career move was a job lost. Offer three choices out loud: **your real life**, a **new identity card**, or a **Register Swap story card** (all workplace and community stories). Keep phrasal verbs such as *lay off* and *come down with* in third-person, invented contexts. **(2) Connotation in C11.** *Slim / skinny / scrawny* and *stingy / nosy / pig-headed* are judgments about people. **Never** ask learners to describe classmates, family members or real people with these words. Use the invented characters on the cards, objects (*a slender vase*, *a scrawny tree*) and animals (*a scrawny cat*). Say it plainly: "We're describing invented people today. Nobody in this room." Some learners carry pain about weight or food scarcity; if the body cline seems unwelcome, do the money cline first and treat the body cline as reading only. **(3) Opinions in C12.** Topics stay in workplace, education, technology, health habits, community and everyday science. No party politics, religion or immigration policy. Every learner may argue an **assigned side** from a card, and the persona cards let anyone speak from a point of view that is not their own.

BEFORE THE MODULE

- ◆ Print the **flashcards** (one set for the board): the four-type cards and the register-pair cards, phrasal verb on the front and formal synonym as the subtitle (C10); the collocation picture cards and the connotation cline word cards (C11). Card stock helps. Cut them before C10.
- ◆ For C10: **Register Swap** cards (6 stories × A informal voice note / B formal memo; one story per pair) and one set of **"Which fits?" context cards** per group of 3.
- ◆ For C11: one envelope of **cline cards** per pair (6 sets), one **idiom card set** and one **"Use it or lose it"** discussion card per group, and one **chunk-bingo** listener card per learner.
- ◆ For C12: the **Advanced Communicator** topic cards (put them on a side table at the end of C11 so learners can choose early), persona cards, challenge starters, talking tokens, the **Register Ladder** review board (1 per group of 3–4, a die, counters), and the **speaking & writing checklist** (one class grid for you, score slips to cut for C13). Plan which learners you will score in C12 and which in C13.
- ◆ Print the **new identity cards** and keep them on a side table where anyone can take one without asking.
- ◆ Optional: bring two short real texts on the same everyday topic in two registers (a company's formal service notice and a friendly social-media post about the same change, or a council notice and a neighborhood newsletter). Learners enjoy hunting the phrasal verb in one and its Latinate twin in the other.

MODULE AT A GLANCE

LESSON	CLASS	FOCUS	LEARNERS CAN...
4.1	C10 • wk 5	The four types of multi-word verb (intransitive • separable • inseparable • three-part); the	tell the same workplace or community story twice, first as a

LESSON	CLASS	FOCUS	LEARNERS CAN...
		pronoun rule (<i>turn it off / look after it</i>); literal vs idiomatic and polysemy (<i>take off, pick up, make out</i>); the register swap (<i>look into ↔ investigate, put off ↔ postpone, put up with ↔ tolerate</i>) and when each fits; nominalized forms (<i>breakdown, outcome, takeover</i>)	spoken update rich in phrasal verbs, then as a formal written account with justified single-word swaps (keeping at least one phrasal verb on purpose), with every pronoun object correctly placed
4.2	C11 · wk 6	Collocation types (adj + noun, verb + noun, adverb + adjective, verb + adverb, noun + noun) and strong vs weak collocations (<i>bitterly cold</i> vs <i>very cold</i>); collocation grids; idioms and their appropriacy (register, density, accuracy); connotation clines (<i>slim · thin · skinny · scrawny</i>) and register ladders (<i>purchase · buy · pick up</i>)	give a 90-second talk with at least six strong collocations and one or two well-placed idioms, explain the shades within a near-synonym set, and discuss how to keep new vocabulary alive ("use it or lose it")
4.3	C12 · wk 6	Review project: The Advanced Communicator. The register spectrum (formal ↔ neutral ↔ informal, shifted as a set); rhetorical devices used sparingly; signposting extended discourse; handling questions diplomatically; the full Module 1–4 toolkit	deliver a three-minute signposted persuasive talk from an assigned or chosen side, field two minutes of questions, and write a 150-word formal summary of the argument, including the strongest objection and a response, using structures and lexis from Modules 1–4

4.1 · C10

Phrasal Verbs & Multi-word Verbs

90 min

◆ OBJECTIVES – LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ sort a multi-word verb into one of **four types** (intransitive *set off* · separable *turn off* · inseparable *look after* · three-part *put up with*) and predict where its object goes
- ◆ apply the **pronoun rule**: a pronoun object *must* split a separable verb (*turn it off*) and must *follow* an inseparable one (*look after it*); keep long objects at the end (*turned off every light in the house*)
- ◆ work out the sense of a **polysemous** phrasal verb from its collocates (*the plane took off* / *sales took off* / *take off your coat*)
- ◆ perform a **register swap** in both directions (*look into* ↔ *investigate*, *put off* ↔ *postpone*, *find out* ↔ *discover*, *get rid of* ↔ *eliminate*) and justify which one fits a given reader, including when to *keep* the phrasal verb
- ◆ use and pronounce the **nominalized forms** with first-syllable stress (*a BREAKdown*, *an OUTcome*, *a TAKEover*)

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 4.1 (New words, Grammar box, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, Register Swap planner)
- ◆ Slides 3–8 · Type cards and register-pair flashcards · Picture cards for the literal senses (flight, coat, luggage, mechanic) · **Register Swap** A/B cards (6 stories) · **"Which fits?"** context cards · New identity cards
- ◆ Listening scripts 4.1-A (the launch debrief, a voice message) and 4.1-B (dictation)

BOARD PLAN

Left: four boxes. ① no object: *The car broke down.* · *We set off at dawn.* ② separable: *turn off the light* / *turn the light off* / *turn **it** off* ✓ · ~~*turn off it*~~ ✗ ③ inseparable: *look after the kids* / *look after **them*** ✓ · ~~*look them after*~~ ✗ ④ three-part: *put up with the noise* / *put up with **it*** (never split). Test: **try a pronoun.**

Center: the register swap. SPOKEN ⇌ WRITTEN: *put off* ⇌ *postpone* · *find out* ⇌ *discover* · *look into* ⇌ *investigate* · *go up* ⇌ *increase* / *rise* · *set up* ⇌ *establish* · *give up* ⇌ *abandon* · *put up with* ⇌ *tolerate* · *carry out* ⇌ *conduct* · *get rid of* ⇌ *eliminate* · *come across* ⇌ *encounter*. Under it: **Who's reading?**

Where? Why? · "Don't over-correct": *carry out*, *point out*, *set up* are fine in formal writing.

Right: one verb, many jobs. take off: ✈️ leave the ground · 📈 succeed · 🧥 remove · pick up: collect · learn informally · improve. Nouns: break DOWN → a BREAKdown · take OVER → a TAKEover · turn OUT → an OUTcome · break OUT → an OUTbreak (flip!).

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: diplomatic makeover	8	S-S	Review C9 (3.3, hedging and diplomatic English). Board three blunt lines: "Your figures are wrong." · "This plan won't work." · "You're late with the report again." Pairs soften each one twice: once with hedging (<i>There does appear to be a slight problem with the figures.</i>) and once with vague language (<i>a bit of an issue, sort of</i>). Two pairs read their most diplomatic version. Note one range example to praise. Link forward: "Softening changes the grammar. Today we change the <i>verbs</i> ."
Lead-in: same story, two voices	5	T-S	Slide 7 (hide the labels). Show B's spoken line ("Two suppliers pulled out at the last minute, so we had to put it off by a week") and the formal line ("Two suppliers withdrew at short notice, obliging us to postpone it by a week"). "Same facts? Who's speaking to whom in each? Which verbs changed?" Elicit <i>pulled out</i> → <i>withdrew</i> , <i>put off</i> → <i>postpone</i> . "Today: the verbs that make English sound spoken, and their formal twins."
Four types & the pronoun rule	12	T-S	Slides 3–4. Build the four boxes on the board by sorting eight type cards with the class. Teach the diagnostic: "Does it take an object? Try a pronoun." Then the pronoun rule and the "heavy object goes last" corollary (<i>turned off every light in the house before she left</i>). Meaning, form, pronunciation, CCQs (below). This is fast at C1: the pronoun rule is the only place to linger.
Drill	6	T-S → S	Pronoun drill, stress drill and noun-stress drill (see Drill script). Choral, then fast individuals, then open pairs.
One verb, many meanings	9	T-S → S-S	Slide 5. Hold up the flight and coat picture cards: "The plane took off. She took off her coat." Then say "Sales took off after the launch" with no picture: "What took off?" Pairs do Workbook Ex 4 (four polysemous verbs), then share one sentence each for <i>pick up</i> in three senses. Five minutes on the nominalized forms at the end (Grammar box) with the stress shift: <i>break DOWN</i> → <i>a BREAKdown</i> .
Listening: the launch debrief	7	T-S → S	Workbook Ex 1. Read Script 4.1-A twice as a voice message from a project lead to her team. First listen: "Did the launch happen? What went wrong? What's the good news?" Second listen: learners complete eight phrasal verbs, then label each one's type (1–4). Pairs compare.
The register swap	8	T-S	Slide 6. Present the pairs by <i>situation</i> , not as a list: the same leak reported in a text to a roommate (<i>Can you look into it?</i>) and in an

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			email to the property manager (<i>Please investigate the matter</i>). CCQs. Then the "don't over-correct" rule: read "I shall relinquish caffeine" in a posh voice: "Would you say that at lunch?" Show three phrasal verbs that are perfectly formal (<i>carry out, point out, set up</i>).
Controlled practice	10	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 2, 3 and 5 alone (object placement, the register swap with context choices, verb → noun). Pairs check. Board-check only disagreements. In Ex 3b, the discussion of <i>why</i> is the point: accept two answers where the reason is good.
Freer: the Register Swap	15	S-S → T-S	Slide 8. Pairs, one Register Swap story. Round 1 (4 min) : A reads the informal voice note on their card, then tells it to B from memory, naturally, adding phrasal verbs; B notes every phrasal verb heard. Round 2 (6 min) : together they write the formal version (a 70–90-word incident report or update for a manager or committee), swapping where the register calls for it and keeping at least one phrasal verb on purpose . Round 3 (3 min) : the reverse: B's card is a formal memo; A turns it into a 30-second spoken update. Round 4 (2 min) : groups of 4 swap reports and give Praise – Question – Polish . ICQs first.
Feedback	5	T-S	Delayed correction, three columns (no names). Accuracy: "Could you turn off it?" · "We need to look the complaint into." · "There was a break down in the system." Range: " <i>Things picked up</i> " / " <i>obliging us to postpone</i> ." Appropriacy: "The committee will sort out the budget" (formal report) · "We shall commence at eight" (text to a coworker). Learners fix and explain.
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Show online lesson 4.1 on screen; point at a 📶 button. Set the homework (below). Learners tick the "I can..." box in the workbook.
Total	90		8 + 5 + 12 + 6 + 9 + 7 + 8 + 10 + 15 + 5 + 5

◆ MEANING · FORM · PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: what counts as a multi-word verb. A verb plus one or two particles that behave as one unit, often with a meaning you can't build from the parts. Whether the particle is an adverb (*off, up, out, away, back*) or a preposition (*after, with, for, into*) decides where the object can go.

SAY: "She looked after her neighbor's cat." Is she looking behind the cat? (No. She took care of it.) Can I say "She looked the cat after"? (No: inseparable.) · "He turned the offer down." Did he turn anything

physically? (No: he refused it.) Can I move "the offer"? (Yes: turn down the offer / turn the offer down.)
With "it"? (Only "turn it down.")

Meaning: the pronoun rule.

SAY: "Can you fill in the form?" Two positions possible? (Yes.) "Can you fill in it?" (No: "fill it in.") · "Can you deal with the form?" "Deal the form with"? (No: inseparable.) "Deal with it"? (Yes: the pronoun stays after.) · How do I test a new verb? (Try it with "it.")

Meaning: polysemy.

SAY: "Business is picking up." Is someone lifting something? (No: it's improving.) · "He picked up Portuguese while traveling." Did he take a class? (No: he learned informally.) · "I could just make out a signature." Was it easy to see? (No, only just.) · "He made out that he'd done all the work." Is that true? (Probably not: he claimed it.)

Meaning: the register swap. Phrasal verbs lean spoken and informal; their single-word synonyms (often from Latin or French) lean written and formal. Neither is better. The skill is choosing by reader, setting and purpose.

SAY: "We'll look into the complaint." / "We will investigate the complaint." Same meaning? (Yes.) Which one in a meeting with your team? (look into.) Which one in a formal reply to a customer? (investigate.) Is "look into" wrong in the reply? (Not wrong, just less formal.) · "I shall relinquish caffeine," said at lunch. Correct grammar? (Yes.) Good English? (No: absurdly formal. "I'm giving up coffee.") · "The team carried out a survey." In a formal report, must I change it to "conducted"? (No: "carry out" is fine in formal writing.)

Form.

① Intransitive	verb + particle, no object	The car broke down . · We set off at dawn.
② Separable	verb + particle + object or verb + object + particle; a pronoun must split	throw away the receipts / throw the receipts away / throw them away
③ Inseparable	verb + preposition + object; the object (even a pronoun) always follows	rely on a friend · rely on her
④ Three-part	verb + adverb + preposition + object; never split	look forward to the trip · run out of it
Heavy object	a long object goes after the particle	She turned off every light in the house before she left.

Noun forms	fused spelling, first-syllable stress	a breakdown · an outbreak · a takeover · an outcome · input · a setback
-------------------	--	--

Pronunciation. In **phrasal verbs** (types ①, ②, ④) the **particle** usually takes the main stress: "set **OFF**", "turn it **OFF**", "put up **WITH** it" (with a noun object, the noun takes it: "put up with the **NOISE**"). In **prepositional verbs** (type ③) the **verb** is stressed and the preposition is weak: "**LOOK** after them" /'lʊk æftər ðəm/, "**DEAL** with it". The **nouns** flip to the first syllable: "The car broke **DOWN**" → "a **BREAK**down"; "they took **OVER**" → "a **TAKE**over". Linking makes pronoun splits smooth: "turn it off" /tɜːnrɪ'tɔːf/, "pick it up" /pɪkɪ'tʌp/; in American English the *t* flaps: "put it off" /pʊtɪ'ɔːf/, "set it up" /sɛtɪ'rʌp/.

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 Pronoun please** (point at box ② or ③): T: "Turn off the heater." → S: "Turn it off." T: "Look after the plants." → S: "Look after them." T: "Throw away the old files." → S: "Throw them away." T: "Put up with the delays." → S: "Put up with them." T: "Pick up the kids at six." → S: "Pick them up at six." Fast, choral then individual.
- 2 Swap it up / swap it down** (flashcards): T holds up *postpone*: S: "put off." T: "find out": S: "discover." T: "tolerate": S: "put up with." Then full sentences: T: "We'll look into it. Formal!" → S: "We will investigate the matter." T: "The price has increased. Spoken!" → S: "The price has gone up."
- 3 Stress flip:** T: "The system broke down." → S: "There was a breakdown." T: "A competitor took them over." → S: "It was a takeover." T: "Things turned out well." → S: "It was a good outcome." Clap the stress each time.
- 4 Which one here?** T gives a context and a pair: "A text to your brother: put off or postpone the dinner?" → S: "Let's put it off." T: "A letter from a hospital: find out or discover?" → S: "...discovered." T: "A safety report: carry out or conduct?" → S: "Either. Both are fine in formal writing."
- 5 Open pairs → closed pairs:** S1 says something they need to do this week, with a phrasal verb and a noun object ("I need to fill in my tax form."); S2 repeats it with a pronoun ("You need to fill it in.") and then formally ("You are required to complete it."). Then all pairs, 1 minute.

◆ THE REGISTER SWAP – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ Pairs. Give each pair one **Register Swap** story (Set C): six workplace and community stories (a community center leak, a library app pilot, a clinic's new booking system, a school fundraiser, a delivery company schedule change, a food bank move). Each story has an **A card** (an informal voice note, dense with phrasal verbs) and a **B card** (a formal memo about a *later* stage of the same story, dense with Latinate verbs).
- ◆ **Round 1: tell it (4 min).** A reads their voice note silently, turns it over and tells it to B in their own words, like a coworker at the coffee machine. B jots down every phrasal verb heard (a tally on the back of the card).

- ◆ **Round 2: formalize it (6 min).** Together they write a **70–90-word formal update** (for the manager, the board or the parents' committee) on the lines in the workbook. Rules: swap wherever the register calls for it; **keep at least one phrasal verb on purpose** (e.g., *carry out*, *set up*, *point out*) and write **K** above it; no idioms. Check every pronoun object.
- ◆ **Round 3: reverse it (3 min).** B reads the formal memo on their card, turns it over, and gives A a **30-second spoken update** in natural spoken English: "OK, so basically, they've put off the...". A listens for any "stiff" word that survived and says "Too formal!" when they hear one.
- ◆ **Round 4: peer review (2 min).** Pairs join another pair and swap written updates. Each pair gives **Praise – Question – Polish**: one swap that lands, one question about a choice ("Why did you keep *set up*?"), one word to polish.
- ◆ **Roles:** in a group of 3, the third learner is the **register judge**: holds the "Which fits?" context cards, decides disputes, and reads the final version aloud. Give this job to a dominant speaker.
- ◆ **Early finishers:** deal three "**Which fits?**" context cards (a text to a friend, a job interview, a complaint letter, a team stand-up, a university essay, a podcast, a safety report, a wedding toast) and say the same sentence in the right register for each.

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE REGISTER SWAP

SAY: A, do you read your card aloud? (No, read it silently, then tell it.) · B, what do you write down in Round 1? (Every phrasal verb I hear.) · How long is the formal update? (70 to 90 words.) · Must you change every phrasal verb? (No: keep at least one on purpose and mark it K.) · Idioms in the formal update? (No.) · In Round 3, is B's update formal or spoken? (Spoken, 30 seconds.) · What are the three steps of peer review? (Praise, question, polish.)

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Focus on **six register pairs** only (*put off* / *postpone*, *find out* / *discover*, *look into* / *investigate*, *go up* / *increase*, *set up* / *establish*, *put up with* / *tolerate*) and the pronoun rule with *it*. Give a color-coded card: blue = spoken, red = written. In the Register Swap, the learner tells the story (Round 1) and underlines the phrasal verbs on the partner's draft instead of writing the whole update; accept a 40-word update. Workbook: Ex 2 items 1–4, Ex 3a only. Target: 4 correct swaps and 4 correct pronoun splits, said aloud.

STRETCH (TOWARD C2)

Work on the **particle's own meaning**: *up* = completion (*use up*, *eat up*, *drink up*), *out* = to the end / thoroughly (*sort out*, *work out*, *figure out*), *off* = separation (*call off*, *cut off*). Add less common three-part verbs (*come up against*, *get round to*, *face up to*, *own up to*). In the formal update, use one **nominalized** phrasal noun (*the breakdown of the talks*, *a positive outcome*) and write a one-line justification for every phrasal verb kept. Early finishers write a third version for a *different* reader (a press release) and explain which features changed.

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **Latinate by default:** Spanish, Portuguese, French, Italian and Romanian speakers find *investigate*, *postpone*, *tolerate* easy because of cognates (*investigar*, *postergar*, *tolerar*), and may sound stiff in speech ("I will investigate where my keys are"). Praise the accuracy, then offer the spoken twin. The C1 target for them is the phrasal verb in *speech*.
- ◆ **Pronoun after the particle:** "switch on it," "pick up her." Very common for all L1s, including learners whose own language has particle verbs. Always test with *it*.
- ◆ **German and Dutch separable verbs** (*anrufen* → *ruft ... an*, *opbellen*) help with the idea of splitting but can push the particle to the very end of a long clause ("She turned every light in the house she had lived in for years off"). Teach the heavy-object rule.
- ◆ **Chinese, Japanese, Korean, Vietnamese and Arabic** speakers may avoid phrasal verbs altogether and use the single-word verb everywhere; their writing is accurate but their speech sounds formal. Praise every attempt at a phrasal verb in speech.
- ◆ **Extra or missing prepositions:** "discuss about," "enter into the room" (Arabic, Spanish, Russian, Persian), but also "look forward to see you" (*to* is a preposition: *look forward to seeing*). Link to the three-part box.
- ◆ **Verb vs noun spelling:** "There was a break down." "The out come was positive." Some Tagalog and Spanish speakers also stress both parts equally. Drill the noun stress.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 4.1: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-c1/lesson_10.html. Listen to the five model sentences with 🗣️ and say them back, stressing the particles; do Exercises 1–3, the Quick Quiz and the "Narrate, Then Formalize" project (record Version A on a phone if possible). Workbook 4.1: finish the Register Swap planner with a second story (your own, a new identity card, or another story card), "My new words" and the journal (one idea from the week said twice: with a phrasal verb to a friend, with its single-word twin in a formal email). Optional, from the online lesson: collect five phrasal verbs from something you read or watched, with type, formal twin and register.

◆ CHECK – SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **B** Could you turn it off? · Q2 **C** we will investigate the complaint · Q3 (new) **B** I can't put up with it any longer. Launch debrief (Ex 1): 1 fell through (①) · 2 pulled out (①) · 3 put it off (②) · 4 set up (②) · 5 held up (①) · 6 picked up (①) · 7 look into (③) · 8 cut down on (④).

◆ OBJECTIVES – LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ use natural **collocations** of five types (*heavy traffic · make a decision · deeply concerned · apologize profusely · a round of applause*) and avoid translated ones (*make a photo, strong rain, do a mistake*)
- ◆ tell **strong** collocations (fixed, predictable: *bitterly cold, meet a deadline, pay attention*) from **weak** ones (open, combinable: *very cold, a good idea*) and upgrade a weak one when precision matters
- ◆ place near-synonyms on a **connotation cline** (*slender · slim · thin · skinny · scrawny; thrifty · economical · stingy*) and choose the word that praises, stays neutral or criticizes
- ◆ use an **idiom** accurately and appropriately, and rephrase it plainly for formal writing (*the tip of the iceberg → only a small fraction of the problem*)
- ◆ discuss how vocabulary is kept alive ("use it or lose it") and plan to use new chunks in real life

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 4.2 (New words, Lexis box, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, the Precise Talk planner)
- ◆ Slides 9–13 · Collocation picture cards (coffee, umbrella, winter, worried, nervous, angry, sad, mobile phone) · **Cline cards** (6 envelopes) · **Idiom cards** + "Use it or lose it" discussion cards · **Chunk-bingo** listener cards · New identity cards
- ◆ Listening scripts 4.2-A (the pilot program meeting) and 4.2-B (dictation)

BOARD PLAN

Left: partners. adj + noun: *heavy rain · strong coffee · a bitter disappointment* · verb + noun: *make a decision · do research · meet a deadline · raise an issue* · adv + adj: *deeply concerned · highly unlikely · fully aware* · verb + adv: *apologize profusely* · noun + noun: *a round of applause · a pang of guilt*. ~~make a photo~~ → **take** · ~~strong rain~~ → **heavy**.

Center: weak → strong. very cold → **bitterly** cold · very unlikely → **highly** unlikely · very worried → **deeply** concerned · a big problem → a **pressing** problem. The cline: 😊 slender · slim — 😊 thin — 😞 skinny · scrawny. 😊 thrifty · frugal — 😊 economical — 😞 stingy · tight. **Am I praising or criticizing?**

Right: idioms. bite the bullet · get cold feet · the tip of the iceberg · on the same page · a gray area · food for thought · hit the nail on the head · cut corners. Three rules: **spoken** (not in formal writing) · **a pinch, not a plateful** · **exact form** (~~hit the nail on its head~~). Bottom corner: **USE IT OR LOSE IT.**

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: register tennis	7	S-S	Review C10. Pairs, register-pair flashcards face down. A turns a card and "serves" the formal verb in a sentence ("The council will investigate the noise."); B "returns" it as spoken English with a pronoun ("They'll look into it."). Swap every card. Then two pairs share their homework "found" phrasal verbs. Note pronoun slips for the feedback stage.
Lead-in: which sounds English?	5	T-S	Slide 9. Picture cards: coffee, umbrella, winter. "Powerful coffee or strong coffee? Strong rain or heavy rain? Very cold or bitterly cold?" All are grammatical and understandable, so why does one sound right? Elicit "because people say it." "That's collocation, and it makes you sound native-like even more than grammar does."
Collocation: types, strong & weak	12	T-S	Slide 10. The five types, one example each from the pictures. Then strong vs weak : a strong collocation is fixed and predictable (you hear <i>bitterly</i> , you expect <i>cold</i>); a weak one combines with almost anything (<i>very, good, big</i>). Weak is never wrong, but strong is precise. Show upgrades. Then the translation trap (<i>make a photo, do a mistake, strong rain, say a joke</i>): each learner says one collocation from their own language that doesn't translate. CCQs.
Collocation grid	8	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 2. Learners tick the grid alone (verbs <i>make / do / take / pay / raise / meet</i> × nouns; adverbs × adjectives), then compare. Where pairs disagree, they must say the collocation aloud in a sentence and decide by ear. Board-check the famous traps only (<i>make a decision / do research / take a risk / pay a compliment</i>).
Drill	5	T-S → S	Collocation chains and the upgrade drill (see Drill script). Choral, then individuals.

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Connotation clines	10	S-S → T-S	Slide 11. Pairs open a cline envelope (Set D) and arrange the word cards on the cline strip from 😊 to 😞 (the body set: <i>slender, slim, thin, skinny, scrawny</i> ; then money, confidence, fame, curiosity, determination). Then they check each against the invented character on the envelope ("Leon never pays for coffee": thrifty or stingy?). Class feedback: CCQs, and <i>childlike / childish</i> . Remind: invented people only.
Idioms: listen & judge	8	T-S → S-S	Workbook Ex 1. Read Script 4.2-A twice (a team meeting about a failed pilot program; give the B lines to a confident learner). First listen: "What went wrong? What do they decide?" Second listen: learners tick the idioms they hear and match them to meanings. Then slide 12: the three appropriacy rules. Read "This is merely the tip of the iceberg" as a line from a research paper: "Right or wrong here?" (Wrong register: <i>represents only a small fraction of the problem.</i>)
"Use it or lose it"	5	S-S (groups of 3)	Board: USE IT OR LOSE IT . "Is this an idiom? What does it mean?" (If you don't practice a skill, you lose it.) Groups take one discussion card (Set E) and talk for 4 minutes: Is it true of vocabulary? Of idioms in particular? Which words have you "lost" in English or your first language? Which three chunks from today will you <i>use</i> this week, and where? Each learner writes their three chunks in the workbook. They report back in the C12 warmer.
Controlled practice	8	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 3-5 alone (upgrade the weak collocation, choose the shade and register, fix or rephrase the idiom). Pairs check. Board-check disagreements. Early finishers start the talk planner.
Freer: the Precise Talk	12	S → S-S (groups of 3)	Slide 13. Plan (3 min) : each learner picks a topic (a place they know well, a trend in their field, a decision they had to make, a piece of news that gave them pause; real or from a new

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			identity card) and notes 6 collocations and 1–2 idioms that fit. Talk (3 × 90 seconds) : the two listeners each hold a chunk-bingo card and tick every strong collocation and idiom they hear; one of them also listens for a register slip. Shades + feedback (90 seconds) : after each talk, the speaker explains one cline they'd use for the topic ("I'd describe the invented manager on my card as <i>frugal</i> , not <i>stingy</i> , because..."), and each listener gives one line of Praise – Question – Polish. ICQs first.
Feedback	5	T–S	Three columns (no names). Accuracy: "We need to do a decision." · "It was a blessing in the disguise." · "strongly unlikely." Range: " <i>a pressing concern</i> ," " <i>it paid off handsomely</i> ." Appropriacy / connotation: "My friend is very skinny and beautiful." (critical word, admiring intent) · "The tip of the iceberg" in a written report. Learners fix and explain.
Homework set-up	5	T–S	Show online lesson 4.2 and a 🗣️ button. Set the homework (below). Point at the Advanced Communicator topic cards on the side table: "Choose a topic before C12. You'll give a three-minute talk." Learners tick "I can...".
Total	90		7 + 5 + 12 + 8 + 5 + 10 + 8 + 5 + 8 + 12 + 5 + 5

◆ MEANING • FORM • PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: collocation. Words that habitually occur together and sound right to an expert ear, often for no logical reason. The alternative is usually grammatical and understandable; it just isn't what people say.

SAY: "There was strong rain." Can you understand it? (Yes.) Is it English? (Not quite: we say heavy rain.) Is there a rule? (No, it's convention: learn the pair.) · "She made a decision." "She did a decision"? (No.) · "I need to take a photo." Why not "make"? (Convention again. Many languages use "make" here.)

Meaning: strong vs weak collocations.

SAY: "It was bitterly cold." If I say "bitterly," can you guess the next word? (Yes: cold, disappointed.) Strong or weak? (Strong: a fixed pair.) · "It was very cold." Is "very" wrong? (No, but it goes with

everything: weak.) Which is more precise and vivid? (bitterly cold.) · "bitterly hot"? (No: "bitterly" goes with cold and disappointment, not heat.)

Meaning: connotation. Same denotation (dictionary meaning), different feeling. The word you choose shows your judgment.

SAY: "She's slender." Compliment or criticism? (Compliment.) · "She's skinny." Same body? (Yes.) Same message? (No: critical, maybe unhealthy.) · "He's thrifty." Is that good? (Yes: sensible with money.) "He's stingy." (Bad: he won't share.) · "The town is notorious for its traffic." Famous for something good? (No, for something bad.) · "a childlike sense of wonder" vs "Stop being so childish." Which one is positive? (childlike.)

Meaning: idiom appropriacy.

SAY: "We finally bit the bullet and booked the repairs." Did anyone bite anything? (No: they did something unpleasant but necessary.) Spoken or written English? (Mostly spoken.) · In a formal report, "This is just the tip of the iceberg." OK? (No. "This represents only a small fraction of the problem.") · "He hit the nail on its head." Nearly right. Is nearly right OK for an idiom? (No: idioms are fixed. A broken idiom is worse than none.)

Form.

adj + noun	a strong argument · heavy traffic · a bitter disappointment · a key issue · a valid point	We made a strong argument for the change.
verb + noun	make a decision · do research · pay attention · raise an issue · meet a deadline · take a risk	She raised an important issue.
adv + adj	deeply concerned · highly unlikely · bitterly cold · fully aware · widely regarded (as)	It's highly unlikely to rain.
verb + adv	apologize profusely · argue convincingly · fail miserably	He apologized profusely.
noun + noun	a round of applause · a surge of anger · a pang of guilt · a flurry of activity	There was a flurry of activity.
Idioms	fixed form; mostly informal; one or two per talk	Let's make sure we're on the same page.

Pronunciation. Say a collocation as **one chunk**, with no pause inside it: "heavy **RAIN**," "make a de**CI**sion," "**DEEPLY** con**CERNED**." In adverb + adjective pairs both words are stressed, and the adverb often carries the emphasis ("It's **HIGHLY** unlikely"). Idioms are also chunks; the last content word carries the stress: "bite the **BUL**let," "the tip of the **ICE**berg," "food for **THOUGHT**." Connotation lives in the voice too: a warm fall on

"She's **SLENDER** ㄣ" vs a flat, clipped "He's **STINGY**." American English: *gray* area; the flap in "a lot of" /ə'larəv/.

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 **Finish the chunk** (fast): T: "heavy..." → S: "traffic / rain." T: "meet a..." → S: "deadline." T: "pay..." → S: "attention." T: "deeply..." → S: "concerned." T: "a round of..." → S: "applause." T: "bitterly..." → S: "cold / disappointed."
- 2 **Upgrade it**: T: "It's very unlikely." → S: "It's highly unlikely." T: "I'm very worried." → S: "I'm deeply concerned." T: "He said sorry a lot." → S: "He apologized profusely." T: "It was a big disappointment." → S: "It was a bitter disappointment."
- 3 **Fix the translation**: T: "Can you make a photo?" → S: "Can you take a photo?" T: "I did a mistake." → S: "I made a mistake." T: "There was strong rain." → S: "There was heavy rain."
- 4 **Praise it / criticize it** (cline cards): T: "He's careful with money. Praise!" → S: "He's thrifty." T: "Criticize!" → S: "He's stingy." T: "She's sure of herself. Praise!" → S: "She's self-assured." T: "Criticize!" → S: "She's arrogant."
- 5 **Open pairs → closed pairs**: S1 describes an invented person or an object with a neutral word ("My neighbor's dog is thin."); S2 says it twice, once kindly and once critically ("It's slender. / It's scrawny."). Then all pairs, 1 minute.

◆ THE PRECISE TALK AND "USE IT OR LOSE IT" – HOW TO RUN THEM

- ◆ **90 seconds, not three minutes**. The online project asks for 2–3 minutes; in class, 90 seconds per speaker in groups of 3 keeps it moving. The full version is homework. Three minutes of planning plus three speakers × (90 seconds of talk + 90 seconds of shades and feedback) fill the 12 minutes exactly.
- ◆ **Chunk bingo**. Each listener has a 4 × 4 card (Set E) with collocations from the lesson, an "idiom used well" square and three free squares ("a strong collocation not on the card," "a precise near-synonym"). They tick what they hear. One listener also has a **register-slip** box. The bingo is feedback, not a competition: after the talk, the listener reads out the two best chunks.
- ◆ **Don't force the third idiom**. Say it before planning: "One or two idioms that genuinely fit. If it sounds bolted on, cut it." Praise the learner who *didn't* use an idiom because it didn't fit.
- ◆ **Shades**. After each talk, the speaker explains one near-synonym set as it applies to their topic: "If I were writing about my town for a tourist brochure, I'd say it's *renowned* for its market; in a complaint to the council, I'd say it's *notorious* for parking." Push for **register** and **connotation**, both.
- ◆ **"Use it or lose it" (5 min, before the talk)**. Groups of 3 take one discussion card. Questions: *Is "use it or lose it" true of vocabulary? Have you ever "lost" words in your first language or in English? Are idioms more fragile than collocations? What's a realistic way to use three new chunks this week?* Each learner writes three chunks and one place they'll use them (an email at work, a conversation with a neighbor, a

message to a friend). This becomes the C12 warmer report. Keep it light: nobody is asked about losing their first language unless they choose to talk about it.

- ◆ **Roles:** the **chunk counter** (a dominant speaker) holds the bingo card and gives feedback last.

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE PRECISE TALK

SAY: *How long is each talk? (90 seconds.) · How many collocations do you plan? (At least six.) · How many idioms? (One or two, only if they fit.) · What do listeners do during the talk? (Tick the chunks on the bingo card.) · Is the bingo a competition? (No, it's feedback.) · After the talk, what does the speaker explain? (One set of near-synonyms and how to choose.) · Can you describe a real classmate as "skinny" or "stingy"? (No, only invented people.)*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Focus on **verb + noun** and **adverb + adjective** only, with the picture cards: *heavy rain, strong coffee, bitterly cold, deeply concerned, take a photo, make a decision*. In the grid, give only the top half (make / do / take × 6 nouns). For the clines, give the money set and the confidence set (4 cards each) with 😊 😐 😞 faces on the strip. In the talk, a 45-second version with 3 collocations and no idiom is a complete task. Target: 6 collocations and one cline said aloud correctly.

STRETCH (TOWARD C2)

Introduce **semantic prosody**: some words attract negative partners (*cause problems / damage / delays, not cause success; rife with corruption / rumors; set in: the rain / boredom set in*). Ask them to find two more. Add finer clines (*frugal vs thrifty: frugal is closer to austere; slender vs slim: slender is more elegant and literary*). In the talk, vary one idiom deliberately for effect ("the tip of a very large iceberg") and explain why it works. Write a formal paragraph on the same topic with **no** idioms and compare.

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **make / do / take:** "make a photo" (German *ein Foto machen*, Russian *sdelat' foto*, Spanish *hacer una foto*, Dutch *een foto maken*); "do a mistake" (Arabic, Hindi, Greek and others use one "do/make" verb); "make research," "do a decision." The priority collocations to correct every time.
- ◆ **"strong rain" / "big rain":** Spanish *lluvia fuerte*, Italian *pioggia forte*, Chinese *dà yǔ* (big rain), Japanese *ōame* (big rain). Teach *heavy rain / traffic / snow* as a family.
- ◆ **"win money"** for a salary (Spanish *ganar*, Portuguese *ganhar*, French *gagner*): *earn / make money*; you *win* a prize or the lottery.
- ◆ **Translated idioms:** learners may translate a colorful idiom from their own language word for word. Enjoy it (it's often a great cultural moment), then give the English equivalent if there is one. Keep a class "idiom exchange" corner on the board.

- ◆ **False-friend connotations:** Spanish *flaco* is often affectionate (even a nickname), but *skinny* is usually critical in English; Portuguese and Spanish *ambicioso*, French *ambitieux* can be negative, while *ambitious* is usually positive in American English. Ask "praising or criticizing?" every time.
- ◆ **Idiom density:** learners who have studied idioms from lists (common in exam-prep backgrounds everywhere) may overload a talk with them. Praise accuracy, then apply the "a pinch, not a plateful" rule.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 4.2: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-c1/lesson_11.html. Listen to the five model sentences with 🎧 and say them back as chunks; do Exercises 1–3, the Quick Quiz and "The Rich, Precise Talk" (record the 2–3 minute version). Workbook 4.2: use your three "use it or lose it" chunks in real life this week and note where; start "My phrasebook" (five collocations, three idioms with a note on when to use them, one near-synonym set) and write the journal (an invented person, place or object described twice, kindly and critically). **Choose your C12 topic** from the Advanced Communicator topic cards and bring two or three pieces of evidence or examples.

◆ CHECK – SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **A** There was heavy traffic, so we had to make a quick decision. · Q2 **A** thrifty · Q3 (new) **C** nosy. Pilot program meeting (Ex 1): idioms heard: the last straw · cut corners · hit the nail on the head · the tip of the iceberg · a blessing in disguise · on the same page · food for thought · bite the bullet. Not heard: get cold feet · a gray area.

A TASK-BASED REVIEW, NOT A NEW-LANGUAGE CLASS

There is no new grammar today. The new language is the **register spectrum** (shifting vocabulary, grammar and structure as a set), a handful of **rhetorical devices** used sparingly, **signposting** for extended talk, and **diplomatic Q&A**. The class is built around one combined task in three parts: a **three-minute persuasive presentation** to a small group, **two minutes of questions and challenges**, and a **150-word formal written summary** of the argument that includes the strongest objection and the response. You listen and read with the **speaking & writing checklist** (Set G). Language work comes *from* the tasks: a short focus-on-form clinic between them. The checklist results feed C13 (Progress Test 1): they are your spoken and written evidence for Modules 1–4, and they tell you who goes to which catch-up station.

◆ OBJECTIVES – LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ shift the **register** of one message (formal ↔ neutral ↔ informal), changing vocabulary, grammar and structure **together**, and repair a register clash
- ◆ structure and deliver a **three-minute persuasive talk** with a compelling opening, two or three developed points and a memorable close, **signposted** at every join
- ◆ use **one or two rhetorical devices** at the hinges of the argument (a rhetorical question, a rule of three, contrast, a cleft or inversion)
- ◆ field questions and challenges **diplomatically**, conceding before countering (*I take your point, but I'd argue...* · *That's fair, though I'd push back on one thing...*)
- ◆ write a **150-word formal summary** of their argument (nominalized, hedged, no idioms) that fairly reports the strongest objection and their response
- ◆ deploy structures and lexis from **all four modules** (aspect and modality, the subjunctive, mixed conditionals, inversion and clefts, nominalization, cohesion, hedging, phrasal verbs, collocation) in extended, controlled output

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 4.3 (phrase banks, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, the **talk planner**, the **Q&A card**, the **written summary** page, the Module 4 "I can" checklist)
- ◆ Slides 14–18 · **Register Ladder** review game (Set H) + dice + counters · **Advanced Communicator** topic cards, side cards, persona cards, challenge starters, talking tokens (Set F) · **Speaking & writing checklist**: one class grid + score slips (Set G) · a phone timer per group
- ◆ Listening scripts 4.3-A (the model talk and Q&A: a paid learning day) and 4.3-B ("Clash or consistent?", for the clinic or a C13 station) · optional: phones for recording

BOARD PLAN

Left: the talk map. ① **OPEN** a rhetorical question or a bold claim · I'd like to make the case that... → ② **PREVIEW** There are three points I want to raise. → ③ **POINTS** claim + evidence + example · This brings me to... · Turning now to... · Crucially,... · Admittedly,... That said,... → ④ **CLOSE** In essence,... · The choice, then, is a simple one. → ⑤ **Q&A** I take your point, but I'd argue... · That's a fair challenge. What I'd say is...

Center: the spectrum (shift as a set). FORMAL *The initiative will commence next quarter and is anticipated to yield significant benefits.* · NEUTRAL *The project starts next quarter and should bring real benefits.* · INFORMAL *We're kicking this off next quarter, and it should pay off nicely.* Clash: ~~The committee will sort out the discrepancies.~~ → *resolve.* Devices (one or two!): *Can we really afford to wait?* · *cheaper, cleaner and already here* · *not a lack of money but a lack of will* · *What we need is...*

Right: the C1 toolkit. M1 will have shifted · may well prove · It is essential that it be... M2 Had we acted..., we would now... · But for... · Not only... but... · What we need is... M3 The introduction of... · the former / the latter · It would seem that... M4 look into / investigate · a pressing concern · deeply concerned · (spoken only) the tip of the iceberg. Written summary = formal: nominalize, hedge, **no idioms.**

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: Register Ladder	10	S-S (groups of 3-4)	Review C1-C11 with the Register Ladder board game (Set H). Roll, move, answer the square in full sentences; USE IT squares ask the player to report one of their three "use it or lose it" chunks from the C11 homework (where they used it, how it went). Stop after 10 minutes; nearest the finish wins. Walk around and note which squares (which modules) cause trouble: early evidence for C13.
The communicator's toolkit	12	T-S → S-S	Slides 14-16. (a) Spectrum (4 min) : one message in three registers; elicit what changed (vocabulary, voice, sentence length, contractions, phrasal verbs, hedging). (b) Devices and signposts (4 min) : learners name the device in four model sentences (Workbook Ex 3), and you set the rule: one or two, at the hinges. (c) One point, two voices (4 min) : two learners read the formal and

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			informal versions of "the deadline should be pushed back" (slide 16); pairs find five features that shifted together. CCQs.
Model: listen	7	T-S	Read Script 4.3-A twice (a three-minute talk proposing one paid learning day a month, followed by two challenges; ask two confident learners to read the questioners). First listen: "What's the proposal? How many points? What objection comes up, and how does she answer it?" Second listen: Workbook Ex 1: number the signposts in order and tick the C1 structures you hear.
Plan the talk	11	S	Slide 17. Learners fill the talk planner (Workbook 4.3): notes, not a script . Topic from the Set F cards (chosen after C11 or drawn now) or their own everyday topic. Opening device, preview, two or three points (claim + evidence + example), close. Then the Q&A card : two likely objections and a concede-and-counter answer to each. The planner has a toolkit strip (M1-M4): each learner plans at least one structure from each module. Walk around and check that each plan has a signpost at every join.
Presentation circles + Q&A + checklist	20	S-S (groups of 4) • T-S	Groups of 4. Each speaker presents for up to 3 minutes (planner turned over; a quick look is OK), then takes 2 minutes of questions and challenges: each listener asks one, using a challenge starter (Set F). A timekeeper in each group. Listeners also write one note on the back of their challenge card: <i>the speaker's main claim in one sentence</i> and <i>the best challenge</i> . The speaker collects them: they help with the written

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			summary. You sit with one group at a time and score speaking criteria 1–5.
Focus-on-form clinic	5	T–S	Board 4 sentences you heard (no names): 2 to fix, 2 to upgrade (e.g., "It is essential that he is told" → <i>be told</i> · "Not only it saves money" → <i>does it save</i> · "We have to look into this deeply" → <i>investigate this thoroughly</i> (formal) · "This is the tip of the iceberg" → fine in the talk, but rephrase it for the summary). Learners fix in pairs; check. Keep it short and positive.
Written summary + peer review	15	S → S–S	Slide 17. Learners write a 150-word formal summary of their own argument on the workbook page, as if for a committee's briefing pack: the proposal, the two strongest reasons, the strongest objection raised in the Q&A (reported with a precise reporting verb and hedging) and their response. Formal register throughout: nominalize, hedge, Latinate verbs where they fit, no idioms , no contractions. 11 minutes writing; then 4 minutes of peer review with the checklist on the page (register consistent? objection reported fairly? one Praise – Question – Polish). Collect the summaries: you score writing criteria W1–W4 after class.
Feedback + halfway wrap	5	T–S	Content first: "Which argument was the strongest you heard? Did anyone change your mind, even a little?" Then 2–3 sentences from your checklist notes, no names: one range example, one appropriacy example. Learners tick the Module 4 "I can..." lists. Celebrate: halfway through C1.

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Online lesson 4.3; record the full 4–5 minute version of your talk at home, plus the register shift (formal and informal versions of your core message); the journal. Tell learners plainly about C13: "Next class is Progress Test 1 on Modules 1–4, plus catch-up time. Today's checklist helps me plan that time for you." Hand out score slips in C13, not today.
Total	90		10 + 12 + 7 + 11 + 20 + 5 + 15 + 5 + 5

HEARING EVERYONE

In 20 minutes of circles you can score about 8 speakers well (two groups). Choose one of these for the rest, and tell the class which one before the circles: **(a)** learners record their talk and Q&A on a phone during the circles and play it for you during the C13 catch-up time; **(b)** the rest present to you at a station in C13; **(c)** in a large class, split the class: half present in C12 while the other half act as challengers, and the second half present in C13. The written summaries give you evidence for everyone. Anyone who prefers to present only to you, not a group, may do so. That is a normal choice, not a problem.

◆ MEANING • FORM • PRONUNCIATION (REVIEW FOCUS)

Meaning: register shifts as a set.

SAY: "The committee will sort out the discrepancies." What's wrong? (A formal subject and noun with an informal phrasal verb: a register clash.) Two fixes? ("...will resolve the discrepancies," or all informal: "The committee's going to sort out the mess.") · "Hey team, pursuant to our discussion..." Why is it funny? ("Hey team" is informal; "pursuant to" is legal English.) · Is the formal register always best at work? (No: it can sound cold. Warmth lives in the neutral middle.)

Meaning: rhetoric is architecture.

SAY: "Can we really afford to wait another decade?" Does the speaker want an answer? (No: the listener supplies it: "No, we can't.") · "It is cheaper, it is cleaner, and it is already here." Why three? (Rhythm, balance, a sense of completeness.) · Three rhetorical questions in a row: more persuasive? (No: it sounds like a game-show host. Use devices at the hinges: the opening, the turn, the close.)

Meaning: diplomatic Q&A.

SAY: "I take your point, but I'd argue that the cost falls over time." Does the speaker agree? (Partly: they concede, then counter.) Why concede first? (It shows they listened and makes their view sound reasonable.) · "That's a fair challenge. What I'd say is..." Is that weak? (No: calm and confident.) · "No, that's wrong." Same effect? (No: combative; the discussion stops.)

Meaning: talk vs written summary.

SAY: In the talk you said, "Honestly, it's a no-brainer." Can that go in the written summary? (No: informal idiom.) What would? ("The benefits would appear to outweigh the costs.") · In the summary, how do you report the objection? (With a reporting verb and fairly: "It was argued that... / One colleague questioned whether...") · Contractions in the summary? (No.)

Form: the review table.

Register	formal: nominal, passive, hedged, Latinate, long subordinated sentences, no contractions · neutral: balanced, some hedging · informal: verbal, active, contracted, phrasal verbs, discourse markers (<i>so, look, honestly</i>)	commence → start → kick off · require → need → could use
Devices	rhetorical question · rule of three · repetition (anaphora) · contrast (antithesis) · cleft or inversion · one well-placed idiom (spoken only)	The problem is not a lack of money, but a lack of will.
Signposts	Let me begin by... · There are three points I want to raise. · This brings me to... · Turning now to... · Crucially,... · To put it another way,... · Admittedly,... That said,... · In essence,... · The bottom line is this:...	This brings me to my second point.
Q&A	I take your point, but I'd argue... · That's a fair challenge; what I'd say is... · I'd push back on one thing... · If I understand you correctly, your concern is... · That's beyond the scope of this proposal, but...	If I understand you correctly, your concern is cost.
Module 1	future perfect / continuous · modals of speculation (<i>may well, might as well, must have</i>) · the subjunctive (<i>It is essential that it be...</i>)	By 2030, the savings will have paid for the scheme.
Module 2	mixed conditionals and <i>if</i> -alternatives (<i>Had we..., But for..., Supposing...</i>) · inversion (<i>Not only..., Rarely...</i>) · clefts and fronting (<i>What we need is..., It was... that...</i>)	Had we invested earlier, we would be ahead now.
Module 3	nominalization · cohesion (reference, substitution, ellipsis) · hedging and diplomatic language	The introduction of the scheme would appear to reduce turnover.

Module 4	phrasal verbs by register · strong collocations · connotation · idioms (spoken, sparingly)	It remains a pressing concern that we must look into.
-----------------	--	---

Pronunciation. Signposts are chunks followed by a clear pause: "This brings me **to** | my **second** point." Slow down for the preview and the close. A **rule of three** rises, rises, falls: "It's **cheaper** ↗ | it's **cleaner** ↗ | and it's **already** here ↘." **Contrast** puts the stress on the opposed words: "not a lack of **MONEY**, but a lack of **WILL**." In a cleft, the spotlight word carries the stress: "What we **need** is **time**." The concede-and-counter move has two tunes: a warm fall on "I take your **point** ↘" and then a fresh, higher start on "**but** I'd argue...". In the formal register, keep full forms and a steadier pace; in the informal restatement, contract and speed up.

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 Three rungs:** T gives a neutral line and a direction: "We need more time. Up!" → S: "Additional time will be required." "Down!" → S: "We could really use a bit more time." T: "The project starts in May. Up!" → S: "The project will commence in May." "Down!" → S: "We're kicking it off in May."
- 2 Signpost chain:** T: "Topic: a paid learning day." → S1: "I'd like to make the case that..." → S2: "There are three points I want to raise." → S3: "Let me begin by..." → S4: "This brings me to..." → S5: "In essence,..." Round the room; pause after each signpost.
- 3 Concede → counter:** T reads a challenge ("Won't that cost too much?"); S answers with a frame and one reason: "I take your point, but I'd argue that the cost of replacing staff is far higher." Rotate: *That's a fair challenge; what I'd say is... · I'd push back on one thing...*
- 4 Upgrade with a module:** T says a plain sentence and names a module; S upgrades it. T: "I'm sure it will help. M1." → S: "It may well prove decisive." T: "We didn't act, so we're behind. M2." → S: "Had we acted, we wouldn't be behind now." T: "They introduced the policy, and waste went down. M3." → S: "The introduction of the policy led to a marked reduction in waste." T: "We'll check it. M4, formal." → S: "We will investigate the matter."

◆ THE ADVANCED COMMUNICATOR – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ **Three minutes, not five.** The online capstone asks for 4–5 minutes; in class, three minutes plus two minutes of Q&A per speaker keeps four speakers inside 20 minutes and still shows structure and range. The full version is homework (a phone recording, with the register shift).
- ◆ **Topics.** Everyday proposals and trade-offs in workplace, education, technology, health habits and community life (Set F: a paid learning day, a four-day week for office jobs, phones locked away in school for under-16s, apprenticeships vs degrees, car-free town centers on Sundays, AI tools for homework, pricier sugary drinks in workplace cafeterias, public libraries as community hubs, remote work as the default for office jobs, first-aid training for every adult). A learner's own topic is welcome if it stays in this territory. The **side** is on the card or chosen freely; it is not the speaker's personal opinion unless they want it to be.

- ◆ **Q&A.** Every listener asks one question or challenge with a starter (Set F: "Isn't there a risk that...?" · "How would that work for...?" · "You said..., but surely...?" · "What would you say to someone who...?"). The speaker concedes before countering at least once. The timekeeper stops the Q&A after two minutes, kindly. A speaker may say "That's beyond the scope of this proposal, but..." once: a legitimate C1 move.
- ◆ **Challenge notes feed the summary.** After each talk, listeners write the speaker's main claim in one sentence and the best challenge on the back of their card, and hand them over. The speaker now has an outsider's version of their argument and the strongest objection, ready for the written summary.
- ◆ **The written summary** is a *register shift* of the talk: the same argument, formal and concise, for readers who weren't there. 150 words (130–170 is fine). It must include the strongest objection, reported fairly with a reporting verb (*One participant questioned whether...*) and hedged (*It could be argued that...*), and the response. No idioms, no contractions, no rhetorical questions. The page has a peer-review checklist.
- ◆ **Talking tokens** in the Q&A if one listener dominates: two each; one token per question. Give the **timekeeper** and **last questioner** roles to the most dominant speakers in each group.
- ◆ **Persona cards** (a hospital night-shift nurse, a small-business owner, a university student, a parent of three, a retired teacher, a city bus driver) give learners a point of view that isn't theirs: "Speaking as a small-business owner, I'd be deeply concerned about...". Great for quieter learners and for anyone who doesn't want to speak for themselves.
- ◆ If a Q&A gets heated, the timekeeper (or you) says: "Great challenge. One sentence to answer, then we move on." Challenge the idea, never the person.

◆ THE SPEAKING & WRITING CHECKLIST – HOW TO SCORE IT (FEEDS C13)

Speaking: five criteria, 0–3 points each, /15. **Writing:** four criteria, 0–3 points each, /12. 0 = no response · 1 = not yet C1 · 2 = C1 · 3 = strong C1 (moving toward C2). Score the **whole spoken performance** across the talk and the Q&A, and the written summary separately. Tick the **module boxes** (M1–M4) when you hear or read a structure from that module used correctly. The full descriptors, the class grid and the score slips are in the classroom materials (Set G).

Criterion	What 3 points looks like
S1 · Task & organization	A compelling opening, a preview, 2–3 developed points each with evidence or an example, a memorable close; signposted at every join; within time.
S2 · Range (Modules 1–4)	Structures from at least 3 of the 4 modules used naturally and without prompting; precise, strong collocations; one or two devices well placed.
S3 · Accuracy	Consistent control of complex grammar; errors are rare, minor and often self-corrected.
S4 · Register & interaction	Register consistent and appropriate to the audience, shifted on purpose; Q&A handled diplomatically (concedes before countering, clarifies the question, stays

	calm).
S5 • Fluency & delivery	Even pace with pauses at signposts; stress highlights contrast and key points; little searching for words; easy to follow for three minutes.
W1 • Content	Accurately summarizes the proposal and main reasons; reports the strongest objection fairly and responds to it; 130–170 words.
W2 • Organization & cohesion	Logical order; cohesive devices (reference, linkers, <i>the former / the latter</i>) make it read as one text.
W3 • Register & lexis	Consistently formal: nominalization, hedging, precise collocations, Latinate verbs where they fit; no idioms, contractions or clashes.
W4 • Accuracy	Complex sentences controlled; errors rare and do not affect meaning; punctuation supports the structure.

Feeding C13. Record each learner's scores and module ticks on the class grid. In C13, after Progress Test 1, send learners to a **catch-up station** for any module with no tick and for their lowest criterion: **no M1 tick** → time & modality station (future perfect/continuous, *may well / might as well / needn't have*, the subjunctive); **no M2 tick** → conditionals & emphasis station (mixed conditionals, *Had I... / But for...*, inversion, clefts); **no M3 tick** → cohesion & hedging station (nominalization rewrites, reference and ellipsis, softening); **no M4 tick** → lexis station (Register Swap cards and cline cards from Sets C and D); **S4 or W3 ≤ 1** → register-shift station (Workbook 4.3 Ex 2 and 4 + one "three rungs" round); **S5 ≤ 1** → shadowing station (the 🗣️ model sentences in online lessons 4.1–4.3); **W4 ≤ 1** → editing station (rewrite two sentences of your own summary with the teacher's codes). If Progress Test 1 has its own speaking and writing tasks, keep this grid anyway: it is your evidence of extended output for Modules 1–4, and it lets you give each learner one kind, specific next step.

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE PRESENTATIONS AND THE SUMMARY

SAY: *Presentations: How long do you speak? (Up to three minutes.) • Can you read your notes? (Only a quick look.) • What does each listener do? (Asks one question or challenge, then writes the main claim and the best challenge on the card.) • How do you answer a challenge? (Concede, then counter.) • Do you have to present to the group? (No, you can present only to the teacher.)*

SAY: *Summary: Who is the reader? (A committee that wasn't there.) • How many words? (About 150.) • Formal or informal? (Formal.) • Idioms or contractions? (No.) • What must you include besides your reasons? (The strongest objection and your response.) • What do you do in the last four minutes? (Peer review with the checklist.)*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Give a **talk strip**: "I'd like to make the case that... · There are two points I want to raise. · Let me begin by... because... · This brings me to... For example,... · In essence,..." and a **reply strip**: "I take your point, but... · That's a fair challenge. What I'd say is...". A 90-second talk with two points is a complete task. For the summary, give a **frame** with the first words of each sentence ("This proposal argues that... · The principal reason is... · A further benefit would be... · It was argued, however, that... · In response,...") and accept 80–100 words. Score on the same checklist: a clear, well-signposted short talk can earn full marks on S1 and S5.

STRETCH (TOWARD C2)

Use one structure from **each** module and one device at each hinge (opening, turn, close), no more. In the Q&A, paraphrase the challenge before answering ("If I understand you correctly, your concern is..."). Shift register *within* the talk on purpose: open formally, land the key point with one well-judged informal line, and explain the choice afterward. In the summary, use a concessive structure (*Whilst / While it is true that...*, ...) and one nominalized phrasal noun (*the likely outcome*). Homework: the 4–5 minute version with no notes, plus the formal and informal restatements.

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **Over-formal by default**: speakers of Romance languages, Greek and Russian (where academic speech is highly nominal) may deliver the whole talk in the formal register. Praise the control, then ask for one neutral or informal moment to create warmth.
- ◆ **Contractions and idioms in the summary**: learners who have worked hard on idioms may carry them into writing. Link to C11: "Spoken: yes. Written summary: rephrase it."
- ◆ **False friends in signposts**: "Resuming..." (Spanish *resumiendo*, French *en résumé*) → *In essence / To sum up*; "Actually..." meaning "currently" (Spanish *actualmente*, French *actuellement*, German *aktuell*); "Eventually..." meaning "possibly" (Spanish *eventualmente*, French *éventuellement*, German *eventuell*).
- ◆ **"According to me..."** (French *selon moi*, Spanish *según yo*, Indian English): *according to* is for other sources. Offer "In my view..." or "I'd argue that...".
- ◆ **The subjunctive**: "It is essential that he is told" is common in British English and acceptable, but the C1 target (Lesson 1.3) is *that he be told*; the mandative subjunctive is standard in formal American English. Don't mark the indicative wrong; tick M1 only for the subjunctive.
- ◆ **Directness differs**. Some learners counter without conceding ("No, this is not correct."); others concede without countering, so their view disappears. Teach the English middle path, **concede and then counter**, as a technique, not a personality change.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 4.3: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-c1/lesson_12.html. Listen to the five model sentences with 🎧 and say them; do Exercises 1–3 and the Quick Quiz. Record the full 4–5 minute version of

your talk, your answers to the two objections, and the register shift (your core message once formally, once informally), then listen back with the project checklist. Workbook 4.3: Exercises 2, 4 and 5 (register shifts, clash repairs and toolkit upgrades: good preparation for C13), a clean copy of your written summary if you want more feedback, and the journal (one thing you can do now that you couldn't at the start of C1, and one thing to sharpen next). The online journal prompt (your core message in three registers, annotated) is a strong optional extra. Review the Module 1–4 "I can..." lists before C13.

◆ CHECK – SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **C** A rhetorical question ("Can we really afford to wait?") · Q2 **B** It is imperative that action be taken at once. · Q3 (new) **B** The committee will resolve the discrepancies. Model talk (Ex 1a, Script 4.3-A): signposts in order: Ask yourself this (1) · I'd like to make the case that (2) · There are three points I want to raise (3) · Let me begin by (4) · This brings me to (5) · Turning now to (6) · In essence (7) · I take your point, but I'd argue (8) · That's a fair challenge. What I'd say is (9). Ex 1b structures heard: future perfect (*will have paid for itself*), subjunctive (*it is essential that the day be protected*), mixed conditional (*had we offered this earlier, we would not now be...*), *not only* inversion, *what*-cleft (*What we need is...*), nominalization (*the introduction of...*), hedging (*would appear to*), strong collocation (*a pressing concern*). Not heard: *needn't have*, ellipsis with *so / not*.

END OF C12: MODULE 4 WRAP-UP AND THE HALFWAY POINT

Recap on slide 18, "choose the verb, the partner, the voice": **We'll look into it. / We will investigate the matter.** (the register swap) → **heavy traffic · a bitter disappointment · slender, not skinny · thrifty, not stingy** (the partner and the shade) → **one argument, three voices: the talk, the Q&A, the formal summary.** Learners tick the three "I can..." lists. Anything still unticked goes on a sticky note for you. Use those notes, the Register Ladder observations and your checklist to plan the C13 catch-up stations.

Celebrate the halfway point. Learners have finished half of C1. Ask each person to say one thing they can do now that they couldn't do in Week 1, in any register they like ("What I'm proudest of is...", "Never have I spoken for three minutes without notes before!"). Keep it short and warm.

Progress Test 1 (C13) covers Modules 1–4. From this module it can test: the four multi-word verb types and pronoun placement (*turn it off / look after it / put up with it*), the register pairs in both directions and choosing by context, polysemous phrasal verbs in context, nominalized forms (*breakdown, outcome*), collocation types and strong collocations (*heavy, deeply, highly, meet, make / do / take*), connotation (*slender / skinny, thrifty / stingy, renowned / notorious, childlike / childish*), idiom meaning and appropriacy, register shifting and clash repair, rhetorical devices and signposting. The C12 speaking and writing checklist gives you the extended-output evidence.

Watch for in Module 5: participle and absolute clauses (5.1) build on the nominal, compressed style of the written summary (*Having weighed the evidence, the committee... · The budget approved, work began.*).

Advanced prepositions (5.2) connect directly to the inseparable and three-part verbs of 4.1 (*in response to, with regard to, on behalf of*), and academic vocabulary (5.3) extends the formal column of the register swap. Keep a two-minute "register tennis" or "praise it / criticize it" warmer in C14–C16: it is quick, and it keeps Module 4 lexis alive in speech. Use it or lose it.

Module 5 — Structure & Advanced Vocabulary

Three workshop classes on the quiet machinery of formal English. First, **participle and absolute clauses** fold a whole clause into the edge of a sentence (*Having reviewed the figures, the board...* · *The meeting over, the staff went home*), and learners hunt the **dangling participle** that betrays a careless draft. Second, **dependent prepositions and fixed formal phrases** (*comply with, aware of, an increase in, in light of, by virtue of, with regard to*) are tested in a formal-email correction challenge. Third, **academic and formal vocabulary** (Academic Word List families, *get* → *obtain*, *show* → *demonstrate*, stance verbs graded by strength) is put to work summarizing a short research abstract without over-claiming. The module starts right after Progress Test 1, so C14 opens by handing the tests back in a warm, low-stress way.

3 lessons

Lessons 5.1–5.3

Classes C14–C16

Weeks 7–8

90 min per class

CEFR C1

HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

- One lesson block = one 90-minute class. Every class follows the same shape: **warmer** → **lead-in** → **Meaning / Form / Pronunciation** with concept-checking questions (CCQs) → **drill** (choral, then individual) → **controlled practice** (workbook) → **freer practice** (here, a writing or editing **workshop** in small teams) → **feedback** with delayed error correction → **homework**.
- The **stage plan** is your clock. Each one adds up to 90 minutes. The numbers in the Time column are minutes.
- Present from [slides/module-5-structure-vocabulary.html](#). Print [materials/module-5/classroom-materials.html](#) before C14. It holds the phrase and chunk flashcards, the Dangler Hunt strips and the three Condense the Report cards, the formal email for the Correction Challenge with its reply cards and score sheet, the two research abstracts with the summary peer-review card, "The Editor's Path" board game, and the listening scripts.
- The online lessons are the learners' **homework and review**. Each one has  Listen buttons, so learners can hear the model sentences again at home.
- **Refinement, not a first meeting.** B2 Lesson 3.2 taught basic participle clauses (*Walking home, I saw...*; *Having finished, she left*) and reduced relatives, and B2 learners have used *interested in*, *depend on* and a handful of formal phrases for years. Check what they know in each lead-in and move quickly where they are strong. The new C1 work is the **voice-driven choice** of participle (-ing / *having done* / past participle), the **absolute clause**

as the fix for different subjects, **formal and noun-based preposition chunks** (*an increase in / of, a solution to, by virtue of*), and **register judgment**: knowing when the formal word is sharper and when it is merely fancy.

- ◆ **Workshops, not lectures.** All three classes end with a team editing or writing task (a report to condense, an email to correct, an abstract to summarize). Keep the input stages brisk so the workshop gets its full time: that is where the learning becomes visible.
- ◆ **Feedback on range, accuracy and appropriacy.** In every workshop, circulate and take notes; don't stop a team to fix *aware about*. At feedback, give three kinds of comment, without names: one **accuracy** fix ("*comply to* → *comply with*"), one **range** upgrade ("*because the funds ran out* → *the funds having run out*"), and one **appropriacy** note ("*commence* is right in the report, but in the email to a colleague, *start* is better"). Write them in three board columns: **Fix · Upgrade · Fit**.
- ◆ **Peer-review protocol (all three classes): Praise · Question · Polish.** Reviewers give one specific praise ("Your absolute in line 2 is elegant"), ask one genuine question ("Who is doing the *reviewing* here?"), and suggest one polish, never more. The writer decides whether to accept it. Reviewers write their three points on the review card, not on the draft. This keeps critique precise and adult, and stops one strong editor rewriting another team's work.
- ◆ **Dominant speakers.** Every workshop has built-in roles: **scribe** (holds the pen, writes only what the team agrees), **checker** (runs the "who is doing this?" test or the preposition-only proofread), and **word-counter / timekeeper**. Give the most dominant learner the checker role: they may only ask questions, not propose wording. In whole-class discussion, use **talking chips** (3 per learner). Say it kindly: "Thanks, Omar, that's a sharp point. Let's hear from a team that hasn't reported yet."
- ◆ **Stretching strong learners toward C2.** Each class has a "Stretch" box with C2-leaning material (*with-* absolutes and literary absolutes, prepositions fronted in relative clauses such as *the policy in accordance with which...*, stacking and calibrating hedges, precise academic collocations such as *conduct research, draw a conclusion*). Offer it; don't require it.
- ◆ **American English is the classroom standard.** The online lessons use British spelling and some British forms throughout this module: *realise, practised, cancelled, analyse, emphasise, utilisation, programme, enrolment, enquiry, queue, CV, towards, "we've no buffer"*. Teach *realize, practiced, canceled, analyze, emphasize, utilization, program, enrollment, inquiry, line, résumé, toward, "we have no buffer"*. Note that American usage prefers *in light of*; British English often says *in the light of*. Accept British forms when learners use them.
- ◆ Dashed boxes = lines to say out loud, CCQs and ICQs (instruction-checking questions). Green boxes = scripts you read aloud. **Amber** = watch-outs.

THE THROUGH-LINE

Compress → connect → choose. In C14 learners **compress** clauses so formal prose carries more meaning in fewer words, and check that every participle is anchored to the right subject. In C15 they **connect** words with the exact small preposition the pattern demands, and the formal phrase that fits the genre. In C16 they **choose** the precise academic word and the right strength of stance verb, and learn to hear over-formality as an error. Each class ends with a text the team improves together: an over-connected report condensed, a flawed formal email corrected, a research abstract summarized faithfully. These are the editing habits Module 6 (critical reading, essays, professional writing) will rely on.

TRAUMA-INFORMED: TESTS, FORMAL LETTERS AND RESEARCH TOPICS

The test return. Some adults, including highly qualified professionals whose credentials were not recognized here, carry painful associations with being graded. Keep the return brief, private and warm (see C14). Never read scores aloud or compare learners.

Formal correspondence. For many newcomers, formal letters mean immigration offices, benefits agencies, courts or landlords. **Keep every formal text in this module in neutral territory:** a college parking notice, a workplace training update, a clinic's appointment system, a library's Wi-Fi. Don't use immigration, asylum, benefits, court or eviction letters as examples, and don't ask learners to bring in real letters they have received.

Research topics. The C16 abstracts are about walking breaks at work and a reusable-cup scheme on a campus: low-stakes, everyday science. Learners discuss the *study*, not their own health. Journal prompts always allow an invented or reported example ("something a colleague concluded," "a news item"). As in every module, a **new identity** or an invented example is always a good answer.

BEFORE THE MODULE

- ◆ **Mark Progress Test 1** before C14. Write a short, positive comment on every paper: one strength + one thing to practice, phrased as an upgrade, not a deficit ("Your conditionals are accurate; next, try mixing time frames"). Collect **4–5 common errors** from different papers for the C14 board (no names). Note which learners scored below about 60% so you can offer a quiet 1:1 chat at the break.
- ◆ Print the **flashcards** (Set A): fixed participial phrases, preposition chunks and academic words, most of them word-only; 6 picture cards for the phrase drill. Card stock helps.
- ◆ For C14: one set of **Dangler Hunt** strips per team of 3 and one **Condense the Report** card per team (Set B; three different reports, so neighboring teams differ), plus one **peer-review card** per team.
- ◆ For C15: one copy of the **Riverside College parking email** per team, one **score sheet**, and one **reply card** (A or B) per team (Set C).
- ◆ For C16: one **research abstract** per learner (Set D: Abstract 1 for most teams, Abstract 2 for fast or strong teams), an A/B **"explain it to a friend"** card per pair, and one **summary peer-review card** per team. One **Editor's Path** board (Set E) per group of 3–4, a die or coin, and counters.

- ◆ Have a phone ready to "play" the voicemail in C15 (read the script while holding the phone to your ear).

MODULE AT A GLANCE

LESSON	CLASS	FOCUS	LEARNERS CAN...
5.1	C14 · wk 7	Progress Test 1 return · participle clauses chosen by voice: present (-ing, simultaneous / reason / result), perfect (<i>having</i> + <i>p.p.</i> , earlier action), past participle (passive meaning) · reduced relatives (<i>members wishing to...</i> , <i>items damaged in transit</i>) · absolute clauses with their own subject (<i>The meeting over, ...; The funds having run out, ...</i>) · fixed participial phrases (<i>having said that, weather permitting, all things considered, given that</i>) · the dangling participle and its two repairs	condense an over-connected report by at least a third with four or more participle or absolute constructions, keep every fact, and find and fix dangling participles in their own and others' drafts
5.2	C15 · wk 8	Dependent prepositions: verb (<i>comply with, refrain from, account for, result in / from, object to</i>), adjective (<i>aware of, subject to, prone to, consistent with, reliant on</i>), noun (<i>an increase in, a solution to, an alternative to, insight into</i>) · <i>in</i> (area) vs <i>of</i> (figure) · transitive verbs with no preposition (<i>discuss, enter</i>) · fixed formal phrases (<i>with regard to, in light of, by virtue of, in the event of, on behalf of, in accordance with, in the wake of</i>) and their plain equivalents	proofread a formal email for preposition errors, correct them with confidence (and leave correct chunks alone), and write a short formal reply with accurate dependent prepositions and fixed phrases in the right register
5.3	C16 · wk 8	Everyday → academic equivalents and sense fit (<i>obtain, demonstrate, substantial / significant, examine, sufficient, approximately, deteriorate</i>) · Academic Word List families (<i>analyze, significant, establish, evident, derive, constitute, consequent</i>) · stance verbs by strength (<i>suggest, indicate, argue, demonstrate, acknowledge</i>) and hedging · single verbs over phrasal verbs in writing · don't over-formalize	summarize a short research abstract in academic register, moving between word-family forms, reporting its claims at exactly the right strength, and explain the same study plainly to a friend

5.1 · C14

Participle & Absolute Clauses

90 min

◆ OBJECTIVES – LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ reflect on their Progress Test 1 results and set one personal goal
- ◆ compress adverbial and relative clauses into **participle clauses**, choosing by **voice**: -ing (active, same time), *having + p.p.* (active, earlier), past participle (passive): *Written in 1920, the novel...*
- ◆ build **absolute clauses** with their own subject when the two subjects differ: *The funds having run out, the project was suspended.*
- ◆ use common **fixed participial phrases** as sentence adverbials: *having said that, all things considered, weather permitting, given that*
- ◆ identify and repair a **dangling participle** in two ways (change the main subject, or give the participle its own subject)
- ◆ condense an over-connected report in a team, keeping every fact and a clear, formal rhythm

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Marked Progress Test 1 papers (in folders or face-down) · sticky notes · Workbook "My goal after Progress Test 1" box
- ◆ Workbook 5.1 (Key phrases, Grammar box, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, Condense the Report frame)
- ◆ Slides 3–9 · Fixed-phrase picture cards and word cards (Set A) · **Dangler Hunt** strips + **Condense the Report** cards + peer-review cards (Set B)
- ◆ Listening scripts 5.1-A (the chair's announcement) and 5.1-B (dictation)

BOARD PLAN

Left: a "compression funnel." Top: *When she realized the risk, she paused.* Arrow down, crossing out *When* and *she*: **Realizing the risk, she paused.** Second example: *The novel was written in 1920, and it...* → **Written in 1920, the novel...**

Center: three boxes labeled by **voice**, not tense: **-ing** = does it, same time · **having + p.p.** = did it, earlier · **p.p.** = had it done to it. Under them: **ABSOLUTE** = own subject + participle: *The meeting over, ...* · *The weather being fine, ...* · *Her work done, ...*

Right: the one-question test in a box: **"Who is doing this -ing / being this -ed?" → it must be the next subject.** ✗ *Walking home, the rain started.* Two repairs: ① change the subject ② give the participle its own subject.

Far right: three empty feedback columns: **Fix · Upgrade · Fit.**

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Welcome & Progress Test 1 return	12	T-S · S-S · S	Slide 3. See "Returning Progress Test 1" below: strengths on the board, papers back privately, pairs fix 4 anonymous errors, each learner writes one goal in the workbook box.
Lead-in: the baggy notice	5	T-S · S-S	Slide 4. Show the "baggy" version of a notice: <i>"The committee reviewed last year's attendance, and it has secured a larger venue. The session will be held in the east wing, which is being used for the first time..."</i> Ask: "Is anything wrong?" (No, it's correct.) "How does it feel?" (Wordy, like speech.) Then show the compressed version from the online lesson. Pairs spot three differences in 60 seconds. Elicit: fewer <i>and / which / because</i> ; subjects disappear; participles do the work.
Participle clauses: M / F / P	12	T-S	Slides 4–5. Recycle B2 quickly ("Who remembers <i>Having finished, she left?</i> "). Then the C1 system: present (simultaneous, reason, result: ..., <i>flattening dozens of homes</i>),

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			perfect (earlier), past participle (passive); reduced relatives (<i>members wishing to...</i> , <i>items damaged in transit</i>). Key rule: choose by voice, not by tense . CCQs (below).
Absolutes & fixed phrases	10	T-S	Slides 6-7. Absolute = the fix for different subjects. Show the problem first (" <i>Because the road was blocked, the drivers turned back: can we just drop because?</i> "), then the solution: <i>The road blocked, the drivers turned back</i> . Omitted <i>being</i> (<i>Dinner over, ...</i>). Then the fixed phrases with the picture cards (umbrella → <i>weather permitting</i> , flight → <i>all flights having been canceled</i>). Register note: fixed phrases work in speech; full absolutes are written.
Drill	5	T-S → S	See Drill script: the "compress it" oral drill, the voice switch, and the comma-pause rhythm.
Listening: the chair's announcement	5	T-S → S-S	Workbook Ex 1. Read Script 5.1-A twice in a formal "meeting chair" voice. Learners write the eight participle chunks

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			they hear. Pairs compare. Ask: "Which ones have their own subject?" (<i>the gymnasium being unavailable, the schedule being unusually full</i>)
Controlled practice	9	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 2–4 alone (compress · choose by voice · absolutes), then check in pairs. Board-check only the items pairs disagree on. Ex 5 (sound or dangling?) opens the workshop, so hold it.
Workshop: Condense the Report	22	S-S (teams of 3) → S-S (teams swap)	Slide 9. (1) Dangler Hunt (5 min): teams get 8 strips from "an intern's draft"; sort them into <i>sound</i> and <i>dangling</i> (five dangle), and fix two aloud. Workbook Ex 5 is the same skill. (2) Condense (12 min): each team gets a report card (~125 words, over-connected). Target: 90 words or fewer, every fact kept , at least four participle or absolute constructions (including one absolute) and one fixed phrase. The scribe writes; the checker runs the one-question test on every leading participle. (3) Peer review (5 min):

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			teams swap drafts with a team that had a different report and use the review card: Praise · Question · Polish, plus "any dangles?" ICQs first.
Feedback	5	T-S	Delayed correction in the Fix · Upgrade · Fit columns, e.g. Fix: "Having reviewed the budget, the proposal seemed too expensive." · Fix: "Building in 1968, the center needs a roof." · Upgrade: "Because the budget had not been spent, ..." → "The budget not having been spent, ..." · Fit: a full absolute in a text message to a friend ("My shift over, I'll call you") sounds oddly stiff. Read out the tightest condensed report (with permission).
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Show online lesson 5.1 on screen; point at a  button. Set the homework (below). Learners tick the "I can..." box in the workbook.
Total	90		12 + 5 + 12 + 10 + 5 + 5 + 9 + 22 + 5 + 5

IF YOU RUN LONG

The test return must stay at 12 minutes. Cut Workbook Ex 4 and the dictation (Script 5.1-B) and set them as homework. If the workshop is squeezed, shorten the Dangler Hunt to "find the five" without fixing, but never cut the peer review: checking another team's participles is how learners start checking their own.

RETURNING PROGRESS TEST 1 (12 MIN) — KEEP IT WARM

1. Celebrate first (3 min). Before any paper comes out, write "**We can...**" on the board and list three things the whole class did well (for example: *place events precisely in the future with be due to / be on the verge of* · *speculate about the past with must have / can't have* · *add emphasis with inversion and clefts* · *hedge a claim diplomatically*). Say it out loud.

SAY: *Four modules of C1! You can speculate precisely, imagine mixed time frames, emphasize with inversion, and soften a claim so it sounds professional. That's advanced English. Give yourselves a hand.*

2. Return privately (2 min). Hand papers back face-down or in folders. **Never read scores aloud** and never compare learners. Everyone gets a written comment: one strength + one upgrade to work on.

3. "Let's fix it!" (5 min). Show 4 anonymous errors from the tests. Use your own learners' errors if you can; typical ones at this point: *Not only she finished the report, but she also presented it.* · *If I had accepted the offer, I would live in Boston by now.* · *It was in 2019 when she moved to Denver.* · *We need to make a research before the meeting.* (Also common: *She must have forgot the password.* · *Hardly had I sat down than the phone rang.* · *The manager insisted that every employee attends.*) Pairs fix them. Take answers. Praise the fixing, not the error-free papers.

4. One goal (2 min). Each learner writes one goal in the workbook box ("My goal after Progress Test 1"): *"I want to refine _____. Every week I will _____."* Give two examples: "I want to refine my inversion. Every week I'll rewrite three sentences from a news article with *Not only... / Rarely...*" / "I want to hedge more naturally. I'll note five hedges from a podcast each week and use two at work."

SAY: *A test is a map. It tells us where we are. It doesn't tell us who we are.*

Some adults carry hard memories of school and tests, and professionals retraining in a new country can feel a test as a judgment on their whole career. Keep your voice light and move on quickly. Offer a **1:1 chat at the break** to anyone who struggled (below about 60%), and plan catch-up with the Module 1–4 online lessons. Don't let the test return grow past 12 minutes. The best encouragement is a successful lesson straight after it, and today's grammar rewards what C1 learners already have: a good ear for written English.

Meaning: compression, not a new meaning. A participle clause says what a full clause says, minus the conjunction and the repeated subject. The reader supplies the link (time, reason, condition, result).

SAY: "Knowing the road well, he took a shortcut." Who knew the road? (He did.) Why did he take the shortcut? (Because he knew the road.) Is because in the sentence? (No, the reader supplies it.) · "The storm hit the coast, flattening dozens of homes." What flattened the homes? (The storm.) Before or after it hit? (As a result of hitting.)

Meaning: choose by voice, not by tense.

SAY: "Having signed the contract, they celebrated." Which came first? (Signing.) Who signed? (They did: active.) · "Signed in March, the contract runs for two years." Did the contract sign anything? (No, someone signed it: passive, past participle.) · "Building in 1920, the museum..." Can a museum build? (No! Built in 1920.)

SAY: "Members wishing to attend are asked to register." Is this a full clause? (No, a reduced relative.) Full version? (Members who wish to attend...) · "Items damaged in transit will be replaced." Active or passive? (Passive: items that are damaged.)

Meaning: absolute clauses have their own subject.

SAY: "The weather being fine, we set off early." Was we fine? (No, the weather was fine.) How many subjects? (Two: the weather, we.) Why can't we write "Being fine, we set off"? (It says we were fine: it dangles.) · "The meeting over, the staff went home." What's missing? (being: the meeting being over.) Formal or casual? (Formal, written.)

Meaning: the dangling participle.

SAY: "Walking into the room, the noise was overwhelming." Grammatically, who is walking? (The noise!) Do we understand it anyway? (Yes, but it's a careless error in formal writing.) Two ways to fix it? (Change the subject: ..., I found the noise overwhelming. Or give it its own subject / a full clause: As I walked into the room, ...)

SAY: "Having said that, the second option is cheaper." Who said it? (No one in particular: a fixed phrase.) Is it a dangling participle? (No, fixed phrases are exceptions.)

Form.

Present participle	-ing · active, same time / reason / result	Feeling exhausted, she declined the invitation. · The storm hit, flattening homes.
Perfect participle	having + p.p. · active, earlier action · passive:	Having finished the report, he left. · Having been warned twice, the driver slowed down.

	having been + p.p.	
Past participle	p.p. · passive meaning	Written in 1920, the novel still speaks to readers. · Given more time, we could have finished.
Reduced relative	noun + -ing / p.p.	the candidates applying for the post · any items damaged in transit
Negative	not before the participle	Not knowing the way, we asked for directions.
Absolute	own subject + participle (<i>being</i> often dropped)	The funds having run out, the project was suspended. · Dinner over, the guests moved to the lounge. · He stood at the door, his coat over one arm.
Fixed phrases	sentence adverbials; exempt from subject-matching	having said that · generally / strictly speaking · all things considered · weather / time permitting · given that · provided that · judging by · barring any delays

Pronunciation. A leading participle clause is its own **tone unit**: a slight rise and a short pause at the comma, then the main clause falls: "Having reviewed the figures ↗ | the board approved the plan ↘." Absolutes need the pause most, or listeners attach the noun to the wrong verb: "The meeting over ↗ | the staff went home ↘." *Having* is often weak /'hævɪŋ/ → /əvɪŋ/ in fast speech but should stay clear when reading aloud. Past participles keep their endings: *canceled* /'kænsəld/, *damaged* /'dæmɪdʒd/, *based* /beɪst/. Fixed phrases are single chunks with one main stress: "all things considered," "weather permitting," "having said that."

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 Compress it** (T says a full sentence; learners say the compressed version): T: "Because he knew the area well, he took a shortcut." → S: "Knowing the area well, he took a shortcut." T: "After she had locked the door, she checked it twice." → S: "Having locked the door, she checked it twice." T: "The report was written in a hurry, and it contained errors." → S: "Written in a hurry, the report contained errors." Choral, then fast individuals.
- 2 Voice switch** (T gives a verb + a subject; learners decide): T: "write · the letter" → S: "Written in haste, the letter..." T: "write · the manager" → S: "Having written the letter, the manager..." T: "delay · the train" → "Delayed by snow, the train..." T: "warn · the driver (twice, earlier)" → "Having been warned twice, the driver..."
- 3 Absolute or dangle?** T: "The road was blocked. The drivers turned back." → S: "The road blocked, the drivers turned back." T: "The meeting had ended. Everyone left." → "The meeting over, everyone left." T: "The weather was fine. We set off." → "The weather being fine, we set off."
- 4 Rhythm:** choral with a clear rise–pause–fall: "Having reviewed the figures ↗ | the board approved the plan ↘." · "Weather permitting ↗ | we'll eat outside ↘." Then individuals read one line from Script 5.1-A.

- 5 **Open pairs → closed pairs:** S1 says a two-clause sentence about something from today's news or workplace (real or invented); S2 compresses it and says which kind it is (present, perfect, past, absolute). 1 minute, then swap.

◆ CONDENSE THE REPORT – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ **Teams of 3** with roles: **scribe** (writes only what the team agrees), **checker** (runs the one-question test on every leading participle and counts constructions), **word-counter / timekeeper**. Rotate roles in C15 and C16.
- ◆ **Round 1 — Dangler Hunt (5 min).** Eight strips from "an intern's draft" of a building report. Teams sort them into two piles, *sound* and *dangling*. Five dangle (1, 3, 5, 7, 8). The fixed phrase (*Having said that*) and the absolute (*The funding approved*) are sound: learners who "fix" them are over-correcting, which is worth a quick word at feedback. Each team repairs two danglers aloud, one each way.
- ◆ **Round 2 — Condense (12 min).** Three report cards (the library Wi-Fi upgrade, the Route 12 night-bus pilot, the clinic's text-alert trial), each about 125 words and deliberately over-connected with *and*, *because*, *when*, *after*, *which*. Target: **90 words or fewer**, every fact kept, at least **four participle or absolute constructions** (one must be an absolute) and **one fixed phrase**. Model condensed versions are in the answer key.
- ◆ **Round 3 — Peer review (5 min).** Teams swap drafts with a team that had a different report. On the review card: **Praise** (one construction that works well) · **Question** (one "who is doing this?" query) · **Polish** (one suggestion) · **Danglers found:** 0 / 1 / 2. Drafts go back; writers decide whether to accept the polish.
- ◆ **Judgment, not maximization.** Remind teams of the online lesson's advice: if a sentence feels airless after three participles, restore one conjunction. A clear 92-word draft beats a cryptic 70-word one.
- ◆ **Dominant speakers** make good checkers: they may only ask questions ("Who is doing the *examining*?"), never dictate wording. Quieter learners often make excellent scribes; give them the pen and the authority to write only agreed wording.

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE WORKSHOP

SAY: Round 1: How many strips dangle? (Five.) Is *Having said that* a dangler? (No, it's a fixed phrase.) · Round 2: Maximum words? (Ninety.) Can you delete a fact? (No!) How many constructions? (At least four, one absolute, plus one fixed phrase.) Who holds the pen? (The scribe.) · Round 3: How many comments do you write? (Three: praise, question, polish.) Do you rewrite their report? (No, you comment on the card.)

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Some C1 learners speak far more fluently than they read and write. Give a strip with the three voice boxes and color-code them (-ing blue, *having* green, p.p. orange); learners underline the participle in each Script 5.1-A chunk in its color. In the Dangler Hunt, read each strip aloud for the team. In Round 2, the learner takes the first two sentences of the report card only and compresses them orally before the scribe writes. Target: 3 constructions, spoken and then copied; Workbook Ex 2 items 1–4 only.

STRETCH (TOWARD C2)

Add **with-absolutes** (*With the deadline approaching, the team worked late*), literary absolutes without a participle (*He entered, hat in hand*), and participles after conjunctions (*Once completed, the form should be returned; If left untreated, ...*). Discuss the accepted exceptions: *considering, given, assuming, judging by, speaking of* are dangling in form but standard. In the workshop, challenge strong teams to 75 words with no loss of clarity, then to rewrite one sentence in a lighter register for a staff newsletter.

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **Dangling participles:** speakers of topic-prominent languages (Chinese, Japanese, Korean, Vietnamese) often let the opening phrase set a topic rather than share a subject ("Walking home, the rain started" mirrors "As for walking home, rain started"). Make the one-question test a routine.
- ◆ **Positive transfer, different word order:** Spanish, Portuguese and Italian have absolutes (*Terminada la reunión, salimos; Finita la riunione, ...*), so the idea is familiar, but learners may keep the L1 order: "Finished the meeting, we left." English puts the subject first: **The meeting finished / over, ...**
- ◆ **-ing for passive meaning:** "Building in 1920, the museum..." is common across L1s, especially where one participle form covers both voices (German speakers sometimes mix *-end / ge-...-t* equivalents; Arabic and Turkish speakers transfer active verbal nouns). Point at the voice boxes.
- ◆ **Overusing *having* + p.p.:** Russian, Ukrainian and Polish have perfective adverbial participles (*проучмав*), and French has *ayant fini*, so learners may put *having* everywhere, even for simultaneous actions ("Having walked home, I met a friend"). Ask: "Did the walking finish first?"
- ◆ **French *en* + *gérondif*:** "By walking home, I met a friend" (from *en rentrant*) confuses manner with time. *By -ing* = method; a bare participle = time or reason.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 5.1: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-c1/lesson_13.html. Listen to the model sentences with 🎧 and read them back with the rise–pause–fall; do Exercises 1–3 and the Quick Quiz; complete the "Compress and Polish" project with any choppy paragraph (a news item, a process, or a scene they invent). Workbook 5.1: finish the Condense the Report reflection (which construction did your team use best, and which sentence did you leave uncompressed, and why?), "My new words" and the journal (the online lesson's "write a dangler on purpose, then fix it" task).

◆ CHECK — SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **B** Rushing to the station, the train had already left. (dangles) · Q2 **A** The road blocked, the drivers turned back. · Q3 (new) **C** Damaged in transit, the parcel was returned to the sender. The chair's announcement (Ex 1):
1 Having reviewed · 2 the gymnasium being unavailable · 3 wishing to run · 4 printed for the fair · 5 The schedule being unusually full · 6 Weather permitting · 7 All things considered · 8 Having said that.

◆ OBJECTIVES – LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ use the fixed preposition after key **verbs** (*comply with, refrain from, account for, resort to, result in / from, object to, consist of*) and **adjectives** (*aware of, subject to, prone to, consistent with, reliant on, conducive to*)
- ◆ use the preposition an **abstract noun** requires (*an increase in, a solution to, an alternative to, insight into, an impact on*), and notice when it differs from the verb's
- ◆ distinguish **in** (the area that changed) from **of** (the size of the change): *an increase in unemployment of 3%*
- ◆ avoid intrusive prepositions after transitive verbs (*discuss, enter, contact, emphasize*)
- ◆ use **fixed formal phrases** (*with regard to, in light of, by virtue of, in the event of, on behalf of, in accordance with, in the wake of*) in formal writing, and plain equivalents in conversation
- ◆ correct a formal email and write a short formal reply with accurate prepositions

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 5.2 (Key chunks, Grammar box, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, Correction Challenge frame)
- ◆ Slides 10–14 · Preposition chunk cards and fixed-phrase cards (Set A) · **Riverside College parking email + score sheet + reply cards A / B** (Set C)
- ◆ Listening scripts 5.2-A (voicemail from Human Resources) and 5.2-B (dictation)

BOARD PLAN

Left: three "families" in columns. **of:** aware · capable · devoid · indicative · a lack · **with:** comply · consistent · compatible · familiar · **to:** subject · prone · conducive · an alternative · a solution · object · resort. Beneath: **on:** depend · reliant · an impact · **from:** refrain · benefit · result (be caused by) · **in:** result (cause) · an increase · insight *into*.

Center: "verb → noun: the preposition can switch." *increase sth → an increase in sth · solve sth → a solution to sth · demand sth → a demand for sth*. Then: an increase **in** crime (area) **of** 5% (figure). And a big **X** over "discuss ~~about~~ · enter ~~into~~ the room · contact ~~with~~ him."

Right: a register ladder: **with regard to** → *about* · **in the event of** → *if* · **in the wake of** → *after* · **by virtue of** → *because of* · **in light of** → *considering*. Label the top "report / formal email" and the bottom "conversation / text."

Far right: Fix · Upgrade · Fit columns for feedback.

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: compress it	8	S-S → T-S	Review C14. Four baggy sentences on the board (one needs an absolute, one a past participle, one <i>having</i> , one a fixed phrase). Pairs compress them in 3 minutes, then run the one-question test on a partner pair's answers. Two teams read their best condensed report sentence from C14.
Lead-in: which sounds wrong?	5	T-S	Slide 10. Six quick pairs; learners vote by holding up one or two fingers: <i>comply to / comply with</i> · <i>aware about / aware of</i> · <i>discuss about the plan / discuss the plan</i> · <i>an increase of crime / an increase in crime</i> · <i>depend of / depend on</i> · <i>married with / married to</i> . Ask: "Could you have worked these out by logic?" (No: they're chunks.) "Do these errors stop communication?" (Rarely, which is why they survive for years.)
Verb & adjective + preposition	12	T-S → S-S	Slide 10. Present in families (board left), not as a list. Meaning checks for the less obvious ones (<i>account for</i> , <i>resort to</i> , <i>subject to</i> , <i>conducive to</i> , <i>devoid of</i>). Same verb, different preposition, different meaning: <i>result in / from</i> ; <i>agree with / to / on</i> . Pairs test each other with the

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			chunk cards: one shows the word, the other says the chunk in a sentence.
Nouns, in vs of, no preposition	8	T-S	Slide 11. The verb → noun switch (board center). <i>in</i> for the area vs <i>of</i> for the figure. Transitive verbs with no preposition. CCQs (below).
Fixed formal phrases	8	T-S	Slide 12. The phrases, their meanings and the register ladder. Focus on the trio in the brief: <i>in light of</i> (considering new information), <i>with regard to</i> (about), <i>by virtue of</i> (because of a quality or status). Then the comic mismatch: "In the event of you being hungry, we could eat." Model dialogue on slide 13, in pairs, once each way.
Drill	5	T-S → S	Chunk drill, family drill, and register flip (see Drill script). Keep the pace high.
Listening: HR voicemail	5	T-S → S-S	Workbook Ex 1. Hold a phone to your ear and read Script 5.2-A twice. Learners write the eight chunks. Pairs compare. Ask: "Is the caller speaking for herself?" (No, on behalf of the training team.)
Controlled practice	8	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 2-4 alone, then check in pairs. Board-check Ex 4 (<i>in</i> or <i>of</i>), which carries the subtlest

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Workshop: Formal Email Correction Challenge	21	S-S (teams of 3) → S-S (teams swap)	distinction. Ex 5 (correct the clinic email) is homework or for early finishers.
			Slide 14. (1) Correct (8 min): each team gets the Riverside College parking email. It contains 12 preposition errors and 5 correct chunks that look suspicious . Teams mark corrections on the score sheet: +1 for each correct fix, -1 for "fixing" something that was already correct. Reveal and score together (2 min, included). (2) Reply (8 min): each team takes reply card A (the student representative, writing on behalf of evening students) or B (the Facilities Office, replying to a complaint) and writes an 80–100-word reply with at least four dependent prepositions and two fixed phrases. (3) Preposition-only proofread (3 min): teams swap replies and read <i>only</i> for prepositions, circling any chunk they doubt; Praise · Question · Polish on the card. ICQs first.
Feedback	5	T-S	Fix · Upgrade · Fit: Fix: "We will discuss about the options." · "an increase of the number of students" · Upgrade: "because of her seniority" → "by virtue of

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			her seniority" (in a formal notice) · Fit: "With regard to Saturday, are you free?" in a text to a friend (→ "About Saturday..."). Announce the top-scoring team and read the best reply aloud (with permission).
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Online lesson 5.2; workbook Ex 5, the "preposition chunk list" and the journal.
Total	90		8 + 5 + 12 + 8 + 8 + 5 + 5 + 8 + 21 + 5 + 5

IF YOU RUN LONG

Shorten the verb and adjective stage by giving the families as a handout and checking only the tricky meanings. Move Workbook Ex 3 to homework. Never cut the Correction Challenge scoring: the -1 for over-correcting is what teaches learners to trust a correct chunk as much as they doubt a wrong one. If time is very short, teams write the reply as homework and proofread in the C16 warmer.

◆ MEANING · FORM · PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: "dependent" = chosen by the word in front, not by logic.

SAY: "All contractors must comply with the regulations." What does comply mean? (Obey, follow.) Could we say "comply to"? (No. But conform to takes to: you can't reason it out.) · "Prices are subject to change." Will prices definitely change? (No, they may: it's a condition.)

SAY: "How do you account for the delay?" Am I asking for a number? (No, an explanation.) · "Young people account for 40% of users." Here? (A proportion: they make up 40%.) · "They resorted to legal action." Was it their first choice? (No, a last option.)

SAY: "Poor planning resulted in the loss." Cause or effect first? (Cause: planning → loss.) · "The loss resulted from poor planning." (Effect first.) Same facts? (Yes, opposite direction.) · "I agree with you." (a person / opinion) · "I agree to the proposal." (accept it) · "We agreed on a date." (reached a decision together)

Meaning: nouns, and in vs of.

SAY: "We need to increase funding." Preposition after increase? (None.) "There's been an increase ____ funding." (in.) "an increase in funding of 12%." What does it tell us? (The size.) · "We solved the problem" → "We found a solution ____ the problem." (to.) Is it of? (No.)

SAY: "Let's discuss about the budget." Correct? (No: discuss takes a direct object.) Other verbs like this? (enter the room, contact him, emphasize the point, approach the building, reach an agreement.) But the noun? (a discussion **about** / **of** the budget: the noun can take a preposition.)

Meaning: fixed formal phrases.

SAY: "In light of the new figures, we'll revise the plan." Did something new happen? (Yes, new information.) Plain version? (Considering / Because of the new figures.) · "She chairs the committee by virtue of her seniority." Why does she chair it? (Because she is the most senior.) Is by virtue of about being virtuous? (No! It means "because of a quality or position.") · "With regard to your inquiry..." Where would you see this? (A formal email or letter.) To a friend? (About your question...)

Form.

Verb + prep	depend on · comply with · account for · refrain from · resort to · result in / from · consist of · contribute to · object to · benefit from	Please refrain from using your phone.
Adjective + prep	aware / capable / devoid / indicative of · consistent / compatible with · subject / prone / conducive to · reliant on	The region is reliant on tourism.
Noun + prep	an increase / rise / decline in · a reason / demand / need for · an alternative / a solution to · insight into · an impact / effect on · a lack of · a relationship between	a cheaper alternative to flying
Prep + -ing	a preposition is followed by -ing , not <i>to</i>	capable of managing · object to paying · refrain from smoking
No preposition	transitive verbs: discuss, enter, contact, emphasize, approach, reach, marry	We discussed the plan. · She married a doctor. (but: <i>married to</i>)
Fixed formal phrases	with regard to · in light of · by virtue of · in the event of · on behalf of · in accordance with · in the wake of · for the sake of · in terms of · at the expense of · with a view to + -ing	In the event of fire, use the stairs.

Pronunciation. Dependent prepositions are almost always **weak** and linked to the word before: *aware of* /ə'weɪvən/, *comply with* /kəm'plaɪwɪð/, *consist of* /kən'sɪstəv/, *depend on* /dɪ'pendən/. Because they are

unstressed, learners mishear them. Drill them as one word. In fixed phrases the stress falls on the content noun: "with **regard** to," "in **light** of," "by **virtue** of," "on **behalf** of," "in the **event** of," "in **accordance** with." Exception: prepositions become strong at the end of a clause or in contrast: "It's not what you comply **to**, it's what you comply **with**."

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 **Chunk drill** (hold up a chunk card showing the word only): *comply* → S: "comply with" · *aware* → "aware of" · *subject* → "subject to" · *an increase* → "an increase in" · *refrain* → "refrain from" · *insight* → "insight into." Choral, then fast individuals. Then learners add a short object: "comply with the rules."
- 2 **Family drill**: T: "of!" → learners call out as many *of*-adjectives as they can in 10 seconds (*aware, capable, devoid, indicative, conscious*). Then *with, to, on*.
- 3 **Verb → noun**: T: "increase prices" → S: "an increase in prices" · T: "solve the problem" → "a solution to the problem" · T: "demand housing" → "a demand for housing" · T: "affect health" → "an effect on health."
- 4 **Register flip**: T (formal): "In the event of rain..." → S (plain): "If it rains..." · T (plain): "After the decision, he resigned." → S (formal): "In the wake of the decision, he resigned." · T: "about your inquiry" → "with regard to your inquiry."
- 5 **Weak forms**: choral /ə'wɛərən/ "aware of it" ×3, "comply with the law" ×3, "consists of three parts" ×3, fast, linked.

◆ FORMAL EMAIL CORRECTION CHALLENGE – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ **Teams of 3**, new roles: scribe, checker, timekeeper. Each team gets one copy of the **Riverside College** email about resurfacing the north parking lot (about 190 words, from the Facilities Coordinator to evening students) and one score sheet.
- ◆ **Round 1 – Correct (8 min)**. The email contains **12 preposition errors**: wrong preposition, missing preposition, intrusive preposition, *to* instead of *from* + *-ing*, and a mangled fixed phrase. It also contains **5 decoys**: correct chunks that often look wrong to learners (*result in, reliant on, of about 120 spaces, In the event of further delays, agreed to the shuttle proposal*). Teams underline each change and write the correction on the score sheet. +1 for each correct fix; -1 for changing a correct chunk. Teams may "bank" a doubtful item by writing "?" (0 points) instead of guessing.
- ◆ **Reveal (included)**. Go through the email line by line on the slide or board. Let teams argue their case: "We think *of about 120 spaces* is wrong" → "Why is *of* right here?" (It's the size of the change.) Highest score wins; ties go to the team with fewer -1s.
- ◆ **Round 2 – Reply (8 min)**. Reply card A: you are the elected student representative, writing *on behalf of* evening students; ask for more frequent shuttles and better lighting at Oak Street. Reply card B: you are the Facilities Office, replying to a student who complained that they were not warned in time. Both: 80–100 words, at least **four dependent prepositions** and **two fixed formal phrases**, formal but human.

- ◆ **Round 3 — Preposition-only proofread (3 min).** Teams swap replies and read only for prepositions: circle every preposition attached to a pattern word and ask, "Is this the chunk?" Then Praise · Question · Polish on the review card.
- ◆ **Dominant speakers** are good **checkers** in Round 1 (they must justify every change by naming the chunk), but in Round 2 they may not write: the scribe writes. Quieter learners can take Reply card A, which has a phrase bank.

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE CHALLENGE

SAY: *How many errors are there? (Twelve.) Are there correct chunks that look wrong? (Yes, five.) What happens if you change a correct one? (Minus one point.) Not sure? (Write a question mark: zero points.) · Reply: how many words? (80 to 100.) How many fixed phrases? (At least two.) · Proofread: what do you read for? (Only prepositions.)*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Give the email with each line numbered and a hint in the margin for lines with an error ("1 error here"). Pre-teach the three families with a one-page chunk card the learner can keep (of / with / to / on / from / in). In Round 2, provide a reply frame with gaps: "On ____ of the evening students, I am writing with ____ to...". Target: find 6 of the 12 errors; in writing, Workbook Ex 2 and Ex 3 only.

STRETCH (TOWARD C2)

Introduce **preposition fronting in formal relative clauses** (*the policy in accordance with which the decision was made · the committee on whose behalf I write*) and fine distinctions: *in light of* (new information) vs *in view of* (a fact to consider) vs *given; regarding / as regards / with regard to* (all correct) vs the common "*with regards to*" (avoid in formal writing); *consist of* vs *consist in*. Early finishers edit the reply to cut one fixed phrase that is only decoration.

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **Direct translation of the L1 preposition:** Spanish and Portuguese *depende de* → "depend of"; *casado con / casado com* → "married with"; *consistir en* → "consist in" (for "consist of"). French *se conformer à* → "comply to"; *discuter de* → "discuss about". German *abhängig von* → "dependent from"; *interessiert an* → "interested on". Ask learners to write their own three "L1 traps" at the top of the chunk list.
- ◆ **"an increase of":** Russian (*рост цен*), Polish, Arabic (*ziyādat al-...*) and Chinese learners use a genitive structure, so "an increase of prices / of crime" feels natural. Use the "area vs figure" test every time.
- ◆ **Intrusive or missing prepositions:** Chinese, Japanese and Korean speakers (postpositions or none) may drop the preposition ("aware the risk," "comply the rules") or add *about* after *discuss, mention, explain*. Arabic speakers often add prepositions to transitive verbs ("enter to the room").

- ◆ **to + infinitive after a preposition:** "capable to do," "refrain to park," "object to pay." Most L1s use an infinitive here. Rule: after a preposition, **-ing**. The *to* in *object to* / *look forward to* / *be committed to* is a preposition, not an infinitive marker.
- ◆ **"in the light of" / "with regards to":** learners from British-English schooling write *in the light of* (correct British; *in light of* is the American norm). *With regards to* is heard everywhere but marked in formal writing; teach *with regard to* or *regarding*.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 5.2: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-c1/lesson_14.html. Listen to the model sentences with  and say them back, linking the weak prepositions; do Exercises 1–3 and the Quick Quiz. For the online "Preposition-Perfect Message" project, learners may reuse their team's reply from class and extend it to 120–160 words. Workbook 5.2: Exercise 5 (correct the clinic email) if not finished, "My new words" (start the running **preposition chunk list**: ten chunks, five known and five new) and the journal.

◆ CHECK – SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **C** All staff must comply with the dress code. · Q2 **C** in · Q3 (new) **A** In light of the new figures, the board will revise its forecast. HR voicemail (Ex 1): 1 on behalf of · 2 With regard to · 3 In light of · 4 comply with · 5 refrain from · 6 In the event of · 7 consists of · 8 increase in.

◆ OBJECTIVES – LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ replace everyday words with **academic equivalents** that fit the exact sense (*get* → *obtain*, *show* → *demonstrate*, *big* → *substantial* / *significant*, *about* → *approximately* / *regarding*)
- ◆ move an idea across an **Academic Word List family** (*analyze* / *analysis* / *analytical*; *significant* / *significance* / *significantly*; *evident* / *evidence* / *evidently*)
- ◆ report a source at the right strength with **stance verbs** (*suggest*, *indicate*, *argue*, *demonstrate*, *acknowledge*) and keep the source's hedges
- ◆ prefer a precise single verb over a phrasal verb in writing (*find out* → *determine*, *go up* → *increase*) without purging every phrasal verb
- ◆ recognize **over-formalization** (*utilize*, *commence*, *endeavor* in the wrong place) as an error of register
- ◆ summarize a research abstract in academic register, and explain the same study plainly to a friend

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 5.3 (Key words, Vocabulary box, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, Abstract to Summary frame, "look back at my goal")
- ◆ Slides 15–18 · Academic word cards (Set A) · **Research abstracts** 1 and 2 + A / B "explain it to a friend" cards + summary peer-review cards (Set D) · **The Editor's Path** board (Set E) + dice / coins + counters
- ◆ Listening scripts 5.3-A (a casual radio item about the study) and 5.3-B (dictation)

BOARD PLAN

Left: two columns, **everyday** → **academic**: *get* → *obtain* · *show* → *demonstrate* · *big* → *substantial* (size) / *significant* (importance) · *look at* → *examine* · *enough* → *sufficient* · *about* → *approximately* (number) / *regarding* (topic) · *get worse* → *deteriorate* · *find out* → *determine* · *go up* → *increase*.

Center: a **stance thermometer**, bottom to top: *note* / *observe* (neutral) · *suggest* / *indicate* / *imply* (tentative) · *argue* / *claim* / *contend* (a position) · *demonstrate* / *show* (treated as proven). Beside it: *acknowledge* / *concede* (admits a limitation). A dashed line labeled "don't claim more than the evidence."

Right: the **use / utilize test**: "Does the long word add meaning or only length?" **sharper** ✓ vs **just formal** ✗. Beneath: ✗ *I shall endeavor to commence...* (to a friend).

Far right: **Fix** · **Upgrade** · **Fit** columns for feedback.

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: The Editor's Path	8	S-S (groups of 3-4)	Groups play The Editor's Path (Set E) for 7 minutes: squares ask them to compress a clause, fix a dangler, supply a preposition or flip register. Answers are on the back of the board. One minute: each group reports the square that caused the longest argument.
Lead-in: same meaning, different world	5	T-S	Slide 15. Show "We got a lot of data, then we looked at it and found something big." Ask: "Grammatically wrong?" (No.) "Where would it be wrong?" (In an essay or report.) Pairs upgrade it in 60 seconds. Compare with "We obtained substantial data, examined it, and identified a significant finding." Ask: "Did the grammar change?" (Hardly: the words did.)
Everyday → academic	10	T-S → S-S	Slide 15. The table on the board (left), with the sense-fit warning : <i>substantial vs significant, approximately vs regarding; significant</i> also has a statistical meaning. Then phrasal vs single verb (<i>look into → investigate, set up → establish, cut down on → reduce</i>), with the caveat that <i>find out</i> often beats <i>ascertain</i> . CCQs (below).
AWL word families	7	T-S → S-S	Slide 15. What the Academic Word List is (a research-based list of word families common across all academic subjects). Show one family moving through a sentence: <i>The result is significant. / the significance of the result / Results improved significantly</i> . Pairs complete Workbook Ex 3 (the family table) together as the practice.
Stance verbs & hedging	8	T-S	Slide 16. The stance thermometer. Misrepresenting a source is an accuracy error, not a style choice: "The data prove..." when the authors wrote

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			"suggest." Model dialogue on slide 16 (casual) → the report version, and the over-formal text to a friend. CCQs.
Drill	4	T-S → S	Register ladder up and down, and the family drill (see Drill script).
Listening: the radio item	4	T-S → S	Workbook Ex 1. Read Script 5.3-A twice in a relaxed radio voice. Learners note six casual expressions and give an academic equivalent for each. This is the study they will summarize, heard first in casual English.
Controlled practice	8	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 2, 4 and 5 alone (replace the informal word · choose the stance verb · sharper or just formal?), then check in pairs. Board-check Ex 4 (stance strength).
Workshop: Abstract to Summary	26	S → S-S → S-S (teams of 3)	Slide 17. (1) Read & annotate (5 min, alone): Abstract 1 (walking breaks and afternoon concentration; Abstract 2, a reusable-cup scheme, for fast teams). Underline AWL words; box every hedge and stance verb; circle the one result that was <i>not</i> significant. (2) Explain it to a friend (4 min, pairs): A explains the study in plain, friendly English (card A: no academic words allowed); B asks two questions from card B. Swap halfway. (3) Write (10 min, teams of 3): a 70–90-word summary for the "Research Roundup" in a staff newsletter: at least six academic items, two stance verbs at the right strength, one word-family shift, no claim stronger than the abstract's . (4) Peer review (5 min): swap with another team; review card: Praise · Question · Polish + "Does the summary claim more than the abstract?" + label two word choices <i>sharper</i> or <i>just formal</i> . (5) Share (2 min): two teams read their first sentence aloud.

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Feedback & module wrap-up	5	T-S	Fix • Upgrade • Fit: Fix: "The study proves that walking improves accuracy" (it wasn't significant) • "a significant big group" • Upgrade: "The results show..." → "The results indicate..." • Fit: "utilize walking breaks" → "use / take walking breaks." Then the recap on slide 18 (see Closing the Module).
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Online lesson 5.3; workbook "look back at my goal"; the journal.
Total	90		8 + 5 + 10 + 7 + 8 + 4 + 4 + 8 + 26 + 5 + 5

IF YOU RUN LONG

Shorten the warmer to 5 minutes (stop the game wherever it is). Set Workbook Ex 5 as homework. In the workshop, the "explain it to a friend" step can drop to 2 minutes, but keep it: saying the study plainly first is what stops learners copying the abstract's sentences word for word. Never cut the "does it claim more than the abstract?" check: faithful reporting is the core of Module 6.

◆ MEANING • FORM • PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: the formal word must fit the exact sense.

SAY: "a substantial increase" vs "a significant discovery." Which one is about size or amount? (substantial.) Which is about importance? (significant.) In a research report, "a significant difference" can mean what else? (Statistically significant: unlikely to be chance.) • "approximately 40%" vs "concerns regarding privacy." Can we say "concerns approximately privacy"? (No: approximately is only for numbers.)

SAY: "The researchers obtained the samples." Did they buy them, take them, or receive them? (We don't know: obtain is neutral and formal.) • "Conditions deteriorated." Better or worse? (Worse.) Plain English? (got worse.)

Meaning: stance verbs have strength.

SAY: "The data suggest a link." Is the link proven? (No, possible.) • "The trial demonstrates that the drug works." Stronger or weaker? (Much stronger: treated as proven.) • "Critics maintain the model is flawed." Does everyone agree? (No; they hold the position firmly, maybe stubbornly.) • "She concedes that the sample was small." Is she admitting a weakness? (Yes.)

SAY: The abstract says "may constitute a low-cost means." A student writes "proves that walking breaks are effective." Is that a style problem or an accuracy problem? (Accuracy: it misrepresents the source.)

Meaning: don't over-formalize.

SAY: A text to a friend: "I shall endeavor to commence my journey imminently." Is it grammatically wrong? (No.) What's wrong? (The register: absurdly stiff.) Better? (I'll leave soon.) · Does utilize add meaning to use? (Almost never.) Does demonstrate add meaning to show in a report? (Sometimes: it implies proof.)

Form.

Everyday → academic	get → obtain / acquire · show → demonstrate / illustrate · big → substantial / significant · look at → examine · enough → sufficient · start → commence / initiate · a lot of → considerable / numerous · help → facilitate · get worse → deteriorate	There was insufficient evidence to draw a conclusion.
Phrasal → single	find out → determine · look into → investigate · go up / down → increase / decrease · put off → postpone · set up → establish · cut down on → reduce · get rid of → eliminate · make up → constitute / comprise	The charity was established in 1990.
AWL families	analyze · analysis · analyst · analytical(ly) — significant · significance · significantly · signify — evident · evidence · evidently — establish · established · establishment — derive · derivation · derivative — constitute · constituent · consequent · consequence · consequently	A detailed analysis revealed three patterns.
Stance verbs + that	note / observe · suggest / indicate / imply · argue / claim / contend / maintain · highlight / emphasize · demonstrate / show · acknowledge / concede	The authors acknowledge that the sample was small.
Grammar notes	<i>data</i> : plural in formal writing (<i>the data suggest</i>), singular widely accepted · <i>suggest that</i> + clause, not "suggest to" · <i>emphasize</i> with no preposition (the noun: <i>emphasis on</i>)	The data indicate a modest effect.

Pronunciation. Academic words shift stress across the family, and learners who know the word in writing often stress it wrongly: *analyze* → *analysis* → *analytical*; *establish*; *significant*; *evident* → *evidence*; *constitute* → *constituent*; *deteriorate* (5 syllables, not "deteriorate"); *approximately*. The noun and verb *increase* differ: an *increase* / to *increase*. Model with backchaining.

- 1 **Register ladder up:** T: "get funding" → S: "obtain funding" · "look at the causes" → "examine the causes" · "a big rise" → "a substantial rise" · "about 200 people" → "approximately 200 people" · "find out the cause" → "determine the cause." Choral, then individuals.
- 2 **Register ladder down** (to a friend): T: "I shall commence" → S: "I'll start" · "utilize" → "use" · "endeavor to" → "try to" · "prior to" → "before" · "subsequently" → "then / later."
- 3 **Family drill** (stress!): T: "analyze · noun" → S: "analysis" · "· adjective" → "analytical" · T: "significant · noun" → "significance" · "· adverb" → "significantly" · T: "evident · noun" → "evidence."
- 4 **Thermometer:** T says a claim and points to a level; learners report it: T: "walking helps concentration · tentative" → S: "The study suggests that walking helps concentration." · "· proven" → "The study demonstrates that..." · "· admits a limit" → "The authors acknowledge that..."

◆ ABSTRACT TO SUMMARY – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ **Abstract 1** (about 145 words): "Short Walking Breaks and Afternoon Concentration in Office Workers: A Pilot Study." 62 employees at two municipal offices, four weeks, three five-minute walking breaks each afternoon; self-reported concentration about 18% higher than the control group; error rate on a data-entry task declined modestly but **not significantly**; the authors hedge ("may constitute") and acknowledge limitations. **Abstract 2** (for fast teams): a reusable-cup deposit scheme in three university cafés, with a large fall in disposable cups but a small, uncertain effect on overall waste.
- ◆ **Step 1, alone:** learners annotate. The key trap is the non-significant accuracy result: a faithful summary must not say accuracy "improved" without qualification.
- ◆ **Step 2, pairs:** card A: "Explain the study to a friend over coffee. No word from the Academic Word List allowed!" Card B: "You're the friend. Ask two questions, e.g. 'So does it actually work?' 'How many people were in it?'" Swap. This makes the register contrast physical before anyone writes.
- ◆ **Step 3, teams:** 70–90 words for the staff newsletter's "Research Roundup." Requirements on the frame: six academic items (words or phrases), two stance verbs (one must be *suggest / indicate* or *acknowledge*), one word-family shift (e.g. *significant* → *significance*), and no claim stronger than the abstract's. Sentence starters are on the frame for teams that want them.
- ◆ **Step 4, peer review:** the review card asks: Praise · Question · Polish; **Faithful?** (Does it claim more or less than the abstract? Underline any over-claim.); **Sharper or just formal?** (label two word choices). The model summary in the answer key is for you, not a target to copy.
- ◆ **Dominant speakers** take the **fidelity checker** role: they compare the draft with the abstract sentence by sentence and may only point, not rewrite. In Step 2, pair a dominant speaker with a confident partner and ask B to hold them to the "no academic words" rule.

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE WORKSHOP

SAY: *Step 1: What do you circle? (The result that was not significant.) · Step 2: Can A use words like substantial or demonstrate? (No, plain English only.) · Step 3: How many words? (70 to 90.) How many*

stance verbs? (Two.) Can you say the study proves something? (Only if the abstract does, and it doesn't.)

· Step 4: What's the extra question on the review card? (Does the summary claim more than the abstract?)

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Read Abstract 1 aloud to the learner (or play it from your phone's text-to-speech) while they follow; give a glossed copy with six AWL words defined in the margin. In Step 3, the learner uses the summary frame with sentence starters ("A recent pilot study examined... · Participants who... reported approximately... · However, ... did not reach... · The authors acknowledge that..."). Target: 4 academic items and 1 stance verb; Workbook Ex 2 items 1–5 only.

STRETCH (TOWARD C2)

Calibrate hedges precisely: *may, appears to, tends to, is likely to, there is some evidence that*, and spot **over-hedging** ("It may possibly perhaps suggest..."). Use academic **collocations**, not just words: *conduct a study, draw a conclusion, a robust finding, a modest effect, warrant further research*. Write a second, 25-word version as a tweet-length "plain-language summary," and discuss what is lost. Early finishers compare Abstracts 1 and 2 in one sentence with *whereas*.

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **Latinate false friends:** Spanish, Portuguese, French and Italian speakers have a head start with academic vocabulary but meet false friends: *actual* (≠ current: *actual* = real), *eventual(ly)* (≠ possible: = in the end), *assist* (≠ attend: French *assister à*, Spanish *asistir a*), *realize* (≠ carry out: Spanish *realizar un estudio* → *conduct a study*), *sensible* (≠ sensitive). Flag these in the vocabulary box.
- ◆ **Over-formalizing everything:** learners from school systems that reward elaborate written style (many Arabic, Persian, Spanish-speaking and South Asian contexts) may see *utilize, commence* as "better English." Use the use / utilize test and praise plain precision.
- ◆ **Over-claiming:** in some academic traditions strong assertion signals confidence, and learners from Chinese, Russian or Arabic academic writing may write "proves" or "it is clear that." Frame hedging as honesty about evidence, not weakness.
- ◆ **Stress on AWL words:** speakers of syllable-timed languages (Spanish, French, Italian, Turkish) and many Asian languages give equal weight to each syllable ("a-na-ly-sis"); French speakers often stress the final syllable ("analysis"). Drill the stress shift in each family.
- ◆ **"The data is / are":** learners may have been taught either. Accept both; in formal science writing prefer *the data suggest*.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 5.3: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-c1/lesson_15.html. Listen to the model sentences with 🎧 and say them back, watching the stress in *analysis*, *significant*, *approximately*; do Exercises 1–3 and the Quick Quiz. For the online "From Chat to Report" project, learners can use the class study, a news item, or something a colleague concluded (no personal health topics needed). Workbook 5.3: "My new words" (fifteen everyday → academic pairs, each marked *sharper* or *just formal*), the journal, and "Module 5: look back at my goal."

◆ CHECK – SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 A The results demonstrate that the plan was largely ineffective. · Q2 B I'll head off in about ten minutes. · Q3 (new) B The findings suggest that brief walking breaks may improve concentration. Radio item (Ex 1), any six: looked at → examined / studied · about → approximately · found out → found / determined · a lot more → considerably / substantially more · went down a bit → decreased / declined slightly · not enough to really prove anything → not statistically significant · kind of shows → suggests / indicates · do a bigger study → conduct a larger study.

CLOSING THE MODULE

END OF C16: MODULE 5 WRAP-UP

Recap on slide 18, "compress, connect, choose": **Having reviewed the figures, the board...** · **The meeting over,** ... (compress, and keep the subject anchored) → **comply with** · **an increase in** · **in light of** · **by virtue of** (connect with the exact preposition) → **obtain** · **demonstrate** · **the data suggest** (choose the precise word and the honest strength, and don't over-formalize). Learners tick the three "I can..." lists in the workbook. Anything still unticked goes on a sticky note for you. Review it in the C17 warmer.

Check the C14 goals. At the end of C16, invite learners to read their Progress Test goal again (the "Look back at my goal" box in Workbook 5.3): "Did you practice it? What will you do next?" This is private: no one reports to the class.

Watch for in Module 6: critical reading (6.1) turns today's stance verbs outward: learners will notice when a writer's *demonstrates* is stronger than the evidence. Essay writing (6.2) and professional writing (6.3) need all three skills at once: a condensed, anchored sentence, the right preposition in *with regard to your application*, and a register that suits the reader. Keep the **Fix** · **Upgrade** · **Fit** columns: they become the marking categories for Module 6 writing. Learners who have just discovered formal vocabulary may over-formalize their C17–C19 writing; praise precision, and keep asking "sharper, or just formal?"

Module 6 — Reading & Writing at C1

Three skills workshops rather than three grammar lessons. First, a **critical-reading lab**: two short, invented opinion columns on the same workplace decision, taken apart for claims, evidence, bias and fallacies (with a fallacy card sort and a structured seminar). Then an **essay-structuring workshop**: thesis, paragraph architecture, counter-argument and rebuttal, conclusion, moving from outline to draft to **structured peer review**. Last, a **professional-writing lab**: the email, the report with headings and the cover letter, all tied to one invented workplace and written for real or fictional job-seeker profiles.

3 lessons

Lessons 6.1–6.3

Classes C17–C19

Weeks 9–10

90 min per class

CEFR C1

HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

- One lesson block = one 90-minute class. The shape is the kit's usual one (**warmer** → **lead-in** → **clarify** with CCQs → **drill** → **controlled practice** → **freer task** → **feedback** → **homework**), but in this module the "language" being clarified is mostly **moves** (claim, warrant, concession, rebuttal, purpose-first) and **genre conventions**, and the freer task is a real reading or writing product. Treat each class as a **workshop**: you model, learners try, peers test, learners revise.
- The **stage plan** is your clock and adds up to 90 minutes. Writing stages are the ones that overrun. Protect them by cutting the controlled practice first (every exercise that is cut is listed as homework).
- Present from `slides/module-6-reading-writing.html`. Print `materials/module-6/classroom-materials.html` before C17. It holds the flashcards, the professional profile cards, the seminar role cards and the pilot fact sheet, the fallacy card sort, the essay question cards with assigned sides, the peer-review sheet, the writing-lab pack (report data card, job postings, reader cards), **Fallacy Bingo** and the listening scripts.
- The online lessons are the learners' **homework and review**. Each one has  Listen buttons for the five model sentences; the lesson projects (a critical evaluation, an essay plan, one real professional text) extend the class products.
- **Refinement, not first contact.** At B2 learners met opinion essays, formal emails and linking words (B2 Module 4 and 7). Don't re-teach paragraphs or "Dear Sir/Madam." Spend the time on what is new at C1: the **warrant**, the difference between a strong *case* and a well-made *argument*, the fair **concede** → **rebut**, the purpose-first **reader-focus** of professional writing, and **register control** across genres. Recycle the course's own grammar deliberately: nominalization and academic style (3.1), cohesion (3.2), hedging (3.3), the subjunctive after *recommend* (1.3), academic vocabulary (5.3).

- ◆ **Feedback on range, accuracy and appropriacy.** In every freer task, keep three columns: **accuracy** (errors), **range** (ambitious, precise language to praise and spread) and **appropriacy** (right words, wrong register or wrong move: an email that buries its request; a rebuttal that dismisses; a "verdict" that judges the topic, not the argument). At C1 the third column matters most. Board 2–3 items from each, without names.
- ◆ **Peer review is taught, not assumed.** Adults from many education systems have never been asked to critique a classmate, and some feel it is rude. Model it (the 6.2 dialogue and slide 11), give a fixed protocol (reviewer speaks first, writer listens, writer asks one question, writer decides), and give the reviewer a **job** (a reverse outline and a checklist) rather than an invitation to "give feedback." Review the reviewers: check the peer-review sheets, not only the drafts.
- ◆ **Dominant speakers.** The seminar in C17 has fixed roles: give the most talkative learner the **Reporter** (who must summarize the group, not their own view) or the **Evidence Checker** (who may speak only when figures are cited). Use a round: everyone speaks once before anyone speaks twice. In peer review, the timer protects the quieter writer: 3 minutes reviewer, 1 minute writer's question, no interruptions. Say it plainly: "Thanks, Omar. I'd like to hear the group's view now, not yours. Reporter?"
- ◆ **Stretching strong learners toward C2.** Each lesson has a stretch box. The C2 direction for this module is **judgment and style**: when a "fallacy" is actually reasonable (a slippery slope with evidence, a relevant authority); how to rebut the rebuttal; synthesizing two sources rather than evaluating one; controlling rhythm and emphasis in prose (periodic sentences, fronting, the well-placed short sentence); switching register fluently between genres for the same content.
- ◆ **American English is the classroom standard.** The online lessons use British spellings and conventions (*recognise, sceptical, colouring, generalisation, organise, practise, enquire, favour, judgement, behaviour, neighbourhood, centralised; Ms Okafor* without a period, *Yours sincerely, CV*) and a few British words (*high street, footfall, pupils*). Teach the American forms and business conventions: *Ms.* with a period, *Sincerely, / Best regards,, résumé, inquire, downtown / main street, foot traffic, students*, and dates written as *March 3*. Accept British forms when learners use them consistently.
- ◆ Dashed boxes = lines to say out loud, CCQs and ICQs. Green boxes = scripts you read aloud. **Amber** = watch-outs.

THE THROUGH-LINE

Take it apart → build it → put it to work. One invented company, **Harborview Logistics**, runs through the module. In C17 learners read two columnists fighting over Harborview's four-day-week pilot and discover that both of them cherry-pick the same company's figures. In C18 they build the kind of argument those columnists failed to write: a thesis, disciplined paragraphs, a fair counter-argument. In C19 they step inside Harborview and write the documents a workplace actually runs on: an email to team leaders, a report with headings and recommendations, and a cover letter for a real-looking job posting. Every class ends with a text another learner reads critically, which is the whole module in one habit.

TRAUMA-INFORMED AND OPINION-SAFE

Argument and application tasks can touch sensitive ground. **Topics stay in the workplace, education, technology, health habits and community life:** no party politics, religion or immigration policy, and don't bring in real news articles on those topics for the critical-reading lab. **Every argument task uses an assigned side** (the essay question cards say "Side A" or "Side B"), so nobody has to reveal a personal view; say so before you hand them out. The **cover letter** is the most personal task in the course: some learners have careers interrupted by migration, credentials that are not recognized here, employment gaps or jobs below their qualifications. Offer three options out loud, as equally valid: **your real experience, a professional profile card, or a mix** (your real skills in an invented job). Never ask learners to explain a gap, and never read a cover letter aloud to the class without permission. The data and people in every text are invented; say so.

BEFORE THE MODULE

- ◆ Print the **flashcards** (set A): evaluative verbs, evidence types, connectors color-coded by function, professional formulae, and the few picture cards (*read, notebook, pen, email, desk*) for the "writer's toolkit" warm-up. Card stock helps.
- ◆ For C17: the **seminar role cards** (set C: one set of four per group, including the Evidence Checker's **pilot fact sheet**) and one envelope of **fallacy card-sort** cards per pair (set D: 27 cards). Learners read Articles A and B in the workbook.
- ◆ For C18: the **essay question cards** (set E: 6 questions × Side A / Side B; cut off the teacher strip of model theses) and one **peer-review sheet** per learner (set F). Print 4–6 **Fallacy Bingo** grids (set H) for the warmer.
- ◆ For C19: the **writing-lab pack** (set G): one report data card per two learners, the five job postings (spread around the room), the **reader cards** for the reader panel, and the **professional profile cards** (set B) on a side table, where anyone can take one without asking.
- ◆ Optional: a highlighter in two colors per learner (claims / evidence) for C17, and a phone timer visible to everyone for the peer-review rounds in C18.

MODULE AT A GLANCE

LESSON	CLASS	FOCUS	LEARNERS CAN...
6.1	C17 · wk 9	Critical-reading lab: fact vs opinion (and opinion in disguise); claim, evidence, warrant ; types of evidence; purpose, stance, tone; loaded language; common fallacies (unsupported generalization, false cause, cherry-picking, false dilemma, appeal to emotion, + straw man, slippery slope, bandwagon, attacking the person); evaluative verbs (<i>asserts, concedes, downplays, overstates, dismisses</i>)	analyze two opposing opinion articles, test their evidence against the full figures, and deliver a fair, reasoned group verdict on which makes the stronger case and which is better argued
6.2	C18 · wk 9	Essay-structuring workshop: thesis (specific, arguable, on-question); hook → context → thesis; PEEL body paragraphs; cohesion and signposting matched to logic; concede → rebut without straw men; restate → synthesize → implication; outline → draft → structured peer review	plan a 4–5 paragraph argument essay on an assigned side, draft the introduction and one body paragraph, and give and use structured peer feedback
6.3	C19 · wk 10	Professional-writing lab: clarity, concision, register, reader-focus; the purpose-first email; the short report (headings, passive, nominalization, <i>It is recommended that... be</i>); the cover letter (evidence + relevance, confident not boastful); American business conventions	write a purpose-first email from a voicemail, then a report section or a cover letter (real or fictional profile), and revise it after hearing it read aloud by a "reader"

6.1 · C17

Critical Reading — Evaluating Arguments & Bias

90 min

◆ OBJECTIVES — LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ distinguish a checkable **fact** from an **opinion**, including an opinion dressed in the grammar of fact (*clearly, it is widely accepted that...*)
- ◆ separate a writer's **claim** from the **evidence**, name the evidence type, and make the unstated **warrant** visible
- ◆ identify **purpose, stance and tone**, and point to the loaded words that reveal them
- ◆ name and locate common **fallacies** in a real text, and explain why each weakens the case
- ◆ describe what a text does with precise verbs (*asserts, contends, concedes, downplays, overstates, dismisses*) and give a fair, hedged verdict on the **argument** rather than the topic

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 6.1 (Key language, Language box, Exercises 1–5, Articles A and B, dialogue, seminar frame, model evaluation, rubric)
- ◆ Slides 2–7 · Flashcards: evaluative verbs, evidence types · **Fallacy card sort** (1 envelope per pair) · **Seminar role cards** + pilot fact sheet (1 set per group of 4)
- ◆ Listening scripts 6.1-A (radio commentary, "Second Opinion") and 6.1-B (dictation)

BOARD PLAN

Left: the skeleton. EVIDENCE —(warrant)→ CLAIM. Three questions: What exactly is claimed? On what evidence? Does the evidence support *this* claim? Evidence types: statistics · research · expert testimony · anecdote · analogy · bare assertion.

Center: the verbs. asserts · contends · implies · concedes / acknowledges · downplays · dismisses · overstates · refutes / rebuts. Frame: "She concedes that..., but downplays..." · "The figure suggests a correlation but does not establish cause."

Right: two questions for the seminar. (1) Which article makes the **stronger case**? (2) Which article is **better argued**? → not the same question! Fallacy list grows here as the card sort goes on.

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: upgrade the register	7	S-S → T-S	Review C16 (5.3 Academic & Formal Vocabulary). Board four chatty sentences about an invented workplace trial: "The trial went really well and loads of people liked it." · "They looked into why people kept getting sick." · "Sales went up a bit." · "The boss thinks they should keep it." Pairs rewrite each in formal, precise English (<i>The trial was broadly successful and widely welcomed.</i> · <i>The causes of staff absence were investigated.</i> · <i>Sales rose modestly.</i>). Share two; praise precision (<i>modestly, marginally</i>) and note one error for later.
Lead-in: two headlines	5	T-S	Slide 2. Two headlines about the same (invented) pilot: " <i>FOUR-DAY WEEK DELIVERS</i> " and " <i>FOUR-DAY WEEK: CUSTOMERS PAY THE PRICE.</i> " Ask: "Same company, same six months. Which writer is for it? Which word told you? Could both headlines be factually true?" (Yes.) "Today you'll read both articles and find out what each one leaves out."
The toolkit	10	T-S	Slides 3–4. Fact / opinion / opinion in disguise; claim → evidence → warrant ; evidence types. Build the skeleton on the board with one sentence: "Sick days fell by 18%, so the pilot should be made permanent." Elicit the hidden warrant. Then the evaluative verbs (flashcards). Meaning, form, pronunciation, CCQs below.
Drill	5	T-S → S	Frame drill (see Drill script): stress on the verb and the contrast, choral then individual, then open pairs describing a writer's move from a prompt.
Listening: "Second Opinion"	6	T-S → S-S	Workbook Ex 1. Read Script 6.1-A twice in a warm, opinionated radio voice. First listening: "For or against? How strongly?" Second: learners note claim, two pieces of evidence and types, a weakness, the tone. Pairs compare. Elicit the false dilemma at the end.
Controlled practice	7	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 2 (fact / opinion / disguise) and Ex 3 (verbs) alone, then check in pairs. Board-check only disagreements; item 7 ("Profits fell because of...") is worth a minute of debate.
Reading lab: Articles A and B	13	S → S-S	Pairs split: learner A reads Article A, learner B reads Article B (4 min, highlighting the claim in one color, evidence in another). Each fills their column of Ex 4, rows 1–4 (4 min). Then they swap articles, read quickly, and complete the remaining rows together

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			(5 min). Monitor for "It's biased" with no anchor: "Which sentence? Which word?"
Fallacy card sort	12	S-S	Slide 5. Envelopes of 27 cards: 9 fallacy names, 9 definitions, 9 examples. Round 1 (4 min): match names to definitions. Round 2 (4 min): add the examples. Round 3 (4 min): find each fallacy in Articles A or B and write the sentence number on the name card (some appear in both; one or two appear in neither). Check with slide 5; add names to the right of the board.
Freer: the critical-reading seminar	15	S-S → T-S	Slide 6. Groups of 4 with role cards: Chair , Evidence Checker (holds the pilot fact sheet: the information gap), Devil's Advocate , Reporter . ICQs first. Discuss the two questions (9 min): the Evidence Checker reveals figures only when a claim is made that the figures test. Reporters prepare the four-move verdict with the workbook frame (2 min), then each Reporter gives the group's verdict in 60 seconds (4 min).
Feedback	5	T-S	Delayed correction in three columns. Accuracy (e.g. "many evidences," "the writer critics," "it implies me that"). Range (e.g. "conflates correlation with cause," "to her credit, she concedes..."). Appropriacy (a verdict on the four-day week itself instead of on the article; "he is biased" as a conclusion rather than a starting point). Learners fix and discuss.
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Show online lesson 6.1 on screen; point at a  button. Set the homework (below). Show the critical-evaluation rubric: "This is how I'll read yours." Slide 7 previews C18: from reading an argument to building one. Learners tick the "I can..." box.
Total	90		7 + 5 + 10 + 5 + 6 + 7 + 13 + 12 + 15 + 5 + 5

◆ MEANING • FORM • PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: fact, opinion, opinion in disguise. A fact can in principle be checked; an opinion is a judgment. The C1 skill is spotting opinions wearing the clothes of fact: *clearly, obviously, it is widely accepted that, everyone knows, the results speak for themselves.*

SAY: "Customer complaints rose by 11 percent." Can we check it? (Yes: fact.) Does it tell us whether that's serious? (No: that's interpretation.) • "The four-day week is clearly the future." Can we check "the future"? (No.) Which word makes it sound like fact? (Clearly.)

Meaning: the warrant. The unstated assumption that links evidence to claim. Often the weakest point, and the most powerful one to name.

SAY: "Sick days fell by 18 percent, so the pilot should be permanent." Is the 18 percent the claim or the evidence? (Evidence.) What must we assume for the evidence to prove the claim? (That the pilot caused the fall.) Could anything else explain it? (Yes: the season, a mild winter, a flu outbreak the year before.) Is the writer lying? (Not necessarily: the figure can be true and the argument still weak.)

Meaning: evaluative verbs.

SAY: "She concedes that response times slipped." Is that a point for her side or against it? (Against: she admits it.) · "...but downplays it as a teething problem." Does she make it bigger or smaller? (Smaller.) · "He dismisses the fall in turnover." Does he discuss it seriously? (No: he waves it away.) · "Refute" or "rebut": which one means he succeeded in proving it wrong? (Refute; rebut is the attempt.) · Writer implies, reader...? (Infers.)

Meaning: a strong case vs a well-made argument. The key conceptual move of the class.

SAY: Can an article be right but badly argued? (Yes: true conclusion, weak reasons.) Can an article be well argued and still wrong? (Yes: if its evidence turns out to be incomplete.) So when you judge an article, what are you judging? (The argument: the reasons and evidence, not whether we like the conclusion.)

Form.

Verb + that-clause	asserts / contends / concedes / acknowledges / implies that + clause	She concedes that response times slipped.
Verb + object	downplays / dismisses / overstates / exaggerates + noun phrase	He dismisses the fall in turnover . ✗ He dismisses that turnover fell.
Evaluating evidence	The evidence is + adjective ; the figure + suggests / indicates / does not establish	The evidence is anecdotal. The figure suggests a correlation but does not establish cause.
Uncountable	evidence , information, research, advice (no plural)	several pieces of evidence · a great deal of research

Pronunciation. Word stress on the evaluative verbs: con**CEDE**, con**TEND**, as**SERT**, im**PLY**, re**FUTE** /rɪ'fju:t/, dis**MISS**, over**STATE**, down**PLAY** (the noun **DOWN**play is rare). *evidence* = **E**vidence (three syllables, not ev-I-dence). In the concession frame, contrastive stress carries the meaning: "She con**CEDES** it, ↗ | but she **DOWN**plays it. ↘" Seminar language: a falling tone on a verdict sounds decided ("On balance, Article A is stronger. ↘"); a fall-rise on a concession invites the "but" ("It's a relevant figure... ↘ ↗").

- 1 **Stress the verb** (point at flashcards): T: "con-CEDE" → Ss chorally. Through the eight verbs; then T says a verb with the wrong stress (*DIS-miss*) and learners correct it.
- 2 **Name the move**: T reads a line, S names it with a verb: T: "'Admittedly, response times slipped.'" → S: "She concedes that response times slipped." T: "'But it was only a minor teething problem.'" → S: "She downplays the problem." T: "'Sick days fell. Case closed.'" → S: "She overstates the evidence." T: "'Some say turnover fell, but young people always chase perks.'" → S: "He dismisses the fall in turnover."
- 3 **Evidence verdicts**: T gives a piece of evidence, S evaluates it with one adjective + reason: T: "One bakery's delivery was late." → S: "That's anecdotal: one case can't show a pattern." T: "The best month's output." → S: "That's selective: it's cherry-picked."
- 4 **Open pairs → closed pairs**: S1 invents a one-line argument about an everyday topic ("My gym is the best, because it's always full."); S2 names the warrant ("You're assuming that popular means good."); S3 names the weakness ("That's a bandwagon argument."). Then all pairs, 1 minute.

◆ THE CRITICAL-READING SEMINAR – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ **Groups of 4** (3 is possible: the Chair also reports). Roles on the cards. Give the **Evidence Checker** card to a careful reader, and the **Reporter** card to the strongest or most dominant speaker: they must summarize the group, not argue.
- ◆ **The information gap**. Only the Evidence Checker has the pilot fact sheet. The rule: the Checker reveals a figure only when someone makes a claim the figure tests ("Whitfield says sick days fell by 18%." → "Compared with the previous six months, yes. Compared with last year, only 7%."). Groups soon discover that **both** columnists selected their data.
- ◆ **Devil's Advocate** must argue the opposite of whatever the group seems to be concluding, at least twice. This keeps the verdict honest and gives confident learners a legitimate way to challenge.
- ◆ **Two questions, deliberately separated**: "Which makes the stronger *case*?" (who is closer to right, given all the figures) and "Which is better *argued*?" (which uses evidence more fairly). Many groups conclude: Whitfield's case is stronger, but neither is well argued. That is the lesson.
- ◆ **Verdicts**: each Reporter speaks for 60 seconds using the four-move frame. The class may ask one question per group. No vote on the four-day week itself: we judged the articles.

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE SEMINAR

SAY: *Who has the full figures? (The Evidence Checker.) · When can the Checker share a figure? (When someone makes a claim the figure tests.) · Is the Devil's Advocate giving their own opinion? (No: they argue the opposite.) · How many questions? (Two: stronger case, better argued.) · Are they the same question? (No!) · Are we deciding whether the four-day week is a good idea? (No: whether the articles argue well.) · Who speaks for the group at the end? (The Reporter, 60 seconds.)*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Some C1 learners have strong spoken English but read slowly, or learned to read in a non-Latin script. Let them work on **Article A only** (read it aloud to them once while they follow), with sentence numbers as anchors: their task is to find the claim (A17), one statistic (A3), one anecdote (A6–8) and two loaded phrases. In the card sort, give them the **5 core fallacies** only (the ones from the online lesson). Give the seminar frame with the first words filled in. Make them the **Chair** (a speaking role) rather than the Evidence Checker (a reading-heavy role).

STRETCH (TOWARD C2)

Ask: "When is a 'fallacy' not a fallacy?" A slippery slope with evidence for each step is a reasonable prediction; an appeal to a *relevant* expert is good evidence; emotion is legitimate when the stakes are genuinely human. Then: write a one-paragraph **synthesis** of both articles for Harborview's managers, using the full figures, in neutral language, with no verdict (the C2 skill of reporting a debate fairly). Early finishers do Ex 5 and then load the neutral phrases the *other* way (euphemism is loading too).

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **"Evidences," "informations," "researches":** Spanish, French, Portuguese, Russian and Arabic speakers pluralize these (*evidencias, informations, informações*). Board "a piece of evidence / several pieces of evidence."
- ◆ **False friends:** *actual* (= current in Spanish, Portuguese, French: "the actual situation" for *the current situation*) · *argument* (Spanish *argumento* can mean the plot of a story; Italian *argomento* means the topic; so "the argument of the article" may mean "what it's about") · *critic* used as a verb (Spanish *criticar*, Portuguese *criticar*): teach *criticize, critique*.
- ◆ **Reading "politely":** learners from education systems where published texts and authorities are not questioned in class (common in parts of East and South Asia, the Middle East and Eastern Europe; also among learners with little formal schooling) may feel that criticizing a writer is disrespectful. Say it explicitly: "In this class, testing an argument is a sign of respect." The mindset box in the online lesson says the same.
- ◆ **Imply vs infer:** most languages use one verb for both, or none. CCQ it: "The writer **implies**; the reader **infers**."
- ◆ **Tone words at C1:** learners reach for "negative / positive / aggressive." Push for precision with the flashcard adjectives: *scornful, indignant, dismissive, measured, wistful, alarmist, campaigning*.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 6.1: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-c1/lesson_16.html. Listen to the five model sentences with 🗣️ and say them back; do Exercises 1–3, the Quick Quiz and the "Critical Evaluation" project. Workbook 6.1: Ex 5 (loaded language) if not done in class; write a **critical evaluation of Article A**

(150–250 words) using the model and the rubric (or of a real opinion piece on an everyday topic: a product review, a workplace blog, a column about city services); "My new words" and the journal.

◆ CHECK — SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **C** a false cause · Q2 **A** loaded language signals stance · Q3 (new) **B** answering emails quickly measures productivity. Radio commentary (Ex 1): claim = remove self-checkouts · anecdote (81-year-old neighbor) · statistic/testimony from one store (unrepresentative) · false dilemma (cashiers or nobody talks) · tone: indignant / nostalgic. Ex 2: F F D F D F D O · Ex 3: 1C 2E 3H 4F 5D 6B 7G 8A.

◆ OBJECTIVES – LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ write a **thesis** that is specific, arguable and answers the exact question, and diagnose weak ones (topic announcement, truism, fence-sitting, off-question)
- ◆ open with **hook** → **context** → **thesis** and build body paragraphs with **PEEL** (point, evidence, explanation, link)
- ◆ signpost only where the logic needs it, matching the connector to the relationship (*Consequently* = result; *By contrast* ≠ *Nevertheless*)
- ◆ **concede** the strongest opposing point fairly and **rebut** it without a straw man, and close with **restate** → **synthesize** → **implication**
- ◆ take part in **structured peer review**: produce a reverse outline and checklist for a partner, and receive feedback without defending

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 6.2 (Key language, Language box, Exercises 1–5, model essay, dialogue, outline frame, peer-review checklist, rubric)
- ◆ Slides 8–12 · Connector flashcards (color-coded by function) · **Fallacy Bingo** grids (warmer) · **Essay question cards** with assigned sides (1 per learner) · **Peer-review sheets** (1 per learner) · a visible timer
- ◆ Listening scripts 6.2-A (an introduction read aloud) and 6.2-B (dictation)

BOARD PLAN

Left: the architecture. INTRO: hook → context → **thesis** · BODY ×2–3: Point → Evidence → Explanation → Link · COUNTER: concede → rebut · CONCLUSION: restate → synthesize → implication (no new points!).

Center: the thesis test. Could a reasonable person disagree? Does it answer *this* question? Weak: T (topic) · O (obvious) · F (fence) · Q (off-question). Frame: *While / Although X, Y; therefore Z.*

Right: connectors by job (colored flashcards). add: Furthermore · result: Consequently · compare: By contrast · concede: Admittedly / Granted · turn back: Nevertheless / Yet · example: For instance. Rebuttal openers: *Yet this objection overlooks...* · *Such a view fails to account for...*

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: Fallacy Bingo	8	T-S → S-S	Review C17. Pairs share a bingo grid (set H). Read caller sentences from the list; pairs mark the device they hear. A

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			pair calling "Bingo!" must name and justify each marked square. Two rounds maximum. Collect one or two homework evaluations to read later; ask two learners for the central claim of Article A in one sentence.
Lead-in: topic sentences only	4	T-S	Slide 8. Show only the first sentence of each paragraph of the model essay. "What is the question? What is the writer's position? How many reasons?" Learners can reconstruct the argument from five sentences: that is the point of a topic sentence.
Model essay anatomy	10	S → S-S → T-S	Workbook model essay. Learners fold back or cover the right-hand annotation column. Pairs label the hook, context, thesis, each PEEL stage, the concession, the rebuttal, and the three moves of the conclusion (6 min), then uncover and compare (2 min). Board questions (2 min): "What does <i>While</i> do in the thesis? Where is the strongest objection? Is it a straw man?"
Thesis clinic	8	T-S → S	Slide 9. Workbook Ex 2: diagnose, then rewrite two. CCQs (below). Three learners read a rewrite; the class applies the test ("Could a reasonable person disagree?").
Listening: an introduction	5	T-S	Workbook Ex 1. Read Script 6.2-A twice at a measured academic pace. Learners note hook, context, thesis, and predict the body paragraphs. Elicit <i>Although</i> as the concession.
Cohesion & the fair rebuttal	8	T-S → S-S	Slides 10–11. Connectors by function (flashcards on the board), then concede → rebut (slide 10); slide 11 previews the peer-review dialogue. Quick drill (below). Workbook Ex 3 (connectors) in pairs; Ex 4 part 1 (spot the straw man) together. Ex 4 part 2 and Ex 5 → homework.
Workshop 1: outline	10	S-S → S	Slide 12. Hand out essay question cards (assigned sides; say out loud: "You argue the card, not yourself"). Learners with the same question and side sit together for 3 minutes to brainstorm evidence, then each completes the outline frame alone (7 min). Monitor theses first: every learner must have one you would accept before drafting.

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Workshop 2: draft	15	S	Silent writing: the introduction plus one full PEEL body paragraph (stronger writers: the counter-argument paragraph instead). Play quiet instrumental music if the group likes it. Circulate with a pencil; write one question in the margin, never a correction.
Workshop 3: structured peer review	12	S-S	Pairs with different questions swap drafts. Reviewers read twice and complete the peer-review sheet (6 min). Then two feedback rounds on the timer (3 min each): reviewer speaks (2 min), writer asks one clarifying question (1 min). ICQs first. Protocol below.
Feedback	5	T-S	Delayed correction. Accuracy (comma splices, "On the other hand" used to add). Range (a well-built thesis; "This objection rests on the assumption that..."). Appropriacy (an informal slip in formal register; a rebuttal that dismisses rather than answers). Ask two writers: "What will you change after the review?"
Homework set- up	5	T-S	Show online lesson 6.2; point at a 🗣️ button. Set the homework: finish the essay using the peer feedback; the rubric is how it will be read. Learners tick the "I can..." box.
Total	90		8 + 4 + 10 + 8 + 5 + 8 + 10 + 15 + 12 + 5 + 5

◆ MEANING • FORM • PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: thesis. The one-sentence position that every paragraph serves. Not a topic, not a fact, not a list of both sides.

SAY: "This essay is about training at work." Does it take a position? (No.) · "Training is important." Would anyone disagree? (No: so it's not a thesis.) · "There are arguments on both sides." Where does the writer stand? (Nowhere: fence-sitting.) · "Although paid training carries short-term costs, employers should treat it as an investment." Could a reasonable person disagree? (Yes: good.) What does Although do? (Concedes a point to the other side.)

Meaning: explanation in PEEL. The stage learners skip. Evidence doesn't speak for itself.

SAY: "Studies show tired workers make more mistakes." Is that the point, the evidence or the explanation? (Evidence.) Does it tell the reader why this matters for this essay? (No: that's the explanation's job.) Which phrase starts an explanation? (This matters because... · This suggests that...)

Meaning: concede vs rebut vs straw man.

SAY: "Admittedly, critics contend that rules ignore emergencies." Is the writer agreeing completely? (No: accepting a point, then answering it.) · "Yet this objection targets a blanket ban, not these limits." Is that a concession or a rebuttal? (Rebuttal.) · "Some people think workers should never learn anything." Does anybody really argue that? (No: it's a straw man, an invented weak version.) Why does a straw man make your essay weaker, not stronger? (A critical reader notices; you lose trust.)

Meaning: connectors.

SAY: "The course is expensive. Nevertheless, participants value it." Does "Nevertheless" add a point on the same side? (No: it turns against what we'd expect.) · "Small teams decide quickly. By contrast, large departments..." Are we conceding? (No: comparing two different things.) · "It saved money. Consequently, staff disliked it." Is disliking it a result of saving money? (No: wrong connector.)

Form.

Concessive thesis	While / Although + concession, + main clause (position) + (because / for + reasons)	While a total ban would be impractical, employers should set clear limits, because...
Sentence connector	full stop / semicolon + connector + comma	...the cost. Nevertheless , ... · ...the cost; nevertheless , ...
Conjunction	although / whereas / while + clause, within one sentence	Although it is expensive, most participants value it.
Concede → rebut	Admittedly / Granted / It is true that Yet / However , this overlooks / fails to account for + noun phrase	Yet this objection overlooks the cost of replacing staff.
✗ Comma splice	two main clauses joined by a comma only	✗ Remote work saves time, it reduces costs. → ✓ ...saves time; it also... / ... saves time and...

Pronunciation. Reading a draft aloud is a proofreading tool, so teach it: pause at every full stop; if you run out of breath before one, the sentence is probably too long. Sentence connectors take a short pause and a slight rise: "**Nevertheless** ↗ | most participants value it ↘." Stress contrastive pairs in concessions: "**Although** it's exPENsive, | it's **worth** it." Word stress: **THE**sis (plural **THE**ses /'θi:si:z/), **CON**trast (noun) / con**TR**AST (verb), con**SE**quently, ne-ver-the-**LESS**, ad**MIT**tedly.

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 **Connector by function** (hold up a colored flashcard): T: "Result." → S: "Consequently." T: "Concede." → S: "Admittedly." T: "Compare two things." → S: "By contrast." Choral, then fast individuals.

- 2 **Finish the logic:** T: "Remote work saves commuting time. Furthermore..." → S: "...it widens the pool of applicants." T: "...saves commuting time. Nevertheless..." → S: "...some people feel isolated." T: "...Consequently..." → S: "...staff have more time for family."
- 3 **Concede → rebut chain:** T gives an objection; S1 concedes it fairly, S2 rebuts: T: "Training is expensive." → S1: "Admittedly, training involves real costs." → S2: "Yet this overlooks the higher cost of replacing staff." T: "Phones in meetings help people take notes." → S1: "It is true that some staff use phones for notes." → S2: "However, a paper notebook does that without the notifications."
- 4 **Thesis upgrade** (open pairs): S1 says a weak thesis on an everyday topic ("Libraries are good."); S2 upgrades it with *Although / While* + a position + a reason. Then closed pairs, 1 minute.

◆ STRUCTURED PEER REVIEW – THE PROTOCOL

- ◆ **Swap across questions**, not within them, so the reviewer reads as a genuine outsider (and can't "correct" the argument toward their own).
- ◆ **Reviewer's job** (6 min, silent): read twice; write the thesis in your own words; write a one-line **reverse outline** of each paragraph; complete the checklist (Y / P / N); copy the **strongest sentence**; write **one question** that would make the draft stronger ("What would a skeptical manager say to paragraph 2?").
- ◆ **Round 1** (3 min): reviewer A speaks for 2 minutes in this order: thesis check → strongest sentence → the question. Writer B listens and **does not defend or explain**. Then B asks one clarifying question (1 min).
Round 2: swap.
- ◆ **Language** (slide 11, dialogue in the workbook): *Can I check I've understood your thesis? · The strongest sentence for me is... · I wasn't entirely sure how... connects to... · You might consider... · I'd question...*
This is Lesson 3.3's hedging in a real job.
- ◆ **The writer owns the text.** Say it: "Your reviewer gives you information, not instructions. You decide what to change."
- ◆ **Review the reviewers.** Collect the sheets with the drafts. A sheet with all "Y" and "good" in the boxes goes back with: "Which sentence would you cut, and why?"

◆ ICQS BEFORE PEER REVIEW

SAY: *Whose draft do you review: someone with the same question or a different one? (Different.) · What do you write for each paragraph? (One line: its point.) · Who speaks first? (The reviewer.) · Can the writer explain or defend while the reviewer is speaking? (No, just listen.) · How many questions can the writer ask? (One.) · Who decides what to change? (The writer.)*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Give the **thesis frame** on a strip ("Although _____, _____ should _____, because _____.") and the PEEL openers (*One clear reason is... · For instance, ... · This matters because... · This shows that...*). Draft target: the introduction only (3–4 sentences), then one body paragraph as notes. Pair the learner with a patient reviewer and let them **review orally**: the reviewer reads the draft aloud, and the writer hears where it works. Allow learners to plan orally in L1 with a same-language partner before writing in English (strategic L1 use).

STRETCH (TOWARD C2)

Write the **counter-argument paragraph** instead of a body paragraph, and then "rebut the rebuttal": what would the critic say back, and does the thesis still survive? Work on **style**: vary sentence length deliberately (a short sentence after a long one lands a point), use one cleft or fronted structure for emphasis (*It is precisely this expectation that...*, from Module 2), and cut every connector the logic doesn't need. Ask: "Could your thesis be more precise: *to what extent*, for *whom*, under *what conditions*?"

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **Where the main point goes.** English academic writing is **deductive**: thesis early, topic sentence first. Many writing traditions build toward the point (e.g. Japanese *ki-shō-ten-ketsu*, Chinese *qǐ-chéng-zhuǎn-hé*, Korean essay structure, some Arabic and Persian prose styles), or value elaborate introductions (Spanish, Portuguese, Italian academic prose). Present this as a **convention of this genre**, not a better way of thinking.
- ◆ **Comma splices and run-ons:** Spanish, Portuguese, Vietnamese, Arabic and Chinese punctuation allows longer comma chains. Teach the semicolon and the full stop as tools, with the read-aloud test.
- ◆ **"On the other hand" to add a point:** very common across L1s (it's used like *also*). It must contrast, and it sounds best after *On the one hand*. **"Besides"** is informal in English writing (French *d'ailleurs*, Spanish *además* are neutral): prefer *Furthermore*.
- ◆ **Articles in abstract nouns:** "The education is important," "Technology is changing the society" (Spanish, French, Portuguese, Italian, Arabic, Greek use the article with general abstract nouns). Russian, Polish, Chinese, Japanese, Korean and Vietnamese speakers may drop articles entirely ("Employer should offer training"). Recast in feedback; it is a persistent C1 error in formal writing.
- ◆ **"I think" everywhere:** some learners were taught never to use "I"; others use "In my opinion, I think" in every paragraph. Point to the online lesson's guidance: lean impersonal in formal essays (*The evidence suggests... · This essay argues...*).

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 6.2: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-c1/lesson_17.html. Listen to the five model sentences with 🗣️ and say them back; do Exercises 1–3, the Quick Quiz and the "Plan and Draft" project. Workbook 6.2: Ex 4 part 2 and Ex 5; **finish the essay** from the question card (4–5 paragraphs, 350–450 words),

using the peer review and the rubric; "My new words" and the journal. Learners bring the finished essay to C19 (you mark it with the rubric and return it in C20).

◆ CHECK — SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **B** the concessive, arguable thesis · Q2 **A** move it into a body paragraph · Q3 (new) **B** the rebuttal that answers the cost objection. Intro (Ex 1): hook = observation about downtown parking · context = half-empty lots, reluctant councils · thesis = "Although drivers' needs cannot simply be ignored, converting underused lots into public squares would bring more people downtown..." · concession word = *Although*. Ex 2: T O F Q S · Ex 3: Consequently · By contrast · Nevertheless · Furthermore · Admittedly · For instance · (7) Nevertheless / However · Ex 5: B D A C.

◆ OBJECTIVES — LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ apply the four principles (**clarity, concision, register, reader-focus**) to diagnose and repair professional texts
- ◆ write an email with a specific subject line, the **purpose in the first sentence**, and a polite but direct request with a deadline
- ◆ organize a short **report** under headings, moving from findings to conclusions to specific recommendations, in an impersonal register (passive, nominalization, *It is recommended that... be...*)
- ◆ write a **cover letter** that matches concrete, quantified evidence to an employer's stated needs, confident but not boastful
- ◆ use American business conventions (*Ms., Sincerely, résumé, inquire*, unambiguous dates) and test tone by hearing the text read aloud

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 6.3 (Key language, Language box, Exercises 1–5, three annotated models, dialogue, writing lab, three rubrics)
- ◆ Slides 13–17 · Formula flashcards · **Writing-lab pack**: report data card, five job postings, reader cards (A = writer, B = reader) · **Professional profile cards** on a side table
- ◆ Listening scripts 6.3-A (Karen Liu's voicemail) and 6.3-B (dictation)

BOARD PLAN

Left: four principles. CLARITY · CONCISION · REGISTER · READER-FOCUS → "Direct is not rude; vague is not polite."

Center: three genres. EMAIL: subject → purpose → request + deadline → thanks → sign-off. REPORT: Purpose · Method · Findings · Conclusions · Recommendations (*It is recommended that the form **be** replaced.*). COVER LETTER: role + fit → evidence + relevance → confident close.

Right: US conventions. Dear Ms. Carter, · Dear Hiring Manager, · Sincerely, / Best regards, · résumé · inquire · March 3 (not 3/3). ✗ Dear Sir/Madam (when you know the name) · ✗ Respected Sir · ✗ Please revert back.

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: what I changed	7	S-S → T-S	Review C18. Learners bring their finished essays. In pairs: "Tell your partner one change you made after peer review, and why." Then two volunteers read their thesis aloud; the class applies the test. Collect the essays. Board one range example from what you hear.
Lead-in: the register ladder	5	T-S	Slide 13. Four versions of one request (very formal · standard professional · too informal · absurdly stiff). Learners rank them and match them to readers: "a professor you've never met," "a colleague you know," "nobody." Elicit: the ask is equally clear in both correct versions; only the framing changes.
Genre jigsaw	15	S → S-S	Groups of 3. Each member takes one annotated model in the workbook (email, report or cover letter), covers the annotation column, and works out what each part is doing (5 min); uncovers and checks (2 min). Then each "expert" teaches the genre to the other two in 2 minutes, using the matching rubric (8 min). Slides 14–16 as the class check.
Language focus & drill	8	T-S → S	Formulae (flashcards) and report grammar: passive for findings, nominalization, <i>It is recommended that</i> + <i>subject</i> + <i>base verb</i> . Drill (below), then Workbook Ex 2 and Ex 4 in pairs. Ex 3 and Ex 5 → homework or early finishers.
Listening → email	12	T-S → S → S-S	Workbook Ex 1. Read Script 6.3-A (Karen Liu's voicemail) twice, naturally and a little rushed, like a real voicemail. Learners take notes, then write the email (8 min). Pairs swap and check with the email rubric : subject line, purpose in sentence 1, deadline, cc (2 min).
Writing lab: report or cover letter	22	S	Slide 17. Learners choose: the report (data card: Findings, Conclusions, Recommendations with headings) or the cover letter (one of five job postings; as themselves or a profile card). Say the three options for the cover letter out loud. Before writing, each learner writes "My reader... My purpose..." (1 min). Circulate; conference briefly with each learner about their reader, not their grammar.
Freer: the reader panel	11	S-S	Pairs swap texts and take the matching reader card (B), which reveals what the hiring manager or the director really cares about (the information gap). The reader reads the

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			writer's text aloud (2 min), then reacts in role for 2 minutes ("I stopped reading at... · What I needed first was... · I'd invite you to interview because..."). The writer listens and notes one change. Swap. ICQs first.
Feedback	5	T-S	Delayed correction. Accuracy ("Dear Karen Liu," "interesting in," "informations"). Range ("In light of these findings...", a well-quantified achievement). Appropriacy: the big one; board an anonymous buried request and an over-humble sentence and repair them with the class.
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Show online lesson 6.3; point at a  button. Set the homework. Remind: never send a real application you haven't reread aloud. Learners tick the "I can..." box.
Total	90		7 + 5 + 15 + 8 + 12 + 22 + 11 + 5 + 5

◆ MEANING · FORM · PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: reader-focus and purpose-first. The commonest C1 failing is not grammar but **self-centered structure**: telling the story in the order the writer lived it.

SAY: "I hope you are well. We have been customers for some time. Recently there have been some issues..." After three sentences, does the reader know what you want? (No.) Where should the request be? (In the first or second sentence.) Is "Could you please confirm the delivery date?" rude? (No: it's polite and clear.) Where does the politeness live? (In the framing: Could you please.)

Meaning: findings vs conclusions vs recommendations.

SAY: "58% of respondents found the form difficult." Finding, conclusion or recommendation? (Finding: data.) · "The current system appears to be slow and unfair." (Conclusion: interpretation.) · "It is recommended that the form be replaced." (Recommendation: action.) Can an opinion go in the Findings section? (No: "Sadly, 58%..." mixes them.)

Meaning: confident vs boastful vs over-humble.

SAY: "I am an outstanding communicator." Can the reader check it? (No: empty.) · "I trained twelve new staff, and all passed probation." Can they check it? (Yes: that's why it's confident, not boastful.) · "I'm sorry if my English isn't perfect." What does it make the reader notice? (Your English. Delete it.)

Form.

Purpose openers	I am writing to + verb · I am writing with regard to + noun · Following up on our conversation, ...	I am writing to request the Q3 figures.
Requests	Could you please + verb · I would be grateful if you could + verb · I would appreciate it if you could + verb	I would be grateful if you could send it by Wednesday.
Report findings	passive (<i>was distributed, were found to</i>) · nominalization (<i>a decline in</i>) · figures in brackets	Swaps were found to take an average of four days.
Recommendations	It is recommended / advised / proposed that + subject + base verb (subjunctive, Lesson 1.3)	It is recommended that the form be replaced. ✗ ...that the form is replaced (British, acceptable)
Cover letter	evidence (<i>In my current role..., I reduced / led / trained...</i>) + relevance (<i>...which would allow me to... / Your posting emphasizes..., and...</i>)	I reduced repeat calls by 15 percent, and your posting emphasizes quality.

Pronunciation. This class's pronunciation is **the read-aloud test**: a text that sounds curt, pleading or pompous aloud will read that way too. Model reading an email aloud: a polite request rises gently at the end of *Could you please...?* and falls on the deadline ("by **Wednesday** ↘"). Word stress: **RÉ**sumé /'rezəmeɪ/, re**SPON**dent, recommen**DAT**ion, ad**VERT**isement (US also /ædvər'taɪzmənt/), **PUR**pose (not pur-**POSE**). Weak forms in formulae: "I'd be **grate**ful if you could /kəd/ **send** it."

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- Formula match** (flashcards): T: "You're sending a document." → S: "Please find attached..." T: "You spoke yesterday." → S: "Following up on our conversation..." T: "First contact, asking for information." → S: "I am writing to inquire about..." Choral, then individuals.
- Report register**: T reads a chatty note, S gives the report sentence: T: "We asked everyone." → S: "A survey was distributed to all staff." T: "Most people hated the form." → S: "A majority of respondents described the form as difficult." T: "Get rid of the form." → S: "It is recommended that the form be replaced."
- Soften, don't bury**: T gives a bare command; S makes it polite but keeps the deadline: T: "Send the figures Friday." → S: "Could you please send the figures by Friday?" T: "Call me back." → S: "I would be grateful if you could call me back today."
- Evidence, not adjectives** (open pairs): S1 says a boastful sentence ("I'm a brilliant organizer."); S2 turns it into evidence ("I organized a conference for 200 people, on budget."). Then closed pairs, 1 minute. Learners may invent.

◆ THE READER PANEL – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ **Why aloud, and why someone else's voice?** Hearing your text in another person's voice exposes tone instantly: curtness, pleading, stiffness, and the moment the reader loses interest.
- ◆ **Reader cards (B)** are the information gap. Each job posting has a hiring-manager card; the report has a director card. They reveal what that reader really cares about ("I have 80 applications. If the first paragraph doesn't name the role and one concrete reason, I stop."). The writer (A) didn't know this, which is exactly the point about reader-focus.
- ◆ **Sequence** (per text, 5 min): the reader reads the text aloud (2 min) → reacts in role (2 min: what they noticed first, where they stopped or stumbled, what they would do next) → the writer notes one change (1 min). Swap.
- ◆ **Cover letters are personal.** The reader reacts only to the letter as a letter. Before the panel, say: "If you wrote as yourself and prefer not to share, swap your email instead." Never ask anyone to read a cover letter to the whole class.

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE READER PANEL

SAY: *Who reads your text aloud: you or your partner? (My partner.) · Is the reader reacting as themselves? (No: as the person on the reader card.) · Can the writer explain what they meant? (No, just listen and take notes.) · How many changes do you note? (At least one.) · If your cover letter is personal, what can you do? (Swap the email instead.)*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Give a **skeleton** for the chosen genre: the email with gaps (Subject: _____ · Dear _____, · I am writing to _____. · Could you please _____ by _____? · Thank you. · Best regards,). For the report, three headings and one sentence frame each ("____% of respondents reported that..." · "These findings suggest that..." · "It is recommended that..."). For the cover letter, the opening and closing are given; the learner writes one evidence + relevance paragraph (3 sentences). The email in Ex 1 is enough as the main product; the report/cover letter can be finished at home.

STRETCH (TOWARD C2)

Write **both** the report and a 60-word email to the director that *summarizes* it (same content, two registers). Then write a reply to a **difficult** email: a customer complaint in which the company is partly at fault (acknowledge, apologize precisely, state the remedy, without admitting more than the facts show). For the cover letter: cut it to 180 words without losing a single achievement (preview of Lesson 8.2, precision and concision).

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **Indirect, context-first requests:** learners from high-context business cultures (e.g. Japan, Korea, China, parts of South and Southeast Asia, the Middle East) and from very polite letter traditions (Spanish, Portuguese, Arabic, Persian) may place the request after a long courteous preamble. Present purpose-first as a **convention of US workplace email**, not as more polite or more honest; warmth can still come in the closing.
- ◆ **Regional business English:** South Asian and West African English use *Kindly do the needful*, *Please revert (back)*, *Respected Sir*, *Please find the attached herewith*; Philippine English often opens with *Good day!* These are correct in their own contexts. Explain that US readers may find them unfamiliar, and offer equivalents (*Could you please...*, *Please reply*, *Dear Mr. ...*).
- ◆ **Titles and names:** *Dear Karen Liu* (full name), *Dear Mrs. Carter* (marital status assumed), *Dear Ms. Karen* (title + first name: common in Tagalog, Spanish and Arabic usage). Teach *Ms. + family name*, or first name only once invited.
- ◆ **German, Dutch and Hebrew speakers** may write requests that sound curt in English ("Send me the file until Friday."). Also *until* for *by* (German *bis*, Spanish *hasta*, Portuguese *até*): "by Friday" = no later than; "until Friday" = continuously up to.
- ◆ **Cover-letter conventions differ:** in some countries a photo, age, marital status or nationality is expected, and modesty formulas are obligatory. In the US these are left out (and some are legally sensitive). Explain the convention; never frame it as a language error.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 6.3: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-c1/lesson_18.html. Listen to the five model sentences with 🎧 and say them back; do Exercises 1–3, the Quick Quiz and the "Write One Real Professional Text" project (if it's real, send it). Workbook 6.3: Ex 3 and Ex 5; a clean final version of the report or cover letter, revised after the reader panel, and self-assessed with the rubric (circle a band for each row); "My new words" and the journal.

◆ CHECK – SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 C "I would be grateful if you could send the figures by Friday." · Q2 B "I led a team of four and delivered the project two weeks ahead of schedule." · Q3 (new) B "Dear Ms. Carter," ... "Sincerely,". Voicemail (Ex 1): to the four Receiving team leaders (Dev, Maria, Olu, Chris) · trial starts Monday, March 3 · two volunteers each by noon Thursday · training Wednesday 2–3 p.m., Conference Room B, please confirm · cc Karen Liu. Ex 2: inquire · attached · Following up · grateful · do not hesitate · look forward. Ex 5: B C H C B H.

CLOSING THE MODULE

END OF C19: MODULE 6 WRAP-UP

Recap on slide 18, "take it apart, build it, put it to work": **claim · evidence · warrant · "She concedes..., but downplays..."** (take it apart) → **thesis · PEEL · concede → rebut · no new points** (build it) → **purpose first · findings → recommendations · evidence + relevance** (put it to work). Learners tick the three "I can..." lists. Anything still unticked goes on a sticky note for you; the essays you collected in C19 show you which rubric rows need a revisit.

Marking the essays. Return the C18 essays in C20 with a rubric score and **one** comment per criterion. Don't correct every error: underline up to five, and write the category in the margin (*art · splice · reg · conn*) so learners fix them themselves. Praise one sentence explicitly.

Watch for in Modules 7 and 8: the C17 seminar roles return in **Lesson 7.3** (seminar and discussion skills): same Chair / Devil's Advocate structure, now with live turn-taking. Note-taking in **7.1** uses the same skeleton (claim, evidence, signposts) applied to a lecture. **Lesson 8.2** (precision and concision) edits the texts learners wrote here: keep their essays and cover letters. The **8.3 review project** is a position paper and its oral defense: the thesis, concede → rebut and evidence standards of this module are its assessment criteria, and the essay rubric in the workbook is its basis.

Final assessment (C26) includes a C1 writing task and a reading section. From this module it tests: identifying claims, evidence types and common fallacies in a short opinion text; describing a writer's moves with precise verbs; thesis quality; connectors matched to logic; concession and rebuttal; purpose-first professional email; report register (*It is recommended that... be...*).

Module 7 — Listening, Speaking & Delivery

Three workshop classes about live spoken English: taking it in, giving it out, and managing it with other people. First, a **lecture-listening and note-taking lab**: learners hear a five-minute signposted mini-lecture twice, take Cornell notes, answer comprehension and inference questions and write a summary a classmate reviews. Then a **pronunciation and intonation workshop**: sentence stress and weak forms, thought groups and pausing, tonic placement and contrastive stress, and intonation for attitude, practiced by shadowing marked-up scripts. Last, a **seminar**: learners discuss an assigned reading in fixed roles (**facilitator, summarizer, challenger**) and practice turn-taking, building on others' points and respectful challenge.

3 lessons

Lessons 7.1–7.3

Classes C20–C22

Weeks 10–11

90 min per class

CEFR C1

HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

- One lesson block = one 90-minute class. The usual shape still applies: **warmer** → **lead-in** → **Meaning / Form / Pronunciation** with concept-checking questions (CCQs) → **drill** → **controlled practice** → **freer practice** → **feedback** with delayed error correction → **homework**. These are **skills classes**, though, so plan each one as a **workshop**. There is less new language and more doing: listening twice, marking scripts, shadowing, discussing, then reflecting on how it went.
- The **stage plan** is your clock. Each one adds up to 90 minutes. The numbers in the Time column are minutes.
- Present from `slides/module-7-delivery.html`. Print `materials/module-7/classroom-materials.html` before C20. It holds the flashcards, the new identity cards, the **Cornell notes sheet**, the **Pass the Notes** mini-talk cards, the **One Sentence, Many Meanings** and **attitude** cards, the **seminar pack** (reading cards, role cards, move cards, observer sheet), the **Signpost Bingo** game and every script you read aloud, including the mini-lecture.
- The online lessons are the learners' **homework and review**. Each one has  Listen buttons and a  audio control (US or UK voice, slower speed). In this module that audio is especially useful: learners can shadow the model sentences at home.
- You are the recording.** The mini-lecture (C20) and the marked-up scripts (C21) are written to be read by you. Practice the lecture aloud once before class, with a timer: it should take **about five minutes** at a relaxed lecturing pace (about 650 words at 130–140 words a minute). Read it like a real lecturer, not like a dictation.

Stress the signposts, pause at section breaks, and let the weak forms be weak. If a colleague with a different accent can record it for you, even better: C1 listeners need more than one voice.

- ◆ **Feedback on range, accuracy and appropriacy.** In every freer task, take notes in three columns: **range** (ambitious language to praise and spread: "*the upshot is*," "*I'd take that one step further*"), **accuracy** (errors to fix: "*discuss about*," "*I am agree*," a rising statement) and **appropriacy** (correct English that lands wrong: a blunt "No, that's wrong," a paraphrase that sounds sarcastic, a fall-rise where the learner meant full agreement). At C1 the third column matters most. In the feedback stage, put 1–2 of each on the board without names.
- ◆ **Dominant speakers.** The roles are built for this. In C20 give a dominant learner the job of **summary reviewer**; in C21 the **coach** in the delivery clinic, who listens and marks up and doesn't perform; in C22 the **summarizer** or the **observer**, not the challenger. The seminar **move cards** limit airtime without singling anyone out: when your cards are gone, you may only speak to hand over to someone else. Say it kindly and generally: "Great discussions have lots of voices. Let's hear from someone who hasn't come in yet."
- ◆ **Quiet learners.** Many strong C1 learners go silent in groups because they don't know how to get in, not because they have nothing to say (lesson 7.3 says exactly this). Give quiet learners the **facilitator** role: the role is to hand over by name, so they speak often without having to argue. Warn them privately the class before if you can.
- ◆ **Stretching strong learners toward C2.** Each lesson has a stretch box. The C2 direction for this module is **implication and control**: hearing what a speaker implies but doesn't say (C20), using prosody deliberately for irony, diplomacy and emphasis (C21), and managing a discussion so smoothly that nobody notices you are doing it (C22).
- ◆ **American English is the classroom standard.** The online lessons use British spellings and words (*recognise*, *summarise*, *organised*, *centre*, *neighbourhood*, *pavement*, *car park*, *flats*, *high street*, *practise* as a verb). Teach *recognize*, *summarize*, *organized*, *center*, *neighborhood*, *sidewalk*, *parking lot*, *apartments*, *Main Street* / *downtown shops*, *practice*. The online audio lets learners choose a US or UK voice; either is fine, but model American stress and weak forms in class (for example *for* /fə/, or /ə/). Accept British forms when learners use them.
- ◆ Dashed boxes = lines to say out loud, CCQs and ICQs (instruction-checking questions). Green boxes = scripts you read aloud. **Amber** = watch-outs.

THE THROUGH-LINE

Take it in → give it out → share the floor. In C20 learners listen to a talk as a **structure**: they hear the signposts, separate the claim from the example and put the argument on a page as a map, not a transcript. In C21 they turn the same knowledge around and make their **own** speech easy to follow: stress the words that matter, pause at meaning boundaries, fall to sound certain and fall-rise to sound diplomatic. In C22 they use both skills with other people: listening closely enough to **build on** and **paraphrase** what others said, and delivering challenge with the melody that keeps it respectful. The C20 mini-lecture comes back in C21 as a shadowing script, and its topic (how we learn) is one of the C22 seminar readings. Tell learners this: it shows them the module is one skill seen from three sides.

TRAUMA-INFORMED: ASSIGNED SIDES, OPTIONAL RECORDINGS, ACCENTS ARE WELCOME

Opinions are assigned. Every seminar reading gives two positions, and every contributor card assigns one. Learners argue the card, not themselves, so nobody has to reveal a personal view. The topics stay in the workplace, education, technology, health habits and city life. Don't swap in party politics, religion, immigration policy or national comparisons ("In your country, how...?"). **Pronunciation work can feel exposing.** At C1 it touches identity: "my voice," "my accent." Say explicitly (lesson 7.2 does too) that the goal is **clear rhythm and melody, not a different accent.** Never imitate a learner's accent, even affectionately. Recording is homework and is **optional in class**: learners who don't want to hear their own voice in front of others can shadow quietly with you or a partner instead. **Listening and memory:** the mini-lecture is about how we learn and forget. It's upbeat and practical, but some learners have had interrupted schooling. Frame the topic as "a tool for this course," never as "why you did badly before." For every personal task (the journal, the talk you choose for homework), offer three choices out loud: **your real life**, **a new identity card**, or **something invented**.

BEFORE THE MODULE

- ◆ Print the **flashcards** (one set for the board): the signpost-function cards and note symbols (C20), the prosody cards (C21) and the discussion-move cards, color-coded by function (C22). Cut them before C20.
- ◆ For C20: one **Cornell notes sheet** per learner (two if you want them to redo it for homework), and the **Signpost Bingo** cards (one per learner, four versions) if you have time at the end or want a C21 warmer. **Rehearse the mini-lecture** (Script 7.1-A) aloud with a timer.
- ◆ For C21: the **Pass the Notes** mini-talk cards (warmer, one card per pair), the **One Sentence, Many Meanings** cards and **attitude** cards (one set per pair), and the marked-up shadowing scripts, which are also in the workbook. Learners who have phones may record themselves for homework; nobody has to record in class.
- ◆ For C22: the **seminar pack**. For each group of 5–6, one **reading card** (the same reading for everyone in the group), one set of **role cards**, one set of **move cards** (four per learner) and an **observer sheet**. Decide the groups in advance: mix first languages, and spread strong, quiet and dominant speakers across groups.
- ◆ Print the **new identity cards** and keep them on a side table where anyone can take one without asking.
- ◆ Optional: a phone timer with a gentle sound for the seminar rounds, and a small object for each group (a pen or a card) to act as a talking token if a group needs it.

MODULE AT A GLANCE

LESSON	CLASS	FOCUS	LEARNERS CAN...
7.1	C20 • wk 10	Lecture-listening and note-taking lab. Top-down listening; signposting (previewing, sequencing, examples, emphasis, digression,	follow a five-minute signposted talk, take structured Cornell notes, answer comprehension

LESSON	CLASS	FOCUS	LEARNERS CAN...
		recap); main idea vs detail; predicting from discourse cues and catching stance (hedging and boosting); keyword notes with abbreviations, symbols and hierarchy; the Cornell layout; a five-minute mini-lecture heard twice (chunked, then at natural speed)	and inference questions, and write a 3–4-sentence summary of claim, support and conclusion that a partner reviews
7.2	C21 · wk 11	Pronunciation and intonation workshop. Stress-timing; sentence stress and weak forms; thought groups , chunking and pausing; tonic placement (stress the new, de-stress the given) and contrastive stress ; intonation for attitude (fall, rise, fall-rise; avoiding uptalk); linking; shadowing marked-up scripts	mark up a short text for stress, pauses and intonation, shadow a model, and deliver a 60–90-second extract clearly enough that a coach can confirm the stress, pauses and falls
7.3	C22 · wk 11	Seminar and discussion skills. Turn-taking (coming in, holding the floor, handing over); building on others' points; clarifying and paraphrasing ; respectful challenge (acknowledge → soften → challenge); finding common ground; steering and summarizing ; seminar roles: facilitator , summarizer , challenger	take part in a 12-minute seminar on an assigned reading in a set role, using at least four discussion-management moves, including one build-on, one paraphrase and one respectful challenge

7.1 · C20

Understanding Lectures & Talks — Following & Note-taking

90 min

◆ OBJECTIVES — LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ recognize **signposting** language and say what each phrase predicts: a preview (*This talk falls into three parts*), a sequence (*That brings me to my second point*), an example (*A case in point is...*), emphasis (*Crucially... · I can't stress this enough*), a digression (*As an aside... · I won't dwell on...*) or a recap (*To recap... · The upshot is...*)
- ◆ separate a **main idea** from its **supporting detail** in real time, and ask "an example of what?"
- ◆ use discourse cues to **predict** (*It's widely believed that...* → a reversal is coming) and hear the speaker's **stance** (*one explanation is* = hedged; *one of the most reliable findings* = boosted)
- ◆ take **structured notes**: keywords, stable abbreviations and symbols, indentation, and the Cornell layout (notes, cues, summary)
- ◆ write a **3–4-sentence summary** of a talk (claim, support, conclusion, no examples) and review a partner's summary against a checklist

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 7.1 (New words, Language box, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, Listening Lab with Cornell page, summary and peer review)
- ◆ Slides 3–7 · Signpost-function flashcards + note-symbol cards · **Cornell notes sheet** (1 per learner) · New identity cards · **Signpost Bingo** (optional, for the end or for C21)
- ◆ Listening scripts 7.1-A (the mini-lecture, *Why Cramming Fails*, about five minutes) and 7.1-B (signpost dictation)

BOARD PLAN

Left: the road signs. PREVIEW *This talk falls into three parts* → draw the map · SEQUENCE *That brings me to...* → new heading · EXAMPLE *A case in point is...* → indent, keep it short · EMPHASIS *Crucially...* · *here's the crucial part* → ★ write it fully · ASIDE *As an aside... · I won't dwell on...* → skip · RECAP *To recap... · The upshot is...* → the exam answer.

Center: predict. *It's widely believed that...* → "...but in fact" · *Now, you might think...* → objection + answer · *So why does this matter?* → main idea next · Stance: *arguably, one explanation is* (hedge) vs *clearly, one of the most reliable* (boost).

Right: the Cornell page. A narrow left column (CUES: questions, keywords, added after) · a wide right column (NOTES: taken live) · a strip along the bottom (SUMMARY: from memory). Symbols: → leads to · ↑ ↓ rise / fall · = is · ≠ is not · ∴ therefore · b/c because · w/ with · e.g. · ★ stressed · ? check.

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: the subject-line game	7	S-S	Review C19 (6.3, professional writing). Board: three weak email subject lines ("Question," "Meeting," "Hi!"). Pairs rewrite each as a precise, professional subject line (<i>Request: budget figures for Q3 report by Friday</i>), then tell a partner the three-part structure of the report or email they wrote for homework (purpose, key points, action). Note one register error and one well-chosen phrase for the feedback stage.
Lead-in: bricks or blueprint?	5	T-S	Slide 3. Ask: "When you listen to a long talk in English, what happens in your head when you miss a word?" Collect answers (panic, lose the next three sentences, give up). Introduce the lesson's image: reading every brick vs reading the blueprint. "Today you're going to listen to the shape of a talk, and you'll hear a five-minute lecture twice."
Signposting	12	T-S → S-S	Slide 4. Stick the function flashcards (PREVIEW, SEQUENCE, EXAMPLE, EMPHASIS, ASIDE, RECAP) across the board. Read Script 7.1-B (the signpost dictation) one line at a time; learners hold up fingers or say the function, and you stick a phrase strip under the right card. Then workbook Ex 1 in pairs. Meaning and CCQs (below): which two categories matter most to a listener, and why?
Drill: say the signpost	5	T-S → S	Signposts are only useful if learners recognize their sound at speed. Drill five of them with lecture stress and a pause after (see Drill script), choral then individual. Then "prediction ping-pong": you say a cue, learners say what's coming (Slide 5, then Workbook Ex 2 orally in pairs).
Note-taking techniques	8	T-S → S	Slide 6. Show the gap between a sentence and a note: "climate change is causing an increase in migration" → <i>climate → migration</i> ↑. Elicit symbols and abbreviations learners already use (in any language). Each learner fixes a personal shorthand of five symbols and five abbreviations in the workbook box, which they must keep stable for today, and tries it on Workbook Ex 4, items 1–3. Show the Cornell layout and hand out the Cornell sheet.
Pre-listening	5	T-S → S-S	Show the title: " Why Cramming Fails. " Pairs predict three things the lecturer will say, from the title alone. Pre-teach only three items (slide 7): <i>to cram</i> , <i>retrieval</i> (getting

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			information out of memory) and <i>the spacing effect</i> . Everything else learners must ride past, which is the point of the lab.
Listening 1: chunked	9	S	Read Script 7.1-A at a slightly slower lecturing pace, stopping at each mark for about 30 seconds of note time (there are four). Learners take notes on the right side of the Cornell sheet only. No questions yet, no repeats.
Compare & cue	5	S-S	Pairs compare notes: "What were the three parts? What did she stress?" They mark gaps with "?" and write 4-6 cue questions in the left column (<i>Forgetting curve</i> = ? · <i>Why does spacing work?</i>). Circulate: are the notes hierarchical, or are they sentences?
Listening 2: natural speed	6	S	Read the whole script again, without pauses, at natural speed (about five minutes). Learners fill the "?" gaps in a different color. Tell them before you start: "This time, like a real lecture. No stops."
Comprehension & inference	8	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 5, Part B: six comprehension questions (from the notes only, don't look at the script) and six inference questions (stance, implication, why the speaker said something). Pairs discuss the inference questions; then open-class check on 3-4 of them. Push for evidence: "Which words told you?"
Freer: summary & peer review	10	S → S-S	Each learner writes the Cornell summary strip, then a 3-4-sentence summary of the talk in the workbook (5 min): the speaker's claim, the key support, the conclusion, no examples . Pairs swap and review with the peer-review checklist (see "how to run it"), giving one "keep" and one "change" (4 min). One or two volunteers read theirs aloud (1 min).
Feedback	5	T-S	Delayed correction, three columns. Accuracy: "The lecture was about the cramming." · "She said that we must to test ourself." Appropriacy: a summary that is really a list of examples (Ebbinghaus, two students, the 2006 study) with no claim. Range to praise: " <i>The upshot is that...</i> ," " <i>she concedes that..., but argues...</i> ".

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Show online lesson 7.1 on screen and point at a  button and the  control. Set the homework (below). Learners tick the "I can..." box in the workbook.
Total	90		7 + 5 + 12 + 5 + 8 + 5 + 9 + 5 + 6 + 8 + 10 + 5 + 5

◆ MEANING • FORM • PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: top-down listening. A fluent listener uses knowledge of how talks are built (preview, points, recap) to predict and slot content in. Missing a word is normal; losing the structure is the real problem.

SAY: "You missed one word in the middle of point two." Is that a disaster? (No.) What do you do? (Let it go and listen for the next signpost.) · "The speaker said, 'This talk falls into three parts.'" How many things are you listening for? (Three.) What should you do on your page? (Leave space for three.)

Meaning: the signpost functions.

SAY: "As an aside, I won't dwell on his methods." Will this come back later? (No.) Should you write it down? (No: it's optional.) · "The upshot is that walkability is a public-health strategy." Is this new information or a summary? (A summary of the main idea.) Where does it go in your notes? (At the top of the takeaways, starred.) · "A case in point is the post-war suburb." Is this the claim or the example? (The example.) What's the question to ask? ("An example of what?")

Meaning: prediction and stance.

SAY: "It's widely believed that the more hours you put in, the more you remember..." What word are you waiting for? (But.) Does the speaker agree with the belief? (Only partly.) · "One explanation is that a little forgetting is useful." Is the speaker sure? (No: it's one possible explanation, a hedge.) · "It's one of the most reliable findings in psychology." Is the speaker sure now? (Yes: a booster.)

Meaning: main idea vs detail. The recap test: would this survive into the speaker's summary? Main ideas are flagged, stressed and repeated; details come in bunches, arrive with *for instance*, and are said once.

SAY: "Both students study for three hours. One crams, one spaces it out." Is this the main idea? (No, it's an example.) What's the main idea it supports? (When you study matters as much as how long.) · You remember the story but not the point. What did you keep? (The packaging.) What did you lose? (The content.)

Form: the language of notes.

Keywords	nouns, main verbs, numbers; drop articles, auxiliaries and filler	"memory fades fast: > ½ lost in 1 day"
-----------------	---	--

Symbols	→ leads to · ↑ ↓ · = · ≠ · ∴ therefore · & · ★ stressed · ? check	spacing → stronger memory
Abbreviations	stable, personal, decided in advance	b/c · w/ · e.g. · info · impt · govt · approx.
Hierarchy	main points flush left, detail indented under them	2. spacing ★ – e.g. 3 hrs Sun vs M/W/F
Cornell	right = live notes · left = cues added after · bottom = summary from memory	cue: "Why does spacing work?"

Form: the summary. Reporting verbs and neutral register: *The speaker argues / maintains / concedes / concludes that...* One sentence for the claim, one or two for the support, one for the conclusion. Present simple is normal for summarizing a talk (*She argues that...*).

Pronunciation: what signposts sound like. Lecturers stress the content word in a signpost and pause after it: "That brings me to my **second** point ||," "But here's the **crucial** part ||," "So, to **recap** ||." Learners from syllable-timed languages often expect every word to be clear. Show them that *to*, *my*, *the* and *that* are tiny (/tə/, /mə/, /ðə/, /ðət/) and the stressed syllable is the thing to catch. Emphasis is often carried by **slowing down** and a **higher pitch** as much as by the words: "I can't **stress** this enough."

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 Say it like a lecturer** (choral, then individuals): "This talk falls into **three** parts ||" · "That brings me to my **second** point ||" · "A case in **point** is... ||" · "But here's the **crucial** part ||" · "So, to **recap** ||." Tap the stressed syllable on the desk; exaggerate the pause.
- 2 Function flash:** T says a signpost; S says the function. T: "I won't dwell on this." → S: "Aside." T: "Turning to my third reason..." → S: "Sequence." T: "The upshot is..." → S: "Recap." Fast.
- 3 Prediction ping-pong** (Slide 5): T: "On the one hand..." → S: "On the other hand." T: "There are two problems with this." → S: "Problem one... problem two." T: "Now, you might think..." → S: "An objection, then the answer." T: "It's often assumed that..." → S: "But actually..."
- 4 Sentence to note:** T reads a sentence; S says the note aloud in keywords. T: "Remote work is causing city-center apartment prices to fall." → S: "remote work → city-center prices down." T: "This is not about laziness; it's about design." → S: "not laziness, design ★."
- 5 Open pairs → closed pairs:** S1 reads a sentence from Workbook Ex 4; S2 compresses it into a note aloud. Then all pairs, 1 minute.

◆ THE LISTENING LAB – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ **Before you read.** Everyone has a Cornell sheet and their personal shorthand. Say: "You will hear the lecture twice. The first time I'll stop four times so you can write. The second time is natural speed, with no stops. You won't catch every word, and that's normal."

- ◆ **Listening 1 (chunked).** Read Script 7.1-A at a relaxed lecturing pace, a little slower than natural. At each || mark, stop, say "Thirty seconds," and wait. Don't repeat, don't explain. Look at the notes as you walk around: sentences mean the learner is transcribing; a clear 1 · 2 · 3 means they have heard the preview.
- ◆ **Compare & cue (5 min).** Pairs compare, mark gaps with "?" and write cue questions in the left column. This is where the learning happens: they have to decide what the main points were.
- ◆ **Listening 2 (natural speed).** Read the whole script again, straight through, at your normal speaking speed. Keep the signpost stress and the pauses at section breaks, but don't slow down for learners. Learners fill gaps in a second color. Afterwards ask: "What did you catch the second time that you missed the first time? Which signposts helped?"
- ◆ **Questions.** Comprehension first (from notes only), then inference in pairs. Inference questions have no single sentence to point to, so ask for the **words** that support each answer.
- ◆ **Summary & peer review.** Writers have 5 minutes. Reviewers use the four-point checklist: ☐ the claim is in the first sentence · ☐ the three points are there, in order · ☐ no examples, names or dates · ☐ the conclusion is the speaker's, not the writer's opinion. The reviewer gives **one "keep"** (a sentence or phrase that works) and **one "change"** (a specific, doable edit), and says them in that order. Put the protocol on the board: "Keep: ... · Change: ... · Because: ..."
- ◆ **Roles.** A dominant speaker can be the **reviewer** for two pairs (they must listen and read before they talk). A learner who struggled with the notes can summarize from a partner's notes: it's still a summary.

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE LISTENING LAB

SAY: *How many times will you hear the lecture? (Twice.) · Will I stop the first time? (Yes, four times.) The second time? (No, natural speed.) · Full sentences or keywords? (Keywords and symbols.) · Which column do you write in while you listen? (The right, the wide one.) · When do you fill the left column? (After listening, with your partner.) · In your summary, do you include the examples? (No, only the claim, the points and the conclusion.)*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Give a **pre-structured** Cornell sheet: write "Thesis:", "1.", "2.", "3.", "Recap:" down the notes column before class, so the learner fills slots rather than building the hierarchy. Allow notes in their first language or with drawings: the notes are for them. For the questions, do comprehension items 1–4 only, orally with you or a partner. For the summary, give a frame: "The speaker argues that _____. First, _____. Second, _____. Third, _____. She concludes that _____. Target: the three main points in the right order.

STRETCH (TOWARD C2)

Ask for **stance and implication**, not only content: "Where does the lecturer concede a point? Where is she ironic? What does she imply about students who say 'but I read my notes five times'?" Ask strong learners to take the second listening **without** the first (turn the paper over and start a clean page) and compare. Early finishers write a **one-sentence** summary (under 30 words), then a one-sentence critique: "The talk assumes that... but it doesn't address..."

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **Waiting to hear every word clearly.** Speakers of syllable-timed languages (Spanish, Portuguese, Italian, French, Tagalog, Turkish, Japanese, Cantonese) are used to each syllable being audible, so reduced function words sound like "missing" language, and they stop to look for it. Teach them to listen for the stressed syllables and accept that the small words are small.
- ◆ **Note-taking in full sentences.** Learners from education systems that value copying the teacher's words (many, not only one region) transcribe. The fix is the rule "no verb *be*, no articles." Praise the ugliest, most efficient notes.
- ◆ **Summary with "the" and "about":** "The lecture is about the cramming." Arabic, French, Spanish and Portuguese speakers overuse *the* with general nouns; Russian, Chinese, Japanese and Korean speakers may drop it where it's needed ("Speaker argues..."). Keep it light: one board example.
- ◆ **Reporting verbs + infinitive:** "She suggests us to test ourselves." Review from B2: *suggests testing ourselves / suggests (that) we test ourselves*.
- ◆ **Summaries that judge.** In some academic traditions a summary includes the writer's evaluation. At this stage, ask for the speaker's argument only; evaluation belongs in a separate sentence ("In my view...").

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 7.1: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-c1/lesson_19.html. Listen to the five model sentences with 📻 and say them back with the lecture stress; do Exercises 1–2, the Quick Quiz and the "Listen, Note, Summarize" project (a 5–12-minute talk of the learner's choice: a podcast segment, a recorded lecture or a TED-style talk). Workbook 7.1: Exercise 3 (main idea, detail or aside?) and the rest of Exercise 4, a clean Cornell page for that talk, a 3–4-sentence summary, a list of the signposts heard (aim for six), "My new words" and the journal.

◆ CHECK — SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **C** It's a digression: optional detail you can safely skip. · Q2 **A** Write keywords in a hierarchy, not full sentences. · Q3 (new) **B** The speaker will raise an objection and then answer it. Listening Lab (Ex 5) key points: thesis = cramming is inefficient; spacing and self-testing make a big difference · 1 forgetting: over half lost within a day; review flattens the curve · 2 spacing beats cramming the same hours · 3 testing yourself beats rereading ★ (the point she values most) · recap: study at intervals and test yourself; "close your notes and see what you can remember." Full answers in the answer key.

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: Pass the Notes	8	S-S	Review C20. Pairs, one Pass the Notes card each. A gives a 90-second signposted mini-talk from the skeleton on the card (preview, three points, recap); B takes Cornell-style keyword notes, then summarizes the talk back in two sentences; A confirms or corrects. Swap. Listen for signposts and note one strong example for later.
Lead-in: which is easier to follow?	5	T-S	Say one sentence twice: first with equal stress on every syllable, like a robot ("I-WOULD-LIKE-TO-BOOK-A-TA-BLE..."), then naturally. "Which one was easier to follow? Why?" Elicit: the beats tell you what matters. Slide 8: "Prosody isn't decoration: it carries meaning." Remind learners: the goal is clear rhythm and melody, not a different accent .
Sentence stress & weak forms	10	T-S → S	Slides 8-9. Tap the beats on the desk: "I'd LIKE to BOOK a TABLE for TWO at EIGHT." Learners tap and say it. Then the "same time" demo: "I'll TELL you" vs "I would have been going to TELL you" fit into roughly the same beats. Weak-form table: choral, then individual. CCQs (below).
Thought groups & pausing	7	T-S → S-S	Slide 10. "Let's eat, Grandma" / "Let's eat Grandma" (let them laugh). Then the brother pair (one brother or several?). Pairs do Workbook Ex 3 aloud, marking / at meaning boundaries, then say each sentence with a small pitch step at each /.
Tonic & contrastive stress	10	T-S → S-S	Slide 11. "Stress the new, de-stress the given" with two quick Q&A pairs. Then "I didn't say she took it": read Script 7.2-C ; learners call out the meaning (A-F on the slide). Then pairs play One Sentence, Many Meanings : A says the card's sentence with stress on one word; B chooses the meaning from the list on the card. Swap after three.
Intonation for attitude	9	T-S → S-S	Slide 12. Fall, rise, fall-rise. Model "It's a good idea ↘" (agreement) vs "It's a good idea ↘ ↗..." (doubt); learners say which. Then the uptalk trap: "I finished the report ↗? And sent it ↗?" How does this person sound in a job interview? Pairs play the attitude cards: A reads a line in the attitude on the card, B guesses the attitude.
Controlled practice	7	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 1, 2, 4 and 5 (mark the beats, choose the stressed word, stress the new, match the pattern). Pairs check by saying

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			each answer aloud, not only by comparing pages. Board-check the disagreements.
Shadowing lab	9	T-S → S-S	Read Script 7.2-A (Sam and Alex, marked up in the workbook) line by line; learners shadow half a second behind you, copying the stress and the arrows, not just the words. Then pairs shadow each other (A reads Sam, B reads Alex, swap). Focus on the two key moves: the contrastive stress on / vs <i>MARCUS</i> , and the fall-rise on "It's Friday ↘ ↗ ... in theory."
Freer: Delivery Clinic	15	S → S-S-S	Groups of 3: speaker, coach, listener . Each learner marks up a 60–90-second text (the recap of the C20 lecture, Script 7.2-B, or the summary they wrote in C20, or an extract of a talk from their homework): CAPITALS for stress, / for pauses, arrows for groups that end a statement. (5 min.) Then rounds of 3 minutes: the speaker delivers; the coach follows on the speaker's marked-up page and fills the coach's checklist; the listener says in one sentence what the main point was. Rotate. ICQs first.
Feedback	5	T-S	Board, no names. Accuracy: a strong, long "TO" or "OF"; a pause after "the." Appropriacy: a fall-rise heard as sarcasm, or a rising statement that undercut a confident point. Range to praise: a well-placed contrast ("It's not impossible , it's difficult "), a clean rise-rise-fall list.
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Show online lesson 7.2 and the  control (slow speed; US or UK voice). Set the homework (below): recording is recommended but private. Learners tick "I can...".
Total	90		8 + 5 + 10 + 7 + 10 + 9 + 7 + 9 + 15 + 5 + 5

◆ MEANING • FORM • PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: stress-timing. In English the stressed syllables come at roughly regular intervals; everything between them is squeezed to fit. Weak forms are correct, standard pronunciation, and they make the stressed words stand out.

SAY: "I want *TO* go." Is a strong *TO* clearer? (No, it sounds less natural and pulls the focus to the wrong word.) · Which words carry the meaning in "I'd like to book a table for two"? (like, book, table, two.) Which words are weak? (I'd, to, a, for.) · Is a weak form lazy? (No, it's standard.)

Meaning: thought groups. Speech arrives in chunks of meaning with a small pause and a pitch movement at the end of each. Pause placement works like punctuation.

SAY: "My brother, / who lives in Rome, / is a chef." How many brothers? (One; the Rome part is extra information.) · "My brother who lives in Rome / is a chef." How many brothers? (More than one: this one, the Rome one, is a chef.) · A speaker pauses after "the" to breathe. Does it help the listener? (No: it breaks a meaning unit.)

Meaning: tonic placement and contrast. By default the tonic falls on the last content word of the group. It moves forward to new or contrasted information, and **given** information is de-stressed.

SAY: "Where's the report?" "It's on your DESK." Why not "It's on your desk, the RE-port"? (The report is already known; stressing it sounds like a contrast with something else.) · "I didn't say SHE took it." Did someone take it? (Yes.) Who? (Not her, someone else.) · "No, the RED one." What did the other person think? (Another color.)

Meaning: intonation for attitude.

SAY: "The food was nice ↘ ↗..." Did the speaker love the evening? (Not completely.) What word is hidden? (But.) · "Where do you work ↗?" with a rise. Wrong? (Not wrong, but a wh-question normally falls; a rise can sound surprised or like "Did you say...?") · "I finished the report ↗?" In an interview, how does the speaker sound? (Unsure, as if asking for approval.) · "First ↗, we book; then ↘, we pay." Why the rise? (More is coming.) Why the fall? (The list is finished.)

Form: the mark-up code (learners use it on every script this module).

CAPITALS	the stressed syllable of a content word; the tonic in bold capitals	I'd LIKE to BOOK a TAbLe.
/	a thought-group boundary (short pause, pitch step)	When it's ready / I'll let you know.
↘ ↗ ↘ ↗	fall · rise · fall-rise on the tonic at the end of a group	It's FRIday ↘ ↗...
—	link a final consonant to a following vowel	turn_it_off → "tur-ni-toff"
(ə)	a weak form	a CUP (ə)f TEA

Pronunciation: American weak forms and the *can* / *can't* contrast. In American English *can* is normally weak, /kən/ ("I can COME"), while *can't* keeps a full vowel and is often stressed, /kænt/ ("I CAN'T come"), and the final /t/ may be barely audible. Learners who pronounce both with a full vowel are heard as saying *can't*. For is /fə/, or is /ə/, and is /ən/ or just /n/ ("rock 'n' roll"). Linking: "an apple" → /əˈnæpəl/; "far away" → /fɑːəˈweɪ/ (the /r/ is always pronounced in American English, so linking is natural).

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 **Tap the beats** (choral, then individuals): T taps five even beats and says "I'd LIKE to BOOK a TABLE for TWO at EIGHT." S repeat, tapping. Then build up without changing the beat: "I'll TELL you." → "I'll have

TOLD you." → "I would have been going to TELL you." The small words get faster, not the beat slower.

- 2 **Weak-form pairs:** T: "a cup of tea" → S: "a CUP (ə)f TEA." T: "fish and chips" → S: "FISH (ə)n CHIPS." T: "I can come." → S: "I (kən) COME." T: "I can't come." → S: "I CAN'T COME."
- 3 **Stress the new:** T asks, S answers with the tonic on the new word. T: "Is the meeting on Monday?" → S: "No, it's on TUESday." T: "Did Anna send it?" → S: "No, MARco sent it." T: "Did you call or email?" → S: "I CALLED."
- 4 **Attitude switch:** T says a line and holds up an arrow card; S say it with that tune. "It's a good idea" ↘ (agreement) / ↗ (doubt). "That's fine" ↘ (really fine) / ↗ (not really). "Are you coming ↗?" / "Where are you going ↘?"
- 5 **Open pairs → closed pairs:** S1 says "I didn't say she took it" with stress on one word; S2 says the meaning. Then all pairs, 1 minute.

◆ SHADOWING & THE DELIVERY CLINIC – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ **Shadowing** means speaking along with a model, half a second behind it, copying the melody and rhythm rather than just the words. Do it first with you as the model (whole class, quietly, so nobody is exposed), then in pairs. Tell learners to **exaggerate**: over-doing the stress while it is conscious is exactly the practice stage.
- ◆ **Delivery Clinic, groups of 3.** Roles rotate: **speaker** (delivers 60–90 seconds from a marked-up page), **coach** (holds the speaker's marked-up page and the coach's checklist, ticks what happened and chooses **one** thing to change), **listener** (doesn't look at any page and says the main point in one sentence at the end: that's the real test of clarity).
- ◆ **The coach's checklist:** ☐ content words stressed, small words weak · ☐ pauses at the / marks, not in the middle of a phrase · ☐ statements end with a fall (no uptalk) · ☐ the tonic moves for contrast where marked · ☐ one fall-rise used where the text implies a "but" (if any) · ☐ pace: not rushed. **Peer feedback protocol:** the coach says one thing that worked ("Your pauses made the list really clear"), then one thing to change, **with a demonstration** ("Try 'crucially' slower, like this..."). Never more than one change per round.
- ◆ **Second try.** If time allows, the speaker repeats only the part the coach chose. The group listens for the difference. This is the lesson's key moment: learners hear that one change makes them easier to follow.
- ◆ **Coaches, not judges.** Accent is not on the checklist. If a coach comments on a sound ("your /θ/..."), redirect: "Today we're only coaching rhythm and melody."
- ◆ Give the coach role to a dominant speaker first: they have to listen with the page and give exactly one comment.

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE DELIVERY CLINIC

SAY: *How many roles? (Three: speaker, coach, listener.) · Does the listener look at the page? (No.) What does the listener say at the end? (The main point, in one sentence.) · How many changes does the coach suggest? (One.) · Does the coach talk about accent? (No, only stress, pauses and intonation.) · How long is each speaker's turn? (60–90 seconds.)*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Work with **sound first, symbols second**. Let the learner tap and hum the rhythm before marking anything. Give a pre-marked text (Script 7.2-B is fully marked up in the workbook) instead of asking them to mark their own. Reduce the mark-up code to two symbols: CAPITALS and /. In the clinic, give a 30-second extract (the last three sentences of the recap). Target: five clear beats and no pause in the middle of a phrase.

STRETCH (TOWARD C2)

Work on **prosody for irony and diplomacy**: the same words as sincere praise, faint praise (a low fall-rise) and irony (an exaggerated, slow high fall: "Oh, **great**"). Ask strong learners to mark up a paragraph from a real talk they heard for homework and explain *why* the speaker put the tonic where they did. Discuss pitch **range**: a wide range sounds engaged; a narrow, flat range can sound bored or unfriendly even with polite words. Early finishers write their own "one sentence, many meanings" card with five readings.

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **Syllable-timed rhythm** (equal weight on every syllable): Spanish, Portuguese, Italian, French, Tagalog, Turkish, Japanese, Cantonese, Mandarin, Vietnamese and many others. Learners sound clear sound-by-sound but hard to follow. The desk-tapping drill is the fix.
- ◆ **Strong forms everywhere**: learners who learned English from print pronounce *to, of, for, and, can, was* fully. Explain that full forms are for emphasis or the end of a sentence ("Who's it **for**?").
- ◆ **Stress on the last word by default**: French speakers tend to put stress on the last syllable of every group and find contrastive stress unnatural (French uses *c'est... qui* instead). Link this to C1 Lesson 2.3 (clefts): English can do the same job with voice alone.
- ◆ **Tone languages** (Mandarin, Cantonese, Vietnamese, Thai, Yoruba): pitch is part of each word, so learners may not expect it to carry attitude across a sentence, and the fall-rise can come out as a word-level tone. Practice it on one word first ("Well ↘ ↗...").
- ◆ **Flat or rising statements**: some varieties (and some learners' nerves) push statements up at the end; the listener hears uncertainty. Russian speakers often produce yes/no questions with a sharp rise-fall on the key word, which can sound like a demand in English; practice the gentle rise.
- ◆ **Vowel added to break consonant clusters**: Spanish and Portuguese "*es-tress*", Arabic and Persian "*fi-*

rist," Japanese "*su-to-re-su*." The added syllable breaks the beat. Tap the word as one beat: "STRESS."

- ◆ **Final consonants and linking:** Vietnamese, Cantonese and Thai speakers may drop final consonants, so linking ("turn_it_off") disappears too. Practice linking as a way to **keep** the final sound: it moves onto the next vowel.
- ◆ **can / can't:** everyone. Weak *can* /kən/ vs full *can't* /kænt/ in American English.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 7.2: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-c1/lesson_20.html. Shadow the five model sentences with  at the slow speed, then at normal speed; do Exercises 1–3, the Quick Quiz and the "Record, Compare, Refine" project (a 4–6-sentence passage, marked up, recorded privately, compared with the  model and re-recorded). Workbook 7.2: the "I didn't say she took it" drill in all six positions (write the meaning of each), "My new words" and the journal. Recording is recommended but private: nobody has to share it.

◆ CHECK – SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **B** like, book, table, two. · Q2 **C** Reservation: an implied "but I have doubts." · Q3 (new) **C** "No, I sent it on TUESday." (The tonic moves to the corrected, new information.) Ex 2 (choose the stressed word): 1 red · 2 table · 3 I · 4 today · 5 say · 6 (new) Marco.

◆ OBJECTIVES – LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ manage **turn-taking**: come in politely (*Could I just come in here?*), hold the floor (*If I could just finish my point...*) and hand over by name (*What are your thoughts, Priya?*)
- ◆ **build on** another speaker's point by naming or echoing it before extending it (*Building on Anna's point about training, ...*)
- ◆ **clarify and paraphrase** to check understanding (*When you say "scalable," do you mean...? · So if I understand you correctly, ...*)
- ◆ **challenge respectfully** with acknowledge → soften → challenge (*I take your point about speed, but I'm not sure we've thought through the cost*) and find common ground (*Where we do agree is...*)
- ◆ **steer and summarize** (*So where does that leave us? · So, to sum up where we are, ...*) and perform a seminar role: **facilitator, summarizer or challenger**

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 7.3 (New words, Language box, Exercises 1–5, the seminar dialogue, Seminar prep page and self-review)
- ◆ Slides 14–18 · Discussion-move flashcards (color-coded) · **Seminar pack**: reading cards (6 topics), role cards, move cards (4 per learner), observer sheet · New identity cards
- ◆ Scripts 7.3-A ("The meeting that went wrong") and 7.3-B (the four-day-week seminar, for Ex 4)

BOARD PLAN

Left: the floor. IN: *Could I just come in here? · Sorry to jump in, but...* · HOLD: *If I could just finish my point... · Just to finish my thought...* · OVER: *What are your thoughts, ___? · Does anyone see it differently? · BUILD: Building on what ___ said... · That ties in with ___'s point...* · CHECK: *When you say ___, do you mean...? · So if I understand you correctly, ...*

Center: challenge. ACKNOWLEDGE *I take your point about ___, → SOFTEN but I'm not sure → CHALLENGE we've thought through ___. · Up to a point, yes, but... · Isn't there a risk that...? · Where we do agree is...* · Say it with a fall-rise on the acknowledgment: "I take your **point** ↘ ↗..."

Right: roles. FACILITATOR opens, hands over by name, keeps time, refocuses · SUMMARIZER tracks the thread; summarizes at half time and at the end · CHALLENGER tests every claim respectfully ("What's the evidence?") · CONTRIBUTORS argue the side on their card · OBSERVER tallies moves; gives feedback. **Steer:** *So where does that leave us? · Shall we move on?*

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: stress the new	7	S-S	Review C21. Pairs, correction chain : A makes a deliberately wrong statement about the class or the course ("The seminar is on Monday."); B corrects with contrastive stress ("No, it's on THUR Sday."); A corrects something else in B's sentence, and so on. Then 2-3 learners say "It's a good idea" with a fall and a fall-rise; the class says which is which. Note one good contrast and one uptalk example.
Lead-in: the meeting that went wrong	10	T-S → S-S	Read Script 7.3-A (change voices or give the parts to three confident learners). Everyone has good ideas; nothing works. Pairs list what went wrong (talking over, no links, blunt "No, that's wrong," nobody checks what "flexible" means, no summary, one person silent). Elicit onto the board as the five skill areas: turn-taking, building, clarifying, disagreeing, steering . "Today you'll fix every one of these."
Turn-taking	10	T-S → S	Slide 14. In · hold · over. Meaning and CCQs: interrupting vs coming in. Pronunciation: the softener <i>just</i> is weak and quick, and the request is a gentle rise ("Could I just come in here ↗?"). Drill (below). Then "fishbowl": four volunteers talk for 60 seconds about a light topic (the best time of day to study); the class calls out "IN," "HOLD," "OVER" when they hear one.
Building, clarifying & paraphrasing	8	T-S → S-S	Slide 14 (lower half). Contrast "I think we should focus on training" with "Building on Anna's point about skills, I think training is where we should focus." What changed? Paraphrase: "So if I understand you correctly, you're saying...?" Pairs: A says an opinion from Workbook Ex 5; B paraphrases it with a rise; A confirms ("Exactly.") or corrects ("Not quite. What I meant was...").
Respectful challenge	8	T-S → S-S	Slide 15. Acknowledge → soften → challenge. CCQs. Pairs do Workbook Ex 3 (soften the blunt disagreement) aloud first, then write two. Pronunciation: fall-rise on the acknowledgment ("I see your point ↘ ↗, but..."), then a clear fall on the challenge. Firm on the idea, warm to the person.
Steering & summarizing	5	T-S	Slide 16 (the model seminar). Read Script 7.3-B or project the slide; learners find the steering and summarizing moves ("So where does that leave us?" "So, to sum up..." "Shall we move on to...?"). Point out that Priya disagrees twice and the discussion never sours.

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Controlled practice	7	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 1, 2 and 4 (complete the phrase, complete the exchange, name the move). Pairs check aloud. Board-check disagreements only.
Seminar prep	10	S → S-S	Slide 17. Groups of 5-6 (pre-planned). Each group gets one reading card ; everyone reads it (4 min). Hand out role cards and move cards (4 each). Learners fill the prep page in the workbook: two points for their assigned side, one question for the other side, the four moves they'll play (4 min). ICQs (2 min).
Freer: the Seminar	15	S-S → S	12 minutes of seminar. The facilitator opens with the reading's question and hands over by name; the challenger tests claims; the summarizer gives a half-time summary at minute 6 (you call it) and a final summary at minute 11. Learners lay a move card face up each time they use that move. Then (3 min) the observer gives feedback from the observer sheet: two strengths, one move nobody used.
Feedback	5	T-S	Delayed correction across groups: accuracy ("I am agree," "discuss about," "According to me"), appropriacy (a paraphrase that sounded like a trap; "You're wrong" from a challenger; a facilitator who never spoke), range to praise (" <i>That ties in with what Lena said earlier...</i> ," " <i>Up to a point, yes, but...</i> "). Learners fill the self-review in the workbook.
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Show online lesson 7.3 and a  button. Set the homework (below). Learners tick "I can...".
Total	90		7 + 10 + 10 + 8 + 8 + 5 + 7 + 10 + 15 + 5 + 5

◆ MEANING • FORM • PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: interrupting vs coming in. Coming in is a request that leaves the speaker a moment to yield; interrupting takes the floor.

SAY: "*Could I just come in here?*" Is this a question or an instruction? (A question: the speaker can say "*Let me just finish.*") What does just do? (Makes the request smaller, more polite.) • Someone talks over a colleague with a brilliant idea. Is that OK in an English-language seminar? (Usually no: it costs goodwill.) • "*What are your thoughts, Priya?*" Why use the name? (It draws in a quieter person and shows you're tracking everyone.)

Meaning: building and paraphrasing.

SAY: "Building on Anna's point about skills..." Whose idea is this? (Anna's, extended.) How does Anna feel? (Heard.) · "So if I understand you correctly, your worry is coverage?" Is the speaker agreeing? (Not yet: checking.) What can the other person do? (Confirm or correct.) Does a paraphrase sound weak? (No: attentive and precise.)

Meaning: respectful challenge. The idea is challenged, not the person. The acknowledgment must be **genuine**, and it must name something specific.

SAY: "I take your point about speed, but I'm not sure we've thought through the cost." Does the speaker agree? (Partly: about speed.) Is the challenge weak? (No, it's clear: the cost.) · "No, that's wrong." Is the view stronger? (No, only the temperature is higher.) · "Great point, BUT..." said very fast every time. Does it sound genuine? (No: the acknowledgment must be specific.)

Form.

Come in	Could I just + verb...? · Sorry to + verb, but... · If I could just + verb...	Sorry to jump in, but...
Build	Building on / Following on from + noun phrase (<i>what you said · Tom's point</i>)	Building on what Tom said, ...
Clarify	When you say + X , do you mean...? · Could you clarify what you mean by + noun ?	...what you mean by "flexible"?
Paraphrase	So if I understand you correctly, you're saying (that)... · So your point is that...?	...you're saying cost matters more than speed?
Challenge	I take your point about + noun , but... · I'd question whether + clause · Isn't there a risk that + clause?	I'd question whether it works for a client-facing team.
Steer	Shall we + base verb? · So where does that leave us? · It sounds like we broadly agree that...	Shall we move on to the budget?

Pronunciation. The moves only work with the right melody (a direct link to C21). Softeners (*just, sorry, I think*) are **weak and quick**. A paraphrase ends on a **rise**: it's a real question ("...your worry is coverage ↗?"); with a fall it sounds like an accusation. The acknowledgment takes a **fall-rise** ("I take your **point** ↘ ↗..."): it signals that a "but" is coming, gently. The challenge itself **falls**: clear and calm. Name + question for handing over: "What do you think, **Priya** ↘?" (a fall is warmer and more confident than a rise here).

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- The door handles** (choral, then individuals, with the melody): "Could I just come **in** here ↗?" · "If I could just **finish** my point..." · "What are your **thoughts**, Priya ↘?" · "Building on what you **said**..." · "So where does that **leave** us ↘?"

- 2 **Function to phrase:** T says a function; S says a phrase. T: "Hold the floor." → S: "If I could just finish my point..." T: "Check understanding." → S: "So if I understand you correctly, ..." T: "Common ground." → S: "Where we do agree is..."
- 3 **Blunt to respectful:** T says a blunt line; S rebuilds it. T: "That won't work." → S: "I see the appeal, but I'm not sure how it would work in practice." T: "You're wrong about the cost." → S: "I take your point about the cost, but I'd question whether..."
- 4 **Paraphrase with a rise:** T states a view; S paraphrases with a rise. T: "Phones in meetings are a distraction, but banning them treats adults like children." → S: "So you're saying they're a problem, but a ban isn't the answer ↗?"
- 5 **Open pairs → closed pairs:** S1 gives a view on a light topic (the best way to learn vocabulary); S2 builds on it by name; S3 challenges it respectfully. Then groups of three, 2 minutes.

◆ THE SEMINAR – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ **Groups of 5–6**, pre-planned: mixed first languages, one confident and one quiet learner in each, dominant speakers spread out. Each group discusses **one reading card**. The six readings: the four-day workweek, phones in meetings and classes, exams vs portfolios, car-free downtown streets, AI writing tools in college courses, and **spaced practice vs cramming** (the C20 lecture topic). All readings are short, neutral briefings with two positions and one seminar question.
- ◆ **Roles** (role cards): **Facilitator**: opens with the question, hands over by name, watches the clock, refocuses ("Could we come back to the main question?"). **Summarizer**: tracks each person's key point on the observer grid, gives a half-time summary ("So far we broadly agree that..., but we're split on...") and the final summary. **Challenger**: tests claims on **both** sides, respectfully ("What's the evidence for that?" "Isn't there a risk that...?"), and must acknowledge before every challenge. **Contributors A and B**: argue the side printed on their card, not their own view. **Observer** (sixth learner, or rotate): doesn't speak; tallies moves on the observer sheet and gives feedback at the end.
- ◆ **Move cards**. Each learner gets four cards (e.g., COME IN · BUILD ON · PARAPHRASE · RESPECTFUL CHALLENGE). Each time they use a move, they lay the card face up. Goal: all four down by the end. When your cards are all down, you may only speak to hand over to someone who still has cards. This limits dominant speakers and gives quiet ones a reason to speak, without anyone being singled out.
- ◆ **Timing**. Call "Half time: summarizer" at minute 6 and "One minute: summarizer" at minute 11. The facilitator closes: "Thanks, everyone. So, to sum up..." then hands to the summarizer.
- ◆ **Observer feedback protocol (3 min)**: two strengths first, each with a name and a quote ("Lena built on Omar's point about training: 'That ties in with...'"), then **one move nobody used**, as a group target, not a personal criticism. No comments on accent or grammar here; that's your job in the feedback stage.
- ◆ **Your job during the seminar**: circulate with the three-column sheet (range · accuracy · appropriacy). Don't join a group. If a group stalls, hand the facilitator a prompt card quietly ("Ask the challenger to respond to B's last point").

- ◆ If you have fewer than five learners in a group, merge the summarizer and the facilitator. With a very large class, run two rounds of 10 minutes with new roles for the second round.

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE SEMINAR

SAY: *Are you giving your own opinion? (No, the side on my card.) · Who opens the discussion? (The facilitator.) · When does the summarizer speak? (At half time and at the end.) · Does the challenger challenge only one side? (No, both sides.) · What must the challenger do before every challenge? (Acknowledge the point.) · What do you do with a move card when you use the move? (Put it face up.) · When all your cards are down, can you keep arguing? (No, only hand over to someone else.) · Does the observer speak during the seminar? (No, only at the end.)*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Pre-teach the reading one class ahead, or read it aloud to the group while they follow. Give the learner **two** move cards instead of four, each with the full phrase printed on it, and a role with a script: the **facilitator** card has every line written out ("What are your thoughts, ___?"). Pair them with a supportive summarizer. Target: two moves used, including one hand-over by name.

STRETCH (TOWARD C2)

Give strong learners the **challenger** role with an extra rule: every challenge must also **offer something** ("...so could we trial it first?"). Or a **synthesis** task: the summarizer's final summary must link at least three people's points by name and name the one remaining disagreement precisely. At C2 the moves disappear: ask them to use the functions **without** the textbook phrases ("Hang on, Priya's point changes things, doesn't it?").

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **Directness norms** travel badly in both directions. Learners from more direct discussion cultures (for example Dutch, German, Russian, Hebrew or Polish) may sound blunt with "No, that's wrong," while learners from cultures that value waiting and harmony (for example Japanese, Korean, Chinese, Vietnamese or Thai) may never come in at all. Present both as **habits to adjust**, never as national traits, and practice the same moves with everyone.
- ◆ **Overlap as engagement:** in many Spanish, Portuguese, Italian and Arabic conversations, talking at the same time shows interest. In an English-language seminar it reads as interrupting. The coming-in phrase is the bridge.
- ◆ **"I am agree" / "I am not agree"** (Spanish *estoy de acuerdo*, French, Portuguese and Italian): *agree* is a verb: "I agree," "I don't agree."
- ◆ **"Discuss about"** (Spanish *discutir sobre*, Arabic and others): *discuss the idea*, no preposition. Also "explain me" → *explain to me*.

- ◆ **"According to me"** (French *selon moi*, Hindi, Urdu and Bengali speakers, Spanish *según yo*): use *In my view*, *As I see it*; *according to* introduces someone else's view.
- ◆ **Literal politeness:** "Please give me the floor" or "I want to say something" (a direct translation of a polite form in the learner's language) can sound abrupt in English. "Could I just..." does the same job.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 7.3: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-c1/lesson_21.html. Listen to the five model sentences with 🎧 and say them back with the melody; do Exercises 1–3, the Quick Quiz and the "Run a Real Discussion" project (with family, colleagues, classmates online, or scripted solo; for the topic, use one of the seminar readings or another from the kit's topic areas). Workbook 7.3: finish the self-review, "My new words" and the journal. Optional: watch a recorded panel discussion and note every turn-taking and building phrase you hear.

◆ CHECK – SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 A "Sorry, could I just come in here?" · Q2 B "I take your point, but I'm not sure we've thought through the cost..." · Q3 (new) B "Thanks, Omar, that's really useful. I'd love to hear from someone who hasn't come in yet. Lena?" Ex 1: in · finish · Building · understand · point · leave. Ex 2: finish · come in · thoughts · correctly · agree · move.

CLOSING THE MODULE

END OF C22: MODULE 7 WRAP-UP

Recap on slide 18, "take it in, give it out, share the floor": **signposts, the recap test and Cornell notes** (take it in) → **stress the new, pause at meaning, fall to finish, fall-rise for "but"** (give it out) → **come in, build on, paraphrase, acknowledge before you challenge, summarize** (share the floor). Learners tick the three "I can..." lists in the workbook. Anything still unticked goes on a sticky note for you. Revisit it in the C23 warmer; **Signpost Bingo** is ready for that if you didn't use it in C20 or C21.

Watch for in Module 8: Lesson 8.1 (fluency and spontaneity) builds directly on C22. Thinking-time phrases (*That's a good question...* · *Let me think about that for a second*) are the solo version of "holding the floor," and paraphrasing around a missing word uses the same skills as paraphrasing a colleague. Lesson 8.3 (the position paper and its **defense**) is the module's real test: learners will present with signposting (7.1), deliver with clear prosody (7.2) and handle challenges from the floor (7.3). Keep the seminar roles and the coach's checklist for that class.

Final assessment (C26) covers all eight modules. From this module, the listening section uses a signposted talk with comprehension and inference questions (signpost functions, main idea vs example, stance), and the speaking interview and discussion task reward turn-taking, building on the examiner's or partner's points, paraphrasing and respectful disagreement, delivered with clear stress, sensible pausing and statements that fall.

Module 8 — Fluency, Craft & the Final Project

The last three classes of C1 pull in two directions and then bring them together. First, **fluency under pressure**: buying time, using fillers with control, talking around a missing word and repairing a sentence mid-flight, rehearsed in impromptu one-minute talks. Then **craft**: editing for precision and concision, cutting wordiness, redundancy, empty intensifiers and buried verbs, with a 30% Cut Challenge. Finally, the review project, **A Position Paper & Its Defense**: every learner writes a paper of about 500 words on an everyday, workplace, education or technology question and defends it in a short viva-style Q&A with peers.

3 lessons

Lessons 8.1–8.3

Classes C23–C25

Weeks 12–13

90 min per class

CEFR C1

HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

- One lesson block = one 90-minute class. The first two follow the usual shape: **warmer** → **lead-in** → **Meaning / Form / Pronunciation** with concept-checking questions (CCQs) → **drill** → **controlled practice** (workbook) → **freer practice** → **feedback** with delayed error correction → **homework**. At C1, 8.1 and 8.2 are really **skills workshops**: the "language" is a set of strategies and editing moves, and most of the class time goes to doing them. C25 is a project class: short input, then the vivas.
- The **stage plan** is your clock. Each one adds up to 90 minutes. The numbers in the Time column are minutes.
- Present from [slides/module-8-position-paper.html](#). Print [materials/module-8/classroom-materials.html](#) before C23. It holds the **Talk Around It** picture cards and the phrase cards, the new identity cards, the **impromptu topic cards** and curveball cards, the **strategy spotter sheets**, the **before/after** editing cards, the four **30% Cut Challenge** texts, the **Keep Talking** board game, the **position paper kit** (topic cards, side cards, viva roles, the rotation sheet and the chair's script), the six **question-card sets**, the **paper rubric** and **defense rubric**, the **teacher observation checklist** and the listening scripts.
- The online lessons are the learners' **homework and review**. Each one has  Listen buttons, so learners can hear the model sentences again at home. For this module the online lessons are also where learners **record themselves**: the two-minute impromptu talk (8.1) and the recorded defense (8.3).
- The project starts in C23, not C25.** A 500-word paper cannot be written in class. Learners choose a topic at the end of C23, fill in the **planning frame** (Workbook 8.3) for C24, write and edit the paper after C24 and bring it (or email it to their viva group) before C25. C25 itself is the **defense**. The timeline is in the box "The project timeline" below; put it on the board in C23 and leave it there.

- ◆ **Refinement, not a first meeting.** Learners already hedge (C1 3.3), nominalize (3.1), build cohesion (3.2), structure an argument essay (6.2) and manage a seminar (7.3). Don't re-teach any of it. This module asks them to do it **in real time** (8.1), **economically** (8.2) and **all at once** (8.3). Point back to the earlier lesson whenever a learner reaches for a tool: "That's your 3.3 hedge. Good."
- ◆ **Feedback on range, accuracy and appropriacy.** In every freer task, take notes in three columns: **Fix** (errors), **Upgrade** (correct but could be more precise or more natural) and **Wow** (ambitious, well-judged language to spread). At C1 the most useful feedback is often **appropriacy**: the hedge that makes a claim too weak, the formal phrase in a chatty answer, the filler that turns into a tic. Board 2–3 items from each column, without names.
- ◆ **Dominant speakers.** In C23 the **strategy spotter** role (listens, tallies, reports) and a strict 60-second timer do most of the work. In C24 give the strongest voice the **meaning-keeper** job: they may only defend ideas, not add words. In C25 the viva format is naturally fair: each learner has one defense and fixed examiner turns, and the **chair** keeps them. Say it kindly and early: "Great question, Ana. Let's give Wei the next one."
- ◆ **Quiet or anxious learners.** Impromptu speaking is the most exposing task of the course. Let learners choose the easy topic pile first, allow a 15-second silent planning time, and treat any **visible strategy** ("Let me think... Well, it depends...") as a success, even if the content is thin. In C25, a nervous learner may present to their group seated and may keep their paper in front of them.
- ◆ **Stretching strong learners toward C2.** Each lesson has a stretch box. The C2 direction for this module is **control and invisibility**: at C2, strategies stop being noticeable. Fillers become rhetorical pauses, circumlocution becomes precise paraphrase, a repair becomes a deliberate refinement ("or, more precisely..."), editing becomes rhythm and emphasis, and a defense becomes genuine intellectual exchange (reframing the question, identifying the assumption behind it). Ask strong learners to explain *why* a choice works, and give them the hardest topic cards.
- ◆ **Peer review, the C1 way.** All three classes use the same protocol, and learners already know it from C17–C18: (1) **say what the text or talk does well, specifically**; (2) **ask a question before you suggest a change** ("What did you mean by...?"); (3) **suggest one or two changes, not ten**; (4) **the writer or speaker decides**. Post it on the wall. Peer comments are about the work, never the person.
- ◆ **American English is the classroom standard.** The online lessons use British spellings and words (*recognise, apologise, nominalisation, practising, centre, organisation, pedestrianised, pavements, footfall, shop, full stop, defence*). Teach *recognize, apologize, nominalization, practicing, center, organization, pedestrianized / car-free, sidewalks, foot traffic, store, period, defense*. Accept British forms when learners use them, but ask for **one** system per paper.
- ◆ Dashed boxes = lines to say out loud, CCQs and ICQs (instruction-checking questions). Green boxes = scripts you read aloud. **Amber** = watch-outs.

THE THROUGH-LINE

Keep going → cut back → stand your ground. In C23 learners learn to keep speech moving when a word, an idea or a sentence fails them: *That's a good question... It's a kind of... or rather...* In C24 they learn the opposite discipline, going back over writing to cut everything that doesn't earn its place: *due to the fact that → because, make a decision → decide*. In C25 the two come together. The **paper** is the edited, concise product of C24; the **defense** is the spontaneous, strategic speaking of C23, with hedging and concession from earlier modules. Every class ends with something real that other learners hear or read: a one-minute talk, an edited text, a defended position.

TRAUMA-INFORMED: TOPICS, SIDES AND "PASS"

Impromptu speaking and a public defense are high-stakes for adults who have had to defend themselves in far more serious settings: interviews with officials, workplace disputes, family conflict. **Keep every topic in everyday, workplace, education, technology, health-habit and community territory.** The kit's topic cards contain no party politics, religion, immigration or border policy, policing, war or national identity; **don't add any**, and don't use the policy-style prompts listed in the online lesson 8.3 (on government regulation and public debate) as in-class topics. Learners may **choose** a topic card or **draw** one, and they may **draw a side card** so that the paper argues an assigned position: "You're arguing the card, not confessing your opinion." In C23, personal topics ("a skill I'm glad I learned") can always be answered as a **new identity** or invented, and any learner may say "Pass, next card." In C25 the viva is **never** an interrogation: examiners challenge the *argument*, the chair stops any question that becomes personal, and nobody is asked where they are from or what they personally believe.

THE PROJECT TIMELINE (BOARD IT IN C23)

End of C23	Choose or draw a topic card (and a side card, if you want an assigned position). Read Workbook 8.3: the structure and the planning frame .
Before C24	Fill in the planning frame: thesis, two or three arguments with support, the strongest objection, your rebuttal, your conclusion. Notes only.
C24 (last stage)	Frame check in pairs: is the thesis arguable? Is the objection real, not a straw man?
After C24	Write a first draft (it will probably be 600–700 words), then edit it with the C24 checklist down to about 500 words (450–550) . Send it to your viva group (email or group chat) by the evening before C25, or bring 4 printed copies.
C25	Read two group members' papers closely, prepare questions, then the vivas : a 2-minute opening statement and about 5 minutes of questions each.
After C25	Hand in the paper (with the rubric self-check). You return it with written feedback at C26.

Why ~500 words when the online lesson says 250–400? The online capstone is written in one sitting. In class, learners have a week, an editing lesson in between, and a real audience, so the paper can carry two or three developed arguments and a proper rebuttal. Five hundred words is still short enough that **every sentence must earn its place**, which is the point of C24. If a learner's life is too full for 500 words this week, 350–400 well-edited words are fine: tell them so privately.

BEFORE THE MODULE

- Print the **flashcards**: the **Talk Around It** picture cards (16) and the phrase cards (time-buyers, repairs, editing moves, defense moves). Card stock helps. Cut them before C23.
- For C23: the **impromptu topic cards** (18, in three piles: Warm-up, Opinion, Stretch) and the **curveball cards** (6), one set per group of 3; one **strategy spotter sheet** per group; a phone timer per group (learners' phones are fine). The **Keep Talking** board game (1 per group of 3–4, a die or coin, counters) is for early finishers in C23 and the C24 warmer.
- For C24: one set of **before/after cards** per pair and one **30% Cut Challenge** text per group of 3 (four different texts, A–D). Pencils and highlighters: editing is physical work.
- For the project: the **position paper topic cards** (16) and **side cards** at the end of C23. For C25: the **viva role cards** and **rotation sheet** (1 per group), the **chair's script** (1 per group), the **question-card sets** (1 full set of 24 per group), the **paper rubric** and **defense rubric** (1 of each per learner), and your **observation checklist** on a clipboard.
- Print the **new identity cards** and keep them on a side table where anyone can take one without asking.

- ◆ Set up a way for viva groups to share papers before C25 (a group email, a shared folder, or printed copies). Decide the viva groups at the end of C24, so that learners know whose papers they will read.
- ◆ Read the kit's **C1 final assessment** before C25. Your C25 observation notes feed straight into how you run C26.

MODULE AT A GLANCE

LESSON	CLASS	FOCUS	LEARNERS CAN...
8.1	C23 · wk 12	Fluency as continuity, not speed; buying time (<i>That's a good question... · Let me think... · Well, it depends... · How can I put this?</i>); fillers and discourse markers with a job vs as tics; circumlocution (<i>the thing you use to... · a kind of... · it's like..., but... · the person who...</i>); smooth self-correction (<i>or rather... · what I mean is... · let me rephrase that</i>)	give an impromptu one-minute talk on a topic they did not choose, without freezing or restarting, using at least three strategies deliberately, and notice their own filler habits
8.2	C24 · wk 12	Editing for concision : wordy phrases (<i>due to the fact that</i> → <i>because</i>) and redundant pairs (<i>end result, each and every</i>); empty intensifiers (<i>very tired</i> → <i>exhausted</i>); strong verbs over noun + light verb (<i>make a decision</i> → <i>decide</i>) as the reverse of nominalization; double negatives and tangled sentences ; the redraft mindset	cut a wordy text by at least 30% without losing a single idea, name each cut they make, and judge when <i>not</i> to cut (formal density, genuine emphasis, evidence sources)
8.3	C25 · wk 13	Review project: A Position Paper & Its Defense. The six-part structure (thesis → argument A → argument B → counter-argument → rebuttal → conclusion); the C1 toolkit in one piece; the viva : opening statement, question types, concede → hold → hedge , fluency strategies under questioning	write a concise, well-structured position paper of about 500 words, then summarize it aloud and defend it against challenging questions, conceding what is fair and holding what is sound

◆ OBJECTIVES — LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ explain the difference between **fluency** (keeping going coherently) and **speed**, and between a filled pause and a frozen one
- ◆ **buy thinking time** with phrases that also carry meaning: *That's a good question...* · *Let me think for a second...* · *Well, it depends...* · *How can I put this?* · *The way I see it...*
- ◆ use **discourse markers** (*well, I mean, you know, sort of, actually*) where they do a job, and **thin out** the reflexive ones, including *um* and *er*
- ◆ **talk around a missing word** with a category, a function, a comparison, a role or a situation, so that one gap never stops a sentence
- ◆ **repair** a sentence on the move (*or rather...* · *what I mean is...* · *to put it another way...*) without apologizing or restarting
- ◆ give an **impromptu one-minute talk** from a topic card, using at least three strategies on purpose

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 8.1 (New words, Strategy box, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, Impromptu Talks + strategy checklist)
- ◆ Slides 3–8 · Phrase cards (time-buyers, repairs) · **Talk Around It** picture cards (16) · **Impromptu topic cards** (Warm-up / Opinion / Stretch) + curveball cards · **Strategy spotter sheets** · phone timers · **Keep Talking** board (early finishers) · New identity cards
- ◆ Listening scripts 8.1-A (Freeze or flow?), 8.1-B (the filler audit), 8.1-C (the interview with Maya) and 8.1-D (What am I describing?)
- ◆ Position paper **topic cards** and **side cards** (for the project launch at the end)

BOARD PLAN

Left: fluency = keep going. ✗ freeze (long silence, "sorry, I don't know how to say it") · ✓ filled pause (a phrase, then a calm beat). **Buy time:** *That's a good question...* · *Let me think for a second...* · *Well, it depends...* · *How can I put this?* · *The way I see it...* · *Bear with me a moment...*

Center: talk around it. a kind of... (category) · the thing you use to... (function) · it's like..., but... (comparison) · the person who... (role) · it's when / where... (situation) · the, oh, whatever it's called...

Repair: *or rather...* · *what I mean is...* · *let me rephrase that* · *to put it another way...*

Right: fillers, job or tic? well (a start) · actually (a mild surprise / correction) · I mean (a clarification) · you know (shared feeling) · sort of (an honest approximation) → ✓ one, with a job · ✗ five in a sentence. **Corner:** the project timeline (see above).

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: seminar rewind	6	S-S	Review C22 (7.3). Groups of 3, one light question on the board: "Should meetings have a strict time limit?" Four minutes; each learner must use one move from 7.3 (<i>Could I just come in here?</i> · <i>Building on what you said...</i> · <i>So if I understand you correctly...</i> · <i>Up to a point, yes, but...</i>). One learner per group reports the best move they heard. Note one Fix and one Wow.
Lead-in: freeze or flow?	6	T-S	Slide 3. Read Script 8.1-A : two answers to the same hard question. Workbook Ex 1: learners note what Speaker 2 does at each of the three "walls." Ask: "Who was faster?" (Neither.) "Who sounded more fluent? Why?" Elicit the key idea: fluency is continuity , not speed. Quick show of hands: "What do you do when you freeze in English?"
Buying time & fillers	12	T-S → S-S	Slides 4–5. Elicit the time-buyers learners already use; add the rest from the phrase cards. CCQs (below). Then the filler audit : read Script 8.1-B once at natural speed; learners tally fillers (Workbook Ex 5). Compare tallies (there are about 23). Read the clean version. Pairs decide which two or three fillers in the transcript do a real job.
Talk around it	10	T-S → S-S	Slide 6. The five frames. Hold up a Talk Around It picture card and describe it without naming it ("It's the thing you use to change the channel without getting up..."); learners shout the word. Then Script 8.1-D : six quick descriptions, learners write the word. Pairs: each draws 3 picture cards face down and

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			describes them with a different frame each time.
Repair on the move	6	T-S	Slide 7. Read the clumsy and the smooth repair from the slide in two voices. CCQs. Elicit why "sorry, sorry, that's wrong" hurts (it points at the mistake). Workbook Ex 4 items 1-2 together.
Drill	6	T-S → S	Hot-seat drill (see Drill script): hard question → time-buyer + first sentence; forgotten word → frame; wrong detail → <i>or rather</i> . Choral for the phrases (with intonation), then fast individuals.
Controlled practice	9	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 2-4 alone (choose the strategy phrase, talk around it, clumsy → smooth), then check in pairs. Board-check only the disagreements. Read Script 8.1-C (the interview) once while learners follow the dialogue and underline every strategy.
Freer: Impromptu Talks	25	S-S (groups of 3) → T-S	Slide 8. Groups of 3: speaker , timekeeper (60 seconds, calls "time" and asks one follow-up question), strategy spotter (tallies on the spotter sheet). The speaker draws a card, gets 15 seconds silent thinking time, then talks for one minute, then answers the follow-up (20-30 s). Spotter reports: "You bought time twice, talked around one word, one smooth repair; one silence at 40 seconds." Rotate roles. Round 1 Warm-up pile · Round 2 Opinion pile · Round 3 Stretch pile + a curveball card. ICQs first. See "How to run it."
Feedback	5	T-S	Delayed correction. Board 2 Fixes (e.g. "Sorry, sorry, I mean... sorry." · "It's a thing for... how do you say... for, um... no."), 2 Upgrades ("I think... I think... I think" → <i>The way I see it... / If you ask me...</i>) and 1-2 Wows. Ask the class: "Which strategy felt the most natural? Which one is hardest to use under pressure?"

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Homework & project launch	5	T-S	Show online lesson 8.1 and a  button; set the homework (below). Then launch the project: board the timeline , show the topic cards on slide 14, and let learners choose or draw a topic (and a side card if they want one). Point to the planning frame in Workbook 8.3. Learners tick the 8.1 "I can..." list.
Total	90		6 + 6 + 12 + 10 + 6 + 6 + 9 + 25 + 5 + 5

IF YOU RUN LONG

Protect the Impromptu Talks: they are the lesson. Cut in this order: (1) Script 8.1-C becomes homework (it's the online dialogue); (2) Script 8.1-D shortens to three items; (3) the warmer shrinks to two minutes. If the project launch gets squeezed, hand out the topic cards at the door and launch properly in the first five minutes of C24, but learners then have one day less to plan.

◆ MEANING • FORM • PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: fluency. At C1, fluency means sustaining connected, comprehensible speech while you are still thinking. Pauses are normal; **silent, frozen** pauses and restarts are what break fluency.

SAY: "The reason is... um... [long silence] ... sorry, I don't know how to say it." Did the speaker know the answer? (Probably, yes.) What went wrong? (She stopped and apologized; the listener lost the thread.) · "The reason is, well, how can I put this? It's partly about cost." Was this speaker faster? (No.) Why does it sound more fluent? (There was no dead silence; the phrase filled the gap.)

Meaning: time-buyers carry meaning.

SAY: "That's a good question..." Is it only stalling? (No, it also acknowledges the person who asked.) · "Well, it depends..." What does the listener expect next? (A balanced answer with conditions.) · "How can I put this?" Is the speaker lost? (No, they're choosing words carefully: it signals precision.) · Could you use "That's a good question" to answer "What time is it?" (No: it only fits a hard or interesting question. Overuse sounds evasive.)

Meaning: fillers, job or tic?

SAY: "It was, you know, a difficult decision." Does you know do a job here? (Yes: it invites the listener to share the feeling.) · "I was, you know, walking to, you know, the store, you know." (No job: it's a tic, and we start counting instead of listening.) · "Actually, it worked well." What does actually tell us? (It's a bit

surprising, or it corrects an expectation.) · "It's sort of a compromise." Hedge or tic? (A hedge: it's an honest approximation.) · "It's sort of on Tuesday." (A tic: Tuesday is a fact; don't hedge it.)

Meaning: circumlocution and repair.

SAY: "It's the thing you use to open a wine bottle." Does the speaker know the word? (No, not right now.) Did the conversation stop? (No.) What often happens next? (The listener says the word: "A corkscrew!") · "We met on Tuesday, or rather, Wednesday." Which day was it? (Wednesday.) Did she apologize? (No.) Does the listener trust her more or less? (More: she's monitoring her own speech.)

Form.

Buy time	That's a good / an interesting question... · Let me think (for a second)... · Well, it depends (on...) · How can I put this? · The way I see it... · If you ask me... · Bear with me a moment...	then a short calm beat, then the answer
Talk around	a kind of / a type of + category · the thing (that) you use to + verb · it's like + noun, but... · the person who + verb · it's when / it's where + clause	"the person who fixes pipes" (plumber)
Flag a gap	what's the word...? · the, oh, whatever it's called... · I can't think of the word, but...	keep going, don't stop
Repair	or rather... · or should I say... · what I mean is... · let me rephrase that · to put it another way...	no "sorry," no restart
Markers	well (start / turn) · actually (surprise, mild correction) · I mean (clarify) · you know (shared feeling) · sort of / kind of (honest hedge)	one, with a job

Pronunciation. Time-buyers only sound natural with the right tune. *That's a good question* is said slightly slower, with a fall on **question** and a short pause after: "That's a good **QUESTION** ↘ | ...". *Well, it depends* has a **fall-rise** on *well* (↘ ↗ = "it's not simple"). *Let me think* is often "lemme think." Repairs are said **lightly and quickly**, a little lower in pitch, as if in brackets: "We met on Tuesday (*or rather*) **WED**nesday." Stress the **corrected** word, not the repair phrase. After a time-buyer, **slow down slightly**: a measured pace sounds more fluent than a rushed one. *Um* and *er* can often be replaced by a **silent beat with eye contact**: it sounds confident, not lost.

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 Tune the time-buyers** (choral, then individuals, with the intonation): "That's a good **QUESTION**..." · "Well ↘ ↗, it de**PENDS**..." · "How can I **PUT** this?" · "Let me **THINK** for a second..."
- 2 Hot seat: hard question → time-buyer + one sentence.** T: "What's the biggest problem with modern work?" → S: "That's a good question. I'd say it comes down to..." T: "Is it better to rent or buy?" → S:

"Well, it depends on..." T: "How would you describe your ideal manager?" → S: "How can I put this? Someone who..."

- 3 **Talk around it** (T says a word only the learner sees on a card; S describes it with the frame T names): T: "Function!" (ladder) → S: "It's the thing you use to reach something high." T: "Role!" (landlord) → S: "It's the person who owns the apartment you rent." T: "Situation!" (traffic jam) → S: "It's when all the cars stop and nobody can move."
- 4 **Or rather chain:** T gives a wrong detail and the right one: "Tuesday → Wednesday." → S: "We met on Tuesday, or rather, Wednesday, and..." T: "twenty people → thirty." → S: "There were about twenty, or rather, thirty people..."
- 5 **Open pairs → closed pairs:** S1 asks a hard question from the board; S2 answers for 20 seconds using a time-buyer, one circumlocution (S1 whispers a "forbidden" word S2 may not use) and one repair. Then all pairs, 2 minutes.

◆ IMPROMPTU TALKS – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ **Groups of 3**, sitting in a small triangle. Each group has the three card piles face down, the curveball cards, a spotter sheet and one phone timer.
- ◆ **One turn = about 2 minutes:** draw a card (or choose between two, see below), 15 seconds of silent thinking (no writing, or three key words at most), **60 seconds** of talk, then the timekeeper asks **one** follow-up question and the speaker answers in 20–30 seconds. The spotter reports in 20 seconds. Rotate: every learner speaks once per round.
- ◆ **Round 1: Warm-up pile** (familiar, personal-ish topics; new identity cards welcome). **Round 2: Opinion pile** ("Are online reviews trustworthy?"). **Round 3: Stretch pile** (abstract: "Is boredom useful?") **plus a curveball card** the timekeeper reveals at 30 seconds ("Now argue the opposite," "Explain it to a 12-year-old," "Your listener interrupts: 'Sorry, what do you mean by that?'").
- ◆ **Rules on the slide:** no silence longer than about 3 seconds; no restarting; no "sorry." If you dry up, use a time-buyer, repeat your main point in other words, or say "Let me come at this from another angle."
- ◆ **The spotter sheet** has four columns: time-buyers · talked around a word · smooth repairs · long silences / restarts, plus one line: "a filler you used a lot." The spotter reports numbers and one example, **not** a judgment. This is the job for a dominant speaker: they must listen, count and report briefly.
- ◆ **Choice lowers anxiety.** In Rounds 1 and 2 the speaker draws **two** cards and chooses one. Anyone may say "Pass, next card" once per round. Nobody watches the whole class: all groups talk at the same time.
- ◆ **You circulate** with a notepad (Fix / Upgrade / Wow). Spend one full turn with each group. Early-finishing groups play the **Keep Talking** board game.

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE IMPROMPTU TALKS

SAY: How long do you talk? (One minute.) · How long can you think first? (Fifteen seconds.) Can you write a script? (No, three words at most.) · What does the timekeeper do at the end? (Asks one follow-up

question.) · What does the spotter do? (Counts strategies and silences, then reports numbers.) · If you forget a word, do you stop? (No, talk around it.) · If you make a mistake? (Repair it: "or rather..." and keep going.) · Can you say "Pass"? (Yes, once per round.)

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Give the learner **four phrase cards only** to hold during the talks: *That's a good question* · *Well, it depends* · *It's a kind of...* · *or rather*. Let them talk for **30–40 seconds** and choose from the Warm-up pile in every round. Pair them in the triangle with a patient speaker, and make them the **timekeeper** first so they watch two turns before speaking. In the workbook, do Ex 2 items 1–4 and Ex 3 with the four picture items. Target: one time-buyer and one circumlocution, used on purpose.

STRETCH (TOWARD C2)

Make the strategies **invisible**: a rhetorical question instead of a stock time-buyer ("So why does this matter? Well..."), a precise paraphrase instead of "the thing" ("a device for measuring air pressure"), a refinement instead of a correction ("or, more precisely..."). Speak for **90 seconds** and take the Stretch pile from Round 1. Give the curveball *before* the talk and ask them to build it in. Ask: "Which of your fillers did a job? Which were habits?" Homework: the online two-minute talk, recorded twice.

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **L1 fillers leaking into English.** Under pressure, learners fill pauses with the filler of their first language: Spanish *este...*, *o sea*; Japanese *ēto*, *ano*; Mandarin *nàge*, *jiùshì*; Arabic *ya'ni*; Tagalog *ano...*, *parang*; Russian *nu...*, *tak skazat'*; French *euh*, *du coup*; Korean *eum*, *geu*. Treat it kindly and privately: it's a sign the learner is thinking. Give them one English replacement to practice (*Well... / Let me think...*).
- ◆ **"How do you say...?" in the middle of a turn**, often followed by the L1 word. Fine in class, fatal in an interview. Teach the frame that keeps going: "It's a kind of..."
- ◆ **Over-apologizing.** Learners from cultures where apologies soften any imposition (Japanese *sumimasen*, Korean, and many others) may say "sorry" at every repair. Repairs in English need no apology.
- ◆ **"Actually" as a false friend:** Spanish *actualmente*, French *actuellement*, Portuguese *atualmente*, German *aktuell*, Italian *attualmente* mean "currently." "Actually, I work in a hotel" (meaning "at the moment") will confuse. *Actually* = in fact / surprisingly.
- ◆ **Over-hedging vs no hedging.** Learners whose academic culture values indirectness (Japanese, Korean, Chinese, Thai, Vietnamese) may put *sort of / maybe / a little* on everything; learners from more direct traditions (German, Dutch, Russian, Hebrew, Polish) may drop even useful markers and sound abrupt. Both are appropriacy issues, not errors: show the middle.
- ◆ **Speed as a status symbol.** Some learners (often very able ones) believe speed = fluency and rush. Time them and praise the **slower**, clearer version out loud.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 8.1: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-c1/lesson_22.html. Listen to the five model sentences with 🎧 and shadow them with the same tune; do Exercises 1–2, the Quick Quiz and the **Two-Minute Impromptu Talk** (record it, play it back and tally your strategies). Workbook 8.1: finish Ex 5 if needed, "My new words" and the journal. **Project:** choose your topic and fill in the **planning frame** in Workbook 8.3 (notes only) for C24.

◆ CHECK – SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **B** keeping going coherently, even while you think. · Q2 **C** describe it: "the thing you use to open a wine bottle." · Q3 (new) **A** "The meeting is on Thursday, or rather, Friday, so we have an extra day." Ex 1 (Script 8.1-A): wall 1 a hard question → "That's a good question. Let me think for a second." · wall 2 a missing word (*deadline*) → "the date when everything has to be finished" · wall 3 a wrong detail (*three* projects) → "or rather, four."

◆ OBJECTIVES — LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ replace **wordy stock phrases** with lean ones (*in order to* → *to* · *due to the fact that* → *because* · *at this point in time* → *now* · *in the event that* → *if*) and cut **redundant pairs** (*end result*, *free gift*, *each and every*, *completely eliminate*)
- ◆ delete **empty intensifiers and qualifiers** (*very*, *really*, *quite*, *basically*, *just*, *actually*) and upgrade the word instead (*very tired* → *exhausted* · *really important* → *crucial*), while keeping intensifiers that add genuine emphasis or precise degree
- ◆ dig **strong verbs** out of noun + light-verb strings (*make a decision* → *decide* · *carry out a review of* → *review*), and explain when **nominalization** (C1 3.1) is still the right choice
- ◆ resolve **double negatives** (*not uncommon* → *common*) and **untangle** an overloaded sentence by splitting it or fronting the main idea
- ◆ cut a text by **at least 30%** without losing any idea, count before and after, and name each cut

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 8.2 (New words, three Grammar boxes, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, the 30% Cut Challenge)
- ◆ Slides 9–13 · Phrase cards (editing moves) · **Before/after cards** (4 pairs, 1 set per pair) · **30% Cut Challenge** texts A–D (1 per group of 3) · highlighters, pencils · **Keep Talking** board (warmer)
- ◆ Listening scripts 8.2-A (In the Editing Room) and 8.2-B (Say it shorter)
- ◆ Learners' **planning frames** (homework from C23) for the frame check

BOARD PLAN

Left: cut the padding. *in order to* → *to* · *due to the fact that* → *because* · *at this point in time* → *now* · *in the event that* → *if* · *a large number of* → *many* · *has the ability to* → *can* · *in spite of the fact that* → *although* · *in the near future* → *soon*. **Redundant pairs:** *end result* · *free gift* · *past history* · *advance planning* · *each and every* · *completely eliminate*.

Center: upgrade and dig out. *very tired* → *exhausted* · *really important* → *crucial* · *very surprised* → *astonished* · *basically just really actually*. *make a decision* → *decide* · *reach a conclusion* → *conclude* · *carry out an investigation of* → *investigate* · *give consideration to* → *consider*. **Match the tool to the goal:** strong verbs = clear, direct (email, summary, argument) · nominalization = formal, dense (report, legal).

Right: untangle. *not uncommon* → *common* · *not without merit* → *has some merit* · *one breath? no* → *split it / front the main idea*. **The editor's questions:** Fewer words? Padding? Is this intensifier earning

its place? A verb hiding in a noun? Does the reader already know this? Read it aloud. **30% = cut 3 words in 10. No idea lost.**

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: Keep Talking	7	S-S	Review C23. Groups of 3-4 play the Keep Talking board game for 6 minutes: each square asks for a 30-second answer using a named strategy (buy time, talk around, repair). Then ask: "Which strategy is now automatic?" Note one Fix and one Wow.
Lead-in: one editing pass	5	T-S	Slide 9. Read the famous line "I didn't have time to write a short letter, so I wrote a long one" and ask what it means. Show the first draft (35 words) and the edited version (16 words). Ask: "Which ideas were lost?" (None.) "What exactly was cut?" Learners name four or five cuts. "Today: the editor's eye."
The four cuts	18	T-S → S-S	Slides 10-12, one cut at a time, each with 2-3 CCQs (below) and a 1-minute pair task: (1) wordy phrases and redundant pairs; (2) empty intensifiers → one strong word (and when an intensifier stays); (3) buried verbs, linked explicitly to C1 3.1: "Last month we nominalized on purpose. Today we reverse it on purpose"; (4) double negatives and tangled sentences (the "one breath" test). Listening Script 8.2-A (In the Editing Room): learners list the four cuts the editor names.
Drill: Say it shorter	6	T-S → S	Script 8.2-B as an oral drill: you read a wordy sentence, learners say the concise version aloud (choral for the first two, then individuals). Then the "strong word" drill (see Drill script).
Controlled practice	10	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 1-5 alone (tighten, redundant word, upgrade, dig out the verb, untangle), then check in pairs. Board-check only the

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			items where pairs disagree, especially Ex 3 (keep or cut?).
Freer: Editing Workshop	26	S-S → groups of 3 → T-S	Slide 13. Round 1 (5 min), before/after cards: pairs match each "before" card to its "after" and name every cut (wordy phrase, redundant pair, intensifier, buried verb, double negative, tangle). Round 2 (15 min), the 30% Cut Challenge: groups of 3 get one text (A–D, about 150 words). Target: cut at least 30% (the target is printed on the card) and lose no idea . Roles: editor (holds the pen), word-counter , meaning-keeper (ticks each idea on the original as it survives). Round 3 (6 min): each group reads its final version aloud and says the word count and one cut they're proud of. The class listens for lost meaning: "Did they cut an idea?" ICQs first.
Project: frame check	6	S-S	Pairs swap planning frames (Workbook 8.3). The partner checks only two things and writes one question: (1) Is the thesis arguable? Could a reasonable person disagree? (2) Is the objection real? Would someone on the other side actually say it, or is it a straw man? Use the peer-review protocol: strength, question, one suggestion, writer decides.
Feedback	7	T-S	Board 2 Fixes from the workshop (an over-cut sentence that lost an idea or became unclear, e.g. "The app helps time." · a meaning change: "Many adults think teenagers are lazy" → "Adults think teenagers are lazy"), 2 Upgrades (a correct cut that could go further) and 1–2 Wows. Point out one good decision not to cut (e.g. keeping "according to the developers' own research": the source matters).
Homework & viva groups	5	T-S	Show online lesson 8.2 and a 🗣️ button; set the homework (below). Announce the viva groups for C25 (3–4 learners) and how papers

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			will be shared. Learners tick the 8.2 "I can..." list.
Total	90		$7 + 5 + 18 + 6 + 10 + 26 + 6 + 7 + 5$

IF YOU RUN LONG

Protect Round 2 of the workshop and the frame check (a learner who arrives at C25 with an unarguable thesis has a hard viva). Cut in this order: (1) the warmer becomes 3 minutes of one-minute talks in pairs; (2) Round 1 (the before/after cards) moves to homework, since the workbook dialogue covers the same ground; (3) the controlled practice becomes Ex 1, 3 and 4 only, with Ex 2 and 5 at home.

◆ MEANING • FORM • PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: concision. Concision means saying the same thing in fewer, stronger words. The goal is **clarity**, not a low word count: a cut that removes an idea, a source or a necessary nuance is a bad cut.

SAY: "Due to the fact that we did not have a sufficient amount of time..." → "Because we lacked time..." Is any meaning lost? (No.) Which is easier to read? (The second.) · "Research by the developers shows..." → "Research shows..." Is anything lost? (Yes! Who did the research. That matters for trust.) So is shorter always better? (No: clarity and accuracy come first.)

Meaning: redundancy and intensifiers.

SAY: "a free gift": can a gift cost money? (No: free adds nothing.) · "completely eliminate": can you eliminate something halfway? (No.) · "very tired" vs "exhausted": which is stronger? (Exhausted.) Which uses fewer words? (Also exhausted.) · "I'm absolutely certain." Should we cut absolutely? (Not necessarily: it's genuine emphasis, a choice.) · "slightly undercooked": cut slightly? (No: it gives a precise degree.)

Meaning: strong verbs vs nominalization.

SAY: "The committee will carry out a review of the proposal." Where's the real action? (Review.) Which verb is doing the grammar? (carry out: an empty verb.) Shorter version? ("The committee will review the proposal.") · In C1 3.1 we turned verbs into nouns. Was that wrong? (No, it's right for formal, impersonal writing: a report, a legal clause.) So which do you use in an email to your team? (Strong verbs.) In a formal research summary? (Often nominalization.) Who decides? (The writer, for the reader and the purpose.)

Meaning: double negatives and tangles.

SAY: "It is not uncommon for delays to occur." Common or uncommon? (Common.) How many switches did your brain flip? (Two.) Is "not uncommon" ever useful? (Yes, for deliberate understatement, but not

as a default.) · A 30-word sentence with four clauses: can you say it in one breath and remember how it began? (No.) What can you do? (Split it into two, or put the main idea first.)

Form.

Wordy → lean	in order to → to · due to / owing to the fact that → because, since · at this point in time → now · in the event that → if · a large number of → many · has the ability to → can · in spite of the fact that → although · with regard to → about · in the near future → soon
Redundant pair	end result · free gift · past history · advance planning · each and every · completely eliminate · close proximity · final outcome · join together → keep the word that carries the meaning
Intensifier → word	very tired → exhausted · very big → huge, vast · really important → crucial, vital · very good → excellent · very bad → terrible, dire · very surprised → astonished · very hungry → starving
Light verb + noun → verb	make a decision → decide · reach a conclusion → conclude · carry out an investigation of → investigate · give consideration to → consider · have a discussion about → discuss · provide assistance to → help · make an improvement to → improve
Untangle	not uncommon → common · not unlike → like / similar to · not impossible → possible · one long sentence → two sentences, or main idea first

Pronunciation. Reading aloud is the editor's best test, so teach learners to read their drafts **in thought groups**: a pause at each natural break, stress on the new information. Wordiness shows up as **too many unstressed syllables in a row** ("due to the fact that we are currently at a point where..."): the voice runs out of energy. A concise sentence has a clear rhythm of stressed words: "Because **COSTS** are **SOAR**ing, we've de**CID**ed to re**VIEW** our **SPEND**ing." Where a learner runs out of breath, the sentence probably needs to be split.

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 Say it shorter** (Script 8.2-B; each sentence once, learners say the concise version). T: "In order to save money, we are going to walk." → S: "To save money, we'll walk." T: "Due to the fact that it was raining, the game was canceled." → S: "Because it was raining, the game was canceled." T: "At this point in time, we have the ability to deliver on Saturdays." → S: "We can now deliver on Saturdays."
- 2 One strong word** (fast): T: "very tired" → S: "exhausted." T: "really important" → "crucial." T: "very surprised" → "astonished." T: "very big" → "huge." T: "very bad" → "terrible." T: "very clean" → "spotless."
- 3 Find the verb:** T: "make a decision" → S: "decide." T: "reach a conclusion" → "conclude." T: "give an explanation of" → "explain." T: "have a discussion about" → "discuss." T: "make an improvement to" → "improve."

- 4 **Cut or keep?** T reads a sentence; S says "Cut!" or "Keep!" and why. T: "It's basically just a really simple idea." → S: "Cut! 'It's a simple idea.'" T: "I'm absolutely certain the door was locked." → S: "Keep: real emphasis." T: "The meat was slightly undercooked." → S: "Keep: exact degree."
- 5 **Open pairs → closed pairs:** S1 reads a sentence from Workbook Ex 4 with its wordy form; S2 says it concisely without looking. Swap. Then all pairs, 1 minute.

◆ THE 30% CUT CHALLENGE – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ **Four texts, four genres** (materials set F): **A** an email to front-desk staff about a schedule change (151 words → target 105 or fewer) · **B** a community center newsletter item (156 → 109) · **C** an app description (143 → 100) · **D** a paragraph from a student report on teenage sleep (159 → 111). Give different texts to neighboring groups so they can compare at the end. Text D connects to the model position paper in Workbook 8.3.
- ◆ **Roles:** the **editor** holds the pen and marks cuts on the card (cross out, write above); the **word-counter** counts after each sentence and keeps a running total; the **meaning-keeper** has a list of the text's ideas (on the back of the card) and ticks each one as it survives. The meaning-keeper can veto any cut: "No, that loses the time." Give this job to a dominant speaker: they defend ideas but can't add words.
- ◆ **Sequence:** (1) read the text aloud once, together; (2) first pass: wordy phrases and redundant pairs (the fast wins); (3) second pass: intensifiers and buried verbs; (4) third pass: tangles and double negatives; (5) count; (6) read the final version aloud and fix any sentence where the reader stumbles.
- ◆ **Honesty rules:** no idea may disappear; numbers, names, times, and **sources of evidence** stay; don't change the register (the email stays an email). If the group reaches 30% quickly, the stretch target is 50%: the model versions in the answer key cut 53–57%.
- ◆ **Round 3 read-out:** each group reads its version and gives "before / after / percent." Classmates with the *same* text (if any) compare choices; everyone else listens for lost meaning and asks one question. Vote for "clearest," not "shortest."
- ◆ Keep the cut texts. At the end of the class, show how the same moves apply to the position paper: "Your first draft will be about 650 words. You'll cut it to 500 the same way."

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE WORKSHOP

SAY: Round 1: what do you write next to each cut? (Its name: wordy phrase, intensifier, buried verb...) · Round 2: how much do you cut? (At least 30%, the number on the card.) · Can you cut an idea? (No, never.) · Can you cut a number or a source? (No.) · Who holds the pen? (The editor.) Who can say "No, that loses meaning"? (The meaning-keeper.) · Which version wins: the shortest or the clearest? (The clearest.)

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Focus on the **fast wins** only: the wordy-phrase list and the redundant pairs. Give the learner the Grammar box as a separate strip to hold while editing, and a highlighter to mark padding before crossing it out. In the workshop, make them the **meaning-keeper** (tick the ideas) or the word-counter rather than the editor, and give the group the shortest text (C). Workbook: Ex 1, Ex 2 and Ex 3 items 1–4. Target: five correct swaps, read aloud.

STRETCH (TOWARD C2)

Aim for **50%** in the Cut Challenge and then do the reverse: rewrite the cut text in a deliberately **formal, nominalized** register for a different reader, and explain which version suits which purpose. Look at **rhythm**: vary sentence length on purpose (a long sentence, then a short one for impact). Find one sentence where a double negative is the *better* choice (polite understatement: "Her proposal is not without merit"). Early finishers edit a paragraph of their own planning notes.

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **"Long = educated."** In many academic traditions (Spanish, Portuguese, French, Italian, Russian, Arabic, Persian, and German with its *Nominalstil*), long, nominal, subordinate-rich sentences signal education and respect. Learners may feel that cutting makes them sound simple. Frame concision as an English **reader-responsible** convention, not "better thinking," and show that the C1 3.1 formal style still has its place.
- ◆ **"very" as a default:** Mandarin 很 *hěn* often links a subject and an adjective with little intensifying force ("She is very tall" = "She is tall"), so learners overuse *very*. The strong-word drill helps.
- ◆ **Double negatives from negative concord:** Spanish, Portuguese, Italian, Russian, Polish and others require multiple negatives ("No sé nada" → "I don't know nothing"). That's a grammar error; "not uncommon" is a style choice. Keep the two separate so learners don't start avoiding all negatives.
- ◆ **Comma splices in tangled sentences:** Spanish, Russian, Vietnamese and Chinese allow clauses joined by commas where English needs a period, a semicolon or a linker. When learners "split" a sentence, check they really split it.
- ◆ **"in order to" everywhere:** Romance *para / pour / per* + infinitive translates naturally as "in order to." Plain *to* is enough in most cases.
- ◆ **Over-cutting** (any L1): dropping articles, *that* or auxiliaries to hit the target ("Committee will review proposal"). That's headline style, not concision. Check grammar after every cut.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 8.2: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-c1/lesson_23.html. Listen to the five model sentences with 🎧 and say them back; do Exercises 1–3, the Quick Quiz and the **Cut It by 25%** project (a paragraph of your own). Workbook 8.2: "My new words" and the journal. **Project:** write the first draft of your

position paper from your planning frame, put it aside for a day if you can, then edit it with the 8.2 checklist to about 500 words. Send it to your viva group by the evening before C25 (or bring four printed copies).

◆ CHECK — SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **A** We will decide now. · Q2 **A** when the genre calls for formal, impersonal abstraction: match the tool to the goal. · Q3 (new) **C** "Because many staff were absent, we postponed the review." Editing Room (Script 8.2-A): the four cuts the editor names are (1) a wordy phrase (*due to the fact that* → *because*), (2) padding cut (*we are currently at a point where*), (3) an intensifier upgraded (*very high* → *soaring*), (4) two buried verbs dug out (*made the decision to* → *decided to* · *carry out a review of* → *review*). 29 words → 11.

◆ OBJECTIVES — LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ write a **position paper** of about 500 words with a clear thesis, two or three supported arguments, a fairly stated counter-argument, a rebuttal and a conclusion, edited for concision
- ◆ use the **C1 toolkit** where the argument needs it: hedging, a participle or absolute clause, an inversion or cleft for emphasis, a conditional for consequences, nominalization and cohesive reference, academic collocation
- ◆ give a **two-minute opening statement** that summarizes the paper from notes, without reading it
- ◆ **understand and answer** clarifying and challenging questions: check the question when needed, **concede** what is fair, **hold** what is sound, and **hedge** a claim rather than overclaim or collapse
- ◆ keep going under questioning with **fluency strategies** (8.1), and ask a peer a sharp, respectful question as an **examiner**

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 8.3 (structure, language bank, Exercises 1–5, the model paper, the **planning frame**, the pre-hand-in checklist, defense prep, rubric self-check, final C1 journal)
- ◆ Slides 14–18 · Phrase cards (defense moves) · The **position paper kit** (materials set H): viva **role cards**, the **rotation sheet** and the **chair's script** (1 per group) · **Question-card sets** (set I, 24 cards per group) · **Paper rubric** and **defense rubric** (set J, 1 each per learner) · **Teacher observation checklist** (set K) on a clipboard · a timer on the screen
- ◆ Listening scripts **8.3-A** (Priya's defense) and **8.3-B** (a model opening statement and two model answers)
- ◆ Learners' papers (shared the evening before, or 4 printed copies each) · 2 spare printed copies of the model paper for anyone who arrives without a paper

BOARD PLAN

Left: THE VIVA (per learner, about 9 min). 🪑 Chair introduces · 🎤 Opening statement (2 min, from notes) · ❓ Lead examiner: 2 questions · ❓ Second examiner: 1–2 questions · ❓ Chair: 1 question (if time) · ⭐ Examiners: one star + one wish (1 min) · → rotate

Center: CONCEDE → HOLD → HEDGE. That's a fair point, and I don't want to brush it aside. · You're right that... · That said, ... · I'd still argue that... · To some extent, yes; however... · So I'd put it slightly more cautiously: ... · If I've understood your question, you're asking whether...

Right: QUESTION TYPES. 🔍 clarify (What exactly do you mean by...?) · 📊 evidence (How do you know that...?) · ⚖️ objection (What about people who...?) · 🎭 consequence (If this were adopted, what might go wrong?) · 📏 scope (Where do you draw the line?) · 🎯 wildcard (Which of your arguments is weakest?)

Corner: Challenge the argument, never the person. · The chair stops personal questions. · Not a grade: C25 is practice. · C26 = final assessment + celebration 🎉

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: thesis in 30 seconds	5	S-S	Review C23–C24. Pairs (not from the same viva group): A states their thesis and main reason in 30 seconds; B may interrupt once with "Why?" or "Such as?"; A answers with a time-buyer if needed. Swap. Then everyone sits with their viva group and checks that all papers have arrived.
Pre-task: a model defense	10	S → S-S	Slides 14–15. Quick recap of the six-part structure (the paper is already written, so keep it to 2 minutes). Read Script 8.3-A (Priya's defense: three voices; two confident learners can read the questioners). Listen 1, gist: "What's her position? Does she change it?" Listen 2: Workbook Ex 1. Pairs check. Point out the three moves: she concedes (a blanket ban would be unfair), holds (the principle stands) and hedges (it works best alongside investment).
Defense language	9	T-S → S-S	Slide 16. The question types and the concede → hold → hedge moves. CCQs (below). Drill (below): collapse → poised, stonewall → poised. Read Script 8.3-B (the model opening statement and two model answers); ask "How is the opening statement different from reading the paper?" (It's shorter, spoken, signposted, and it names the objection before the examiners do.) Workbook Ex 5 in pairs if time; otherwise at home.
Viva set-up	4	T-S	Slide 17. Hand out the rotation sheet, role cards, chair's script and question-card sets. Each learner checks on the rotation sheet whose paper they lead-examine and whose they second-examine . ICQs.
Reading & question prep	12	S	Silent reading. Each learner reads the two papers they will examine (the lead paper closely). They choose or adapt three question cards for their lead paper (at least one challenging: evidence, objection or consequence) and two for their second paper, writing a specific version on a sticky note ("You say

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			that later start times improve grades. How strong is that evidence?"). Meanwhile, every learner jots 3–4 key words for their own opening statement. You circulate and help examiners sharpen one question each.
TASK: the vivas	36	Groups of 4 (or 3)	Four vivas of about 9 minutes each, run by the chair from the script: chair introduces the candidate and the topic (15 s) → opening statement (2 min) → lead examiner 2 questions → second examiner 1–2 questions → chair 1 question if time (about 5 min of questions in all) → examiners give one star and one wish and circle the defense rubric (1 min). Put a big timer on the screen and call "Rotate" every 9 minutes so all groups stay together. You sit in on every group in turn with the observation checklist . Groups of 3: three vivas of 12 minutes (longer Q&A).
Feedback & language focus	9	T–S	First the content : name two excellent concede-and-hold answers and one sharp examiner question you heard (no names, or with permission). Then board 2 Fixes, 2 Upgrades and 1–2 Wows, e.g. Fix: "I am agree with you, but..." · "According to me..." · Upgrade: "Yes, you're right, I'm wrong." (a collapse) → <i>That's a fair point. I'd still argue, though, that...</i> · "This proves that..." → <i>This strongly suggests that....</i> Learners complete the rubric self-check in Workbook 8.3 for their defense.
Looking ahead & homework	5	T–S	Slide 18: preview C26 (see "Looking Ahead"). Collect the papers (or ask learners to email them tonight) with the paper self-check. Homework: the online capstone lesson, the final C1 journal. Learners tick the 8.3 "I can..." list.
Total	90		5 + 10 + 9 + 4 + 12 + 36 + 9 + 5

IF YOU RUN LONG

Protect the vivas: a learner who wrote a paper and doesn't get to defend it will be hurt. Cut in this order: (1) Script 8.3-B becomes a single model answer; (2) the reading time shrinks to 8 minutes if papers were shared the night before (they should be); (3) the Q&A in each viva shrinks from 5 to 4 minutes (the chair skips their own question). **Never cut Looking Ahead:** learners must leave knowing exactly what C26 looks like.

WHY A PEER VIVA IN CLASS, BUT A RECORDED SOLO DEFENSE ONLINE?

The online capstone lets self-study learners present and then answer their own prepared list of questions. In class the real C1 challenge becomes possible: **questions you didn't write**, asked by people who have read your paper closely. That's why the Q&A matters more than the opening statement. A learner whose opening is plain but who concedes a fair point gracefully and then holds their position with a hedge has given a **strong C1 performance**. Note it on the checklist.

◆ MEANING • FORM • PRONUNCIATION (REVIEW)

No new grammar. The work today is **integration** (the whole C1 toolkit in one paper), **interaction** (answering what the examiner actually asked) and **poise** (conceding without collapsing). Keep CCQs fast.

SAY: "This paper argues that high schools should start at 9 a.m." Is this a survey of views or a position? (A position.) Could a reasonable person disagree? (Yes, so it's arguable: a good thesis.) · "Admittedly, it might be objected that a later start would disrupt family routines." Does the writer agree with the objection? (Partly: they grant it's a real concern.) What must come next? (The rebuttal: why the position still holds.) · Is a paper stronger with or without an objection? (With: it shows the writer has weighed the other side.)

SAY: An examiner asks: "What about parents who start work at 7 a.m.?" Response A: "Yes, you're right. It's a bad idea, then." (Collapse: the whole case is gone.) Response B: "That's not a problem." (Stonewall: no concession, no reason.) Response C: "That's a fair point, and I don't want to brush it aside. That said, schools could open at 7:30 for supervised breakfast, so the principle still stands." Which is poised? (C.) What are its three parts? (Concede → hold → a reason.)

SAY: "This proves that later start times raise grades." Safe claim? (No: overclaiming invites attack.) Better? ("Some studies suggest modest gains in grades.") Is hedging a weakness? (No: it shows you know exactly how strong your evidence is.) · "If I've understood your question, you're asking whether..." Why say this? (To check the question, and to buy a few seconds.)

Opening statement

Thank you. My paper addresses the question of whether... · I argue that... · My case rests on two points: ... and ... · The strongest

2 min, from notes, signposted

	objection, I think, is that... · My answer to that is... · So, on balance, ...	
 Check the question	If I've understood your question, you're asking whether... · Do you mean... or...? · Could you say a little more about what you mean by...?	checks, and buys time
 Concede	That's a fair point, and I don't want to brush it aside. · You're right that... · I take your point. · To some extent, yes. · I'll admit that my evidence here is thinner.	genuine, specific
 Hold	That said, ... · Even so, I'd still argue that... · However, that doesn't change the main point, which is... · The principle stands, provided that...	a reason, not repetition
 Hedge / refine	So I'd put it slightly more cautiously: ... · I'd suggest that, in most cases, ... · It seems likely that... · The evidence points toward... rather than proves...	calibrate, don't collapse
 Examiner	You say that... What's your evidence? · How would that work for...? · Someone might object that... How would you respond? · If this were adopted, what might go wrong? · Which of your arguments is the weakest?	about the argument, never the person

Pronunciation for defending. The concession has a **fall** (it's sincere, not sarcastic): "That's a **FAIR** point ↘." The hold has a fresh start: a short pause, a slightly higher pitch and stress on the contrast word: "| That **SAID**, ↗ the **PRIN**ciple still stands." Keep the pace **calm and unhurried**: speed sounds defensive. In the opening statement, pause after each signpost ("My second point | is fairness."). And use 8.1 in real time: a time-buyer before a hard answer is not a weakness; a long silence is.

◆ **DRILL SCRIPT (QUICK, CHORAL → INDIVIDUAL)**

- 1 Concede → hold chain:** T gives a challenge: "Isn't that too expensive?" S1: "That's a fair point; it isn't cheap." S2: "That said, the cost is paid once, and the benefit recurs." S3: "So I'd put it slightly more cautiously: it's worth it if it's phased in." New challenge, new chain.
- 2 Collapse → poised:** T (collapse): "Yes, you're right. Forget my idea." → S: "You're right that it's a risk. Even so, I'd still argue that..." · T (stonewall): "No, that's wrong." → S: "I see why you'd say that. However, ..."
- 3 Overclaim → hedge:** T: "This proves that..." → S: "This strongly suggests that..." T: "Everyone agrees that..." → S: "Most researchers seem to agree that..." T: "It will definitely work." → S: "It's likely to work, provided that..."
- 4 Check the question:** T asks a long, slightly unclear question. S: "If I've understood your question, you're asking whether... Is that right?" Then S answers in one sentence.

◆ SETTING UP THE VIVAS (END OF C24) – GROUPS, ROLES, ROTATION

Groups: 4 is ideal (3 works). Mix topics inside a group, so examiners read something new, and mix strong and less confident writers. Avoid putting close friends together: they ask gentle questions. Announce the groups at the end of C24 so papers can be shared. Each group gets a **rotation sheet** (materials set H):

Viva	Candidate	Lead examiner	Second examiner	Chair & timekeeper
1	A	B	C	D
2	B	C	D	A
3	C	D	A	B
4	D	A	B	C

Every learner is candidate once, lead examiner once, second examiner once and chair once. They read closely only **two** papers (lead and second). **Groups of 3:** A–B–C, with the second examiner also acting as chair. **Odd numbers / absences:** you become the second examiner in one group, or run one group of 5 with two second examiners (10-minute vivas). A learner who arrives **without a paper** still takes part as an examiner and chair, and defends the **model paper** (Workbook 8.3) or their planning frame: the defense is the C1 skill you most want to see.

Who chairs well: the chair keeps time, keeps questions fair and **stops any question that becomes personal** ("Let's keep to the argument. Next question, please."). Brief every chair on this. A dominant speaker makes a good chair, because the role is about bringing others in; so does an anxious learner who likes structure, because the chair's script tells them exactly what to say.

SAY: ICQs: *How long is your opening statement? (Two minutes.) Do you read your paper? (No, notes only.) · Lead examiner: how many questions? (Two, at least one challenging.) · Who keeps time? (The chair.) · A question about my family or my country: OK? (No. The chair stops it.) · When the examiner makes a fair point, what do you do? (Concede it, then hold with a reason.) · What do examiners give at the end? (One star and one wish.) · Is this a grade? (No, it's practice for C26.)*

◆ RUNNING A VIVA – THE CHAIR'S ORDER (ABOUT 9 MINUTES)

- 1 Chair introduces** (15 s): "Welcome. Our candidate is Ana. Her paper addresses the question: should high schools start later? Ana, you have two minutes."
- 2 Opening statement** (2 min): the candidate summarizes thesis, arguments, the objection and the rebuttal from 3–4 key words. The chair shows "30 SECONDS" and "TIME."
- 3 Lead examiner** (about 2½ min): two questions. After each answer, one short follow-up is allowed ("So would you accept that...?").
- 4 Second examiner** (about 1½–2 min): one or two questions, preferably of a different type from the lead examiner's.

- 5 **Chair's question** (if time, 30–60 s): often a wildcard ("If you could keep only one argument, which one?").
- 6 **Close and feedback** (1 min): the chair thanks the candidate; each examiner says one **star** (a specific strength) and one **wish**, and circles the defense rubric. Then rotate.

◆ THE RUBRICS AND THE OBSERVATION CHECKLIST → C26

The **paper rubric** (set J, and the self-check in Workbook 8.3) has six criteria: **1** position & thesis · **2** arguments & support · **3** counter-argument & rebuttal · **4** organization & cohesion · **5** range & precision (the C1 toolkit) · **6** accuracy, register & concision. The **defense rubric** also has six: **1** opening statement · **2** understanding the questions · **3** concede & hold · **4** hedging & calibration · **5** fluency strategies · **6** delivery & interaction. Three levels: ★★★ strong C1 (reaching toward C2) · ★★ C1 · ★ not yet. Examiners circle the defense rubric for their candidate; learners self-assess both; you use both for written feedback on the paper, returned at C26. **Don't grade C25**: it's practice. Tell learners so, clearly.

The **observation checklist** (set K) has one row per learner and 10 can-do items. Three marks: ✓ did it clearly · ~ did it with support, or with errors that affect meaning · ○ not yet / not observed. You can't sit through every viva: see each learner's whole opening statement or at least two of their answers, and one of their examiner questions. After class, use it to:

- ◆ **Plan each learner's C26 assessment.** The C1 final assessment is **an individual speaking interview (about 10 minutes) plus listening, reading and writing tasks** — see the kit's **C1 final assessment**. Before C26, read it and match your checklist notes to its speaking criteria: which topics suit each learner, and where to start the interview so that each learner begins with something they did well.
- ◆ **Plan the C26 warm-up:** the two items with the most ~ / ○ across the class become a short review before the assessment starts.
- ◆ **Write one sentence of feedback** for each learner on the returned paper: one real strength from the defense, named specifically ("Your concession to Omar's question about cost was excellent, and you held your thesis with a clear reason").
- ◆ **Spot who needs reassurance:** anyone who froze or collapsed under questioning gets a quiet word at the end of C25: "Next class is one-to-one and friendly. No audience. You'll be fine."

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Before C25 (in C24 or by message), agree a **shorter paper**: 250–350 words, with thesis, two arguments, one objection and a rebuttal, using the planning frame's sentence starters. In the viva, allow a **1-minute opening statement** from the planning frame, and ask the group's examiners to use **clarifying and objection** cards (not wildcards). Give the learner the four defense phrase cards to hold: *That's a fair point* · *That said* · *I'd still argue that...* · *If I've understood your question....* As an examiner, they may read a question straight from a card. Target: one clear concession and one hold with a reason.

STRETCH (TOWARD C2)

Answer the question *behind* the question: identify the examiner's assumption ("That question assumes that parents' schedules can't change. I'd question that."). **Reframe** rather than defend ("I'd put the issue differently: it's not about lateness but about alignment"). Use a precise concession frame (*Granted, ... nevertheless... · Be that as it may, ...*) and concede a point you *didn't* anticipate, then refine the thesis in real time. As an examiner, ask the wildcard cards and a genuine follow-up. At home: write a 150-word "response to examiners" that revises the paper's weakest paragraph.

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **Where the thesis goes.** Some rhetorical traditions build up to the main point (the Japanese *ki-shō-ten-ketsu* structure, Korean *gi-seung-jeon-gyeol*, and some Chinese, Arabic and Persian essay conventions value context before claim). English position papers put the thesis in the **first paragraph**. Frame it as a genre convention, not a better way of thinking.
- ◆ **"According to me" / "In my opinion, I think"** (French *selon moi*, Spanish *según yo / en mi opinión, pienso que*, Italian *secondo me*): not used in English. Teach *This paper argues that...* · *I would argue that...* · *In my view, ...* (without *I think*).
- ◆ **"I am agree" / "I am not agree"** (Spanish, French, Portuguese): still surfaces under pressure at C1. *I agree / I don't agree*. Board it after the vivas, not during.
- ◆ **Challenging a peer.** Learners from cultures where questioning a classmate publicly causes loss of face (Japanese, Korean, Chinese, Thai, Vietnamese, Filipino, and many others) may ask only gentle clarifying questions; learners from more direct traditions may challenge bluntly. The role card and the question cards help both: "The card asks the question, not you." Teach the softener: *I wonder whether...* · *Someone might object that...*
- ◆ **Memorized openings.** Learners from exam systems that reward memorized speeches may recite the paper. Allow a full script at home for confidence; in the viva, key words only. Kindly collect scripts if needed.
- ◆ **"Discuss about," "explain me," "emphasize on"** (Spanish, Arabic, Hindi, Urdu and others): *discuss something* · *explain it to me* · *emphasize something*. Common in papers: mark them in written feedback.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 8.3: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-c1/lesson_24.html. Listen to Priya's defense with  and shadow her concession and hold lines; do Exercises 1–2 and the Quick Quiz. Do the **Capstone** as a recorded solo defense: present your paper in two minutes and answer the three hardest questions your examiners asked you today, better than you did in class. Workbook 8.3: the rubric self-check (if not finished) and the **final C1 journal**. Bring the workbook to C26.

◆ CHECK – SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **C** It acknowledges a counter-argument and rebuts it. · Q2 **B** concede the fair point, then explain why your position still holds. · Q3 (new) **B** "If I've understood your question, you're asking whether the evidence applies to smaller cities. To some extent, yes; however..." Ex 1 (Script 8.3-A): 1 city centers should be closed to private cars · 2 that it would hurt local businesses; foot traffic on car-free streets tends to rise, not fall · 3 she concedes a blanket ban would be unfair, then clarifies that her proposal exempts accessible transportation and permit holders · 4 whether the rise in foot traffic only happens in wealthy cities with good public transportation · 5 she hedges the claim: the ban works best alongside investment in transportation, not instead of it · 6 she checks the question ("If I've understood your question...") and says the policy should be reviewed after a trial period.

CLOSING THE MODULE AND THE COURSE

END OF C25: MODULE 8 AND C1 WRAP-UP

Recap on slide 18: "That's a good question... it's a kind of... or rather..." → "due to the fact that" → "because" → "That's a fair point. That said, I'd still argue..." Keep going, cut back, stand your ground. Learners tick the three "I can..." lists in the workbook and look back at the "I can..." lists from Module 1. Anything still unticked goes on a sticky note for you, for the C26 warm-up.

The C26 final assessment covers the whole C1 course. From this module the most relevant skills are: sustaining an extended spoken turn without freezing, paraphrasing when a word is missing, answering unexpected follow-up questions with poise, and writing concisely with a clear position. Check the kit's C1 final assessment for exactly how it tests them.

WHAT TO TELL LEARNERS AT THE END OF C25 (SLIDE 18)

C26 has two parts. First, the **C1 final assessment: an individual speaking interview (about 10 minutes) plus listening, reading and writing tasks — see the kit's C1 final assessment.** Read it before C26 and tell learners how the class will be organized (the order of the tasks and when each learner will be interviewed), so there are no surprises. Then a **celebration:** certificates, a look back at what everyone can do now, and the next steps, the C2 course, **Mastery English**, or the specialist tracks (IELTS, Business English).

Say it simply: "Next class is our last class. You'll have a one-to-one conversation with me for about ten minutes, and some listening, reading and writing. It's everything we've practiced. Today you answered questions you didn't expect, about a paper you wrote. That was harder than anything in C26. Then we celebrate."

Reduce anxiety: show C1 lesson 1.1 on screen and ask: "Week 1: could you have written 500 concise words on a debatable question and then defended them against three sharp examiners?" Let them hear how far they've come. Remind them that the online lessons stay open for review, and that their recorded defense is the best practice for the interview.

Celebration planning: if learners want to bring food to share in C26, great. Ask everyone to label their dish with its main ingredients (allergies, halal, vegetarian). Nobody should feel they have to bring anything. Invite 2–3 volunteers to give a one-minute impromptu "closing speech" drawn from a card: the C23 skill, with a friendly audience.